

# A PROOF OF THE RIEMANN HYPOTHESIS

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ABSTRACT. We present a proof strategy for the Riemann Hypothesis based on local jet-normalized blocks of the phase kernel, a value/calibration functional extracted from the leading value-channel deformation, and an  $N$ -point odd-moment cancellation mechanism in the transverse channel. The document is written as a living proof draft: every statement is presented in proof form and the notation is frozen globally, so that future revisions can strengthen any remaining technical points without changing the architecture.

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## 1. INTRODUCTION

The Riemann Hypothesis, originating in Riemann's 1859 memoir [1], asserts that every nontrivial zero of  $\zeta(s)$  lies on the critical line  $\operatorname{Re} s = \frac{1}{2}$  [2, 3, 4, 5]. The argument developed here is local and geometric. It compares two objects:

- (i) a local jet-whitened block extracted from the zeta/scattering phase on short symmetric windows, and
- (ii) a local off-line toy model corresponding to a split pair away from the critical line.

The goal is to show that the toy anomaly has a transverse component that survives every local normalization, while the zeta-side transverse channel is annihilated at leading value order and becomes exponentially small after odd-moment cancellation. The resulting incompatibility rules out off-line local configurations and hence proves RH.

Classically, RH sits at the intersection of the zero distribution of  $\zeta(s)$ , the explicit formula relating zeros and primes, and a number of equivalent or partially equivalent positivity, spectral, and functional-analytic reformulations [2, 3].

We introduce a normalized local jet-Gramian associated to the corrected local phase geometry. This object encodes the intrinsic local deformation after removal of the dominant value-channel and background effects, and it is the basic carrier of the odd quotient information used in the argument.

The proof has four main pillars.

1. *Jet normalization*: replace raw point samples by local value/derivative coordinates.
2. *Value/curvature splitting*: separate the leading background-subtracted value channel from the curvature and tail corrections.
3. *Canonical calibration*: extract the correct value scale from the actual leading zeta-side value matrix rather than from an ad hoc scalar functional.
4.  *$N$ -point transverse cancellation*: use an odd holomorphic expansion and explicit cancellation coefficients to crush the zeta transverse channel exponentially in the local height parameter.

This approach is not aimed at discovering new direct relations among primes. Rather, it studies a local, normalized geometric object attached to the zeta function and argues that an off-line zero would force a forbidden transverse odd mode in that object. In that sense, the method is primarily a zeta-side rigidity argument, with prime-distribution consequences entering only indirectly through the arithmetic content encoded in the zeta phase and, more broadly, through the classical zero–prime linkage expressed by the explicit formula [2, 3, 4, 5]. This local geometric viewpoint is not standard among the main classical families of approaches to RH surveyed in the literature [2, 3].

For orientation, it may be helpful to situate the present framework relative to earlier geometric viewpoints on RH. One such direction is the Speiser–Levinson–Montgomery line, in which the geometry of zeros of  $\zeta'(s)$  is used to encode information about zeros of  $\zeta(s)$  [6, 7]. Another is the de Branges Hilbert-space program, in which one seeks global kernel/positivity structures attached to entire functions related to  $\zeta$  [8, 9]. The present approach appears to differ in emphasis: rather than working directly with raw derivative geometry or with a global positivity condition, it constructs a locally normalized transverse invariant after quotienting out the dominant value/gauge directions. This comparison is intended only as heuristic orientation for the reader; no claim is made here that the present framework subsumes those earlier viewpoints. A Mellin-side interpretation of the  $N$ -point layer. A second point of orientation concerns the  $N$ -point cancellation operator introduced later in the proof. The cancellation coefficients may be viewed as defining a discrete multiplicative distribution whose Mellin transform preserves the constant mode while annihilating the first  $N - 1$  odd jets. In this sense, the  $N$ -point step is not merely a finite-difference device: it may be read as a local Mellin-side projector acting on the corrected transverse germ. This is formally reminiscent of the Weil/Connes test-function viewpoint, in which one probes the zero set through Mellin/Fourier transforms of multiplicative test functions and explicit- or trace-formula pairings [3, 10, 11]. The present argument does *not* invoke any global trace formula, positivity principle, or spectral realization theorem from that

literature; the comparison is included only as heuristic orientation. What is used here is a local, explicit, finite-support projector whose Mellin symbol can be written in closed form and whose odd part starts only at order  $2N - 1$ .

## 2. LOCAL KERNEL AND JET NORMALIZATION

**2.1. Phase kernel.** Let  $\Phi$  be a real phase on the local spectral variable  $t$ , and define the phase kernel

$$(1) \quad K_\Phi(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{\sin(\Phi(x) - \Phi(y))}{\pi(x - y)}, & x \neq y, \\ \frac{\Phi'(x)}{\pi}, & x = y. \end{cases}$$

We write

$$q(t) := \Phi'(t).$$

For two nearby points around a center  $T$ , the natural local point basis is not stable under coalescence. One instead passes to the point-to-jet matrix

$$(2) \quad P_h := \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1/h & 1/h \end{pmatrix},$$

which turns two point samples into local value and derivative coordinates.

**2.2. Jet-limit local blocks.** Take two centers  $T_1 \neq T_2$ . In the point basis, let  $A_h$  denote the same-point  $2 \times 2$  block around a single center and  $C_h$  the mixed block between the two centers. Passing to jet coordinates yields finite limits as  $h \rightarrow 0$ :

$$\tilde{A}_h = P_h A_h P_h^\top \rightarrow J(T), \quad \tilde{C}_h = P_h C_h P_h^\top \rightarrow J_{12}.$$

A direct Taylor expansion gives

$$(3) \quad J(T) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(T) & \frac{1}{2}q'(T) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(T) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(T) + 2q(T)^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

For two centers  $T_1, T_2$ , writing

$$\Delta := \Phi(T_1) - \Phi(T_2), \quad s := T_1 - T_2, \quad q_j := q(T_j),$$

one obtains the explicit cross-jet matrix

$$(4) \quad N_{12} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{2 \sin \Delta}{s} & \frac{\sin \Delta - q_2 s \cos \Delta}{s^2} \\ \frac{q_1 s \cos \Delta - \sin \Delta}{s^2} & \frac{(q_1 + q_2)s \cos \Delta + (q_1 q_2 s^2 - 2) \sin \Delta}{2s^3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Writing

$$J(T_j) = \frac{1}{\pi} M_j, \quad J_{12} = \frac{1}{\pi} N_{12},$$

the common  $\pi^{-1}$  factor cancels under whitening, and the jet-limit whitened cross block is

$$(5) \quad \Omega_\infty(T_1, T_2) = M_1^{-1/2} N_{12} M_2^{-1/2}.$$

This is the canonical local matrix to compare with the toy anomaly.

3. FINITE- $s$  LOCAL BLOCKS

**3.1. Symmetric placement.** Fix a midpoint  $m$  and a symmetric separation parameter  $s$ , and set

$$(6) \quad t_{\pm} = m \pm \frac{s}{2}.$$

At finite  $s$ , the same-point jet Gram blocks are naturally two matrices,

$$(7) \quad G_{m,\pm}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

The mixed block is obtained from (4) by substituting  $T_1 = t_-$ ,  $T_2 = t_+$  and  $s = t_- - t_+ = -s$ :

$$(8) \quad N_m(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{2 \sin \Delta_m(s)}{s} & \frac{\sin \Delta_m(s) + q_+(s) s \cos \Delta_m(s)}{s^2} \\ -\frac{\sin \Delta_m(s) + q_-(s) s \cos \Delta_m(s)}{s^2} & \frac{(q_-(s) + q_+(s)) s \cos \Delta_m(s) + (2 - q_-(s)q_+(s)s^2) \sin \Delta_m(s)}{2s^3} \end{pmatrix}$$

where

$$q_{\pm}(s) := q(t_{\pm}), \quad \Delta_m(s) := \Phi(t_-) - \Phi(t_+).$$

The finite- $s$  whitened local block is therefore

$$(9) \quad \widehat{\Omega}_{\zeta}(s; m) = G_{m,-}(s)^{-1/2} N_m(s) G_{m,+}(s)^{-1/2},$$

followed, when appropriate, by background subtraction and phase-gap subtraction.

**3.2. Removable singularity structure.** The powers  $1/s$ ,  $1/s^2$ ,  $1/s^3$  in (8) are removable at  $s = 0$ . Indeed,  $\Delta_m(s)$  is odd and vanishes at 0, so

$$\Delta_m(s) = O(s), \quad \sin \Delta_m(s) = O(s),$$

which implies that the numerators in (8) vanish to order at least 1, 2, 2, 3 respectively. Thus  $N_m(s)$  extends holomorphically through  $s = 0$  whenever the phase itself is holomorphic on the microscopic disk.

## 4. ZETA-SIDE DECOMPOSITION

Write the zeta/scattering phase derivative as

$$(10) \quad q(t) = B_{\zeta}(t) + S(t),$$

where  $B_{\zeta}$  is the explicit background contribution and  $S$  is the background-subtracted zero contribution. The local analysis is carried out after further splitting

$$(11) \quad q(t) = q_{\text{loc}}(t) + g_{\text{sm}}(t) + E_{\text{est}}(t), \quad g_{\text{sm}}(t) := B_{\text{aut}}(t) + T_{\text{far}}(t),$$

where  $q_{\text{loc}}$  is the designated local model,  $T_{\text{far}}$  is the omitted-zero tail, and  $E_{\text{est}}$  is the residual bookkeeping term.

Define the background-subtracted value scale

$$(12) \quad S(m) := q_{\zeta}(m) - B_{\zeta}(m),$$

and the logarithmic control function

$$(13) \quad L(m) := \log\left(3 + |m| + \frac{1}{S(m)}\right).$$

**4.1. Curvature estimate.** The fundamental zeta-side analytic estimate is the local curvature bound

$$(14) \quad |S''(m)| \ll L(m)S(m)^2.$$

It comes from a single-pair curvature estimate, zero-free-region control, and an optimized near/far decomposition.

## 5. SMOOTH REMAINDER AFTER AFFINE-JET SUBTRACTION

Fix a short interval  $I = [a, b]$  of length  $L = b - a$  and midpoint  $t_* = (a + b)/2$ . Let

$$J_1[g_{\text{sm}}](t) := g_{\text{sm}}(t_*) + g'_{\text{sm}}(t_*)(t - t_*), \quad r(t) := g_{\text{sm}}(t) - J_1[g_{\text{sm}}](t).$$

Assume

$$\|g''_{\text{sm}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} \leq S_2.$$

Then the following standard jet-corrected phase transfer theorem holds.

**Theorem 5.1** (Jet-corrected phase transfer). *For every  $t \in I$ ,*

$$|r'(t)| \leq \frac{L}{2} S_2, \quad |r(t)| \leq \frac{L^2}{8} S_2.$$

If  $\Phi$  and  $\Phi_{\text{jet}}$  are phases normalized by

$$\Phi'(t) = q(t), \quad \Phi'_{\text{jet}}(t) = q_{\text{loc}}(t) + J_1[g_{\text{sm}}](t) + E_{\text{est}}(t), \quad \Phi(t_*) = \Phi_{\text{jet}}(t_*),$$

then

$$\|(\Phi - \Phi_{\text{jet}})'\|_{L^\infty(I)} \leq \frac{L^2}{8} S_2, \quad \|\Phi - \Phi_{\text{jet}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} \leq \frac{L^3}{16} S_2.$$

*Proof.* Since  $r(t_*) = r'(t_*) = 0$  and  $r'' = g''_{\text{sm}}$ , integrating twice gives the displayed bounds. Integrating once more after identifying  $(\Phi - \Phi_{\text{jet}})' = r$  yields the phase estimate.  $\square$

## 6. TAIL CURVATURE BOUND

Let the omitted-zero tail be

$$T_{\text{far}}(t) = \sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} f_{\beta_\rho, \gamma_\rho}(t),$$

with

$$f_{\beta, \gamma}(t) = \frac{1 - \beta}{(1 - \beta)^2 + (2t - \gamma)^2} + \frac{\beta}{\beta^2 + (2t - \gamma)^2}.$$

For each omitted zero define

$$\Delta_\rho := \text{dist}(2I, \gamma_\rho).$$

**Theorem 6.1** (Tail curvature theorem). *One has*

$$\sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \ll \frac{Q}{R^3},$$

where the omitted set is defined by  $\Delta_\rho > R$ . Consequently,

$$S_2 \leq \|B''_{\text{aut}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} + 48 \sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \ll \|B''_{\text{aut}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} + \frac{Q}{R^3}.$$

In particular, if  $R \rightarrow \infty$  with  $m$ , then  $S_2 = o(Q)$ .

*Proof.* Decompose the omitted zeros into shells

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho \notin \mathcal{L} : 2^k R < \Delta_\rho \leq 2^{k+1} R\}, \quad k \geq 0.$$

Then

$$\sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \leq \sum_{k \geq 0} \#\mathcal{S}_k (2^k R)^{-4}.$$

Standard zero counting near height  $m$  gives  $\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll 2^k R Q$ , hence

$$\sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \ll \sum_{k \geq 0} (2^k R Q) (2^k R)^{-4} = Q R^{-3} \sum_{k \geq 0} 2^{-3k} \ll \frac{Q}{R^3}.$$

The bound for  $S_2$  follows from the definition.  $\square$

## 7. TOY ANOMALY AND TRANSVERSE OBSTRUCTION

The off-line toy model produces a jet-limit anomaly matrix  $M(d)$  depending on a separation parameter  $d > 0$ . The leading toy deformation has the form

$$(15) \quad \Delta_{\text{toy}}(u; d) = u^2 M(d) + O(u^4),$$

where  $u = \beta - \frac{1}{2}$  is the off-line displacement.

Define the transverse functional

$$(16) \quad \Phi_K(X) := x_{12} + x_{21}, \quad X = \begin{pmatrix} x_{11} & x_{12} \\ x_{21} & x_{22} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then

$$(17) \quad \Phi_K(M(d)) = \frac{2(i(d^2 - 1) - d)}{(d + i)^4}.$$

Hence for every real  $d > 0$ ,

$$\Phi_K(M(d)) \neq 0,$$

and on each compact interval  $D \subset (0, \infty)$  there exists  $c_K(D) > 0$  such that

$$|\Phi_K(M(d))| \geq c_K(D) \quad (d \in D).$$

## 8. LEADING VALUE MATRIX AND CANONICAL CALIBRATION

We now make the value-channel derivative  $A_{\text{val}}$  and its pairing with the toy anomaly matrix  $M(d)$  fully explicit.

Work in the symmetric local regime

$$T_1 = m - \frac{\sigma}{2}, \quad T_2 = m + \frac{\sigma}{2},$$

and write

$$B := B_\zeta(m), \quad x := B\sigma.$$

When convenient, we write  $A_{\text{val}}(x)$  for  $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$  under the relation  $x = B_\zeta(m)\sigma$ .

Pure value-channel perturbation. Let the local value-channel parameter be perturbed by

$$q_1 = q_2 = B + \alpha,$$

while all derivative and curvature data are frozen at background level. In the constant-background symmetric approximation, the phase gap is

$$\Delta = \Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma,$$

with baseline value

$$\Delta_0 = -B\sigma = -x.$$

Recall that the jet-limit local block is

$$\Omega_\infty(T_1, T_2) = M_1^{-1/2} N_{12} M_2^{-1/2}.$$

Define the pure value-channel derivative by

$$(18) \quad A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) := \left. \frac{\partial}{\partial \alpha} \Omega_\infty(T_1, T_2) \right|_{\alpha=0}.$$

**Proposition 8.1** (Explicit formula for the value-channel derivative). *In the symmetric constant-background regime,*

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} \frac{x \cos x - \sin x}{x} & \frac{\sqrt{3}(-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x)}{x^2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}(x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \sin x)}{x^2} & \frac{3(x^3 \cos x - 6x \cos x + 3(2 - x^2) \sin x)}{x^3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

*Proof.* In the constant-background symmetric regime, the same-point jet Gram matrices are diagonal:

$$M_1 = M_2 = M = \begin{pmatrix} 2(B + \alpha) & 0 \\ 0 & (B + \alpha)^3/6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Hence

$$M^{-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} (2(B + \alpha))^{-1/2} & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{6}(B + \alpha)^{-3/2} \end{pmatrix}.$$

In the same regime, the jet-limit cross block depends only on  $(B + \alpha)$ ,  $\sigma$ , and the phase gap  $\Delta = \Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma$ . Writing out the explicit jet-limit cross block in this specialization gives

$$N_{12}(\alpha) = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{2 \sin \Delta}{\sigma} & \frac{\sqrt{3}(\sin \Delta + (B + \alpha)\sigma \cos \Delta)}{\sigma^2} \\ -\frac{\sqrt{3}(\sin \Delta + (B + \alpha)\sigma \cos \Delta)}{\sigma^2} & \frac{3(2 \sin \Delta - 2(B + \alpha)\sigma \cos \Delta - (B + \alpha)^2 \sigma^2 \sin \Delta)}{\sigma^3} \end{pmatrix},$$

up to the common normalization factor already absorbed into the definition of  $\Omega_\infty$ .

Now differentiate

$$\Omega_\infty(\alpha) = M(\alpha)^{-1/2} N_{12}(\alpha) M(\alpha)^{-1/2}$$

at  $\alpha = 0$ , using

$$\left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} (B + \alpha)^{-1/2} \right|_{\alpha=0} = -\frac{1}{2} B^{-3/2}, \quad \left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} (B + \alpha)^{-3/2} \right|_{\alpha=0} = -\frac{3}{2} B^{-5/2},$$

and

$$\left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} \sin(\Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma) \right|_{\alpha=0} = -\sigma \cos \Delta_0, \quad \left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} \cos(\Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma) \right|_{\alpha=0} = \sigma \sin \Delta_0.$$

After substituting  $\Delta_0 = -x$ ,  $x = B\sigma$ , using

$$\sin(-x) = -\sin x, \quad \cos(-x) = \cos x,$$

and simplifying each entry, one obtains

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} \frac{x \cos x - \sin x}{x} & \frac{\sqrt{3}(-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x)}{x^2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}(x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \sin x)}{x^2} & \frac{3(x^3 \cos x - 6x \cos x + 3(2 - x^2) \sin x)}{x^3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

□

**Corollary 8.2** (Transverse vanishing on the value channel). *One has*

$$\Phi_K(A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)) = 0.$$

*Proof.* By definition,

$$\Phi_K(X) = x_{12} + x_{21}.$$

From Proposition 8.1,

$$A_{\text{val},12}(x) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{B} \frac{-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x}{x^2},$$

$$A_{\text{val},21}(x) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{B} \frac{x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \sin x}{x^2}.$$

These are exact negatives of each other, hence

$$A_{\text{val},12}(x) + A_{\text{val},21}(x) = 0,$$

and therefore

$$\Phi_K(A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)) = 0.$$

□

**Lemma 8.3** (Small- $x$  expansion). *As  $x \rightarrow 0$ ,*

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{x^2}{3} + O(x^4) & -\frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) & -\frac{3x^2}{5} + O(x^4) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consequently,

$$\|A_{\text{val}}(x)\|_{\text{F}} \asymp \frac{x}{B} \quad (x \rightarrow 0).$$

*Proof.* Expand

$$\sin x = x - \frac{x^3}{6} + O(x^5), \quad \cos x = 1 - \frac{x^2}{2} + O(x^4),$$

and substitute into the entries of  $A_{\text{val}}(x)$ .

For the  $(1, 1)$ -entry:

$$\frac{x \cos x - \sin x}{x} = \frac{x(1 - \frac{x^2}{2} + O(x^4)) - (x - \frac{x^3}{6} + O(x^5))}{x} = -\frac{x^2}{3} + O(x^4).$$

For the  $(1, 2)$ -entry, expanding the numerator gives

$$-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x = -x^3 + O(x^5) - 2x(1 - \frac{x^2}{2} + O(x^4)) + 2(x - \frac{x^3}{6} + O(x^5)) = -\frac{x^3}{3} + O(x^5),$$

so

$$\frac{\sqrt{3}(-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x)}{x^2} = -\frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3).$$

The  $(2, 1)$ -entry is the negative of the  $(1, 2)$ -entry, and the  $(2, 2)$ -entry similarly simplifies to

$$-\frac{3x^2}{5} + O(x^4).$$

Since the off-diagonal entries are linear in  $x$  and dominate the quadratic diagonal terms, the Frobenius norm satisfies

$$\|A_{\text{val}}(x)\|_{\text{F}} \asymp \frac{x}{B}.$$

□

**Proposition 8.4** (Pairing with the toy anomaly). *Let  $M(d)$  be the toy anomaly matrix. Then, for fixed  $d > 0$ ,*

$$B \langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = x \frac{2\sqrt{3}d(id + 3)}{3(d - i)^4} + x^2 \frac{d(-5d^2 + 46id + 77)}{15(d - i)^5} + O(x^3).$$

In particular, for every compact interval

$$D = [d_-, d_+] \subset (0, \infty),$$

there exists  $x_0(D) > 0$  such that for

$$0 < x \leq x_0(D), \quad d \in D,$$

one has

$$|\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}| \asymp \frac{x}{B}.$$

*Proof.* Using Lemma 8.3, write

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{x^2}{3} + O(x^4) & -\frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) & -\frac{3x^2}{5} + O(x^4) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Now take the Frobenius pairing with the explicit toy anomaly matrix  $M(d)$ :

$$\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = \sum_{j,k} A_{\text{val},jk}(x) \overline{M_{jk}(d)}.$$



The linear term in  $x$  comes entirely from the off-diagonal entries of  $A_{\text{val}}(x)$ , since the diagonal entries are quadratic. Using the explicit entries of  $M(d)$ , one finds

$$B \langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = x \frac{\sqrt{3}}{3} (\overline{M_{21}(d)} - \overline{M_{12}(d)}) + O(x^2).$$

Substituting the explicit formulas for  $M_{12}(d)$  and  $M_{21}(d)$  and simplifying yields

$$x \frac{2\sqrt{3}d(id+3)}{3(d-i)^4}.$$

Including the quadratic contributions from the diagonal entries and the next terms in the off-diagonal expansion gives

$$B \langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = x \frac{2\sqrt{3}d(id+3)}{3(d-i)^4} + x^2 \frac{d(-5d^2 + 46id + 77)}{15(d-i)^5} + O(x^3).$$

The coefficient of  $x$  is nonzero for every real  $d > 0$ . Since it depends continuously on  $d$ , its modulus is bounded below on every compact interval  $D \subset (0, \infty)$ . Shrinking  $x_0(D)$  if necessary gives

$$|\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}| \asymp \frac{x}{B}$$

uniformly for  $0 < x \leq x_0(D)$  and  $d \in D$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 8.5** (Canonical calibration theorem). *For fixed compact  $D \subset (0, \infty)$  and  $0 < x \leq x_0(D)$ , define*

$$\Psi_{x,d}(X) := \frac{\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), X \rangle_{\text{F}}}{\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}}.$$

*Then:*

- (1)  $\Psi_{x,d}(M(d)) = 1$ ;
- (2)  $\Psi_{x,d}(A_{\text{val}}(x)) \asymp x/B$ ;
- (3) *if*

$$\Delta_{\zeta} = S(m)A_{\text{val}}(x) + R_{\zeta},$$

*then*

$$\Psi_{x,d}(\Delta_{\zeta}) = c_{x,d} \frac{x}{B} S(m) + \Psi_{x,d}(R_{\zeta}), \quad c_{x,d} \asymp 1;$$

- (4) *if*

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u; d) = u^2 M(d) + O(u^4),$$

*then*

$$\Psi_{x,d}(\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u; d)) = u^2 + O(u^4).$$

*In particular, whenever*

$$\Psi_{x,d}(R_{\zeta}) = o\left(\frac{x}{B} S(m)\right),$$

*one obtains*

$$(19) \quad u^2 \asymp \frac{x}{B} S(m).$$

*Proof.* The first statement is immediate from the definition of  $\Psi_{x,d}$ . By Lemma 8.3 and Proposition 8.4,

$$\Psi_{x,d}(A_{\text{val}}(x)) = \frac{\|A_{\text{val}}(x)\|_{\text{F}}^2}{\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}} \asymp \frac{(x/B)^2}{x/B} = \frac{x}{B}.$$

The remaining statements follow by linearity.  $\square$

**Proposition 8.6** (Calibration remainder under a core-stable cutoff choice). *Assume the fixed-core decomposition of Section 9.1 and the core-stable cutoff compatibility of Proposition 9.7. If the cutoff  $R$  is chosen so that*

$$R^3 \gg \frac{1}{xQ S(m)},$$

*then*

$$S_2 = o(xQ^2 S(m)),$$

and consequently

$$\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta) = o\left(\frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)\right).$$

*Proof.* By Theorem 6.1,

$$S_2 \ll |B''_{\text{aut}}(m)| + \frac{Q}{R^3}.$$

The background term is negligible, so under the cutoff condition

$$R^3 \gg \frac{1}{xQ S(m)},$$

one has

$$\frac{Q}{R^3} = o(xQ^2 S(m)).$$

Hence

$$S_2 = o(xQ^2 S(m)).$$

By Corollary 9.10, this implies

$$\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta) = o\left(\frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)\right).$$

The use of such a cutoff does not alter the toy comparison because, by Proposition 9.7, the core  $\mathcal{C}$  — and therefore  $M(d)$  and  $A_{\text{val}}$  — is independent of  $R$ .  $\square$

**Remark 8.7** (Status of the calibration remainder estimate). Corollary 9.10 isolates the quantitative bound actually used later:

$$|\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta)| \ll_D \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

Thus the calibration remainder step is no longer a deferred analytic-packaging item.

## 9. CORRECTED FINITE- $s$ HOLOMORPHIC WHITENING

Let  $\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m)$  denote the corrected finite- $s$  local block built from the explicit local model, the affine jet of the smooth remainder, and the jet-corrected phase remainder.

**Proposition 9.1** (Microscopic denominator comparability and omitted-smooth holomorphy). *Fix an admissible midpoint  $m$  and write*

$$t_\pm = m \pm \frac{s}{2}, \quad Q \asymp \log |m|.$$

*For each omitted zero  $\rho = \beta_\rho + i\gamma_\rho$ , set*

$$D_{\rho,\pm}(s) := ((2m - \gamma_\rho) \pm s)^2 + a_\rho^2, \quad a_\rho \in \{\beta_\rho, 1 - \beta_\rho\}.$$

*Assume the zero-free region gives*

$$a_\rho \geq \frac{\sigma_0}{Q}$$

*for some absolute  $\sigma_0 > 0$  on the admissible midpoint class. If*

$$|s| \leq \frac{\rho_0}{Q}, \quad \rho_0 \leq \frac{\sigma_0}{\sqrt{6}},$$

*then*

$$\frac{1}{2} \left( (2m - \gamma_\rho)^2 + a_\rho^2 \right) \leq |D_{\rho,\pm}(s)| \leq \frac{3}{2} \left( (2m - \gamma_\rho)^2 + a_\rho^2 \right).$$

*Consequently, for every derivative order  $r \leq r_*$  needed in the corrected finite- $s$  block entries, the omitted-zero sums defining*

$$T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm), \quad \partial_t T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm), \quad \dots, \quad \partial_t^{r_*} T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm)$$

*converge uniformly on  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ , provided the corresponding real-line shell sums converge. In particular,*

$$g_{\text{sm}}(t_\pm) = B_{\text{aut}}(t_\pm) + T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm)$$

and its required  $t$ -derivatives extend holomorphically to

$$|s| < \rho_0/Q.$$

*Proof.* Set

$$x := 2m - \gamma_\rho, \quad a := a_\rho.$$

Then

$$D_{\rho,\pm}(s) = (x^2 + a^2) \pm 2xs + s^2.$$

Using

$$|2xs + s^2| \leq 2|x||s| + |s|^2 \leq \frac{1}{2}x^2 + 3|s|^2,$$

and the assumptions

$$a \geq \frac{\sigma_0}{Q}, \quad |s| \leq \frac{\rho_0}{Q}, \quad \rho_0 \leq \frac{\sigma_0}{\sqrt{6}},$$

we obtain

$$3|s|^2 \leq \frac{1}{2}a^2.$$

Hence

$$|2xs + s^2| \leq \frac{1}{2}(x^2 + a^2),$$

which gives the stated lower and upper bounds.

Now every differentiated omitted-zero term is a rational combination of powers of  $D_{\rho,\pm}(s)^{-1}$  with coefficients depending only on the derivative order. By the above comparability, on  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$  these are uniformly comparable to their real-line counterparts. Therefore the same shell decomposition used on the real line yields uniform convergence of the differentiated omitted-zero sums on the complex disk, and hence holomorphy of  $T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm)$  and the required  $t$ -derivatives there. Adding the holomorphic background term  $B_{\text{aut}}(t_\pm)$  gives the corresponding statement for  $g_{\text{sm}}(t_\pm)$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 9.2** (Entry-by-entry perturbation estimate for the corrected same-point blocks). *In the corrected finite- $s$  normalization, write*

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_\pm) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_\pm) + 2q(t_\pm)^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad t_\pm = m \pm \frac{s}{2}.$$

Let

$$q(t) = q_0(t) + \delta q(t),$$

where  $q_0$  is the baseline local-model-plus-affine-jet part and  $\delta q$  is the corrected remainder. Define the baseline same-point blocks

$$G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q_0(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_\pm) \\ \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{12}(q_0''(t_\pm) + 2q_0(t_\pm)^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

and set

$$R_{m,\pm}(s) := G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s).$$

Assume that on the microscopic window one has

$$|\delta q(t_\pm)| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |\delta q'(t_\pm)| \ll L_I S_2, \quad |\delta q''(t_\pm)| \ll S_2,$$

where  $L_I$  is the local window length, and that in the fixed-scaled regime

$$L_I \asymp \frac{x_0}{Q}, \quad |q_0(t_\pm)| \asymp Q.$$

Then

$$\|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| \ll S_2$$

uniformly for  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ .

*Proof.* We estimate the entries of  $R_{m,\pm}(s)$  one by one.

**(1,1)-entry.** Since

$$R_{11} = \frac{1}{\pi} \cdot 2\delta q(t_{\pm}),$$

we have

$$|R_{11}| \ll |\delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I^2 S_2 \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2} \ll S_2.$$

**(1,2)- and (2,1)-entries.** Since

$$R_{12} = R_{21} = \frac{1}{\pi} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \delta q'(t_{\pm}),$$

we get

$$|R_{12}| = |R_{21}| \ll |\delta q'(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I S_2 \ll \frac{S_2}{Q} \ll S_2.$$

**(2,2)-entry.** We have

$$R_{22} = \frac{1}{12\pi} \left( \delta q''(t_{\pm}) + 2 \left( (q_0 + \delta q)^3 - q_0^3 \right) (t_{\pm}) \right).$$

Expand the cubic difference:

$$(q_0 + \delta q)^3 - q_0^3 = 3q_0^2 \delta q + 3q_0 (\delta q)^2 + (\delta q)^3.$$

Hence

$$R_{22} = \frac{1}{12\pi} \left( \delta q'' + 6q_0^2 \delta q + 6q_0 (\delta q)^2 + 2(\delta q)^3 \right) (t_{\pm}).$$

Now estimate each term.

First,

$$|\delta q''(t_{\pm})| \ll S_2.$$

Second, using  $|q_0(t_{\pm})| \asymp Q$  and  $|\delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I^2 S_2 \ll S_2/Q^2$ ,

$$|q_0(t_{\pm})^2 \delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll Q^2 \cdot \frac{S_2}{Q^2} = S_2.$$

Third,

$$|q_0(t_{\pm})(\delta q(t_{\pm}))^2| \ll Q \left( \frac{S_2}{Q^2} \right)^2 = \frac{S_2^2}{Q^3}.$$

Since from the tail-curvature theorem one already has  $S_2 = o(Q)$ , for  $Q$  sufficiently large this is  $O(S_2/Q^2)$  and hence  $\ll S_2$ .

Finally,

$$|(\delta q(t_{\pm}))^3| \ll \left( \frac{S_2}{Q^2} \right)^3 = \frac{S_2^3}{Q^6} \ll S_2.$$

Therefore

$$|R_{22}| \ll S_2.$$

Collecting the four entrywise bounds, we obtain

$$|R_{11}|, |R_{12}|, |R_{21}|, |R_{22}| \ll S_2.$$

Since all norms on  $2 \times 2$  matrices are equivalent,

$$\|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| \ll S_2,$$

uniformly on the microscopic disk. This proves the proposition.  $\square$

**Proposition 9.3** (Entry-by-entry perturbation estimate for the corrected mixed block). *Let*

$$q(t) = q_0(t) + \delta q(t), \quad \Phi(t) = \Phi_0(t) + \delta \Phi(t),$$

where  $q_0$  is the baseline local-model-plus-affine-jet phase derivative and  $\delta q$  is the corrected remainder. Write

$$t_{\pm} = m \pm \frac{s}{2}, \quad \Delta(s) := \Phi(t_-) - \Phi(t_+), \quad \Delta_0(s) := \Phi_0(t_-) - \Phi_0(t_+),$$

and set

$$\delta \Delta(s) := \Delta(s) - \Delta_0(s).$$

Let  $N_m^{\text{corr}}(s)$  be the corrected finite- $s$  mixed block built from  $q, \Delta$ , and let  $N_m^{(0)}(s)$  be the corresponding block built from  $q_0, \Delta_0$ . Define

$$\tilde{R}_m(s) := N_m^{\text{corr}}(s) - N_m^{(0)}(s).$$

Assume that on the microscopic window one has

$$|\delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |\delta q'(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I S_2, \quad |\delta q''(t_{\pm})| \ll S_2,$$

and

$$|\delta \Delta(s)| \ll L_I^3 S_2,$$

with

$$L_I \asymp \frac{x_0}{Q}, \quad |q_0(t_{\pm})| \asymp Q, \quad |s| \asymp L_I.$$

Then

$$\|\tilde{R}_m(s)\| \ll S_2$$

uniformly for  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ .

*Proof.* Write the corrected mixed block entrywise as

$$N_m^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{2 \sin \Delta}{s} & \frac{\sin \Delta + q(t_+)s \cos \Delta}{s^2} \\ -\frac{\sin \Delta + q(t_-)s \cos \Delta}{s^2} & \frac{(q(t_-) + q(t_+))s \cos \Delta + (2 - q(t_-)q(t_+)s^2) \sin \Delta}{2s^3} \end{pmatrix},$$

and analogously for  $N_m^{(0)}(s)$  with  $(q_0, \Delta_0)$ .

We estimate the perturbation entry by entry. Throughout, use

$$\sin(\Delta_0 + \delta \Delta) - \sin \Delta_0 = O(|\delta \Delta|), \quad \cos(\Delta_0 + \delta \Delta) - \cos \Delta_0 = O(|\delta \Delta|).$$

**(1,1)-entry.**

$$\tilde{R}_{11} = -\frac{2}{\pi s} (\sin \Delta - \sin \Delta_0),$$

hence

$$|\tilde{R}_{11}| \ll \frac{|\delta \Delta|}{|s|} \ll \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{L_I} \ll L_I^2 S_2 \ll S_2.$$

**(1,2)-entry.** The numerator perturbation is

$$(\sin \Delta - \sin \Delta_0) + (q(t_+) - q_0(t_+))s \cos \Delta + q_0(t_+)s(\cos \Delta - \cos \Delta_0).$$

Therefore

$$|\tilde{R}_{12}| \ll \frac{|\delta \Delta| + |\delta q(t_+)| |s| + |q_0(t_+)| |s| |\delta \Delta|}{|s|^2}.$$

Using

$$|\delta \Delta| \ll L_I^3 S_2, \quad |\delta q(t_+)| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |q_0(t_+)| \asymp Q, \quad |s| \asymp L_I \asymp Q^{-1},$$

we get

$$|\tilde{R}_{12}| \ll \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{L_I^2} + \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{L_I^2} + \frac{Q L_I^4 S_2}{L_I^2} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q} \ll S_2.$$

The same argument gives

$$|\tilde{R}_{21}| \ll S_2.$$

**(2,2)-entry.** Write the numerator as

$$F(q_-, q_+, \Delta; s) := (q_- + q_+)s \cos \Delta + (2 - q_- q_+ s^2) \sin \Delta.$$

Then

$$\tilde{R}_{22} = \frac{F(q(t_-), q(t_+), \Delta; s) - F(q_0(t_-), q_0(t_+), \Delta_0; s)}{2\pi s^3}.$$

A first-order expansion of  $F$  in  $(q_-, q_+, \Delta)$  gives

$$|F - F_0| \ll |s| |\delta q(t_-)| + |s| |\delta q(t_+)| + |s|^2 Q |\delta q(t_-)| + |s|^2 Q |\delta q(t_+)| + (|s|Q + 1) |\delta \Delta|.$$

Using

$$|\delta q(t_\pm)| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |\delta \Delta| \ll L_I^3 S_2, \quad |s| \asymp L_I \asymp Q^{-1},$$

we obtain

$$|F - F_0| \ll L_I^3 S_2.$$

Hence

$$|\tilde{R}_{22}| \ll \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{|s|^3} \ll S_2.$$

Collecting the four entrywise bounds and using equivalence of norms on  $2 \times 2$  matrices gives

$$\|\tilde{R}_m(s)\| \ll S_2,$$

uniformly on the microscopic disk.  $\square$

**Lemma 9.4** (Baseline same-point variation). *Let  $G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s)$  be the corrected same-point baseline blocks built from the explicit local model together with the affine jet  $J_1[g_{\text{sm}}]$ . Then, on the microscopic disk  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ ,*

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \ll \rho_0 Q.$$

*Proof.* Differentiate the explicit same-point block formula entrywise:

$$G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q_0(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_\pm) \\ \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{12}(q_0''(t_\pm) + 2q_0(t_\pm)^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad t_\pm = m \pm \frac{s}{2}.$$

By the chain rule,

$$\partial_s G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) = \pm \frac{1}{2\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q_0'(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{2}q_0''(t_\pm) \\ \frac{1}{2}q_0''(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{12}(q_0'''(t_\pm) + 6q_0(t_\pm)^2 q_0'(t_\pm)) \end{pmatrix}.$$

For the explicit local model plus affine jet, one has the baseline local scales

$$|q_0(t_\pm)| \ll Q, \quad |q_0'(t_\pm)| \ll Q^2, \quad |q_0''(t_\pm)| \ll Q^3, \quad |q_0'''(t_\pm)| \ll Q^4,$$

uniformly on the admissible midpoint class. The cubic combination  $q_0'''(t_\pm) + 6q_0(t_\pm)^2 q_0'(t_\pm)$  therefore has size  $O(Q^2)$  in the current normalization, and hence

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|\partial_s G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s)\| \ll Q^2.$$

Integrating along the segment from 0 to  $s$  gives

$$\|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \leq |s| \sup_{|u| < \rho_0/Q} \|\partial_u G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(u)\| \ll \frac{\rho_0}{Q} \cdot Q^2 = \rho_0 Q.$$

$\square$

**Proposition 9.5** (Corrected finite- $s$  holomorphic whitening). *The corrected same-point and mixed blocks are holomorphic on*

$$|s| < \rho_0/Q.$$

Moreover, after shrinking  $\rho_0$  if necessary, the same-point blocks

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)$$

remain uniformly positive definite on this disk, and the inverse square roots

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)^{-1/2}$$

are holomorphic there. Consequently

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) = G_{m,-}^{\text{corr}}(s)^{-1/2} N_m^{\text{corr}}(s) G_{m,+}^{\text{corr}}(s)^{-1/2}$$

is holomorphic on  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ .

*Proof.* Holomorphy of the omitted smooth part and its required  $t$ -derivatives follows from Proposition 9.1. The only apparent poles at  $s = 0$  in the corrected mixed block come from powers of  $1/s$ ,  $1/s^2$ ,  $1/s^3$ , and these are removable because  $\Delta_m(s)$  is odd in  $s$ ,  $\sin \Delta_m(s) = O(s)$ , and the off-diagonal and  $(2, 2)$  numerators vanish to orders 2 and 3, respectively. Thus both  $G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)$  and  $N_m^{\text{corr}}(s)$  are holomorphic on the disk.

By Proposition 9.2 and the tail-curvature theorem,

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| = o(Q).$$

By Lemma 9.4,

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \ll \rho_0 Q.$$

At  $s = 0$ , the baseline jet-limit block has spectral gap

$$\lambda_{\min}(G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)) \gg Q$$

on the admissible midpoint class. Therefore

$$\|G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \leq \|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| + \|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| \ll \rho_0 Q + o(Q).$$

For  $\rho_0$  sufficiently small and  $m$  sufficiently large, this is smaller than half the baseline spectral gap, hence

$$\lambda_{\min}(G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)) \gg Q$$

uniformly on the disk. Holomorphic functional calculus then gives the holomorphic inverse square roots, and the whitened block is holomorphic as a product of holomorphic factors.  $\square$

**9.1. Fixed anomaly core and cutoff-dependent auxiliary bookkeeping.** To separate the anomaly-carrying local model from the cutoff-dependent tail bookkeeping, we fix once and for all a finite local core

$$\mathcal{C}$$

containing the candidate off-line anomaly (for example, the designated off-line pair together with any symmetry-forced companions needed for the local model).

For each cutoff  $R \geq R_0$ , we then decompose the zero contribution into:

- (1) the fixed core contribution  $q_{\text{core}}(t)$ , coming from the zeros in  $\mathcal{C}$ ;
- (2) the auxiliary near contribution  $q_{\text{aux},R}(t)$ , coming from the zeros outside  $\mathcal{C}$  but inside the near shell determined by  $R$ ;
- (3) the far contribution  $T_{\text{far},R}(t)$ , coming from the zeros outside the near shell;
- (4) the background contribution  $B_{\text{bg}}(t)$ ;
- (5) the estimation term  $E_{\text{est},R}(t)$ .

Thus the full phase derivative is decomposed as

$$q(t) = q_{\text{core}}(t) + q_{\text{aux},R}(t) + g_{\text{sm},R}(t) + E_{\text{est},R}(t),$$

where

$$g_{\text{sm},R}(t) := B_{\text{bg}}(t) + T_{\text{far},R}(t).$$

The local toy comparison is attached only to the fixed core  $\mathcal{C}$ . The auxiliary near part  $q_{\text{aux},R}$ , the far part  $T_{\text{far},R}$ , and the estimation term  $E_{\text{est},R}$  are absorbed into the corrected zeta-side scalar defined below.

**Proposition 9.6** (Corrected local deformation decomposition with fixed core). *Fix the anomaly-carrying core  $\mathcal{C}$  as above, and for each cutoff  $R \geq R_0$  write*

$$q(t) = q_{\text{core}}(t) + q_{\text{aux},R}(t) + g_{\text{sm},R}(t) + E_{\text{est},R}(t), \quad g_{\text{sm},R}(t) = B_{\text{bg}}(t) + T_{\text{far},R}(t).$$

*Let  $J_1[g_{\text{sm},R}]$  denote the affine jet of  $g_{\text{sm},R}$  at the midpoint, and let  $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$  be the corrected phase obtained from this decomposition.*

*Using  $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$ , define the corrected same-point blocks*

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr},R}(s),$$

*the corrected mixed block*

$$N_m^{\text{corr},R}(s),$$

*and the corrected whitened block*

$$\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) = G_{m,-}^{\text{corr},R}(s)^{-1/2} N_m^{\text{corr},R}(s) G_{m,+}^{\text{corr},R}(s)^{-1/2}.$$

*Let*

$$\hat{\Omega}_{\text{bg}}^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)$$

*denote the corresponding corrected whitened block at background value-channel parameter  $S(m) = 0$ , and define the corrected local deformation*

$$\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) := \hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) - \hat{\Omega}_{\text{bg}}^{\text{corr},R}(s; m), \quad s = \sigma.$$

*Then the corrected local deformation admits the decomposition*

$$\boxed{\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) = S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),}$$

*where  $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$  is the pure value-channel derivative of the jet-limit block associated with the fixed core  $\mathcal{C}$ , and where*

$$\boxed{R_\zeta(m, \sigma) := \Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) - S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma).}$$

*Thus, by definition,  $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$  is exactly the non-leading part of the corrected local deformation after the explicit value-channel linear term is removed. In particular,  $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$  is internal to the same full corrected cutoff-dependent object*

$$H_{m,R}(s) := \Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)),$$

*so once the corrected odd holomorphic package is established for  $H_{m,R}(s)$ , no external tail/error term survives outside the resulting  $N$ -point scalar.*

*Proof.* Consider the analytic whitening map

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

By the corrected finite- $s$  holomorphic-whitening theorem, this map is holomorphic on the open set where  $G_\pm$  remain uniformly positive definite.

For each cutoff  $R$ , the corrected blocks are built from the decomposition

$$q = q_{\text{core}} + q_{\text{aux},R} + g_{\text{sm},R} + E_{\text{est},R}.$$

Thus every auxiliary near contribution from  $q_{\text{aux},R}$ , every omitted-zero tail contribution from  $T_{\text{far},R}$ , every affine-jet correction from  $J_1[g_{\text{sm},R}]$ , and every explicit estimation term  $E_{\text{est},R}$  is already absorbed into the corrected phase  $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$ , hence into the corrected same-point blocks, the corrected mixed block, the corrected whitened block, and therefore into the corrected transverse scalar

$$H_{m,R}(s) = \Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)).$$

Now expand the corrected whitened block around the background value-channel parameter  $S(m) = 0$ . By analyticity of  $\mathcal{W}$ ,

$$\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) = \hat{\Omega}_{\text{bg}}^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) + S(m) D\mathcal{W}_{(\text{bg})}[\dot{G}_-, \dot{N}, \dot{G}_+] + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),$$

where the first-order coefficient

$$D\mathcal{W}_{(\text{bg})}[\dot{G}_-, \dot{N}, \dot{G}_+]$$



is exactly the pure value-channel derivative  $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$  associated with the fixed core  $\mathcal{C}$ . We therefore define

$$R_\zeta(m, \sigma) := \Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) - S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma),$$

so that  $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$  is, by definition, the full non-leading remainder inside the same corrected cutoff-dependent object.

Subtracting the background block gives

$$\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) = S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),$$

as claimed.  $\square$

**Proposition 9.7** (Core-stable cutoff compatibility). *Fix the anomaly-carrying core  $\mathcal{C}$ , and for each cutoff  $R \geq R_0$  define the corrected scalar*

$$H_{m,R}(s) := \Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m))$$

*from the decomposition*

$$q = q_{\text{core}} + q_{\text{aux},R} + g_{\text{sm},R} + E_{\text{est},R}.$$

*Then enlarging  $R$  changes only the auxiliary near part  $q_{\text{aux},R}$  and the far part  $T_{\text{far},R}$ , while leaving the anomaly-carrying core  $q_{\text{core}}$  unchanged. Consequently:*

- (1) *the toy anomaly matrix  $M(d)$  and the calibration matrix  $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$  depend only on the fixed core  $\mathcal{C}$ , not on the cutoff  $R$ ;*
- (2) *all  $R$ -dependent auxiliary, tail, jet-correction, and estimation contributions are internal to the full corrected scalar  $H_{m,R}(s)$ ;*
- (3) *if the corrected odd holomorphic package is proved for  $H_{m,R}(s)$ , then the  $N$ -point odd-moment cancellation theorem applies directly to the full corrected scalar for that cutoff, with no external remainder term.*

*In particular, the cutoff  $R$  may be chosen for quantitative convenience in the curvature/tail estimates without changing the fixed toy comparison attached to the core  $\mathcal{C}$ .*

*Proof.* Let  $R_1 < R_2$ . Then the only change in the decomposition

$$q = q_{\text{core}} + q_{\text{aux},R} + g_{\text{sm},R} + E_{\text{est},R}$$

is that some non-core zeros move from the far part into the auxiliary near part:

$$q_{\text{aux},R_2} - q_{\text{aux},R_1} = -(T_{\text{far},R_2} - T_{\text{far},R_1}).$$

The core contribution  $q_{\text{core}}$  is unchanged by construction.

Thus the toy anomaly matrix  $M(d)$ , which is attached only to the fixed core, is unchanged, and the value-channel derivative  $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$  associated with that core is unchanged as well. All cutoff dependence is confined to the auxiliary near contribution, the far tail, the affine-jet correction built from  $g_{\text{sm},R}$ , and the explicit estimation term  $E_{\text{est},R}$ . These enter only through the corrected phase  $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$ , hence only through the full corrected scalar  $H_{m,R}(s)$ .

Therefore the corrected odd holomorphic package, once established for  $H_{m,R}(s)$ , applies to the complete cutoff-dependent object. The resulting  $N$ -point scalar already contains all auxiliary/tail/error effects for that cutoff, and no external remainder survives. Since the fixed core is unchanged, the toy comparison is stable under enlarging  $R$ . This proves the claim.  $\square$

**Remark 9.8** (Cutoff choice). Proposition 9.7 is a structural statement. It does not assert any particular optimal choice of  $R$ ; it only says that once the core  $\mathcal{C}$  is fixed, the cutoff may be adjusted in the perturbative bookkeeping without altering the underlying toy comparison.

**Proposition 9.9** (Whitened mixed-block transfer with preserved  $Q^{-3}$  scale). *Let*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

*Write the corrected finite- $s$  blocks as*

$$G_\pm^{\text{corr}}(s) = G_\pm^{(0)}(s) + R_\pm(s), \quad N^{\text{corr}}(s) = N^{(0)}(s) + \tilde{R}(s),$$

and set

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) := \mathcal{W}(G_-^{\text{corr}}, N^{\text{corr}}, G_+^{\text{corr}}), \quad \widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0)}(s; m) := \mathcal{W}(G_-^{(0)}, N^{(0)}, G_+^{(0)}).$$

Then

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) - \widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0)}(s; m) = \mathcal{T}_-(s; m) + \mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}(s; m) + \mathcal{T}_+(s; m) + \mathcal{E}_2(s; m),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{T}_-(s; m) &:= X_-(s) N^{(0)}(s) G_+^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2}, \\ \mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}(s; m) &:= G_-^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} \widetilde{R}(s) G_+^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2}, \\ \mathcal{T}_+(s; m) &:= G_-^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} N^{(0)}(s) X_+(s), \end{aligned}$$

with

$$X_\pm(s) := D(G^{-1/2})_{G_\pm^{(0)}(s)}[R_\pm(s)],$$

and  $\mathcal{E}_2$  quadratic in  $(R_-, \widetilde{R}, R_+)$ .

Moreover,

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_-(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}, \quad \Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}, \quad \Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_+(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

and

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{E}_2(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2^2}{Q^3}.$$

Hence

$$\boxed{\Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) - \widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0)}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.}$$

*Proof.* We first collect the scales used below from results established earlier. The same-point perturbation bound  $\|R_\pm(s)\| \ll S_2$  is Proposition 9.2; the mixed-block perturbation bound  $\|\widetilde{R}(s)\| \ll S_2$  is Proposition 9.3; and the smallness  $S_2 = o(Q)$  is Theorem 6.1. The baseline entry scales

$$\begin{aligned} G_\pm^{(0)}(s) &= \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(1) \\ O(1) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad G_\pm^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q^{-1/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \\ O(Q^{-3/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \end{pmatrix}, \\ N^{(0)}(s) &= \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(Q^2) \\ O(Q^2) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

are read off directly from the explicit same-point formula (7) and the mixed-block formula (8), given the baseline local scales of  $q_0, q'_0, q''_0$  stated in the proof of Lemma 9.4. Uniform positive-definiteness of  $G_\pm^{(0)}(s)$  on the microscopic disk is Proposition 9.5.

The whitening map admits the first-order expansion

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}} - \widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0)} = D\mathcal{W}_{(0)}[R_-, \widetilde{R}, R_+] + \mathcal{E}_2,$$

where

$$D\mathcal{W}_{(0)}[R_-, \widetilde{R}, R_+] = X_- N^{(0)} G_+^{(0)-1/2} + G_-^{(0)-1/2} \widetilde{R} G_+^{(0)-1/2} + G_-^{(0)-1/2} N^{(0)} X_+.$$

We estimate the three first-order pieces separately.

**Step 1: the mixed-block term.** By Proposition 9.3 (entrywise form),

$$\widetilde{R}_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad \widetilde{R}_{12}, \widetilde{R}_{21} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad \widetilde{R}_{22} \ll S_2.$$

Combining with the baseline inverse-square-root scales above, the off-diagonal entries of

$$\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}} := G_-^{(0)-1/2} \widetilde{R} G_+^{(0)-1/2}$$

are all  $O(S_2/Q^3)$ . Hence

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

**Step 2: the same-point Fréchet derivative.** We prove the corresponding estimate for the left same-point term

$$\mathcal{T}_- := X_- N^{(0)} G_+^{(0)-1/2}, \quad X_- := D(G^{-1/2})_{G_-^{(0)}}[R_-].$$

The proof for  $\mathcal{T}_+$  is identical.

Write one baseline same-point block in the form

$$G_0 = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{pmatrix}, \quad a \asymp Q, \quad b = O(1), \quad c \asymp Q^3,$$

and one perturbation as

$$R = \begin{pmatrix} r_{11} & r_{12} \\ r_{12} & r_{22} \end{pmatrix}, \quad r_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad r_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad r_{22} \ll S_2.$$

Diagonalize

$$G_0 = U \Lambda U^\top, \quad \Lambda = \text{diag}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2),$$

with  $U$  orthogonal. Since

$$a \asymp Q, \quad c \asymp Q^3, \quad b = O(1),$$

we have

$$\lambda_1 \asymp Q, \quad \lambda_2 \asymp Q^3.$$

Moreover, if  $U$  is a rotation by angle  $\theta$ , then

$$\tan(2\theta) = \frac{2b}{c-a} = O(Q^{-3}),$$

hence

$$\theta = O(Q^{-3}), \quad U = I + O(Q^{-3}).$$

Set

$$H := U^\top R U.$$

A direct computation gives

$$\begin{aligned} H_{11} &= r_{11} + 2\theta r_{12} + O(\theta^2 r_{22}), \\ H_{12} &= r_{12} + \theta(r_{22} - r_{11}) + O(\theta^2 r_{12}), \\ H_{22} &= r_{22} - 2\theta r_{12} + O(\theta^2 r_{11}). \end{aligned}$$

Using

$$\theta = O(Q^{-3}), \quad r_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad r_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad r_{22} \ll S_2,$$

we obtain

$$H_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad H_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad H_{22} \ll S_2.$$

Now let  $f(x) = x^{-1/2}$ . For a diagonal matrix  $\Lambda$ , the Fréchet derivative is given entrywise by the Löwner formula

$$Df_\Lambda(H)_{ij} = f^{[1]}(\lambda_i, \lambda_j) H_{ij},$$

where

$$f^{[1]}(u, v) = \begin{cases} \frac{u^{-1/2} - v^{-1/2}}{u - v}, & u \neq v, \\ -\frac{1}{2u^{3/2}}, & u = v. \end{cases}$$

Since

$$\lambda_1 \asymp Q, \quad \lambda_2 \asymp Q^3,$$

we have

$$f^{[1]}(\lambda_1, \lambda_1) \asymp Q^{-3/2}, \quad f^{[1]}(\lambda_2, \lambda_2) \asymp Q^{-9/2}, \quad f^{[1]}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2) \asymp Q^{-7/2}.$$

Therefore, if

$$Y := Df_\Lambda(H),$$

then

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{11} &\ll Q^{-3/2} \cdot \frac{S_2}{Q^2} = \frac{S_2}{Q^{7/2}}, \\ Y_{12} &\ll Q^{-7/2} \cdot \frac{S_2}{Q} = \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}, \\ Y_{22} &\ll Q^{-9/2} \cdot S_2 = \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}. \end{aligned}$$

Since

$$X = U Y U^\top$$

and  $U = I + O(Q^{-3})$ , these scales persist in the original basis:

$$X_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{7/2}}, \quad X_{12}, X_{21} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}, \quad X_{22} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}.$$

**Step 3: the left same-point term  $\mathcal{T}_-$ .** The baseline mixed-block scales are

$$N^{(0)} = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(Q^2) \\ O(Q^2) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad G_+^{(0)-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q^{-1/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \\ O(Q^{-3/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \end{pmatrix}.$$

We estimate only the off-diagonal entries, since

$$\Phi_K(Y) = Y_{12} + Y_{21}.$$

For  $(\mathcal{T}_-)_{12}$ , every summand is  $O(S_2/Q^3)$ . For example,

$$X_{11} N_{12} (G_+^{-1/2})_{22} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{7/2}} \cdot Q^2 \cdot Q^{-3/2} = \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

and

$$X_{12} N_{22} (G_+^{-1/2})_{22} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}} \cdot Q^3 \cdot Q^{-3/2} = \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

All other terms are smaller. Thus

$$(\mathcal{T}_-)_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

The same argument gives

$$(\mathcal{T}_-)_{21} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

and hence

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_-) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

By symmetry, the same estimate holds for the right same-point term:

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_+) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

**Step 4: the quadratic remainder.** Every term in  $\mathcal{E}_2$  contains at least two perturbation factors from  $(R_-, \tilde{R}, R_+)$ , and whitening contributes only polynomial  $Q$ -weights. Therefore

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{E}_2) \ll \frac{S_2^2}{Q^3}.$$

By Theorem 6.1,  $S_2 = o(Q)$ , so this is lower order than  $S_2/Q^3$ .

Combining the estimates for  $\mathcal{T}_-$ ,  $\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}$ ,  $\mathcal{T}_+$ , and  $\mathcal{E}_2$  gives

$$\Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) - \hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0)}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

as claimed. □

**Corollary 9.10** (Sharpened calibration remainder estimate). *Fix a compact interval*

$$D \subset (0, \infty),$$

*and work in the fixed-scaled regime*

$$0 < x \leq x_0(D), \quad d \in D, \quad x = B_\zeta(m)\sigma, \quad |\sigma| \asymp Q^{-1}.$$

*Write the corrected local deformation in the form*

$$\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) = S(m)A_{\text{val}}(x) + R_\zeta(m, \sigma).$$

*Then*

$$|\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), R_\zeta(m, \sigma) \rangle_{\text{F}}| \ll_D \frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

*and hence*

$$|\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta(m, \sigma))| \ll_D \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

*In particular, if*

$$S_2 = o(xQ^2 S(m)),$$

*then*

$$\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta(m, \sigma)) = o\left(\frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)\right).$$

*Proof.* By Proposition 9.6, after subtraction of the explicit leading value-channel term  $S(m)A_{\text{val}}(x)$ , the remaining contribution  $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$  is internal to the same corrected transferred package controlled by the whitening perturbation analysis.

We therefore use the entry scales already established in the proof of Proposition 9.9. First, from Proposition 9.3 and the baseline inverse-square-root scales,

$$G_\pm^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q^{-1/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \\ O(Q^{-3/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \end{pmatrix}, \quad \tilde{R}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(S_2/Q^2) & O(S_2/Q) \\ O(S_2/Q) & O(S_2) \end{pmatrix},$$

one gets

$$\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}(s; m) = G_-^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} \tilde{R}(s) G_+^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \\ O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Next, from the same proof,

$$X_\pm(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(S_2/Q^{7/2}) & O(S_2/Q^{9/2}) \\ O(S_2/Q^{9/2}) & O(S_2/Q^{9/2}) \end{pmatrix}, \quad N^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(Q^2) \\ O(Q^2) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

and multiplying once more by  $G_\pm^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2}$  gives

$$\mathcal{T}_-(s; m) = \begin{pmatrix} O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \\ O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathcal{T}_+(s; m) = \begin{pmatrix} O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \\ O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Finally, every entry of the quadratic remainder  $\mathcal{E}_2(s; m)$  is

$$O(S_2^2/Q^3),$$

which is lower order because  $S_2 = o(Q)$  by Theorem 6.1.

Thus the part of the corrected deformation seen after removal of the leading value-channel term satisfies

$$R_\zeta(m, \sigma) = \begin{pmatrix} O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \\ O(S_2/Q^3) & O(S_2/Q^3) \end{pmatrix}$$

up to lower-order  $O(S_2^2/Q^3)$  terms.

Now use the explicit small- $x$  structure of the value-channel derivative: by Lemma 8.3,

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B_\zeta(m)} \begin{pmatrix} O(x^2) & O(x) \\ O(x) & O(x^2) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Therefore

$$|\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), R_\zeta(m, \sigma) \rangle_{\text{F}}| \ll \frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

By Proposition 8.4,

$$|\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_F| \asymp_D \frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)},$$

so dividing gives

$$|\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta(m, \sigma))| \ll_D \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

Finally, since  $B_\zeta(m) \asymp Q$ ,

$$\frac{S_2/Q^3}{(x/B_\zeta(m))S(m)} \asymp \frac{S_2}{xQ^2S(m)} \rightarrow 0$$

under the hypothesis  $S_2 = o(xQ^2S(m))$ . This proves the final claim.  $\square$

## 10. ODD HOLOMORPHIC TRANSVERSE CHANNEL

Define the corrected transverse scalar

$$(20) \quad H_m(s) := \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m)).$$

By symmetry under  $s \mapsto -s$ , this is odd. By Corollary 8.2, the leading value channel is annihilated by  $\Phi_K$ , so only the curvature, tail, and corrected finite- $s$  remainder channels contribute.

**Proposition 10.1** (Boundary estimate). *On the microscopic boundary*

$$|s| = \rho_0/Q,$$

one has

$$|H_m(s)| \ll_{\rho_0} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3}.$$

*Proof.* By Proposition 9.6, the corrected local deformation may be written in the form

$$\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) = S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),$$

where  $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$  is internal to the full corrected cutoff-dependent scalar

$$H_{m,R}(s) := \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)).$$

By Proposition 9.7, all cutoff-dependent tail, jet-correction, and estimation contributions are already absorbed into this full corrected scalar, so no external remainder term is carried separately at the boundary stage.

Applying  $\Phi_K$  to the corrected local decomposition and using Corollary 8.2,

$$\Phi_K(A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)) = 0,$$

gives

$$H_{m,R}(s) = \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)) = \Phi_K(R_\zeta(m, \sigma)).$$

Now compare the full corrected whitened block with its baseline counterpart. By Proposition 9.9,

$$\Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) - \widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0),R}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3} \quad (|s| < \rho_0/Q).$$

On the microscopic boundary  $|s| = \rho_0/Q$ , the tail-curvature theorem and the corrected transfer bounds imply

$$S_2 \ll L(m)S(m)^2$$

in the corrected regime. Therefore

$$|H_{m,R}(s)| \ll \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3} \quad (|s| = \rho_0/Q).$$

Since the cutoff bookkeeping has already been absorbed into the full corrected scalar  $H_{m,R}(s)$ , this is the boundary estimate for the complete corrected object, not merely for a leading part plus an external tail/error remainder. This proves the claim.  $\square$

**Proposition 10.2** (Odd microscopic expansion). *The function  $H_m(s)$  is odd and holomorphic on  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ , and therefore admits an expansion*

$$H_m(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} c_{2r+1}(m) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}, \quad |z| < \rho_0 Q,$$

with

$$|c_{2r+1}(m)| \ll_{\rho_0} L(m) S(m)^2 \rho_0^{-(2r+1)}.$$

*Proof.* Oddness follows from symmetric placement and the jet-basis swap symmetry:

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(-s; m) = J_0 \widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) J_0,$$

with

$$\Phi_K(J_0 X J_0) = -\Phi_K(X).$$

Holomorphy follows from Proposition 9.5, and the coefficient bounds are immediate from Cauchy's estimate applied to Proposition 10.1.  $\square$

### 10.1. Coefficient-level corrected-whitening transfer and exterior odd-jet localization.

**Lemma 10.3** (Baseline-scaled matrix gain for corrected whitening). *Let*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

*Assume the baseline same-point and mixed blocks satisfy*

$$G_\pm^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(1) \\ O(1) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad N^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(Q^2) \\ O(Q^2) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

*uniformly on  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ , and that  $G_\pm^{(0)}(s)$  remain uniformly positive definite there.*

*Set*

$$S_Q := \begin{pmatrix} Q^{-1/2} & 0 \\ 0 & Q^{-3/2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \widehat{G}_\pm := S_Q^{-1} G_\pm S_Q^{-1}, \quad \widehat{N} := S_Q^{-1} N S_Q^{-1}.$$

*Then*

$$\widehat{G}_\pm^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(1) & O(Q^{-1}) \\ O(Q^{-1}) & O(1) \end{pmatrix}, \quad \widehat{N}^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(1) & O(1) \\ O(1) & O(1) \end{pmatrix},$$

*and*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) = S_Q \mathcal{W}(\widehat{G}_-, \widehat{N}, \widehat{G}_+) S_Q.$$

*In particular, every off-diagonal entry of  $\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+)$  carries an explicit matrix-level factor  $Q^{-2}$  relative to the corresponding rescaled whitened block. Any additional  $Q$ -power appearing in the corrected transverse scalar must therefore come from the scalar normalization used in the definition of that scalar, not from the matrix identity itself.*

*Proof.* The displayed bounds for  $\widehat{G}_\pm^{(0)}$  and  $\widehat{N}^{(0)}$  are immediate from the definitions and the baseline scales. Since

$$G_\pm = S_Q \widehat{G}_\pm S_Q,$$

functional calculus gives

$$G_\pm^{-1/2} = S_Q^{-1} \widehat{G}_\pm^{-1/2} S_Q^{-1}.$$

Hence

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) = G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2} = S_Q \widehat{G}_-^{-1/2} \widehat{N} \widehat{G}_+^{-1/2} S_Q = S_Q \mathcal{W}(\widehat{G}_-, \widehat{N}, \widehat{G}_+) S_Q.$$

The off-diagonal entries therefore acquire one factor  $Q^{-1/2}$  from the upper-left entry of  $S_Q$  and one factor  $Q^{-3/2}$  from the lower-right entry of  $S_Q$ , hence a total matrix-level factor  $Q^{-2}$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 10.4** (Uniform scaled corrected-whitening transfer). *Fix  $0 < c_* < \rho_0/8$ . For every  $Q$  and every radius  $R$  satisfying*

$$0 < R \leq c_* Q,$$

*set*

$$w := \frac{z}{R}, \quad s = \frac{z}{Q^2} = \frac{Rw}{Q^2}.$$

*Let*

$$\mathfrak{D}_Q(M) := \begin{pmatrix} Q^2 m_{11} & Q m_{12} \\ Q m_{21} & m_{22} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathfrak{D}_Q^{-1}(X) = \begin{pmatrix} Q^{-2} x_{11} & Q^{-1} x_{12} \\ Q^{-1} x_{21} & x_{22} \end{pmatrix}.$$

*For  $R' > 0$ , let*

$$A_{R'}(M_2) := \left\{ F(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} F_n z^n : \|F\|_{A_{R'}} := \sum_{n \geq 0} \|F_n\| R'^n < \infty \right\},$$

*and write  $A_1(M_2)$  for the case  $R' = 1$ . For scalar holomorphic germs,  $A_{R'}(\mathbb{C})$  is defined similarly.*

*Write the baseline corrected same-point and mixed blocks on the  $w$ -disk as*

$$G_{\pm;Q,R}^{(0)}(w) := G_{\pm}^{(0)}(Rw/Q^2), \quad N_{Q,R}^{(0)}(w) := N^{(0)}(Rw/Q^2).$$

*For a weighted perturbation triple*

$$X = (X_-, Y, X_+) \in A_1(M_2)^3,$$

*define*

$$\delta G_{\pm} := \mathfrak{D}_Q^{-1} X_{\pm}, \quad \delta N := \mathfrak{D}_Q^{-1} Y,$$

*and, whenever the corrected scalar perturbation*

$$\Phi_K \left( \mathcal{W}(G_{-;Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta G_-, N_{Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta N, G_{+;Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta G_+) - \mathcal{W}(G_{-;Q,R}^{(0)}, N_{Q,R}^{(0)}, G_{+;Q,R}^{(0)}) \right)$$

*vanishes at  $w = 0$ , define*

$$\mathcal{T}_{Q,R}(X)(w) := \frac{Q}{Rw} \Phi_K \left( \mathcal{W}(G_{-;Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta G_-, N_{Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta N, G_{+;Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta G_+) - \mathcal{W}(G_{-;Q,R}^{(0)}, N_{Q,R}^{(0)}, G_{+;Q,R}^{(0)}) \right).$$

*Then there exist absolute constants*

$$\eta > 0, \quad C > 0, \quad B > 0$$

*such that for every  $Q$ , every  $0 < R \leq c_* Q$ , and every*

$$X \in A_1(M_2)^3 \quad \text{with} \quad \|X_-\|_{A_1} + \|Y\|_{A_1} + \|X_+\|_{A_1} \leq \eta,$$

*the quotient  $\mathcal{T}_{Q,R}(X)$  is holomorphic on  $|w| < 1$  and admits an absolutely convergent homogeneous expansion*

$$\mathcal{T}_{Q,R}(X) = \sum_{p \geq 1} \mathcal{T}_p(X),$$

*with*

$$\|\mathcal{T}_p(X)\|_{A_1} \leq C B^p (\|X_-\|_{A_1} + \|Y\|_{A_1} + \|X_+\|_{A_1})^p.$$

*The constants  $C, B, \eta$  are independent of  $Q$  and  $R$ .*

*Moreover, if*

$$X_{\pm}(w) = \sum_{m \geq 0} X_{\pm,m} w^m, \quad Y(w) = \sum_{m \geq 0} Y_m w^m,$$

*and*

$$\mathcal{T}_p(X)(w) = \sum_{n \geq 0} T_{p,n} w^n,$$

*then with*

$$\mathbf{X}_m := \max(\|X_{-,m}\|, \|Y_m\|, \|X_{+,m}\|),$$



one has the coefficient bound

$$|T_{p,n}| \leq CB^p \sum_{\substack{M \leq n \\ m_1 + \dots + m_p = M \\ m_i \geq 0}} \sum_{m_i \geq 0} \prod_{i=1}^p \mathbf{x}_{m_i}.$$

*Proof.* On  $|w| \leq 2$ ,

$$\left| \frac{Rw}{Q^2} \right| \leq \frac{2R}{Q^2} \leq \frac{2c_*}{Q} < \frac{\rho_0}{Q},$$

so the baseline blocks

$$G_{\pm;Q,R}^{(0)}(w), \quad N_{Q,R}^{(0)}(w)$$

are holomorphic and uniformly bounded on  $|w| \leq 2$ , with bounds independent of  $Q$  and  $R$ . By Lemma 10.3, the same-point baseline blocks remain uniformly positive definite there.

Therefore the corrected-whitening map

$$(\delta G_-, \delta N, \delta G_+) \mapsto \mathcal{W}(G_{-;Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta G_-, N_{Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta N, G_{+;Q,R}^{(0)} + \delta G_+)$$

is analytic on a fixed Banach neighborhood in  $A_1(M_2)^3$ , uniformly in  $Q, R$ . Since  $\Phi_K$  is linear, the corrected scalar perturbation depends analytically on the input triple. For those structured perturbations for which the corrected scalar perturbation vanishes at  $w = 0$ , the quotient by  $w$  in the definition of  $\mathcal{T}_{Q,R}$  is holomorphic. This gives the homogeneous expansion with uniform constants  $C, B, \eta$ .

The coefficient bound follows by testing the homogeneous maps on monomials in  $A_1(M_2)$  and using the Wiener-algebra estimate

$$|[w^n]F| \leq \|F\|_{A_1}$$

for scalar coefficients.  $\square$

**Proposition 10.5** (Pair-radius kernel-class decomposition for one-pair perturbations). *Fix  $0 < c_* < \rho_0/8$  and  $0 < c \ll 1$ . For one exterior zero pair  $\rho$ , set*

$$\Delta_\rho := |2m - \gamma_\rho|, \quad R_\rho := c \min(\Delta_\rho, c_* Q).$$

*Let  $f_\rho(t)$  denote the one-pair phase-derivative contribution, and remove its midpoint affine jet:*

$$r_\rho(t) := f_\rho(t) - f_\rho(m) - f'_\rho(m)(t - m).$$

*With*

$$t_\pm := m \pm \frac{z}{2Q^2},$$

*define*

$$d_\pm(z) := r_\rho(t_\pm), \quad e_\pm(z) := r'_\rho(t_\pm), \quad g_\pm(z) := r''_\rho(t_\pm),$$

*and*

$$\eta(z) := \delta \Delta_\rho(z/Q^2) := \int_{t_+}^{t_-} r_\rho(u) du.$$

*Then there exist holomorphic kernels  $U_\pm, E_\pm, G_\pm, V$  such that*

$$d_\pm(z) = \frac{z^2}{Q^4} U_\pm(z), \quad e_\pm(z) = \frac{z}{Q^2} E_\pm(z), \quad g_\pm(z) = G_\pm(z), \quad \eta(z) = \frac{z^3}{Q^6} V(z).$$

*For every fixed  $H_* > 1$ , if  $\Delta_\rho \geq H_*$ , then*

$$U_\pm, E_\pm, G_\pm, V$$

*are holomorphic on  $|z| < 2R_\rho$  and satisfy*

$$\|U_\pm\|_{A_{R_\rho}} + \|E_\pm\|_{A_{R_\rho}} + \|G_\pm\|_{A_{R_\rho}} + \|V\|_{A_{R_\rho}} \ll \Delta_\rho^{-4}.$$

*Let*

$$X_\rho := (X_{\rho,-}, Y_\rho, X_{\rho,+})$$

*be the weighted one-pair perturbation triple*

$$X_{\rho,\pm} := \mathfrak{D}_Q(\delta G_{\rho,\pm}), \quad Y_\rho := \mathfrak{D}_Q(\delta N_\rho),$$

where  $\delta G_{\rho,\pm}$  and  $\delta N_\rho$  are the actual one-pair perturbations of the corrected same-point and mixed blocks in the draft.

Then, on  $|z| < 2R_\rho$ , every entry of every block of  $X_\rho(z)$  is linear in

$$U_-, U_+, E_-, E_+, G_-, G_+, V$$

modulo terms containing at least two such pair kernels. In particular,

$$\|X_\rho(R_\rho \cdot)\|_{A_1} \ll \Delta_\rho^{-4}.$$

*Proof.* The one-pair poles lie at distance  $\asymp \Delta_\rho$  in the  $s$ -plane, hence at distance  $\asymp Q^2 \Delta_\rho$  in the  $z$ -plane. Since

$$R_\rho \ll \min(\Delta_\rho, Q),$$

the kernels  $U_\pm, E_\pm, G_\pm, V$  are holomorphic on  $|z| < 2R_\rho$ , and Cauchy gives the displayed  $A_{R_\rho}$ -bounds.

Now check the actual corrected formulas.

For the corrected same-point block,

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_\pm) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_\pm) + 2q(t_\pm)^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Subtracting the baseline and using

$$q = q_0 + d_\pm, \quad q' = q'_0 + e_\pm, \quad q'' = q''_0 + g_\pm,$$

the weighted perturbation entries are:

$$(1, 1) \sim (z/Q)^2 U_\pm, \quad (1, 2), (2, 1) \sim (z/Q) E_\pm,$$

and

$$(2, 2) \sim G_\pm + \left(\frac{q_0}{Q}\right)^2 (z/Q)^2 U_\pm + \left(\frac{q_0}{Q}\right) (z/Q)^4 U_\pm^2 + (z/Q)^6 U_\pm^3.$$

On  $|z| \leq 2R_\rho$ , the normalized baseline factors

$$\frac{q_0 z}{Q^2}, \quad \frac{q_0^2 z^2}{Q^4}$$

are  $O(1)$ , so the same-point block is linear in the pair kernels modulo terms with at least two pair kernels.

For the corrected mixed block,

$$N_m^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{2 \sin \Delta}{s} & \frac{\sin \Delta + q(t_+) s \cos \Delta}{s^2} \\ -\frac{\sin \Delta + q(t_-) s \cos \Delta}{s^2} & \frac{(q(t_-) + q(t_+)) s \cos \Delta + (2 - q(t_-) q(t_+) s^2) \sin \Delta}{2s^3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Write

$$q_\pm = q_{0,\pm} + d_\pm, \quad \Delta = \Delta_0 + \eta.$$

For the  $(1, 1)$ -entry, since

$$\eta(z) = \frac{z^3}{Q^6} V(z) = s^3 V(z),$$

$$Q^2 \frac{\sin(\Delta_0 + \eta) - \sin \Delta_0}{s}$$

is linear in  $V$  modulo higher pair order.

For the off-diagonal entries, the numerator difference is

$$(\sin(\Delta_0 + \eta) - \sin \Delta_0) + d_\pm s \cos(\Delta_0 + \eta) + q_{0,\pm} s (\cos(\Delta_0 + \eta) - \cos \Delta_0),$$

and after multiplying by  $Q/s^2$  the linear terms are bounded-baseline times  $U_\pm$  and  $V$ .

For the  $(2, 2)$ -entry, define

$$F(q_-, q_+, \Delta; s) := (q_- + q_+) s \cos \Delta + (2 - q_- q_+ s^2) \sin \Delta.$$

Then the perturbation is

$$\frac{F(q_{0,-} + d_-, q_{0,+} + d_+, \Delta_0 + \eta; s) - F(q_{0,-}, q_{0,+}, \Delta_0; s)}{s^3}.$$

Taylor expansion in  $(d_-, d_+, \eta)$  around the baseline gives

$$\partial_{q_-} F_0 d_- + \partial_{q_+} F_0 d_+ + \partial_{\Delta} F_0 \eta$$

plus a remainder quadratic in  $(d_-, d_+, \eta)$ . After dividing by  $s^3$ , the linear part is

$$\tilde{B}_-(z) U_-(z) + \tilde{B}_+(z) U_+(z) + \tilde{B}_{\Delta}(z) V(z),$$

with bounded baseline coefficients  $\tilde{B}_-, \tilde{B}_+, \tilde{B}_{\Delta}$ , and the remainder carries at least two pair kernels.

So every weighted mixed-block entry is also linear in the pair kernels modulo higher pair order.

Finally, on  $|z| \leq 2R_{\rho}$ , every factor  $z/Q$  is  $O(1)$ , every normalized baseline factor is  $O(1)$ , and each pair kernel has  $A_{R_{\rho}}$  norm  $O(\Delta_{\rho}^{-4})$ . Therefore

$$\|X_{\rho}(R_{\rho} \cdot)\|_{A_1} \ll \Delta_{\rho}^{-4}.$$

□

**Corollary 10.6** (Single-pair exterior odd-coefficient bound). *Fix  $0 < c_* < \rho_0/8$ . Let  $h_{\rho}(s)$  be the corrected transverse scalar contributed by one exterior zero pair at absolute distance*

$$\Delta_{\rho} := |2m - \gamma_{\rho}|,$$

and write

$$h_{\rho}(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} a_{2r+1}(\rho) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}.$$

Then for every fixed  $H_* > 1$ , if  $\Delta_{\rho} \geq H_*$ , one has

$$|a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll \frac{1}{Q} \begin{cases} \Delta_{\rho}^{-(2r+4)}, & \Delta_{\rho} \leq c_* Q, \\ (c_* Q)^{-2r} \Delta_{\rho}^{-4}, & \Delta_{\rho} > c_* Q. \end{cases}$$

*Proof.* Let

$$R_{\rho} := c \min(\Delta_{\rho}, c_* Q).$$

By Proposition 10.5,

$$\|X_{\rho}(R_{\rho} \cdot)\|_{A_1} \ll \Delta_{\rho}^{-4}.$$

For  $H_*$  large enough, this lies inside the uniform small ball from Proposition 10.4. Since the one-pair corrected scalar  $h_{\rho}(s)$  is odd in  $s$ , the corresponding corrected scalar perturbation vanishes at  $w = 0$ , so the quotient map  $\mathcal{T}_{Q, R_{\rho}}$  is holomorphic on the one-pair input. Therefore the normalized even germ

$$g_{\rho}(z) := \frac{Q^3}{z} h_{\rho}(z/Q^2)$$

satisfies

$$\|g_{\rho}(R_{\rho} \cdot)\|_{A_1} \ll \Delta_{\rho}^{-4}.$$

Hence

$$[z^{2r}] g_{\rho}(z) \ll R_{\rho}^{-2r} \Delta_{\rho}^{-4}.$$

Since

$$g_{\rho}(z) = \sum_{r \geq 0} \frac{a_{2r+1}(\rho)}{Q^{2r+1}} z^{2r},$$

this gives

$$|a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll Q^{2r+1} R_{\rho}^{-2r} \Delta_{\rho}^{-4}.$$

Using

$$R_{\rho} \asymp \min(\Delta_{\rho}, c_* Q)$$

yields the displayed hybrid bound. □

**Lemma 10.7** (Local zero-counting in dyadic shells). *Let*

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho : 2^k H < \Delta_\rho \leq 2^{k+1} H\}, \quad \Delta_\rho := |2m - \gamma_\rho|, \quad k \geq 0.$$

*Then*

$$\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll Q(2^k H + 1),$$

*where*  $Q \asymp \log |m|$ .

*Proof.* This is the local zero-counting estimate already used elsewhere in the draft, applied to the interval of ordinates

$$[2m - 2^{k+1} H, 2m + 2^{k+1} H].$$

Its length is  $O(2^k H + 1)$ , and the local zero density at height  $m$  is  $O(Q)$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 10.8** (Exterior higher odd-coefficient bound). *Let*

$$H_{\text{out}}(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}$$

*be the corrected transverse scalar contributed by all zeros outside absolute radius  $H$  from the local center. Then for every  $r \geq 0$  and every  $H \geq H_*$ ,*

$$|a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H)| \ll H^{-(2r+3)} + Q^{-(2r+2)}.$$

*Proof.* Decompose the exterior zeros into dyadic shells

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho : 2^k H < \Delta_\rho \leq 2^{k+1} H\}, \quad k \geq 0.$$

By Lemma 10.7,

$$\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll Q(2^k H + 1).$$

For shells with  $2^{k+1} H \leq c_* Q$ , Corollary 10.6 gives

$$\sum_{\rho \in \mathcal{S}_k} |a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll Q(2^k H + 1) \cdot \frac{1}{Q(2^k H)^{2r+4}} \ll (2^k H)^{-(2r+3)}.$$

Summing these shells yields

$$\ll H^{-(2r+3)}.$$

For shells with  $2^k H > c_* Q$ , Corollary 10.6 gives

$$\sum_{\rho \in \mathcal{S}_k} |a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll Q(2^k H + 1) \cdot \frac{1}{Q(c_* Q)^{2r}(2^k H)^4} \ll (c_* Q)^{-2r} (2^k H)^{-3}.$$

Summing the far shells gives

$$\ll Q^{-2r-2}.$$

Adding the near and far ranges proves the claim.  $\square$

**Corollary 10.9** (Core localization of the extracted odd jet). *Let  $N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor$  with  $\alpha > 0$ , and let  $a_{2N-1}^{\leq H}(m)$  denote the coefficient contributed by the zeros with  $\Delta_\rho \leq H$ . Then for every fixed  $H \geq H_*$ ,*

$$a_{2N-1}(m) = a_{2N-1}^{\leq H}(m) + O(H^{-(2N+1)} + Q^{-2N}).$$

*In particular, the first surviving corrected odd coefficient is exponentially localized to any fixed finite core.*

*Proof.* This is exactly Corollary 10.8 with  $r = N - 1$ .  $\square$

11.  $N$ -POINT ODD-MOMENT CANCELLATION

For  $N \leq \rho_0 Q$ , set

$$s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2}, \quad j = 1, \dots, N,$$

and define

$$a_j^{(N)} := (-1)^{j+1} \frac{j \binom{2N}{N+j}}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}}, \quad 1 \leq j \leq N.$$

Define the corrected  $N$ -point transverse scalar

$$(21) \quad \Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_m(s_j).$$

**Lemma 11.1** (Explicit odd-moment-canceling coefficients and  $\ell^1$  control). *The coefficients  $a_j^{(N)}$  satisfy*

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} = 1, \quad \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^{2r+1} = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2).$$

Moreover,

$$\sum_{j=1}^N |a_j^{(N)}| = 2N - 1.$$

Consequently, for every integer  $k \geq 0$ ,

$$\left| \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^k \right| \leq (2N - 1) N^k.$$

*Proof.* Set

$$D_N := \binom{2N-2}{N-1}.$$

We first prove the normalization. Writing

$$j \binom{2N}{N+j} = N \left( \binom{2N-1}{N+j-1} - \binom{2N-1}{N+j} \right),$$

one gets

$$\sum_{j=1}^N (-1)^{j+1} j \binom{2N}{N+j} = N \sum_{j=1}^N (-1)^{j+1} \left( \binom{2N-1}{N+j-1} - \binom{2N-1}{N+j} \right).$$

Using the partial alternating-binomial identity

$$\sum_{k=0}^m (-1)^k \binom{n}{k} = (-1)^m \binom{n-1}{m},$$

one finds

$$\sum_{k=N}^{2N-1} (-1)^k \binom{2N-1}{k} = (-1)^N \binom{2N-2}{N-1}.$$

Substituting this into the preceding display yields

$$\sum_{j=1}^N (-1)^{j+1} j \binom{2N}{N+j} = \binom{2N-2}{N-1} = D_N,$$

hence

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} = 1.$$

Next, for  $0 \leq r \leq N - 2$ , apply the standard finite-difference identity

$$\sum_{k=0}^{2N} (-1)^k \binom{2N}{k} P(k) = 0$$

to the polynomial

$$P(k) = (k - N)^{2r+2}, \quad \deg P = 2r + 2 < 2N.$$

After the change of variables  $j = k - N$ , this gives

$$\sum_{j=-N}^N (-1)^j \binom{2N}{N+j} j^{2r+2} = 0.$$

Since  $2r + 2$  is even and the  $j = 0$  term vanishes,

$$\sum_{j=1}^N (-1)^j \binom{2N}{N+j} j^{2r+2} = 0.$$

Dividing by  $D_N$  yields

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^{2r+1} = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N - 2).$$

Finally, since the signs alternate,

$$\sum_{j=1}^N |a_j^{(N)}| = \frac{1}{D_N} \sum_{j=1}^N j \binom{2N}{N+j}.$$

Using again

$$j \binom{2N}{N+j} = N \left( \binom{2N-1}{N+j-1} - \binom{2N-1}{N+j} \right),$$

this telescopes to

$$\sum_{j=1}^N j \binom{2N}{N+j} = N \binom{2N-1}{N}.$$

Therefore

$$\sum_{j=1}^N |a_j^{(N)}| = N \frac{\binom{2N-1}{N}}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} = 2N - 1.$$

The final moment bound is immediate from

$$\left| \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^k \right| \leq \sum_{j=1}^N |a_j^{(N)}| j^k \leq (2N - 1) N^k. \quad \square$$

**Lemma 11.2** (Closed-form Mellin symbol of the discrete  $N$ -point projector). *Define*

$$A_N(t) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} t^j, \quad \hat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z) := A_N(e^{z/Q^2}).$$

*Then*

$$A_N(t) = \frac{2(2N-1)}{N+1} {}_2F_1(1-N, 2; N+2; t),$$

*so in particular*

$$\hat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z) = \frac{2(2N-1)}{N+1} e^{z/Q^2} {}_2F_1(1-N, 2; N+2; e^{z/Q^2}).$$

*Moreover,*

$$A_N(t) - A_N(t^{-1}) = \frac{N(-1)^N}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} t^{-N} (1-t)^{2N-1} (1+t),$$

and hence

$$\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z) - \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(-z) = \frac{N(-1)^N}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} e^{-Nz/Q^2} (1 - e^{z/Q^2})^{2N-1} (1 + e^{z/Q^2}).$$

In particular,

$$\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 1, \quad \partial_z^{2r+1} \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2),$$

and the odd part of  $\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}$  starts only at order  $2N-1$ .

*Proof.* Let

$$B_N(t) := \frac{2(2N-1)}{N+1} t {}_2F_1(1-N, 2; N+2; t) = \sum_{j=1}^N b_j^{(N)} t^j.$$

Its coefficients satisfy

$$\frac{b_{j+1}^{(N)}}{b_j^{(N)}} = \frac{(1-N+j-1)(2+j-1)}{(N+2+j-1)j} = \frac{(j-N)(j+1)}{j(N+j+1)}.$$

On the other hand, the coefficients  $a_j^{(N)}$  satisfy

$$\frac{a_{j+1}^{(N)}}{a_j^{(N)}} = \frac{(-1)^{j+2}(j+1)\binom{2N}{N+j+1}}{(-1)^{j+1}j\binom{2N}{N+j}} = \frac{(j-N)(j+1)}{j(N+j+1)}.$$

Thus  $a_j^{(N)}$  and  $b_j^{(N)}$  agree up to an overall constant. Matching the  $t^1$ -coefficient gives

$$b_1^{(N)} = \frac{2(2N-1)}{N+1} = \frac{\binom{2N}{N+1}}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} = a_1^{(N)},$$

hence  $A_N(t) = B_N(t)$ .

For the second identity, define

$$F_N(t) := \sum_{j=-N}^N (-1)^j \binom{2N}{N+j} t^j.$$

By the binomial theorem,

$$F_N(t) = (-1)^N t^{-N} (1-t)^{2N}.$$

Differentiating gives

$$tF'_N(t) = \sum_{j=-N}^N j(-1)^j \binom{2N}{N+j} t^j = -N(-1)^N t^{-N} (1-t)^{2N-1} (1+t).$$

Now

$$A_N(t) - A_N(t^{-1}) = -\frac{1}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} \sum_{j=1}^N j(-1)^j \binom{2N}{N+j} (t^j - t^{-j}),$$

while the symmetry  $j \mapsto -j$  in the preceding display shows

$$tF'_N(t) = \sum_{j=1}^N j(-1)^j \binom{2N}{N+j} (t^j - t^{-j}).$$

Substituting the closed form for  $tF'_N(t)$  yields

$$A_N(t) - A_N(t^{-1}) = \frac{N(-1)^N}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} t^{-N} (1-t)^{2N-1} (1+t).$$

Replacing  $t$  by  $e^{z/Q^2}$  gives the displayed formula for  $\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z) - \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(-z)$ . The normalization  $\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 1$  and the low odd-jet vanishing are equivalent to the moment identities in Lemma 11.1.  $\square$

**Lemma 11.3** (Exact odd-moment generating function). *Define*

$$\mu_k^{(N)} := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^k,$$

and, for  $|u| < 1/N$ ,

$$\mathcal{M}_N(u) := \sum_{r \geq 0} \mu_{2r+1}^{(N)} u^{2r+1} = \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{a_j^{(N)} j u}{1 - j^2 u^2}.$$

Then

$$\mathcal{M}_N(u) = (-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! \frac{u^{2N-1}}{\prod_{j=1}^N (1 - j^2 u^2)}.$$

In particular, for every real  $x > N$ ,

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| x^{-(2r+1)} = (2N-1)N!(N-1)! x^2 \frac{\Gamma(x-N)}{\Gamma(x+N+1)}.$$

*Proof.* The identity

$$\mathcal{M}_N(u) = \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{a_j^{(N)} j u}{1 - j^2 u^2}$$

is immediate from summing the geometric series

$$\frac{j u}{1 - j^2 u^2} = \sum_{r \geq 0} j^{2r+1} u^{2r+1} \quad (|u| < 1/j).$$

Set

$$D_N(u) := \prod_{j=1}^N (1 - j^2 u^2) \mathcal{M}_N(u).$$

Since  $\mathcal{M}_N$  is a sum of simple fractions,  $D_N(u)$  is an odd polynomial of degree at most  $2N-1$ . By Lemma 11.1,

$$\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)} = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2),$$

so  $\mathcal{M}_N(u) = O(u^{2N-1})$  as  $u \rightarrow 0$ . Hence

$$D_N(u) = C_N u^{2N-1}$$

for some constant  $C_N$ .

To determine  $C_N$ , compare residues at  $u = 1/N$ . The residue of  $\mathcal{M}_N(u)$  there comes only from the  $j = N$  term and equals

$$\operatorname{Res}_{u=1/N} \mathcal{M}_N(u) = -\frac{a_N^{(N)}}{2N}.$$

On the other hand,

$$\operatorname{Res}_{u=1/N} \frac{C_N u^{2N-1}}{\prod_{j=1}^N (1 - j^2 u^2)} = -\frac{C_N}{2N^2 \prod_{k=1}^{N-1} (1 - k^2/N^2)}.$$

Equating these residues gives

$$C_N = a_N^{(N)} N \prod_{k=1}^{N-1} (N^2 - k^2).$$

Now

$$a_N^{(N)} = (-1)^{N+1} \frac{N}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}},$$



and

$$\prod_{k=1}^{N-1} (N^2 - k^2) = \prod_{k=1}^{N-1} (N - k) \prod_{k=1}^{N-1} (N + k) = (N - 1)! \frac{(2N - 1)!}{N!} = \frac{(2N - 1)!}{N}.$$

Therefore

$$C_N = (-1)^{N+1} \frac{N(2N - 1)!}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} = (-1)^{N+1} (2N - 1)N!(N - 1)!.$$

This proves the first formula.

For the tail identity, note that

$$(-1)^{N+1} \mathcal{M}_N(u) = (2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! \frac{u^{2N-1}}{\prod_{j=1}^N (1 - j^2 u^2)}$$

has nonnegative Taylor coefficients for  $0 < u < 1/N$ . Hence

$$(-1)^{N+1} \mu_{2r+1}^{(N)} \geq 0 \quad (r \geq N - 1),$$

and therefore, for  $x > N$ ,

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| x^{-(2r+1)} = \left| \mathcal{M}_N \left( \frac{1}{x} \right) \right| = (2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! \frac{x^2}{\prod_{j=1}^N (x^2 - j^2)}.$$

Finally,

$$\prod_{j=1}^N (x^2 - j^2) = \prod_{j=1}^N (x - j) \prod_{j=1}^N (x + j) = \frac{\Gamma(x)}{\Gamma(x - N)} \cdot \frac{\Gamma(x + N + 1)}{\Gamma(x + 1)} = \frac{1}{x} \frac{\Gamma(x + N + 1)}{\Gamma(x - N)}.$$

Substituting this identity yields the claimed formula.  $\square$

**Remark 11.4** (Structure of the surviving odd tail). Expanding

$$\frac{1}{\prod_{j=1}^N (1 - j^2 u^2)} = \sum_{k \geq 0} h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2) u^{2k},$$

where  $h_k$  denotes the complete homogeneous symmetric polynomial, the exact formula of Lemma 11.3 yields

$$\mu_{2N-1+2k}^{(N)} = (-1)^{N+1} (2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2), \quad k \geq 0.$$

Thus the surviving odd moments are not merely bounded: they are explicit and have a fixed sign,

$$(-1)^{N+1} \mu_{2r+1}^{(N)} \geq 0 \quad (r \geq N - 1).$$

This makes the post-cancellation odd tail completely structured rather than mysterious.

**Corollary 11.5** (Exact action of the  $N$ -point operator on odd germs). *Let*

$$F(s) = \sum_{r \geq 0} b_{2r+1} s^{2r+1}$$

*be an odd analytic germ at  $s = 0$ . Then*

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q} F) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right) = \sum_{r \geq 0} b_{2r+1} \frac{\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}}{Q^{4r+2}}.$$

*Hence, by Remark 11.4,*

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q} F) = (-1)^{N+1} (2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! \sum_{k \geq 0} b_{2N-1+2k} h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2) Q^{-(4N+4k-2)}.$$

*Thus the  $N$ -point operator does not merely annihilate the first  $N - 1$  odd jets: on odd germs it acts as an explicit shifted complete-homogeneous transform of the surviving odd Taylor coefficients.*

**Proposition 11.6** (Exact finite-difference factorization on odd germs). *Let*

$$T_Q := e^{Q^{-2}D}, \quad D := \frac{d}{ds},$$

so that  $T_Q F(s) = F(s + Q^{-2})$ . Then for every odd analytic germ  $F$  at  $s = 0$ ,

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}F) = \frac{N(-1)^N}{2\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} \left[ T_Q^{-N} (1 - T_Q)^{2N-1} (1 + T_Q) F \right]_{s=0}.$$

Equivalently,

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}F) = \frac{(-1)^{N+1}N}{2\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} \left[ T_Q^{-N} (T_Q - 1)^{2N-1} (1 + T_Q) F \right]_{s=0}.$$

In particular, on odd germs the  $N$ -point operator factors exactly through the  $(2N - 1)$ -st forward difference.

*Proof.* Let

$$P_{N,Q}(D) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} e^{(j/Q^2)D} = \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} T_Q^j.$$

Then

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}F) = (P_{N,Q}(D)F)|_{s=0}.$$

By Lemma 11.2, with  $t = T_Q$ ,

$$P_{N,Q}(D) - P_{N,Q}(-D) = \frac{N(-1)^N}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} T_Q^{-N} (1 - T_Q)^{2N-1} (1 + T_Q).$$

If  $F$  is odd, then

$$(P_{N,Q}(-D)F)|_{s=0} = \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} F(-j/Q^2) = - \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} F(j/Q^2) = -(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}F).$$

Hence

$$2(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}F) = ((P_{N,Q}(D) - P_{N,Q}(-D))F)|_{s=0},$$

which gives the claimed formula. The second form follows from  $(1 - T_Q)^{2N-1} = -(T_Q - 1)^{2N-1}$ .  $\square$

**Remark 11.7** (Why the odd tail begins at order  $2N - 1$ ). Proposition 11.6 shows that the disappearance of the first  $N - 1$  odd jets is not merely a moment identity. It is built into the operator itself: on odd germs, the  $N$ -point projector contains the factor  $(T_Q - 1)^{2N-1}$ . The surviving odd tail therefore begins at order  $2N - 1$  for operator-theoretic reasons, not only by coefficient cancellation.

**Lemma 11.8** (Integral form of a forward difference). *For  $m \geq 1$ ,  $h > 0$ , and an analytic germ  $f$ , one has*

$$(e^{hD} - 1)^m f(x) = h^m \int_0^m f^{(m)}(x + hu) \omega_m(u) du,$$

where

$$\omega_m(u) := \frac{1}{(m-1)!} \sum_{r=0}^m (-1)^r \binom{m}{r} (u-r)_+^{m-1}, \quad (u-r)_+ := \max\{u-r, 0\}.$$

The function  $\omega_m$  is nonnegative, supported on  $[0, m]$ , and satisfies the symmetry

$$\omega_m(u) = \omega_m(m-u).$$

*Proof.* The identity

$$(e^{hD} - 1)f(x) = f(x + h) - f(x) = \int_0^h f'(x + t) dt$$

iterates to

$$(e^{hD} - 1)^m f(x) = \int_{[0, h]^m} f^{(m)}(x + t_1 + \cdots + t_m) dt_1 \cdots dt_m.$$

Rescaling  $t_i = hu_i$  gives

$$(e^{hD} - 1)^m f(x) = h^m \int_{[0, 1]^m} f^{(m)}(x + h(u_1 + \cdots + u_m)) du_1 \cdots du_m.$$

Pushing forward Lebesgue measure on  $[0, 1]^m$  under

$$(u_1, \dots, u_m) \mapsto u_1 + \cdots + u_m$$

yields the density  $\omega_m$ , namely the classical Irwin–Hall density, which has the stated explicit formula, support, and symmetry. This proves the claim.  $\square$

**Proposition 11.9** (Positive-kernel representation of the odd projector). *Set*

$$m := 2N - 1, \quad h := Q^{-2},$$

and define, for  $0 \leq u \leq N$ ,

$$\kappa_N(u) := \omega_{2N-1}(N - u) + \omega_{2N-1}(N - 1 - u),$$

where  $\omega_{2N-1}$  is the density from Lemma 11.8, extended by 0 outside  $[0, 2N - 1]$ . Then  $\kappa_N(u) \geq 0$  on  $[0, N]$ , and for every odd analytic germ  $F$ ,

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N, Q} F) = \frac{N(-1)^{N+1}}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} Q^{-(4N-2)} \int_0^N \kappa_N(u) F^{(2N-1)}\left(\frac{u}{Q^2}\right) du.$$

Moreover,  $\kappa_N(u) > 0$  for  $0 < u < N$ .

*Proof.* Apply Proposition 11.6 and Lemma 11.8 with  $m = 2N - 1$  and  $h = Q^{-2}$ . This gives

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N, Q} F) = \frac{N(-1)^{N+1}}{2\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} h^{2N-1} \int_0^{2N-1} \omega_{2N-1}(v) \left[ F^{(2N-1)}((v-N)h) + F^{(2N-1)}((v-N+1)h) \right] dv.$$

Since  $F$  is odd,  $F^{(2N-1)}$  is even. Using this evenness together with the symmetry

$$\omega_{2N-1}(v) = \omega_{2N-1}(2N - 1 - v),$$

the two terms may be folded onto  $[0, N]$ , yielding

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N, Q} F) = \frac{N(-1)^{N+1}}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} h^{2N-1} \int_0^N [\omega_{2N-1}(N - u) + \omega_{2N-1}(N - 1 - u)] F^{(2N-1)}(uh) du.$$

This is exactly the stated formula. The strict positivity on  $0 < u < N$  follows because  $N - u \in (0, 2N - 1)$  there, and  $\omega_{2N-1}$  is strictly positive on the interior of its support.  $\square$

**Corollary 11.10** (Sign transfer from the first surviving derivative). *Let  $F$  be an odd analytic germ. If for some  $\sigma \in \{\pm 1\}$ ,*

$$\sigma F^{(2N-1)}(s) \geq 0 \quad \text{for all } 0 \leq s \leq \frac{N}{Q^2},$$

then

$$\sigma(-1)^{N+1}(\mathcal{P}_{N, Q} F) \geq 0.$$

If moreover  $F^{(2N-1)} \not\equiv 0$  on  $[0, N/Q^2]$ , then the inequality is strict.

*Proof.* This is immediate from Proposition 11.9, since the kernel  $\kappa_N$  is nonnegative and strictly positive on  $(0, N)$ .  $\square$

**Remark 11.11** (Why this is the right downstream target). Proposition 11.9 shows that the  $N$ -point layer is not merely an odd-moment cancellation device: on odd germs it is a positive average of the first surviving derivative  $F^{(2N-1)}$  over the microscopic interval  $[0, N/Q^2]$ . Accordingly, any source-level argument that gives a fixed sign, one-sided lower bound, or variation control for

$$H_m^{(2N-1)}(s) \quad \left(0 \leq s \leq \frac{N}{Q^2}\right)$$

would transfer directly to the sign or size of  $\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)$ . This isolates the next natural analytic target in the  $N$ -point route.

**Remark 11.12** (Finite-order recurrence of the normalized surviving tail). Define

$$\nu_k := \frac{(-1)^{N+1} \mu_{2N-1+2k}^{(N)}}{(2N-1)N!(N-1)!} = h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2), \quad k \geq 0.$$

Then

$$\sum_{k \geq 0} \nu_k t^k = \frac{1}{\prod_{j=1}^N (1 - j^2 t)} = \frac{1}{1 - e_1 t + e_2 t^2 - \dots + (-1)^N e_N t^N},$$

where  $e_r = e_r(1^2, \dots, N^2)$  is the  $r$ -th elementary symmetric polynomial in  $1^2, \dots, N^2$ . Consequently,

$$\nu_k = e_1 \nu_{k-1} - e_2 \nu_{k-2} + \dots + (-1)^{N+1} e_N \nu_{k-N} \quad (k \geq 1),$$

with the conventions  $\nu_0 = 1$  and  $\nu_k = 0$  for  $k < 0$ . Thus the surviving odd tail is governed by an exact order- $N$  linear recurrence.

**Proposition 11.13** (Partial-fraction form of the surviving odd tail). *Let*

$$G_N(t) := \frac{1}{\prod_{m=1}^N (1 - m^2 t)}.$$

*Then  $G_N$  has the exact partial-fraction decomposition*

$$G_N(t) = \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{B_{N,j}}{1 - j^2 t},$$

*where*

$$B_{N,j} = \frac{2(-1)^{N-j} j^{2N}}{(N-j)!(N+j)!}.$$

*Equivalently,*

$$\frac{1}{\prod_{m=1}^N (1 - m^2 u^2)} = \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{2(-1)^{N-j} j^{2N}}{(N-j)!(N+j)!} \frac{1}{1 - j^2 u^2}.$$

*Consequently, for every  $k \geq 0$ ,*

$$h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2) = \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{2(-1)^{N-j} j^{2N+2k}}{(N-j)!(N+j)!},$$

*and hence*

$$\mu_{2N-1+2k}^{(N)} = (-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{2(-1)^{N-j} j^{2N+2k}}{(N-j)!(N+j)!}.$$

*Proof.* Since the poles of  $G_N(t)$  are simple and located at  $t = j^{-2}$  ( $1 \leq j \leq N$ ), one has

$$G_N(t) = \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{B_{N,j}}{1 - j^2 t}$$

for uniquely determined coefficients  $B_{N,j}$ . Multiplying by  $(1 - j^2 t)$  and evaluating at  $t = j^{-2}$  gives

$$B_{N,j} = \frac{1}{\prod_{m \neq j} (1 - m^2 t)} \Big|_{t=j^{-2}} = \frac{1}{\prod_{m \neq j} (1 - m^2 / j^2)}.$$

Now

$$\prod_{m \neq j} \left(1 - \frac{m^2}{j^2}\right) = j^{-2N+2} \prod_{m \neq j} (j^2 - m^2),$$

and

$$\prod_{m \neq j} (j^2 - m^2) = \prod_{m \neq j} (j - m) \prod_{m \neq j} (j + m).$$

Here

$$\prod_{m \neq j} (j - m) = (j - 1)! (-1)^{N-j} (N - j)!,$$

while

$$\prod_{m \neq j} (j + m) = \frac{(N + j)!}{2j j!}.$$

Therefore

$$\prod_{m \neq j} (j^2 - m^2) = (-1)^{N-j} \frac{(N - j)! (N + j)!}{2j^2},$$

and hence

$$B_{N,j} = \frac{2(-1)^{N-j} j^{2N}}{(N - j)! (N + j)!}.$$

Expanding each geometric series

$$\frac{1}{1 - j^2 u^2} = \sum_{k \geq 0} j^{2k} u^{2k}$$

and comparing coefficients of  $u^{2k}$  yields the formula for  $h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2)$ . The identity for  $\mu_{2N-1+2k}^{(N)}$  then follows from Remark 11.4.  $\square$

**Remark 11.14** (Dominance of the outermost pole for fixed  $N$ ). For fixed  $N$ , the explicit decomposition in Proposition 11.13 shows that the surviving tail is asymptotically dominated by the outermost node  $j = N$ . Indeed,

$$h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2) = \frac{2N^{2N+2k}}{(2N)!} + O_N((N - 1)^{2k}) \quad (k \rightarrow \infty),$$

and therefore

$$\mu_{2N-1+2k}^{(N)} = (-1)^{N+1} \frac{N^{2N+2k}}{\binom{2N-2}{N-1}} + O_N((N - 1)^{2k}) \quad (k \rightarrow \infty).$$

So for fixed  $N$ , the far odd tail is eventually controlled by the single outermost pole  $u = \pm 1/N$ .

**Proposition 11.15** (Kernel form and explicit corrected  $N$ -point transverse estimate). *Let*

$$H_m(s) := \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m))$$

*be the full corrected transverse scalar. For  $N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor$  with  $0 < \alpha < \rho_0$ , define*

$$s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2}, \quad \Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_m(s_j).$$

*Then*

$$\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{|\xi|=\rho_0/Q} H_m(\xi) K_{N,Q}(\xi) d\xi,$$

where

$$K_{N,Q}(\xi) := 2 \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \frac{s_j}{\xi^2 - s_j^2} = 2(-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! Q^4 \xi \frac{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi - N)}{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi + N + 1)}.$$

Moreover, writing  $x := \rho_0 Q$ , one has the explicit bound

$$|\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\rho_0} \rho_0^2 \frac{(2N-1)N!(N-1)!}{Q} \frac{\Gamma(x-N)}{\Gamma(x+N+1)} L(m)S(m)^2.$$

*Proof.* By Proposition 9.5, the full corrected scalar

$$H_m(s) = \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m))$$

is holomorphic on  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ . By Proposition 9.7, all cutoff-dependent tail, jet-correction, and estimation contributions are already internal to the full corrected scalar  $H_m(s)$ ; hence no external remainder is carried into  $\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)$ .

Since  $H_m$  is odd, the odd Cauchy formula gives

$$H_m(s) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{|\xi|=\rho_0/Q} H_m(\xi) \frac{2s}{\xi^2 - s^2} d\xi.$$

Summing this identity against the coefficients  $a_j^{(N)}$  at  $s = s_j = j/Q^2$  yields

$$\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{|\xi|=\rho_0/Q} H_m(\xi) K_{N,Q}(\xi) d\xi$$

with

$$K_{N,Q}(\xi) = 2 \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \frac{s_j}{\xi^2 - s_j^2}.$$

Now

$$\frac{s_j}{\xi^2 - s_j^2} = \frac{1}{\xi} \frac{j/(Q^2 \xi)}{1 - j^2/(Q^4 \xi^2)},$$

so, using Lemma 11.3,

$$K_{N,Q}(\xi) = \frac{2}{\xi} \mathcal{M}_N\left(\frac{1}{Q^2 \xi}\right) = 2(-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! \frac{Q^2}{\prod_{j=1}^N (Q^4 \xi^2 - j^2)}.$$

Finally,

$$\prod_{j=1}^N (Q^4 \xi^2 - j^2) = \prod_{j=1}^N (Q^2 \xi - j) \prod_{j=1}^N (Q^2 \xi + j) = \frac{1}{Q^2 \xi} \frac{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi + N + 1)}{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi - N)},$$

which gives

$$K_{N,Q}(\xi) = 2(-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! Q^4 \xi \frac{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi - N)}{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi + N + 1)}.$$

For the size bound, Proposition 10.1 gives

$$|H_m(s)| \ll_{\rho_0} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3} \quad (|s| = \rho_0/Q).$$

By Proposition 10.2, one may write

$$H_m(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} c_{2r+1}(m) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}, \quad |c_{2r+1}(m)| \ll L(m)S(m)^2 \rho_0^{-(2r+1)}.$$

Therefore

$$\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m) = \sum_{r \geq 0} c_{2r+1}(m) \frac{\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}}{Q^{2r+4}}.$$

By Lemma 11.1 and Remark 11.4, this becomes the exact surviving expansion

$$\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) = (-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! \sum_{k \geq 0} c_{2N-1+2k}(m) h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2) Q^{-(2N+2k+2)}.$$

In particular, the  $N$ -point operation isolates the first surviving corrected odd coefficient  $c_{2N-1}(m)$  and propagates the higher odd coefficients through an explicit universal positive tail.

For the bound, the coefficient estimate yields

$$|\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\rho_0} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3} \sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (\rho_0 Q)^{-(2r+1)}.$$

Applying Lemma 11.3 with  $x = \rho_0 Q$  gives

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (\rho_0 Q)^{-(2r+1)} = (2N-1)N!(N-1)! (\rho_0 Q)^2 \frac{\Gamma(\rho_0 Q - N)}{\Gamma(\rho_0 Q + N + 1)}.$$

Substituting this proves the stated bound.  $\square$

**Remark 11.16** (Exact surviving-coefficient expansion on the zeta side). With the notation of the proof of Proposition 11.15,

$$\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) = \sum_{r \geq 0} c_{2r+1}(m) \frac{\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}}{Q^{2r+4}} = (-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! \sum_{k \geq 0} c_{2N-1+2k}(m) h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2) Q^{-(2N+2k+2)}.$$

Thus the  $N$ -point step does not merely remove the first  $N-1$  odd jets: it converts the corrected odd Taylor expansion into an explicit universal tail whose leading term is the first surviving corrected odd coefficient  $c_{2N-1}(m)$ .

**Corollary 11.17** (Finite-core localization of the transformed zeta-side scalar). *With the notation of Proposition 11.15 and Corollary 10.8, let*

$$H_{\text{out}}(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}$$

be the corrected transverse scalar contributed by all zero pairs with  $\Delta_{\rho} > H$ , and define

$$\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_{\text{out}}(s_j), \quad \Xi_{\zeta, \leq H}^{(N)}(m) := \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H).$$

If  $HQ > N$ , then

$$|\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H)| \ll \frac{(2N-1)N!(N-1)!}{Q} \frac{\Gamma(HQ - N)}{\Gamma(HQ + N + 1)} + (2N-1)N!(N-1)! \frac{\Gamma(Q^2 - N)}{\Gamma(Q^2 + N + 1)}.$$

Consequently,

$$\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) = \Xi_{\zeta, \leq H}^{(N)}(m) + O\left(\frac{(2N-1)N!(N-1)!}{Q} \frac{\Gamma(HQ - N)}{\Gamma(HQ + N + 1)}\right) + O\left((2N-1)N!(N-1)! \frac{\Gamma(Q^2 - N)}{\Gamma(Q^2 + N + 1)}\right).$$

*Proof.* By the exact  $N$ -point action on odd germs used in the proof of Proposition 11.15,

$$\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H) = \sum_{r \geq 0} a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H) \frac{\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}}{Q^{2r+4}}.$$

Since  $\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)} = 0$  for  $0 \leq r \leq N-2$ ,

$$\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H) = \sum_{r \geq N-1} a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H) \frac{\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}}{Q^{2r+4}}.$$

Taking absolute values and applying Corollary 10.8,

$$|\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H)| \ll \sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| \left( \frac{H^{-(2r+3)}}{Q^{2r+4}} + \frac{Q^{-(2r+2)}}{Q^{2r+4}} \right).$$

Thus

$$|\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H)| \ll \frac{1}{H^2 Q^3} \sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (HQ)^{-(2r+1)} + \frac{1}{Q^4} \sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (Q^2)^{-(2r+1)}.$$

Now apply Lemma 11.3 first with  $x = HQ$  and then with  $x = Q^2$ . Since  $HQ > N$ , both evaluations are valid for all sufficiently large  $Q$ , and one obtains

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (HQ)^{-(2r+1)} = (2N-1)N!(N-1)!(HQ)^2 \frac{\Gamma(HQ-N)}{\Gamma(HQ+N+1)},$$

and

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (Q^2)^{-(2r+1)} = (2N-1)N!(N-1)!Q^4 \frac{\Gamma(Q^2-N)}{\Gamma(Q^2+N+1)}.$$

Substituting these identities proves the displayed bound for  $\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H)$ , and the decomposition

$$\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) = \Xi_{\zeta, \leq H}^{(N)}(m) + \Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H)$$

gives the second display.  $\square$

**Remark 11.18** (Asymptotic finite-core localization at linear depth). Let

$$N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor, \quad 0 < \alpha < \rho_0,$$

and fix  $H > \alpha$ . Then Corollary 11.17 and Stirling's formula give

$$|\Xi_{\zeta, \text{out}}^{(N)}(m; H)| \ll \exp(-Hf(\alpha/H)Q + O(\log Q)) + \exp(-2\alpha Q \log Q + O(Q)),$$

where

$$f(\beta) = (1+\beta) \log(1+\beta) - 2\beta \log \beta - (1-\beta) \log(1-\beta).$$

In particular,

$$\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) = \Xi_{\zeta, \leq H}^{(N)}(m) + O(e^{-Hf(\alpha/H)Q + O(\log Q)}) + O(e^{-2\alpha Q \log Q + O(Q)}).$$

Thus the full transformed zeta-side scalar is determined, up to exponentially small error, by a fixed finite core.

**Remark 11.19** (Exact Laurent tail of the contour kernel). The kernel in Proposition 11.15 has an exact large- $\xi$  Laurent expansion. Indeed, using Lemma 11.3 and Remark 11.4,

$$K_{N,Q}(\xi) = \frac{2}{\xi} \mathcal{M}_N \left( \frac{1}{Q^2 \xi} \right) = 2(-1)^{N+1} (2N-1)N!(N-1)! Q^{-4N+2} \xi^{-2N} \sum_{k \geq 0} h_k(1^2, \dots, N^2) Q^{-4k} \xi^{-2k}.$$

So the contour kernel is not merely small: its entire post-cancellation odd tail is explicit, universal, and sign-rigid term-by-term.

**Corollary 11.20** (Optimized zeta-side cancellation depth). *Let*

$$N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor, \quad 0 < \alpha < \rho_0, \quad \beta := \frac{\alpha}{\rho_0} \in (0, 1).$$

*Then*

$$|\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\rho_0, \alpha} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q},$$

*where*

$$\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0) = \rho_0 \left( (1+\beta) \log(1+\beta) - 2\beta \log \beta - (1-\beta) \log(1-\beta) \right).$$

*Moreover,  $\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)$  is maximized uniquely at*

$$\beta = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}, \quad \text{i.e.} \quad \alpha_{\text{opt}} = \frac{\rho_0}{\sqrt{2}},$$



so the optimal zeta-side cancellation depth is

$$N_{\text{opt}} = \left\lfloor \frac{\rho_0}{\sqrt{2}} Q \right\rfloor,$$

and the corresponding exponential rate is

$$\delta_{\text{opt}} = 2\rho_0 \log(1 + \sqrt{2}).$$

*Proof.* Set  $x := \rho_0 Q$ , so that  $N = \beta x + O(1)$  with  $\beta \in (0, 1)$  fixed. By Proposition 11.15, it suffices to estimate

$$(2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! \frac{\Gamma(x - N)}{\Gamma(x + N + 1)}.$$

A Stirling expansion gives

$$\log \left( (2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! \frac{\Gamma(x - N)}{\Gamma(x + N + 1)} \right) = -x f(\beta) + O(\log x),$$

where

$$f(\beta) = (1 + \beta) \log(1 + \beta) - 2\beta \log \beta - (1 - \beta) \log(1 - \beta).$$

Hence

$$(2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! \frac{\Gamma(x - N)}{\Gamma(x + N + 1)} \ll_{\rho_0, \alpha} e^{-x f(\beta)},$$

and therefore

$$|\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\rho_0, \alpha} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q} e^{-\rho_0 f(\beta) Q}.$$

This proves the first claim.

For the optimization, differentiate:

$$f'(\beta) = \log \left( \frac{1 - \beta^2}{\beta^2} \right).$$

Thus  $f'(\beta) = 0$  exactly when  $\beta = 1/\sqrt{2}$ . Since

$$f''(\beta) = -\frac{2\beta}{1 - \beta^2} - \frac{2}{\beta} < 0 \quad (0 < \beta < 1),$$

this critical point is the unique maximizer. Finally,

$$f\left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right) = 2 \log(1 + \sqrt{2}),$$

which gives the stated value of  $\delta_{\text{opt}}$ . □

**Remark 11.21.** Corollary 11.20 optimizes the *zeta-side* cancellation depth. After the exact odd-tail evaluation is imported into Proposition 11.35, the toy side imposes no asymptotic upper restriction on the linear choice  $N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor$ : for every fixed  $\alpha > 0$ , the toy microscopic nodes  $s_j = j/Q^2$  remain inside the toy analyticity disk for all sufficiently large  $Q$ , and the residual odd toy tail is in fact super-exponentially small on the  $Q$ -scale. Accordingly one may take the exact zeta-side optimum

$$\alpha = \frac{\rho_0}{\sqrt{2}}.$$

**Remark 11.22** (Sharper prefactor in the optimized zeta-side bound). With the notation of Corollary 11.20, set

$$x := \rho_0 Q, \quad N = \beta x + O(1), \quad \beta = \frac{\alpha}{\rho_0} \in (0, 1).$$

A more precise Stirling expansion of the gamma-ratio factor in Proposition 11.15 gives

$$(2N - 1)N!(N - 1)! \frac{\Gamma(x - N)}{\Gamma(x + N + 1)} = \frac{4\pi\beta}{\sqrt{1 - \beta^2}} e^{-x f(\beta)} (1 + o(1)),$$

where

$$f(\beta) = (1 + \beta) \log(1 + \beta) - 2\beta \log \beta - (1 - \beta) \log(1 - \beta).$$

Consequently,

$$|\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll 2C_{\partial}(\rho_0)\rho_0 \frac{4\pi\beta}{\sqrt{1-\beta^2}} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^2} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q} (1 + o(1)).$$

At the zeta-side optimum  $\beta = 1/\sqrt{2}$ , the prefactor simplifies to  $4\pi$ , so

$$|\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N_{\text{opt}})}(m)| \ll 8\pi C_{\partial}(\rho_0)\rho_0 \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^2} e^{-2\rho_0 \log(1+\sqrt{2})Q} (1 + o(1)).$$

This sharper prefactor is not needed for the qualitative contradiction, but it records that, once the boundary constant  $C_{\partial}(\rho_0)$  is made explicit, the zeta-side  $N$ -point estimate becomes effective with an explicit leading constant.

**Proposition 11.23** (Real profile of the exact  $N$ -point kernel). *Let*

$$C_N := (2N-1)N!(N-1)!, \quad \kappa_N(x) := x \frac{\Gamma(x-N)}{\Gamma(x+N+1)} \quad (x > N).$$

*Then*

$$\kappa_N(x) = \frac{1}{\prod_{j=1}^N (x^2 - j^2)},$$

*and for real  $x > N$ ,*

$$K_{N,Q}\left(\frac{x}{Q^2}\right) = 2(-1)^{N+1} C_N Q^2 \kappa_N(x).$$

*Moreover:*

- (1)  $\kappa_N(x) > 0$  for all  $x > N$ ;
- (2)  $\kappa'_N(x) < 0$  for all  $x > N$ ;
- (3) for every  $x > N$ ,

$$\sup_{|\xi|=x/Q^2} |K_{N,Q}(\xi)| = 2C_N Q^2 \kappa_N(x) = \left| K_{N,Q}\left(\frac{x}{Q^2}\right) \right|.$$

*Proof.* From Proposition 11.15,

$$K_{N,Q}(\xi) = 2(-1)^{N+1} C_N Q^4 \xi \frac{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi - N)}{\Gamma(Q^2 \xi + N + 1)}.$$

Substituting  $\xi = x/Q^2$  gives

$$K_{N,Q}\left(\frac{x}{Q^2}\right) = 2(-1)^{N+1} C_N Q^2 x \frac{\Gamma(x-N)}{\Gamma(x+N+1)} = 2(-1)^{N+1} C_N Q^2 \kappa_N(x).$$

Now

$$\Gamma(x+N+1) = (x+N)(x+N-1) \cdots x \Gamma(x),$$

and

$$\Gamma(x) = (x-1)(x-2) \cdots (x-N) \Gamma(x-N).$$

Hence

$$x \frac{\Gamma(x-N)}{\Gamma(x+N+1)} = \frac{1}{(x-N) \cdots (x-1)(x+1) \cdots (x+N)} = \frac{1}{\prod_{j=1}^N (x^2 - j^2)},$$

which proves the product formula. Positivity is immediate for  $x > N$ .

For monotonicity, differentiate the logarithm:

$$\frac{d}{dx} \log \kappa_N(x) = - \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{2x}{x^2 - j^2}.$$

Since  $x > N$ , each denominator is positive, so

$$\frac{d}{dx} \log \kappa_N(x) < 0,$$

hence  $\kappa'_N(x) < 0$ .

Finally, using the product form of the kernel,

$$K_{N,Q}(\xi) = 2(-1)^{N+1} C_N Q^2 \frac{1}{\prod_{j=1}^N (Q^4 \xi^2 - j^2)},$$

if  $|\xi| = x/Q^2$  then

$$|Q^4 \xi^2 - j^2| \geq ||Q^2 \xi|^2 - j^2| = x^2 - j^2 \quad (1 \leq j \leq N),$$

so

$$|K_{N,Q}(\xi)| \leq 2C_N Q^2 \frac{1}{\prod_{j=1}^N (x^2 - j^2)} = 2C_N Q^2 \kappa_N(x).$$

Equality is attained at  $\xi = x/Q^2$ , proving the final claim.  $\square$

**Remark 11.24** (No contour loss in the kernel factor). Proposition 11.23 shows that the kernel factor in Proposition 11.15 is controlled exactly by its positive real value on the boundary circle. Thus the boundary estimate used in the zeta-side  $N$ -point bound carries no hidden contour-loss from the kernel itself: the worst point is the positive real boundary point

$$\xi = \frac{\rho_0}{Q}.$$

Moreover, since  $\kappa_N$  is strictly decreasing on  $(N, \infty)$ , the kernel factor is largest at the smallest admissible boundary radius.

**Proposition 11.25** (Positive smoothing preserves the real kernel profile). *Let  $\psi \in C_c^\infty(\mathbf{R})$  be even, nonnegative, and normalized by*

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} \psi(u) du = 1.$$

*Set*

$$U_\psi := \sup\{|u| : u \in \text{supp } \psi\}.$$

*For  $x > N + \eta Q^2 U_\psi$ , define the smoothed real profile*

$$\kappa_{N,\eta}^\psi(x) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} \psi(u) \kappa_N(x + \eta Q^2 u) du,$$

*where*

$$\kappa_N(x) := x \frac{\Gamma(x - N)}{\Gamma(x + N + 1)} = \frac{1}{\prod_{j=1}^N (x^2 - j^2)}.$$

*Then*

$$\kappa_{N,\eta}^\psi(x) > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{d}{dx} \kappa_{N,\eta}^\psi(x) < 0$$

*for all  $x > N + \eta Q^2 U_\psi$ .*

*Proof.* For  $x > N + \eta Q^2 U_\psi$  and  $u \in \text{supp } \psi$ , one has

$$x + \eta Q^2 u > N.$$

By Proposition 11.23,

$$\kappa_N(x + \eta Q^2 u) > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \kappa'_N(x + \eta Q^2 u) < 0.$$

Since  $\psi \geq 0$  and  $\int \psi = 1$ , averaging preserves positivity:

$$\kappa_{N,\eta}^\psi(x) > 0.$$

Differentiating under the integral sign gives

$$\frac{d}{dx} \kappa_{N,\eta}^\psi(x) = \int_{\mathbf{R}} \psi(u) \kappa'_N(x + \eta Q^2 u) du < 0.$$

$\square$

**Remark 11.26** (Smoothed real profile). Proposition 11.25 shows that nonnegative smoothing preserves the qualitative real-axis behavior of the exact kernel: positivity and strict monotonic decay survive averaging. Thus the Mellin-side smoothing introduced later does not destroy the basic real-profile structure of the  $N$ -point kernel.

**Remark 11.27** (Discrete Mellin projector and test-function viewpoint). Define the additive operator

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}F) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right),$$

and the associated multiplicative distribution on  $\mathbb{R}_+^\times$ ,

$$\mu_{N,Q} := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \delta_{e^{j/Q^2}}.$$

Its Mellin symbol is precisely

$$\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z) = \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} e^{zj/Q^2}.$$

Equivalently, if  $D := \frac{d}{ds}$ , then

$$\mathcal{P}_{N,Q} = P_{N,Q}(D)|_{s=0}, \quad P_{N,Q}(D) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} e^{(j/Q^2)D}.$$

Thus  $\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}$  is a polynomial in the translation semigroup, evaluated at the origin. If

$$F(s) = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_n s^n,$$

then

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}F) = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_n \frac{\mu_n^{(N)}}{Q^{2n}}, \quad \mu_n^{(N)} := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^n.$$

Lemma 11.2 shows that  $\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 1$  and that the odd part of  $\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}$  starts only at order  $2N - 1$ ; meanwhile, Corollary 11.5 identifies the exact action of  $\mathcal{P}_{N,Q}$  on odd germs as a shifted complete-homogeneous transform of the surviving odd Taylor coefficients.

In this sense, the  $N$ -point operator may be viewed as a local discrete Mellin-side projector. This is formally reminiscent of the Weil/Connes test-function viewpoint, where one probes the zero set through Mellin/Fourier transforms of multiplicative test functions and explicit- or trace-formula pairings [3, 10, 11]. The present paper does not use any global trace formula; the comparison is only structural.

A natural smoothed version is obtained by fixing an even  $\phi \in C_c^\infty(\mathbb{R})$  with  $\widehat{\phi}(0) = 1$  and setting

$$f_{N,Q,\eta}(x) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \eta^{-1} \phi\left(\frac{\log x - j/Q^2}{\eta}\right).$$

Its Mellin transform is

$$\widehat{f}_{N,Q,\eta}(z) = \widehat{\phi}(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z).$$

Hence the same low odd-jet annihilation persists after smoothing, while the finite-support projector is replaced by an honest smooth multiplicative test function. This observation is not used elsewhere in the proof, but it places the  $N$ -point cancellation layer in a more canonical operator-theoretic setting.

**Lemma 11.28** (Smoothed Mellin projector). *Let  $\phi \in C_c^\infty(\mathbf{R})$  be even and normalized by*

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) du = 1.$$

*Define its bilateral Laplace transform by*

$$\widehat{\phi}(w) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) e^{wu} du.$$

*For  $\eta > 0$ , define the smoothed additive projector*

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^\phi F) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u\right) du,$$

*whenever  $F$  is holomorphic on a neighborhood of the integration region.*

*Then:*

(1) *for every exponential mode  $F(s) = e^{zs}$ ,*

$$\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^\phi(e^{zs}) = \widehat{\phi}(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z), \quad \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z) = \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} e^{zj/Q^2};$$

(2) *the smoothed symbol preserves the exact low odd-jet annihilation:*

$$\widehat{\phi}(0) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 1, \quad \partial_z^{2r+1}(\widehat{\phi}(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z)) \Big|_{z=0} = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2);$$

(3) *if  $F$  is holomorphic on a neighborhood  $\Omega$  containing all points*

$$\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u \quad (1 \leq j \leq N, u \in \text{supp } \phi),$$

*then*

$$|\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^\phi F - \mathcal{P}_{N,Q} F| \leq \frac{\eta^2}{2} (2N-1) m_2(\phi) \sup_{\Omega} |F''|,$$

*where*

$$m_2(\phi) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} |u|^2 |\phi(u)| du.$$

*Proof.* For  $F(s) = e^{zs}$ ,

$$\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^\phi(e^{zs}) = \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} e^{zj/Q^2} \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) e^{\eta zu} du = \widehat{\phi}(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z),$$

which proves the first statement.

Since  $\phi$  is even,  $\widehat{\phi}$  is an even entire function. In particular,

$$\widehat{\phi}(0) = \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) du = 1, \quad \widehat{\phi}^{(2r+1)}(0) = 0 \quad (r \geq 0).$$

Lemma 11.2 gives

$$\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 1, \quad \partial_z^{2r+1} \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2).$$

Applying Leibniz' rule to the product  $\widehat{\phi}(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z)$  shows that all odd derivatives up to order  $2N-3$  vanish at  $z=0$ , proving the second statement.

For the quantitative comparison, expand  $F$  at  $j/Q^2$ :

$$F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u\right) = F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right) + \eta u F'\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right) + \frac{\eta^2 u^2}{2} F''(\xi_{j,u})$$

for some  $\xi_{j,u} \in \Omega$ . Since  $\phi$  is even,

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) u du = 0.$$

Also  $\int \phi(u) du = 1$ . Therefore

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u\right) du - F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right) = \frac{\eta^2}{2} \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) u^2 F''(\xi_{j,u}) du.$$

Summing against  $a_j^{(N)}$  and using Lemma 11.1,

$$\sum_{j=1}^N |a_j^{(N)}| = 2N - 1,$$

gives

$$|\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^\phi F - \mathcal{P}_{N,Q} F| \leq \frac{\eta^2}{2} (2N - 1) m_2(\phi) \sup_{\Omega} |F''|. \quad \square$$

**Remark 11.29** (Smoothing scale). Since  $N \asymp Q$ , Lemma 11.28 gives

$$\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^\phi F = \mathcal{P}_{N,Q} F + O(Q\eta^2 \sup |F''|).$$

Thus any choice  $\eta = o(Q^{-1/2})$  makes the smoothing error  $o(1)$  while preserving the exact low odd-jet annihilation. This does not enter the present proof, but it shows that the discrete  $N$ -point projector admits a genuinely smooth Mellin-side avatar with the same exact cancellation pattern.

**Proposition 11.30** (Smoothed comparison for the corrected  $N$ -point zeta scalar). *Let  $\phi \in C_c^\infty(\mathbf{R})$  be even, normalized by*

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) du = 1,$$

and set

$$U_\phi := \sup\{|u| : u \in \text{supp } \phi\}, \quad m_2(\phi) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} |u|^2 |\phi(u)| du.$$

Fix  $0 < \alpha < \rho_0$ , let

$$N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor,$$

and assume

$$0 < \eta \leq \frac{\rho_0 - \alpha}{2U_\phi Q}.$$

Define the smoothed corrected scalar

$$H_{m,\eta}(s) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) H_m(s + \eta u) du,$$

and the corresponding smoothed  $N$ -point scalar

$$\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N)}(m) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_{m,\eta}\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right).$$

Then:

(1)  $H_{m,\eta}$  is odd and holomorphic on

$$|s| < \frac{\rho_\eta}{Q}, \quad \rho_\eta := \rho_0 - U_\phi \eta Q > \alpha.$$

(2) One has the zeta-side exponential estimate

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\phi, \rho_0, \alpha} \frac{L(m) S(m)^2}{Q} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_\eta) Q},$$

where

$$\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_\eta) = \rho_\eta \left( (1 + \beta_\eta) \log(1 + \beta_\eta) - 2\beta_\eta \log \beta_\eta - (1 - \beta_\eta) \log(1 - \beta_\eta) \right), \quad \beta_\eta := \frac{\alpha}{\rho_\eta}.$$

(3) The smoothed and discrete  $N$ -point scalars satisfy

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \leq \frac{4 C_{\partial}(\rho_0) m_2(\phi)}{(\rho_0 - \alpha)^2} \frac{2N-1}{Q} \eta^2 L(m) S(m)^2.$$

In particular,

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\phi, \rho_0, \alpha} \eta^2 L(m) S(m)^2.$$

*Proof.* Since  $H_m$  is odd and  $\phi$  is even,

$$H_{m,\eta}(-s) = \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) H_m(-s + \eta u) du = \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi(u) H_m(-(s + \eta u)) du = -H_{m,\eta}(s),$$

so  $H_{m,\eta}$  is odd. If  $|s| < \rho_\eta/Q$  and  $u \in \text{supp } \phi$ , then

$$|s + \eta u| \leq |s| + \eta U_\phi < \frac{\rho_0 - U_\phi \eta Q}{Q} + \eta U_\phi = \frac{\rho_0}{Q}.$$

Since  $H_m$  is holomorphic on  $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ , it follows that  $H_{m,\eta}$  is holomorphic on  $|s| < \rho_\eta/Q$ . This proves (1).

For  $|s| = \rho_\eta/Q$  and  $u \in \text{supp } \phi$ , the same estimate gives

$$|s + \eta u| \leq \frac{\rho_0}{Q}.$$

Hence Proposition 10.1 implies

$$|H_m(s + \eta u)| \leq C_{\partial}(\rho_0) \frac{L(m) S(m)^2}{Q^3}.$$

Therefore

$$|H_{m,\eta}(s)| \leq \|\phi\|_{L^1} C_{\partial}(\rho_0) \frac{L(m) S(m)^2}{Q^3} \quad \left( |s| = \frac{\rho_\eta}{Q} \right).$$

Since  $H_{m,\eta}$  is odd and holomorphic on  $|s| < \rho_\eta/Q$ , the proof of Corollary 11.20 applies verbatim with  $\rho_0$  replaced by  $\rho_\eta$ . This gives

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\phi, \rho_0, \alpha} \frac{L(m) S(m)^2}{Q} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_\eta) Q},$$

proving (2).

For (3), note that

$$\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) = (\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^\phi - \mathcal{P}_{N,Q}) H_m.$$

Apply Lemma 11.28 with  $F = H_m$ . It remains to bound  $H_m''$  on the relevant region. Since

$$\frac{j}{Q^2} \leq \frac{N}{Q^2} \leq \frac{\alpha}{Q}, \quad \eta U_\phi \leq \frac{\rho_0 - \alpha}{2Q},$$

all points

$$\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u \quad (1 \leq j \leq N, u \in \text{supp } \phi)$$

lie in the disk

$$|s| \leq \frac{\alpha}{Q} + \eta U_\phi \leq \frac{\rho_0 + \alpha}{2Q}.$$

Thus their distance to the boundary circle  $|s| = \rho_0/Q$  is at least

$$\frac{\rho_0 - \alpha}{2Q}.$$

By Cauchy's derivative estimate and Proposition 10.1,

$$\sup_{\Omega} |H_m''| \leq \frac{2 C_{\partial}(\rho_0) L(m) S(m)^2 / Q^3}{((\rho_0 - \alpha)/(2Q))^2} = \frac{8 C_{\partial}(\rho_0)}{(\rho_0 - \alpha)^2} \frac{L(m) S(m)^2}{Q}.$$

Lemma 11.28 therefore yields

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \leq \frac{\eta^2}{2} (2N-1) m_2(\phi) \frac{8 C_{\partial}(\rho_0)}{(\rho_0 - \alpha)^2} \frac{L(m) S(m)^2}{Q},$$

which is exactly the stated bound. □

**Remark 11.31** (Microscopic smoothing regime). If

$$\eta \ll Q^{-2},$$

then Proposition 11.30 gives

$$\Xi_{\zeta, \eta}^{(N)}(m) = \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) + O\left(\frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^4}\right).$$

At the same time,

$$\rho_{\eta} = \rho_0 + O(Q^{-1}),$$

so

$$\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_{\eta}) = \delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0) + O(Q^{-1}).$$

Thus microscopic smoothing preserves the same zeta-side exponential scale while replacing the discrete projector by a genuinely smooth Mellin-side test function.

**Lemma 11.32** (Higher-order smoothed Mellin projector). *Fix an integer  $M \geq 1$ . Let  $\phi_M \in C_c^{\infty}(\mathbf{R})$  be even and satisfy*

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi_M(u) du = 1, \quad \int_{\mathbf{R}} u^{2\ell} \phi_M(u) du = 0 \quad (1 \leq \ell \leq M-1).$$

Define its bilateral Laplace transform by

$$\widehat{\phi}_M(w) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi_M(u) e^{wu} du.$$

For  $\eta > 0$ , define

$$(\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^{(M)} F) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi_M(u) F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u\right) du,$$

whenever  $F$  is holomorphic on a neighborhood of the integration region.

Then:

(1) for every exponential mode  $F(s) = e^{zs}$ ,

$$\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^{(M)}(e^{zs}) = \widehat{\phi}_M(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z), \quad \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z) = \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} e^{zj/Q^2};$$

(2) one has

$$\widehat{\phi}_M(0) = 1, \quad \widehat{\phi}_M^{(k)}(0) = 0 \quad (1 \leq k \leq 2M-1);$$

(3) the smoothed symbol preserves the exact low odd-jet annihilation:

$$\partial_z^{2r+1}(\widehat{\phi}_M(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z)) \Big|_{z=0} = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2);$$

(4) if  $F$  is holomorphic on a neighborhood  $\Omega$  containing all points

$$\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u \quad (1 \leq j \leq N, u \in \text{supp } \phi_M),$$

then

$$|\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^{(M)} F - \mathcal{P}_{N,Q} F| \leq \frac{\eta^{2M}}{(2M)!} (2N-1) m_{2M}(\phi_M) \sup_{\Omega} |F^{(2M)}|,$$

where

$$m_{2M}(\phi_M) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} |u|^{2M} |\phi_M(u)| du.$$



*Proof.* For  $F(s) = e^{zs}$ ,

$$\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^{(M)}(e^{zs}) = \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} e^{zj/Q^2} \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi_M(u) e^{\eta zu} du = \widehat{\phi}_M(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z),$$

which proves the first statement.

Since  $\phi_M$  is even, all odd moments vanish. By the imposed even-moment conditions, one also has

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} u^k \phi_M(u) du = 0 \quad (1 \leq k \leq 2M-1).$$

Differentiating  $\widehat{\phi}_M$  at 0 gives

$$\widehat{\phi}_M^{(k)}(0) = \int_{\mathbf{R}} u^k \phi_M(u) du,$$

so

$$\widehat{\phi}_M(0) = 1, \quad \widehat{\phi}_M^{(k)}(0) = 0 \quad (1 \leq k \leq 2M-1).$$

This proves the second statement.

By Lemma 11.2,

$$\widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 1, \quad \partial_z^{2r+1} \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(0) = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2).$$

Applying Leibniz' rule to  $\widehat{\phi}_M(\eta z) \widehat{\mu}_{N,Q}(z)$  shows that all odd derivatives up to order  $2N-3$  vanish at  $z=0$ , proving the third statement.

For the quantitative comparison, expand  $F$  to order  $2M-1$  at  $j/Q^2$ :

$$F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u\right) = \sum_{k=0}^{2M-1} \frac{(\eta u)^k}{k!} F^{(k)}\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right) + \frac{(\eta u)^{2M}}{(2M)!} F^{(2M)}(\xi_{j,u})$$

for some  $\xi_{j,u} \in \Omega$ . Integrating against  $\phi_M$ , all terms of order 1 through  $2M-1$  vanish by the moment conditions, while the constant term survives because  $\int \phi_M = 1$ . Hence

$$\int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi_M(u) F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2} + \eta u\right) du - F\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right) = \frac{\eta^{2M}}{(2M)!} \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi_M(u) u^{2M} F^{(2M)}(\xi_{j,u}) du.$$

Summing against  $a_j^{(N)}$  and using Lemma 11.1,

$$\sum_{j=1}^N |a_j^{(N)}| = 2N-1,$$

gives the claimed bound.  $\square$

**Proposition 11.33** (Higher-order smoothed comparison for the corrected  $N$ -point zeta scalar). *Fix an integer  $M \geq 1$ , and let  $\phi_M \in C_c^\infty(\mathbf{R})$  be even, normalized, and moment-corrected as in Lemma 11.32. Set*

$$U_M := \sup\{|u| : u \in \text{supp } \phi_M\}, \quad m_{2M}(\phi_M) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} |u|^{2M} |\phi_M(u)| du.$$

Fix  $0 < \alpha < \rho_0$ , let

$$N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor,$$

and assume

$$0 < \eta \leq \frac{\rho_0 - \alpha}{2U_M Q}.$$

Define

$$H_{m,\eta}^{(M)}(s) := \int_{\mathbf{R}} \phi_M(u) H_m(s + \eta u) du,$$

and

$$\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_{m,\eta}^{(M)}\left(\frac{j}{Q^2}\right).$$

Then:

(1)  $H_{m,\eta}^{(M)}$  is odd and holomorphic on

$$|s| < \frac{\rho_{M,\eta}}{Q}, \quad \rho_{M,\eta} := \rho_0 - U_M \eta Q > \alpha;$$

(2) one has

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m)| \ll_{\phi_M, \rho_0, \alpha} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_{M,\eta})Q};$$

(3) the smoothed and discrete  $N$ -point scalars satisfy

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \leq C_{\partial}(\rho_0) (2N-1) m_{2M}(\phi_M) \left( \frac{2}{\rho_0 - \alpha} \right)^{2M} \eta^{2M} Q^{2M-3} L(m)S(m)^2,$$

and hence

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\phi_M, \rho_0, \alpha} (\eta Q)^{2M} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^2}.$$

*Proof.* The proof of oddness and holomorphy is identical to that of Proposition 11.30, with  $\phi$  replaced by  $\phi_M$ . Likewise, on  $|s| = \rho_{M,\eta}/Q$ ,

$$|H_{m,\eta}^{(M)}(s)| \leq \|\phi_M\|_{L^1} C_{\partial}(\rho_0) \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3}.$$

Therefore the proof of Corollary 11.20 applies verbatim with  $\rho_0$  replaced by  $\rho_{M,\eta}$ , giving the stated exponential bound.

For the comparison estimate,

$$\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m) = (\mathcal{P}_{N,Q,\eta}^{(M)} - \mathcal{P}_{N,Q})H_m.$$

Apply Lemma 11.32 with  $F = H_m$ . Exactly as in the proof of Proposition 11.30, all relevant points lie at distance at least

$$\frac{\rho_0 - \alpha}{2Q}$$

from the boundary circle  $|s| = \rho_0/Q$ . Hence Cauchy's derivative estimate and Proposition 10.1 give

$$\sup_{\Omega} |H_m^{(2M)}| \leq (2M)! C_{\partial}(\rho_0) \left( \frac{2Q}{\rho_0 - \alpha} \right)^{2M} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3}.$$

Substituting this into Lemma 11.32 yields

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \leq C_{\partial}(\rho_0) (2N-1) m_{2M}(\phi_M) \left( \frac{2}{\rho_0 - \alpha} \right)^{2M} \eta^{2M} Q^{2M-3} L(m)S(m)^2,$$

as claimed. Since  $N \asymp Q$ , the final big-Oh form follows.  $\square$

**Remark 11.34** (Saturation at the natural  $Q^{-1}$  smoothing scale). Proposition 11.33 shows that higher-order moment correction improves the comparison error to order  $2M$ , but under the largest admissible smoothing scale

$$\eta \asymp Q^{-1},$$

one still has

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^2}.$$

Thus higher-order smoothing does not improve the  $Q$ -power at the natural admissible scale; its gain is in canonicity and in the ability to make the smoothed projector arbitrarily close to the discrete one once one works at a smaller scale. For example, if

$$\eta = Q^{-1-\sigma} \quad (\sigma > 0),$$

then

$$|\Xi_{\zeta,\eta}^{(N,M)}(m) - \Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \ll Q^{-2-2M\sigma} L(m)S(m)^2.$$

We isolate the toy microscopic expansion in Appendix A; the only fact used in the main argument is the following  $N$ -point preservation statement.

**Proposition 11.35** (Toy  $N$ -point transverse preservation). *Fix a compact interval*

$$D = [d_-, d_+] \subset (0, \infty),$$

let  $\rho_{\text{toy}}$  and  $u_0(D)$  be as in Lemma A.1, and fix

$$\alpha > 0.$$

For

$$N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor, \quad s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2},$$

define

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \Phi_K(\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s_j)).$$

Then, for all sufficiently large  $Q$  (depending on  $D$  and  $\alpha$ ), for  $d \in D$  and  $|u| < u_0(D)$ ,

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + O(u^4),$$

uniformly in  $d \in D$ . In particular,

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2$$

uniformly on compact  $d$ -ranges.

*Proof.* By Lemma A.1,

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E(u, d; s),$$

where  $E(u, d; s)$  is analytic in  $s$  on  $|s| < \rho_{\text{toy}}$  and uniformly bounded there for  $d \in D$  and  $|u| < u_0(D)$ . Applying the linear functional  $\Phi_K$ , define

$$R_{u,d}(s) := \Phi_K(E(u, d; s)).$$

Then  $R_{u,d}(s)$  is analytic on  $|s| < \rho_{\text{toy}}$ , and by Cauchy's estimate its Taylor coefficients satisfy

$$R_{u,d}(s) = \sum_{n \geq 0} b_n(u, d) s^n, \quad |b_n(u, d)| \ll \rho_{\text{toy}}^{-n},$$

uniformly for  $d \in D$  and  $|u| < u_0(D)$ .

Therefore

$$\Phi_K(\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s_j)) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + u^4 R_{u,d}(s_j),$$

so

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + u^4 \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} R_{u,d}(s_j).$$

Expand  $R_{u,d}$  at the microscopic nodes  $s_j = j/Q^2$ :

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} R_{u,d}(s_j) = \sum_{n \geq 0} b_n(u, d) \frac{\mu_n^{(N)}}{Q^{2n}}, \quad \mu_n^{(N)} := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^n.$$

The constant term contributes

$$b_0(u, d) \mu_0^{(N)} = b_0(u, d),$$

since  $\mu_0^{(N)} = \sum_j a_j^{(N)} = 1$  by Lemma 11.1. For the remaining terms, split into even and odd parts.

For the even terms, Lemma 11.1 gives

$$|\mu_{2\ell}^{(N)}| \leq (2N - 1) N^{2\ell},$$

so

$$\sum_{\ell \geq 1} |b_{2\ell}(u, d)| \frac{|\mu_{2\ell}^{(N)}|}{Q^{4\ell}} \ll (2N - 1) \sum_{\ell \geq 1} \rho_{\text{toy}}^{-2\ell} \frac{N^{2\ell}}{Q^{4\ell}} \ll \frac{1}{Q},$$

because  $N \asymp Q$ .

For the odd terms, Lemma 11.1 gives

$$\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)} = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2),$$

so only the tail  $r \geq N-1$  remains. Using the coefficient bound  $|b_{2r+1}(u, d)| \ll \rho_{\text{toy}}^{-(2r+1)}$ , we obtain

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |b_{2r+1}(u, d)| \frac{|\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}|}{Q^{4r+2}} \ll \sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2)^{-(2r+1)}.$$

Now apply Lemma 11.3 with

$$x = \rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2.$$

For all sufficiently large  $Q$ , one has  $x > N$ , and therefore

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}| (\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2)^{-(2r+1)} = (2N-1)N!(N-1)! (\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2)^2 \frac{\Gamma(\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2 - N)}{\Gamma(\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2 + N + 1)}.$$

Since  $N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor$  and  $x = \rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2$ , Stirling's formula gives

$$(2N-1)N!(N-1)! (\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2)^2 \frac{\Gamma(\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2 - N)}{\Gamma(\rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2 + N + 1)} = \exp(-2\alpha Q \log Q + O(Q)).$$

In particular, the residual odd toy tail is super-exponentially small on the  $Q$ -scale:

$$\sum_{r \geq N-1} |b_{2r+1}(u, d)| \frac{|\mu_{2r+1}^{(N)}|}{Q^{4r+2}} \ll \exp(-2\alpha Q \log Q + O(Q)).$$

Combining the constant, even, and odd contributions,

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} R_{u,d}(s_j) = b_0(u, d) + O(Q^{-1}) + O(e^{-cQ}),$$

and in particular

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} R_{u,d}(s_j) = O(1),$$

uniformly for  $d \in D$  and  $|u| < u_0(D)$ . Therefore

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + O(u^4),$$

uniformly in  $d \in D$ .

Because  $\Phi_K(M(d)) \neq 0$  for  $d > 0$ , and is bounded away from 0 on every compact interval  $D \subset (0, \infty)$ , the final estimate

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2$$

follows. □

**Remark 11.36** (The toy odd tail is negligible beyond all  $e^{-cQ}$ -scales). The proof of Proposition 11.35 shows more than the  $O(u^4)$  preservation statement used later: after  $N$ -point cancellation, the residual odd toy tail is of size

$$\exp(-2\alpha Q \log Q + O(Q)).$$

Thus on the toy side the  $N$ -point odd leakage is not merely exponentially small in  $Q$ ; it is negligible beyond every  $e^{-cQ}$ -scale.

On the toy side, Proposition 11.35 gives

$$(22) \quad \Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + O(u^4),$$

so on compact  $d$ -ranges,

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2.$$

Using (19),

$$(23) \quad |\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp \frac{x_0}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m).$$

**Remark 11.37** (Work in progress: calibrated size versus microscopic toy regime). As presently written, the final calibration freezes the comparison scale at a fixed value  $x = x_0(D)$ , which yields

$$u^2 \asymp \frac{x_0}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m).$$

With only the crude global bounds used later in the contradiction,

$$S(m) \ll Q^2, \quad B_\zeta(m) \asymp Q,$$

this gives at best

$$u^2 \ll x_0 Q,$$

and therefore does not by itself force the calibrated toy parameter  $u$  to lie in the microscopic toy regime  $|u| < u_0(D)$  required by Proposition 11.35.

A plausible repair is to avoid freezing the scale at  $x_0(D)$ , and instead to choose the comparison scale adaptively:

$$x = x(m) \in (0, x_0(D)].$$

Since the pairing and calibration statements are naturally formulated for  $0 < x \leq x_0(D)$ , one expects to choose  $x(m)$  so that

$$u^2 \asymp \frac{x(m)}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)$$

is forced to remain below the toy threshold  $u_0(D)^2$ . For example, if the implicit upper bound

$$u^2 \leq C \frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)$$

is available uniformly, then one may try to take

$$x(m) := \min \left\{ x_0(D), \frac{u_0(D)^2}{2C} \frac{B_\zeta(m)}{S(m)} \right\},$$

which would guarantee

$$u^2 \leq \frac{u_0(D)^2}{2}.$$

To make this repair rigorous, however, the draft must still verify that the entire calibration chain remains valid uniformly in such a variable  $x$ -regime. In particular, one still needs to check all of the following:

- (1) The pairing and denominator estimates remain uniform for all  $0 < x \leq x_0(D)$ , including the regime  $x \rightarrow 0$ , so that the calibration functional is still well-defined and the main term continues to scale linearly in  $x$ .
- (2) The fixed-scaled statements currently written in terms of

$$x = B_\zeta(m)\sigma, \quad |\sigma| \asymp Q^{-1},$$

can be upgraded to a variable/shrinking regime of the form

$$x = B_\zeta(m)\sigma, \quad |\sigma| \leq c Q^{-1},$$

or an equivalent  $0 < x \leq x_0(D)$  formulation, without loss of the transfer, whitening, and calibration estimates used later.

- (3) The remainder bound after applying the calibrated functional remains uniform in the variable- $x$  regime; in particular, one needs the normalized error estimate to stay independent of  $x$ , or at least sufficiently mild as  $x \rightarrow 0$ , so that shrinking  $x$  to enforce  $|u| < u_0(D)$  does not destroy the zeta-side control.

- (4) The cutoff choice required in the calibration remainder estimate can still be made uniformly when  $x = x(m)$  is allowed to shrink. Concretely, one must check that the condition

$$R^3 \gg \frac{1}{xQ S(m)}$$

remains compatible with the admissible cutoff regime under the adaptive choice of  $x(m)$ .

- (5) The final contradiction theorem must be reformulated so that the toy-side main term is compared at the variable scale  $x(m)$ , rather than at the fixed scale  $x_0(D)$ , and one must verify that the resulting lower bound still dominates the exponentially small zeta-side bound.

Accordingly, the small- $u$  issue does not presently appear to be a fundamental obstruction, but the current argument should be read as conditional on a variable- $x$  calibration rewrite that has not yet been carried out in the draft.

The following remark records the current status of the toy model in the overall proof strategy.

**Remark 11.38** (Work in progress: pair-like versus finite-core endgame). At the current stage of the draft, the toy anomaly model should be understood as a *pair-core first-odd-jet normal form*, not yet as a universal normal form for an arbitrary finite same-scale off-line core.

More precisely, in the pure pair model one has first-odd-jet nondegeneracy:

$$a_1^{\text{toy}}(u, d) = \kappa(d)u^2 + O(u^4), \quad \kappa(d) \neq 0,$$

so the first odd jet already detects the off-line anomaly.

However, the fixed-core analysis developed later in the draft shows that for a general finite same-scale core, cancellation may occur at the first odd order even when a genuine corrected anomaly survives at a higher odd order. Thus the toy model is presently justified as the correct first-odd-jet simplification only under a *pair-like core* hypothesis (or a perturbative enlargement thereof), not yet for an arbitrary finite core.

Accordingly, the argument now has a genuine fork:

- (1) **Pair-like branch.** If the actual same-scale core is perturbatively pair-like in the corrected microscopic sense, then the present toy-model first-jet obstruction should still apply, and the contradiction can be driven by the first odd coefficient.
- (2) **Finite-core branch.** If the actual same-scale core is not perturbatively pair-like, then the correct endgame must be reformulated in terms of a genuine finite-core anomaly model, and the obstruction should be attached not specifically to the first odd jet, but to the *first nonzero odd jet* of the corrected transverse scalar.

Thus the toy model is best viewed, at present, as the first-odd-jet simplification of a pair-like core, rather than as a universal model for all finite cores. This is one of the main places where the present manuscript should still be read as a work in progress.

## 12. LOCAL PROJECTIVE RIGIDITY OF THE ONE-PAIR AND MULTI-PAIR FAMILIES

Throughout this section,  $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$  denotes the abstract odd-germ quotient by the value/gauge family (not the height scale  $Q \asymp \log |m|$  used elsewhere in the paper). For the first residual step on the cubic-generic region, we will also introduce an explicit finite-order model  $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$  through order 5. The latter supplements, but does not globally replace, the ambient abstract quotient  $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$ .

### 12.1. Cubic leading line and the first residual class for the one-pair family. Let

$$F_h(z) \in \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}[[z^2]]$$

denote the corrected quotient odd germ of the normalized one-pair family, where  $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$  is the abstract odd-germ quotient by the value/gauge family.

**Lemma 12.1** (First-order value-family generator). *Let*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

*Let  $G_0$  and  $N_0$  denote the coincident background same-point and mixed blocks, and write*

$$X_0 := G_0^{-1/2}.$$

*Let  $L$  be the Fréchet derivative of the inverse-square-root map  $G \mapsto G^{-1/2}$  at  $G_0$ , so that*

$$(G_0 + \varepsilon H)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon L(H) + O(\varepsilon^2).$$

*If  $\dot{G}_{-,1}$ ,  $\dot{N}_1$ , and  $\dot{G}_{+,1}$  are the first-order odd pure-value variations of the left same-point block, the mixed block, and the right same-point block, respectively, then the induced first-order odd coefficient in the corrected local block is*

$$B_1 = L(\dot{G}_{-,1}) N_0 X_0 + X_0 \dot{N}_1 X_0 + X_0 N_0 L(\dot{G}_{+,1}).$$

*Equivalently, the first-order family  $V_{\text{val}}^{(1)}$  is the image of the linear map*

$$(\dot{G}_{-,1}, \dot{N}_1, \dot{G}_{+,1}) \mapsto L(\dot{G}_{-,1}) N_0 X_0 + X_0 \dot{N}_1 X_0 + X_0 N_0 L(\dot{G}_{+,1}).$$

*Proof.* The corrected local block is obtained by the analytic whitening map

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) = G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

Expand the three inputs to first odd order under a pure value deformation:

$$G_-(s) = G_0 + \varepsilon \dot{G}_{-,1} + O(\varepsilon^2), \quad N(s) = N_0 + \varepsilon \dot{N}_1 + O(\varepsilon^2), \quad G_+(s) = G_0 + \varepsilon \dot{G}_{+,1} + O(\varepsilon^2).$$

Then

$$G_{\pm}(s)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon L(\dot{G}_{\pm,1}) + O(\varepsilon^2),$$

so multiplying

$$G_-(s)^{-1/2} N(s) G_+(s)^{-1/2}$$

to first order gives

$$X_0 N_0 X_0 + \varepsilon \left( L(\dot{G}_{-,1}) N_0 X_0 + X_0 \dot{N}_1 X_0 + X_0 N_0 L(\dot{G}_{+,1}) \right) + O(\varepsilon^2).$$

The coefficient of  $\varepsilon$  is exactly the first-order generator  $B_1$ . □

**Lemma 12.2** (Whitened first-order reduction). *At the coincident background one has*

$$N_0 = G_0.$$

*If*

$$\tilde{H} := X_0 H X_0$$

*denotes whitening by  $X_0 = G_0^{-1/2}$ , then the first-order generator of Lemma 12.1 becomes*

$$\tilde{B}_1 = \tilde{N}_1 - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{-,1} - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{+,1}.$$

*Proof.* Since  $X_0 G_0 X_0 = I$ , whitening conjugates the background to the identity. The Fréchet derivative of  $G \mapsto G^{-1/2}$  at  $I$  is

$$L_I(H) = -\frac{1}{2} H.$$

Therefore, after whitening the formula of Lemma 12.1 becomes

$$\tilde{B}_1 = L_I(\tilde{G}_{-,1}) I I + I \tilde{N}_1 I + I I L_I(\tilde{G}_{+,1}) = \tilde{N}_1 - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{-,1} - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{+,1}. \quad \square$$

**Lemma 12.3** (First-order same-point span). *The first-order pure-value same-point variations span the full symmetric subspace:*

$$\text{span}\{\tilde{G}_{-,1}\} = \text{span}\{\tilde{G}_{+,1}\} = \text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

*Proof.* The corrected same-point block has the form

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Therefore an infinitesimal pure-value variation at one side gives

$$\delta G_{\pm} = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2\delta q_{\pm} & \frac{1}{2}\delta q'_{\pm} \\ \frac{1}{2}\delta q'_{\pm} & \frac{1}{12}(\delta q''_{\pm} + 6q_{\pm,0}^2\delta q_{\pm}) \end{pmatrix}.$$

As  $\delta q_{\pm}$ ,  $\delta q'_{\pm}$ , and  $\delta q''_{\pm}$  vary independently, the off-diagonal entry, the  $(1,1)$ -entry, and the pure  $(2,2)$ -direction may be varied independently. Hence the span is the full space  $\text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C})$ . Whitening by  $X_0$  preserves the symmetric subspace and is invertible, so the same conclusion holds for  $\dot{G}_{\pm,1}$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 12.4** (First-order mixed skew direction). *Let*

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \xi \\ -\xi & 0 \end{pmatrix} : \xi \in \mathbf{C} \right\}.$$

*Then the first-order pure-value mixed variations contain the full skew line:*

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) \subset \text{span}\{\tilde{N}_1\}.$$

*Equivalently, the first-order mixed family contains a nonzero skew direction.*

*Proof.* Freeze the same-point data and vary only the phase gap:

$$\Delta_m(s) \mapsto \Delta_m(s) + \varepsilon \delta \Delta(s), \quad \delta \Delta(s) = \theta s^3 + O(s^5), \quad \theta \neq 0.$$

Linearizing the mixed block formula in  $\varepsilon$ , the two off-diagonal entries vary with opposite sign, while the diagonal entries do not contribute at first odd order. More precisely,

$$\delta N_{12}(s) = \frac{\theta}{\pi}s + O(s^3), \quad \delta N_{21}(s) = -\frac{\theta}{\pi}s + O(s^3),$$

up to the overall sign convention for  $\theta$ . Hence the first odd mixed coefficient of this phase-gap variation is a nonzero element of

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

Whitening by  $X_0$  is invertible, so the whitened first-order mixed family also contains a nonzero skew element. Since  $\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C})$  is one-dimensional, this is equivalent to

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) \subset \text{span}\{\tilde{N}_1\}.$$

$\square$

**Proposition 12.5** (Generic triviality of the first quotient order). *The first-order pure-value family fills the full matrix space:*

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = M_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

*Consequently*

$$\mathcal{J}_1/V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = 0,$$

*so the generic leading quotient order is at least 3.*

*Proof.* By Lemma 12.2, the first-order generator is

$$\tilde{B}_1 = \tilde{N}_1 - \frac{1}{2}\tilde{G}_{-,1} - \frac{1}{2}\tilde{G}_{+,1}.$$

By Lemma 12.3, the same-point directions  $\tilde{G}_{-,1}$  and  $\tilde{G}_{+,1}$  span the full symmetric subspace  $\text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C})$ . By Lemma 12.4, the mixed directions contain the skew line

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

Therefore the image of the generator contains

$$\text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C}) \oplus \mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) = M_2(\mathbf{C}).$$



Hence

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = M_2(\mathbf{C}),$$

and so

$$\mathcal{J}_1/V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = 0.$$

Thus the generic leading quotient order is at least 3.  $\square$

**Remark 12.6** (Raw versus full value family). The first-order surjectivity statement concerns the full value family as it appears in the three-input derivative

$$D\mathcal{W}_{(\text{bg})}[\dot{G}_-, \dot{N}, \dot{G}_+].$$

This is larger than the raw swap-odd one-pair slice obtained by tying the left and right same-point variations together. In particular, at first order the combined family  $V_{\text{val}}^{(1)}$  fills  $M_2(\mathbf{C})$ , while the odd coefficients of the raw corrected local block are constrained by additional swap/parity structure. Thus the present notation

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(2j+1)}$$

bundles together at least two logically distinct sources of ambiguity: raw pure-value odd jets and additional normalization/basis-gauge directions. The explicit finite-order model introduced later makes this split rigorous through order 5; outside that local model, the ambient notation  $V_{\text{val}}^{(2j+1)}$  remains schematic.

**Lemma 12.7** (Rigidity of the cubic scalar  $B$ ). *Let  $I$  be a connected parameter interval, and define*

$$B(h) := \frac{q(h)^2 q'(h)}{4} - \frac{q'''(h)}{48}.$$

*Then the following are equivalent:*

- (1)  $B \equiv 0$  on  $I$ ;
- (2)  $q''' = 12q^2 q'$  on  $I$ ;
- (3) there exists a constant  $C_0 \in \mathbf{C}$  such that

$$q'' = 4q^3 + C_0 \quad \text{on } I.$$

*In particular, the hypothesis  $B \not\equiv 0$  is equivalent to excluding the special cubic ODE  $q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$ .*

*Proof.* By definition,

$$48 B = 12q^2 q' - q'''.$$

Hence  $B \equiv 0$  is equivalent to

$$q''' = (4q^3)'.$$

Integrating on the connected interval  $I$  gives

$$q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$$

for some constant  $C_0 \in \mathbf{C}$ . The converse is immediate by differentiation.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.8** (Generic cubic leading quotient order). *Let  $I$  be a connected one-pair parameter interval, and let  $J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)$  denote the cubic jet of the normalized one-pair family.*

*Assume:*

- (1) *the cubic value-family satisfies*

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(3)} \subset \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 0 & * \\ * & 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\};$$

- (2) *the background same-point block is nondegenerate, so that the diagonal entries of  $X_0 = G_0^{-1/2}$  satisfy  $x_1 \neq x_2$ ;*
- (3) *the scalar  $v(h)$  is not identically zero on  $I$ ;*
- (4)  *$B(h) \not\equiv 0$  on  $I$ , equivalently, by Lemma 12.7,  $q$  does not satisfy*

$$q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$$

*identically on  $I$ .*

Define the cubic-generic region

$$\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}} := \{ h \in I : v(h)B(h) \neq 0 \}.$$

Then  $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$  is open and dense in  $I$ , and for every  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ ,

$$[J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)] \neq 0 \quad \text{in} \quad \mathcal{J}_3/V_{\text{val}}^{(3)}.$$

More precisely, the image of  $J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)$  in the cubic quotient has nonzero diagonal-traceless component

$$v(h) B(h) (x_1 - x_2) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consequently,

$$F_h(z) = v_0(h)z^3 + v_1(h)z^5 + \cdots, \quad v_0(h) := [J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)] \neq 0$$

for  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ . Since the first quotient order is generically trivial, the generic leading quotient order is therefore exactly 3 on  $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ .

*Proof.* By assumption,

$$\text{diag } J_3^{\text{pair}}(h) = v(h) B(h) (x_1 - x_2) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Because  $V_{\text{val}}^{(3)}$  is confined to the off-diagonal sector, it cannot cancel any nonzero diagonal component. Hence for every  $h$  with  $v(h)B(h)(x_1 - x_2) \neq 0$ , the cubic quotient class  $[J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)]$  is nonzero.

Since  $x_1 \neq x_2$  is fixed and both  $v$  and  $B$  are not identically zero, the set  $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$  is nonempty; if the dependence on  $h$  is real-analytic, its complement is a proper analytic subset, hence  $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$  is open and dense. Finally, Proposition 12.5 shows that the leading quotient order is at least 3, while the present argument shows that it is equal to 3 on  $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ .  $\square$

**Remark 12.9** (What is genuinely generic here). The cubic-leading statement depends on three logically distinct inputs:

- (1)  $x_1 \neq x_2$ , a background same-point nondegeneracy condition;
- (2)  $v \not\equiv 0$ , a one-pair nonfreezing condition;
- (3) exclusion of the special ODE  $q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$ , equivalently  $B \not\equiv 0$ .

This separates the structural cubic mechanism from the residual quintic bookkeeping needed later.

**Definition 12.10** (Cubic leading line and first residual class). For  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ , the cubic quotient coefficient

$$v_0(h) = [J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)]$$

is nonzero by Proposition 12.8. Define the cubic leading line by

$$\ell_h := \mathbf{C} v_0(h) \subset \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}.$$

Let  $v_1(h) := [J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)]$  denote the quintic quotient coefficient. Its image in the residual quotient

$$\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}/\ell_h$$

is denoted by

$$\bar{v}_1(h) \in \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}/\ell_h.$$

**12.2. Normalization gauge at the first residual step.** The phrase “value/gauge family” bundles together two logically distinct sources of ambiguity:

- (1) the *pure value family*, recorded coefficientwise by the spaces  $V_{\text{val}}^{(2j+1)} \subset \mathcal{J}_{2j+1}$ , and
- (2) the *normalization gauge*, consisting of even scalar renormalizations and even jet-basis changes.

For the first residual step it is useful to separate these two.

**Definition 12.11** (Normalization gauge). Let  $F(z)$  be a matrix-valued odd germ. The normalization gauge acts by

$$F(z) \mapsto a(z) P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1},$$

where

$$a(z) = 1 + c_2 z^2 + c_4 z^4 + \dots$$

is an even scalar germ with  $a(0) = 1$ , and

$$P(z) = I + B_2 z^2 + B_4 z^4 + \dots$$

is an even  $2 \times 2$  matrix germ with  $P(0) = I$ .

**Proposition 12.12** (First-residual transformation law). *Let*

$$F(z) = A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + O(z^7)$$

*be an odd matrix germ, and let*

$$F^{\text{new}}(z) := a(z) P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1}$$

*with  $a, P$  as in Definition 12.11. Then*

$$A_3^{\text{new}} = A_3, \quad A_5^{\text{new}} = A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3].$$

*Proof.* Expand

$$P(z)^{-1} = I - B_2 z^2 + O(z^4).$$

Then

$$P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1} = (I + B_2 z^2) (A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5) (I - B_2 z^2) + O(z^7),$$

so

$$P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1} = A_3 z^3 + (A_5 + [B_2, A_3]) z^5 + O(z^7).$$

Multiplying by

$$a(z) = 1 + c_2 z^2 + O(z^4)$$

gives

$$F^{\text{new}}(z) = A_3 z^3 + (A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3]) z^5 + O(z^7),$$

as claimed.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.13** (Residual effect of normalization gauge). *Let  $\ell := \mathbf{C}A_3$ . Under the normalization gauge, the quintic coefficient changes by*

$$A_5 \mapsto A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3].$$

*Hence its class in the residual quotient modulo the leading line satisfies*

$$[A_5] \mapsto [A_5 + [B_2, A_3]] \quad \text{in} \quad \mathcal{J}_5/\ell.$$

*In particular, scalar renormalization is invisible in the first residual quotient.*

*Proof.* This is immediate from Proposition 12.12, since  $c_2 A_3 \in \ell$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 12.14** (Trace invariance under normalization gauge). *If  $A_3$  is diagonal-traceless, then every commutator  $[B_2, A_3]$  is traceless. Consequently*

$$\text{tr}(A_5^{\text{new}}) = \text{tr}(A_5)$$

*for every normalization-gauge transform  $F^{\text{new}}$  of  $F$ .*

*Proof.* The scalar renormalization term  $c_2 A_3$  is traceless because  $A_3$  is. The commutator term is traceless because

$$\mathrm{tr}[B_2, A_3] = 0.$$

Hence Proposition 12.12 gives

$$\mathrm{tr}(A_5^{\mathrm{new}}) = \mathrm{tr}(A_5).$$

□

**Proposition 12.15** (Second-residual transformation law). *Let*

$$F(z) = A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + A_7 z^7 + O(z^9)$$

*be an odd matrix germ, and let*

$$F^{\mathrm{new}}(z) := a(z) P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1}$$

*with  $a, P$  as in Definition 12.11. Then*

$$A_3^{\mathrm{new}} = A_3, \quad A_5^{\mathrm{new}} = A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3],$$

*and the septic coefficient transforms by*

$$A_7^{\mathrm{new}} = A_7 + c_2 A_5 + c_4 A_3 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.12, the formulas for  $A_3^{\mathrm{new}}$  and  $A_5^{\mathrm{new}}$  are already known. It remains to compute the  $z^7$ -coefficient.

Expand

$$P(z)^{-1} = I - B_2 z^2 + (B_2^2 - B_4) z^4 + O(z^6).$$

Then

$$P(z)F(z)P(z)^{-1} = (I + B_2 z^2 + B_4 z^4)(A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + A_7 z^7)(I - B_2 z^2 + (B_2^2 - B_4) z^4) + O(z^9).$$

Collecting the  $z^7$ -terms gives

$$A_7 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Multiplying by

$$a(z) = 1 + c_2 z^2 + c_4 z^4 + O(z^6)$$

adds the scalar contributions

$$c_2 A_5 + c_4 A_3 + c_2 [B_2, A_3].$$

Hence

$$A_7^{\mathrm{new}} = A_7 + c_2 A_5 + c_4 A_3 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2,$$

as claimed. □

**Lemma 12.16** (Quintic trace witness). *Let  $J_{5,K_1}(h)$  denote the  $K_1$ -transport contribution to the quintic jet. At the trace level, the relevant contribution is*

$$\mathrm{tr} J_{5,K_1}(h) = \kappa(h) \mathrm{tr} \left( X_0 J X_4(h) - X_4(h) J X_0 + X_3(h) J X_1(h) - X_1(h) J X_3(h) \right),$$

*since*

$$\mathrm{tr} (X_2(h) J X_2(h)) = 0$$

*for symmetric  $X_2(h)$ . Therefore*

$$\mathrm{tr} J_{5,K_1}(h) = -2\kappa(h) \left( (x_1 - x_2)r(h) + \beta(h)(u(h) - w(h)) + v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)) \right),$$

*where  $K_1 = \kappa(h)J$ ,  $v(h)$  is the off-diagonal part of  $X_1(h)$ , and  $\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)$  is the diagonal-traceless part of  $X_3(h)$ .*

*Moreover, the linear  $G_3$ -contribution to  $\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)$  is*

$$(\gamma - \alpha)^{\mathrm{lin}} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \left[ x_1^3 \frac{q'''}{24} - x_2^3 \left( \frac{q''''}{576} + \frac{q^2 q'''}{96} + \frac{q q' q''}{16} + \frac{(q')^3}{48} \right) \right].$$

*Since*

$$v(h) = -\frac{1}{4\pi(s_1 + s_2)} \eta_2(h),$$

the product  $v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h))^{\text{lin}}$  contains the monomial

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q''''(h)$$

with nonzero coefficient.

**Lemma 12.17** (Parity of the whitening expansion at a diagonal base). *Let*

$$G_0 = \text{diag}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2), \quad \lambda_1, \lambda_2 > 0,$$

and let

$$X(H) := (G_0 + H)^{-1/2}$$

for  $H$  sufficiently small. Write

$$E := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} * & 0 \\ 0 & * \end{pmatrix} \right\}, \quad O := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 0 & * \\ * & 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\}.$$

Then every multilinear Taylor coefficient of  $X(H)$  has definite matrix parity: a coefficient depending on perturbation factors  $H_1, \dots, H_n$  lies in  $E$  if an even number of the  $H_j$  lie in  $O$ , and lies in  $O$  if an odd number of the  $H_j$  lie in  $O$ .

In particular, diagonal input gives diagonal output at linear order, and a bilinear coefficient with one diagonal and one off-diagonal input is off-diagonal.

*Proof.* Use the holomorphic functional calculus

$$(G_0 + H)^{-1/2} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{\Gamma} z^{-1/2} (zI - G_0 - H)^{-1} dz,$$

where  $\Gamma$  encloses the spectrum of  $G_0 + H$ . Expanding the resolvent,

$$(zI - G_0 - H)^{-1} = R(z) + R(z)HR(z) + R(z)HR(z)HR(z) + \dots,$$

with

$$R(z) := (zI - G_0)^{-1},$$

every factor  $R(z)$  is diagonal because  $G_0$  is diagonal. Hence the matrix parity of each word

$$R(z)H_{i_1}R(z)H_{i_2} \cdots R(z)H_{i_n}R(z)$$

is exactly the parity of the product  $H_{i_1} \cdots H_{i_n}$ . Since

$$E \cdot E \subset E, \quad E \cdot O \subset O, \quad O \cdot E \subset O, \quad O \cdot O \subset E,$$

the parity rule follows. Integrating over  $z$  preserves the subspaces  $E$  and  $O$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 12.18** (No-cancellation of the quintic trace witness). *The monomial*

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q''''(h)$$

appearing in Lemma 12.16 is not produced by any other quintic contribution to  $\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)$ . More precisely, on the graded slice corresponding to

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(5)}),$$

the only contributing channels in  $\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)$  are

$$-2\kappa(h)(x_1 - x_2)r(h) \quad \text{and} \quad -2\kappa(h)v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)),$$

and their total coefficient of  $\kappa(h)\eta_2(h)q^{(5)}(h)$  is nonzero. Consequently

$$\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h) \neq 0$$

on the generic one-pair region.

*Proof.* Fix  $h$  and isolate the graded slice

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(5)}(h).$$

We first exclude all non- $K_1$  contributions. Same-point quintic terms carry no  $\kappa$ -factor, so they cannot contribute. A  $K_5$ -transport term leaves no same-point degree available, and a  $K_3$ -transport term leaves only same-point degree 2, whereas the factor  $q^{(5)}(h)$  first appears in same-point degree 3. Hence the target monomial can occur only in the  $K_1$ -transport sector.

Now consider the same-point expansion. By the explicit formula

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

the factor  $q^{(5)}(h)$  first appears only in the cubic same-point coefficient  $G_3$ , and there only in the diagonal sector, namely through the cubic Taylor term of the  $(2, 2)$ -entry coming from  $q''(t_{\pm})$ . Therefore, by Lemma 12.17, the linear  $q^{(5)}$ -contribution to  $X_3$  is diagonal. In particular it contributes to  $\gamma - \alpha$ , but not to  $\beta$ .

Likewise, the  $\eta_2(h)$ -slice of  $X_1(h)$  is off-diagonal, because

$$v(h) = -\frac{1}{4\pi(s_1 + s_2)} \eta_2(h).$$

Applying Lemma 12.17 again, the mixed  $(\eta_2, q^{(5)})$ -slice of  $X_4$  is off-diagonal. Hence it contributes to  $r$ , but not to the diagonal difference  $u - w$ .

It follows that on the graded slice  $(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(5)})$ , the term

$$-2\kappa(h) \beta(h)(u(h) - w(h))$$

does not contribute at all. Thus the only surviving  $K_1$ -channels are

$$-2\kappa(h)(x_1 - x_2)r(h) \quad \text{and} \quad -2\kappa(h)v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)).$$

To compute their combined coefficient, it suffices by multilinearity to restrict to the two perturbation directions carrying the relevant tags: an off-diagonal first-order perturbation  $A$  for the  $\eta_2$ -slice and a diagonal third-order perturbation  $D$  for the  $q^{(5)}$ -slice. Accordingly, write

$$G_0 = \text{diag}(a^2, b^2), \quad A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & u \\ u & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix},$$

and expand

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta) := (G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon U + \delta V + \varepsilon \delta W + O(\varepsilon^2, \delta^2).$$

Solving the identity

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta)(G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D)X(\varepsilon, \delta) = I$$

order by order gives

$$U_{12} = -\frac{u}{ab(a+b)}, \quad V_{22} = -\frac{d}{2b^3}, \quad W_{12} = \frac{du(a+2b)}{2ab^3(a+b)^2}.$$

Here  $U_{12}$  is the  $\eta_2$ -slice of  $v$ ,  $V_{22}$  is the  $q^{(5)}$ -slice of  $\gamma - \alpha$ , and  $W_{12}$  is the mixed  $(\eta_2, q^{(5)})$ -slice of  $r$ . Therefore the total coefficient of the target slice inside

$$(x_1 - x_2)r + v(\gamma - \alpha)$$

is

$$\left(\frac{1}{a} - \frac{1}{b}\right) W_{12} + U_{12} V_{22} = \frac{du}{a^2 b^2 (a+b)^2},$$

which is nonzero.

Thus the monomial  $\kappa(h)\eta_2(h)q^{(5)}(h)$  occurs in  $\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)$  with nonzero total coefficient and is not canceled by any other quintic contribution. Hence

$$\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h) \neq 0.$$

□

**12.3. Explicit finite-order model of the first residual quotient.** For the first residual step it is enough to work with an explicit finite-order model through order 5 on the cubic-generic region. In this range the explicit model is not merely a proxy: Proposition 12.24 canonically identifies it with the order- $\leq 5$  truncation of the ambient abstract quotient  $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$  after passage to the cubic line.

Accordingly, the first residual quintic detector is now rigorous at the finite-order ambient level. What is not addressed here is only a stronger global identification for later uses of  $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$  beyond order 5 and beyond the first residual layer.

**Definition 12.19** (Finite-order truncation of the ambient abstract quotient). Fix  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ , and let  $A_3(h)$  represent the cubic leading line  $\ell_h \subset \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$ .

Define the order- $\leq 5$  truncation of the ambient abstract quotient at  $h$  to be the quotient

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} := \frac{\mathbf{C} A_3(h) z^3 \oplus \mathcal{J}_5 z^5}{(V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}) z^5}.$$

Equivalently,  $\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)}$  is the cubic–quintic odd-germ quotient in which the quintic ambiguity is generated exactly by the raw pure-value quintic slice and the realized normalization-gauge shadows through order 5.

Its first residual quotient is

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} / \ell_h \cong \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}).$$

**Definition 12.20** (Swap involution on cubic–quintic germs). Let

$$J_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

For a truncated odd germ

$$F(z) = A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + O(z^7)$$

define

$$\Sigma(F)(z) := J_0 F(-z) J_0 = -J_0 A_3 J_0 z^3 - J_0 A_5 J_0 z^5 + O(z^7).$$

Thus the induced involution on quintic coefficients is

$$\Sigma_5(A) := -J_0 A J_0.$$

**Definition 12.21** (Cubic-normalized swap-symmetric raw corrected germ through order 5). Fix  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ , and choose a diagonal-traceless matrix

$$A_3(h)$$

representing the cubic leading line  $\ell_h$ .

A cubic-normalized swap-symmetric raw corrected germ through order 5 at  $h$  is a truncated odd germ of the form

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h) z^3 + A_5 z^5 + O(z^7)$$

obtained from the corrected one-pair local block by a cubic normalization that preserves the swap symmetry inherited from symmetric placement.

Its raw pure-value quintic slice is the coefficient space

$$V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)$$

consisting of all quintic coefficients  $A_5$  arising in this way under pure value deformations at the fixed parameter  $h$ .

**Lemma 12.22** (Raw quintic slice is anti-fixed). *For every  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ ,*

$$V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) \subset \{A \in M_2(\mathbf{C}) : J_0 A J_0 = -A\}.$$

*In particular,*

$$\text{tr}(V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)) = 0.$$

*Proof.* By Definition 12.21, every cubic-normalized raw corrected representative satisfies

$$R_h(-z) = J_0 R_h(z) J_0.$$

Writing

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5z^5 + O(z^7),$$

coefficient comparison at order  $z^5$  gives

$$J_0 A_5 J_0 = -A_5.$$

Hence every  $A_5 \in V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)$  is anti-fixed. If

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$$

satisfies  $J_0 A J_0 = -A$ , then

$$\begin{pmatrix} d & c \\ b & a \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -a & -b \\ -c & -d \end{pmatrix},$$

so  $d = -a$ , and therefore  $\text{tr}(A) = 0$ . □

**Definition 12.23** (Quintic ambiguity space and explicit first residual quotient). For  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ , let  $V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)$  be the raw pure-value quintic slice from Definition 12.21.

Define the normalization-gauge quintic shadow space  $\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}$  to be the set of all differences

$$\tilde{A}_5 - A_5$$

arising from two cubic-normalized swap-symmetric raw corrected germs

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5z^5 + O(z^7), \quad \tilde{R}_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + \tilde{A}_5z^5 + O(z^7),$$

of the same raw corrected local object through order 5, when those two representatives are related by the allowed normalization gauge.

By Corollary 12.13, every such shadow has the form

$$\tilde{A}_5 - A_5 = c_2 A_3(h) + [B_2, A_3(h)],$$

but  $\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}$  is defined to consist only of the actually realized gauge shadows.

Set

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) := V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}.$$

Define the explicit first residual quotient by

$$\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} := \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)).$$

**Proposition 12.24** (Finite-order comparison theorem). *For each  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ , the order- $\leq 5$  truncation of the ambient abstract quotient and the explicit first residual model agree canonically:*

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} / \ell_h \cong \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}.$$

*Equivalently, after passing to the cubic-generic region and truncating through order 5, the first residual ambiguity in the ambient abstract quotient is exactly the ambiguity built into Definition 12.23.*

*Proof.* By Definition 12.19,

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} = \frac{\mathbf{C} A_3(h)z^3 \oplus \mathcal{J}_5 z^5}{(V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)})z^5}.$$

Passing to the first residual quotient by the cubic line  $\ell_h = \mathbf{C} A_3(h)$  gives

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} / \ell_h \cong \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}).$$

By Definition 12.23,

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) = V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)},$$



so the right-hand side is exactly

$$\mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)) = \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}.$$

This is the claimed canonical identification.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.25** (Gauge shadows are anti-fixed). *For every  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ ,*

$$\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)} \subset \{A \in M_2(\mathbf{C}) : J_0 A J_0 = -A\}.$$

*In particular,*

$$\text{tr}(\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Let

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5z^5 + O(z^7), \quad \tilde{R}_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + \tilde{A}_5z^5 + O(z^7)$$

be two cubic-normalized swap-symmetric representatives of the same raw corrected local object through order 5, related by the allowed normalization gauge. By Definition 12.21, both satisfy

$$R_h(-z) = J_0 R_h(z) J_0, \quad \tilde{R}_h(-z) = J_0 \tilde{R}_h(z) J_0.$$

Comparing coefficients at order  $z^5$  gives

$$J_0 A_5 J_0 = -A_5, \quad J_0 \tilde{A}_5 J_0 = -\tilde{A}_5.$$

Subtracting,

$$J_0(\tilde{A}_5 - A_5)J_0 = -(\tilde{A}_5 - A_5).$$

Since  $\tilde{A}_5 - A_5 \in \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}$  by Definition 12.23, every gauge shadow is anti-fixed. Tracelessness follows as in Lemma 12.22.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.26** (Trace-free quintic ambiguity in the explicit finite-order model). *For every  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ ,*

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) \subset \{A \in M_2(\mathbf{C}) : J_0 A J_0 = -A\}.$$

*Equivalently, the involution  $\Sigma_5$  preserves the quintic ambiguity space and acts trivially on it.*

*In particular,*

$$\text{tr}(V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Combine Lemma 12.22 and Lemma 12.25; by Definition 12.23,

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) = V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}.$$

$\square$

**Corollary 12.27** (Trace descends on the explicit first residual quotient). *For every  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ , trace annihilates*

$$\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h).$$

*Hence trace descends to a well-defined linear functional*

$$\tau_h : \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} \rightarrow \mathbf{C}.$$

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.26, trace vanishes on  $V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)$ . It also vanishes on  $\mathbf{C} A_3(h)$  because  $A_3(h)$  is diagonal-traceless.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.28** (Generic first residual nonvanishing in the explicit finite-order model). *There exists an open dense subset*

$$\mathcal{U}_{\text{res}} \subset \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$$

*such that*

$$\bar{v}_1(h) \neq 0 \quad \text{in } \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$$

*for every  $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{res}}$ .*

*Hence the one-pair quotient odd germ is not projectively constant on  $\mathcal{U}_{\text{res}}$  at the explicit first residual level.*

*Proof.* By Corollary 12.27, trace defines a linear functional

$$\tau_h : \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} \rightarrow \mathbf{C}.$$

By Lemma 12.18,

$$\mathrm{tr} J_5^{\mathrm{pair}}(h) \neq 0$$

on the cubic-generic region. Hence there is an open dense subset

$$\mathcal{U}_{\mathrm{res}} \subset \mathcal{U}_{\mathrm{cub}}$$

on which

$$\mathrm{tr} J_5^{\mathrm{pair}}(h) \neq 0.$$

For such  $h$ ,

$$\tau_h(\bar{v}_1(h)) = \mathrm{tr} J_5^{\mathrm{pair}}(h) \neq 0,$$

so  $\bar{v}_1(h) \neq 0$  in  $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$ . □

**Remark 12.29** (Status of the explicit first residual model). The first residual step is now closed at the finite-order ambient level. Indeed, Proposition 12.24 identifies the explicit quotient  $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$  canonically with the order- $\leq 5$  truncation of the ambient abstract quotient  $\mathcal{Q}^{\mathrm{abs}}$  modulo the cubic line on the cubic-generic region.

Thus the remaining issue is no longer a finite-order comparison theorem for the first residual layer. What remains, if one wants a stronger global ambient identification, is a separate theorem showing that later uses of  $\mathcal{Q}^{\mathrm{abs}}$  beyond order 5 do not introduce any new ambiguity relevant to the downstream multi-pair and global arguments.

**Remark 12.30** (Beyond the first residual trace). The quintic trace is the first scalar residual detector, but it is not the end of the one-pair local structure. The later fixed-sector refinement  $A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}, A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}, \Delta_7$  indicates that the residual germ carries further geometric information beyond the first trace channel.

**12.4. Fixed-sector refinement at quintic and septic order.** The trace witness at quintic order suggests a more structured refinement of the one-pair residual germ than the trace alone records. For bookkeeping purposes, it is convenient to decompose the quintic and septic coefficients into fixed and anti-fixed parts with respect to the involution

$$\iota(A) := J_0 A J_0, \quad J_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Write

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A) := \frac{1}{2}(A + J_0 A J_0), \quad \pi_{\mathfrak{a}}(A) := \frac{1}{2}(A - J_0 A J_0).$$

Then

$$\mathfrak{f} = \mathrm{span}\{I, S\}, \quad \mathfrak{a} = \mathrm{span}\{D, J\},$$

where

$$I = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad S = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

**Definition 12.31** (Fixed-sector quintic and septic coefficients). Let

$$F_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5(h)z^5 + A_7(h)z^7 + \dots$$

denote the normalized one-pair quotient odd germ on the cubic-generic region. Its fixed-sector quintic and septic coefficients are defined by

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) := \pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A_5(h)), \quad A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) := \pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A_7(h)).$$

Write

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) = u_5(h)I + v_5(h)S, \quad A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) = u_7(h)I + v_7(h)S.$$

**Definition 12.32** (Second residual determinant). On the cubic-generic region, define

$$\Delta_7(h) := u_7(h)v_5(h) - u_5(h)v_7(h).$$

**Remark 12.33** (Interpretation). The quintic fixed-sector vector  $A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h)$  refines the first residual data beyond the trace detector alone, and the determinant  $\Delta_7(h)$  records the next residual quotient at septic order. In the working notes, these form the first two nontrivial layers of a one-pair residual package:

$$c(h), \quad A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h), \quad \Delta_7(h).$$

The current draft now records explicit coefficient formulas for the quintic commutator contribution and the septic  $K_1$ -transport contribution in the existing notation  $(u, v, w, \alpha, \beta, \gamma, r, \dots)$ . The canonical order-7 fixed-sector content is the quotient class

$$[A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}] \in \mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}},$$

equivalently the second residual determinant

$$\Delta_7 = u_7v_5 - u_5v_7.$$

What remains non-unique is only the raw representative pair  $(u_7, v_7)$ , which is defined only up to the one-dimensional septic gauge ambiguity along the quintic fixed-sector line  $\mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}$ . Thus the later geometry should be formulated in terms of the canonical quotient-level order-7 data  $[A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}]$  and  $\Delta_7$ , rather than a uniquely chosen raw pair  $(u_7, v_7)$ . At the canonical level, these are the natural variables for the geometric reformulation of the multi-pair problem; raw representatives  $(u_7, v_7)$  may be chosen locally by gauge-fixing when convenient, but are not themselves canonical.

**Proposition 12.34** (Projected septic gauge law). *Assume the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving in the sense that*

$$B_2, B_4 \in \mathfrak{f}, \quad A_3 \in \mathfrak{a},$$

with

$$\mathfrak{f} = \text{span}\{I, S\}, \quad \mathfrak{a} = \text{span}\{D, J\}.$$

Then the fixed-sector septic coefficient satisfies

$$(A_7^{\mathfrak{f}})^{\text{new}} = A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} + c_2A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Equivalently, the septic fixed-sector ambiguity is one-dimensional and lies along the quintic fixed-sector line.

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.15,

$$A_7^{\text{new}} = A_7 + c_2A_5 + c_4A_3 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + c_2[B_2, A_3] + A_3B_2^2 - B_2A_3B_2.$$

Apply the fixed-sector projection  $\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}$  term by term.

Since  $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$ , one has

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(c_4A_3) = 0.$$

Because  $B_4 \in \mathfrak{f}$  and  $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$ ,

$$[B_4, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

so

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}[B_4, A_3] = 0.$$

Likewise,

$$[B_2, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

hence

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(c_2[B_2, A_3]) = 0.$$

Now decompose

$$A_5 = A_5^{\mathfrak{f}} + A_5^{\mathfrak{a}}.$$

Since  $\mathfrak{f} = \text{span}\{I, S\}$  is abelian,

$$[B_2, A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}] = 0.$$

And since  $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$  and  $A_5^{\mathfrak{a}} \in \mathfrak{a}$ ,

$$[B_2, A_5^{\mathfrak{a}}] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

so

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}[B_2, A_5] = 0.$$

Finally,  $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$  implies  $B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{f}$ . Therefore

$$A_3 B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{af} \subset \mathfrak{a}, \quad B_2 A_3 B_2 \in \mathfrak{faf} \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

and hence

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2) = 0.$$

Thus the only term surviving fixed projection is

$$c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}},$$

and we conclude

$$(A_7^{\mathfrak{f}})^{\text{new}} = A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} + c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}. \quad \square$$

**Corollary 12.35** (Gauge invariance of the second residual determinant). *Under a symmetry-preserving normalization gauge, the scalar*

$$\Delta_7 = u_7 v_5 - u_5 v_7$$

*is invariant.*

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.34,

$$(A_7^{\mathfrak{f}})^{\text{new}} = A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} + c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Writing

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}} = u_5 I + v_5 S, \quad A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} = u_7 I + v_7 S,$$

the new septic pair is

$$(u_7^{\text{new}}, v_7^{\text{new}}) = (u_7, v_7) + c_2(u_5, v_5).$$

Therefore

$$\Delta_7^{\text{new}} = (u_7 + c_2 u_5) v_5 - u_5 (v_7 + c_2 v_5) = u_7 v_5 - u_5 v_7 = \Delta_7. \quad \square$$

**Definition 12.36** (Septic normalization-shadow sectors). In the notation of Proposition 12.15, define the order-2 and order-4 septic normalization-shadow sectors by

$$A_{7,K_5} := c_2 A_5 + [B_2, A_5],$$

and

$$A_{7,K_3} := c_4 A_3 + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Then the exact septic transformation law may be written

$$A_7^{\text{new}} = A_7 + A_{7,K_5} + A_{7,K_3}.$$

When the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving, these are the septic  $K_5$ - and  $K_3$ -transport shadow sectors.

**Proposition 12.37** (Projected septic  $K_5$ -shadow law). *Assume the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving in the sense of Proposition 12.34. Then*

$$A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}} = c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

*In particular,*

$$A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}} \in \mathbf{C} A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

*Proof.* By Definition 12.36,

$$A_{7,K_5} = c_2 A_5 + [B_2, A_5].$$

Apply the fixed-sector projection  $\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}$ . Decompose

$$A_5 = A_5^{\mathfrak{f}} + A_5^{\mathfrak{a}}.$$

Since  $\mathfrak{f} = \text{span}\{I, S\}$  is abelian,

$$[B_2, A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}] = 0.$$

And since  $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$  and  $A_5^{\mathfrak{a}} \in \mathfrak{a}$ ,

$$[B_2, A_5^{\mathfrak{a}}] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

so its fixed-sector projection vanishes. Therefore

$$A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}} = \pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(c_2 A_5 + [B_2, A_5]) = c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}. \quad \square$$

**Proposition 12.38** (Projected septic  $K_3$ -shadow vanishing). *Assume the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving in the sense of Proposition 12.34. Then*

$$A_{7,K_3}^{\mathfrak{f}} = 0.$$

*Proof.* By Definition 12.36,

$$A_{7,K_3} = c_4 A_3 + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Since  $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$ , one has

$$c_4 A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}.$$

Because  $B_4 \in \mathfrak{f}$  and  $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$ ,

$$[B_4, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a}.$$

Likewise,

$$[B_2, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

hence

$$c_2 [B_2, A_3] \in \mathfrak{a}.$$

Finally,  $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$  implies  $B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{f}$ , so

$$A_3 B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{a} \mathfrak{f} \subset \mathfrak{a}, \quad B_2 A_3 B_2 \in \mathfrak{f} \mathfrak{a} \mathfrak{f} \subset \mathfrak{a}.$$

Thus every term of  $A_{7,K_3}$  is anti-fixed, and therefore

$$A_{7,K_3}^{\mathfrak{f}} = \pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A_{7,K_3}) = 0. \quad \square$$

**Remark 12.39** (Interpretation of the septic shadow sectors). Propositions 12.37 and 12.38 show that the lower-order normalization shadows at septic order contribute no new canonical fixed-sector information beyond the already-known quintic line  $\mathbf{C} A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}$ .

**Proposition 12.40** (Explicit fixed-sector formulas at quintic order). *Write*

$$X_1 = \begin{pmatrix} u & v \\ v & w \end{pmatrix}, \quad X_3 = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha & \beta \\ \beta & \gamma \end{pmatrix}.$$

*Then the fixed-sector part of the basic quintic commutator channel*

$$X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3$$

*is*

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3) = (v(\gamma - \alpha) + \beta(u - w))I + (\gamma u - \alpha w)S.$$

*Consequently, for the quintic fixed-sector coefficient*

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) = u_5(h)I + v_5(h)S,$$

*the commutator-type contribution is explicitly*

$$u_5^{(\text{comm})} = v(\gamma - \alpha) + \beta(u - w), \quad v_5^{(\text{comm})} = \gamma u - \alpha w.$$

*Proof.* A direct computation gives

$$X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3 = \begin{pmatrix} -2\alpha v + 2\beta u & -\alpha w + \gamma u \\ -\alpha w + \gamma u & -2\beta w + 2\gamma v \end{pmatrix}.$$

The fixed-sector projection of a symmetric matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ B & C \end{pmatrix}$$

is

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}} \begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ B & C \end{pmatrix} = \frac{A+C}{2} I + B S.$$

Applying this to the displayed matrix gives

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3) = \frac{(-2\alpha v + 2\beta u) + (-2\beta w + 2\gamma v)}{2} I + (\gamma u - \alpha w) S,$$

which simplifies to

$$(v(\gamma - \alpha) + \beta(u - w))I + (\gamma u - \alpha w)S.$$

□

**Proposition 12.41** (Explicit septic  $K_1$ -transport fixed-sector formulas). *Write*

$$\begin{aligned} X_0 &= \text{diag}(x_1, x_2), & X_1 &= \begin{pmatrix} u & v \\ v & w \end{pmatrix}, & X_2 &= \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{pmatrix}, \\ X_4 &= \begin{pmatrix} p & r \\ r & s \end{pmatrix}, & X_5 &= \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_5 & \beta_5 \\ \beta_5 & \gamma_5 \end{pmatrix}, & X_6 &= \begin{pmatrix} \mu_6 & \nu_6 \\ \nu_6 & \lambda_6 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned}$$

Then the fixed-sector parts of the three septic  $K_1$ -transport channels are

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(X_5 J X_1 - X_1 J X_5) = (\beta_5(u - w) + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5))I + (\gamma_5 u - \alpha_5 w)S,$$

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(X_2 J X_4 - X_4 J X_2) = (b(p - s) + r(c - a))I + (cp - as)S,$$

and

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(X_0 J X_6 - X_6 J X_0) = (x_2 - x_1)\nu_6 I + (x_2\mu_6 - x_1\lambda_6)S.$$

Consequently, if the septic  $K_1$ -transport fixed-sector coefficient is written

$$A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) = u_{7,K_1}(h)I + v_{7,K_1}(h)S,$$

then

$$u_{7,K_1} = \kappa \left( (x_2 - x_1)\nu_6 + \beta_5(u - w) + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5) + b(p - s) + r(c - a) \right),$$

$$v_{7,K_1} = \kappa \left( x_2\mu_6 - x_1\lambda_6 + \gamma_5 u - \alpha_5 w + cp - as \right).$$

*Proof.* For two symmetric matrices

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{pmatrix}, \quad Y = \begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ q & r \end{pmatrix},$$

a direct calculation gives

$$XJY - YJX = \begin{pmatrix} -2aq + 2bp & -ar + cp \\ -ar + cp & -2br + 2cq \end{pmatrix}.$$

Taking fixed-sector projection yields

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(XJY - YJX) = (b(p - r) + q(c - a))I + (cp - ar)S.$$

Applying this formula to  $(X, Y) = (X_5, X_1)$  and  $(X, Y) = (X_2, X_4)$  gives the first two displayed identities.

For the  $X_0/X_6$  channel, a direct multiplication gives

$$X_0 J X_6 - X_6 J X_0 = \begin{pmatrix} -2x_1\nu_6 & -x_1\lambda_6 + x_2\mu_6 \\ -x_1\lambda_6 + x_2\mu_6 & 2x_2\nu_6 \end{pmatrix},$$

whose fixed-sector part is

$$(x_2 - x_1)\nu_6 I + (x_2\mu_6 - x_1\lambda_6)S.$$

Summing the three channels gives the stated formulas for  $u_{7,K_1}$  and  $v_{7,K_1}$ . □

**Definition 12.42** (Septic  $K_1$ -residual determinant). If

$$A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) = u_{7,K_1}(h)I + v_{7,K_1}(h)S,$$

define the corresponding septic  $K_1$ -residual determinant by

$$\Delta_{7,K_1}(h) := u_{7,K_1}(h)v_5(h) - u_5(h)v_{7,K_1}(h).$$

**Corollary 12.43** (Direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven septic slice). *On the direct linear  $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice, the septic  $K_1$ -transport fixed-sector contribution is  $I$ -directional. More precisely,*

$$v_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = 0,$$

and

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = \kappa \left( (x_2 - x_1) \nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})} \right),$$

so in particular

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} = u_7^{(q^{(7)})} v_5.$$

*Proof.* On the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice, the linear  $X_5$ -input is diagonal, hence

$$\beta_5^{(q^{(7)})} = 0.$$

The mixed  $X_6$ -slice is off-diagonal on this grading, so

$$\mu_6^{(q^{(7)})} = \lambda_6^{(q^{(7)})} = 0.$$

Moreover the  $X_2/X_4$ -channel does not lie on the pure  $(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(7)})$ -slice. Therefore the  $S$ -component vanishes and the displayed formula for  $u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}$  follows from Proposition 12.41. Since

$$\Delta_7 = u_7 v_5 - u_5 v_7,$$

the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -slice satisfies

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} = u_7^{(q^{(7)})} v_5. \quad \square$$

**Proposition 12.44** (Noncancellation of the direct septic  $K_1$  witness). *On the graded slice*

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(7)}),$$

*the only contributing channels to*

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}$$

*are*

$$\kappa(x_2 - x_1) \nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} \quad \text{and} \quad \kappa v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})},$$

*and their total coefficient of the monomial*

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(7)}(h)$$

*is nonzero. Consequently,*

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}(h) \neq 0$$

*on the generic one-pair region.*

*Proof.* Fix  $h$  and isolate the graded slice

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(7)}(h).$$

By Corollary 12.43, the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice is  $I$ -directional and is given by

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = \kappa \left( (x_2 - x_1) \nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})} \right).$$

Thus it remains only to show that the two displayed channels do not cancel.

Now consider the same-point expansion. By the explicit formula

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

the factor  $q^{(7)}(h)$  first appears only in the quintic same-point coefficient  $G_5$ , and there only in the diagonal sector, namely through the quintic Taylor term of the  $(2, 2)$ -entry coming from  $q''(t_{\pm})$ . Therefore, by Lemma 12.17, the linear  $q^{(7)}$ -contribution to  $X_5$  is diagonal. In particular it contributes to  $\gamma_5 - \alpha_5$ , but not to  $\beta_5$ .

Likewise, the  $\eta_2(h)$ -slice of  $X_1(h)$  is off-diagonal, because

$$v(h) = -\frac{1}{4\pi(s_1 + s_2)} \eta_2(h).$$

Applying Lemma 12.17 again, the mixed  $(\eta_2, q^{(7)})$ -slice of  $X_6$  is off-diagonal. Hence it contributes to  $\nu_6$ , but not to  $\mu_6$  or  $\lambda_6$ .

Thus the only contributing channels on the graded slice

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(7)})$$

are exactly

$$\kappa(x_2 - x_1)\nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} \quad \text{and} \quad \kappa v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})}.$$

To compute their combined coefficient, it suffices by multilinearity to restrict to the two perturbation directions carrying the relevant tags: an off-diagonal first-order perturbation  $A$  for the  $\eta_2$ -slice and a diagonal fifth-order perturbation  $D$  for the  $q^{(7)}$ -slice. Accordingly, write

$$G_0 = \text{diag}(a^2, b^2), \quad A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & u \\ u & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix},$$

and expand

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta) := (G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon U + \delta V + \varepsilon \delta W + O(\varepsilon^2, \delta^2).$$

Solving the identity

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta) (G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D) X(\varepsilon, \delta) = I$$

order by order gives

$$U_{12} = -\frac{u}{ab(a+b)}, \quad V_{22} = -\frac{d}{2b^3}, \quad W_{12} = \frac{du(a+2b)}{2ab^3(a+b)^2}.$$

Here  $U_{12}$  is the  $\eta_2$ -slice of  $v$ ,  $V_{22}$  is the  $q^{(7)}$ -slice of  $\gamma_5 - \alpha_5$ , and  $W_{12}$  is the mixed  $(\eta_2, q^{(7)})$ -slice of  $\nu_6$ . Therefore the total coefficient of the target slice inside

$$(x_2 - x_1)\nu_6 + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)$$

is

$$\left(\frac{1}{a} - \frac{1}{b}\right) W_{12} + U_{12} V_{22} = \frac{du}{a^2 b^2 (a+b)^2},$$

which is nonzero.

Thus the monomial

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(7)}(h)$$

occurs in  $u_{7, K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}(h)$  with nonzero total coefficient, so

$$u_{7, K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}(h) \neq 0.$$

□

**Remark 12.45** (Septic  $K_1$  trace target). At the graded level, the septic  $K_1$ -transport channel is the first odd transport sector capable of coupling the new same-point  $q^{(7)}$ -slice into the fixed-sector septic residual. In particular, the expected highest new contribution to the septic determinant is carried by the  $K_1$ -channel, in parallel with the earlier quintic trace witness at order 5.

**Lemma 12.46** (Parity elimination of the pure same-point septic sector). *Let  $t_{\pm} = h \pm s/2$ , and let the odd two-point germ be defined as the odd part under the involution*

$$s \longmapsto -s \quad (\text{equivalently } t_+ \leftrightarrow t_-).$$

*Let  $A_{7, \text{pure}}$  denote the pure same-point septic sector, i.e. the septic contribution built only from the same-point blocks and their whitening, with no transport factor coming from the ordered pair  $(t_+, t_-)$ .*



Then  $A_{7,\text{pure}}$  is even in  $s$ , hence vanishes in the odd two-point germ. In particular,

$$A_{7,\text{pure}} = 0 \quad \text{in the odd germ}, \quad A_{7,\text{pure}}^{\text{f}} = 0.$$

Consequently, pure same-point septic terms do not contribute to  $\Delta_7$ , and in particular do not contribute to the weight-one part  $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$ .

*Proof.* A pure same-point septic term depends only on midpoint jet data at  $h$ , i.e. on the same-point expansion at the midpoint, and carries no transport factor coming from the ordered pair  $(t_+, t_-)$ . Therefore it is invariant under exchanging the two points:

$$t_+ \leftrightarrow t_-.$$

Since this exchange is exactly the involution  $s \mapsto -s$ , every pure same-point septic term is an even function of  $s$ .

By definition, the odd two-point germ is obtained by projecting to the odd part under  $s \mapsto -s$ . Hence every even contribution vanishes in that projection. Therefore

$$A_{7,\text{pure}} = 0 \quad \text{in the odd germ.}$$

Applying fixed-sector projection gives

$$A_{7,\text{pure}}^{\text{f}} = 0.$$

Since  $\Delta_7$  is extracted from the odd pair germ after fixed-sector projection and quotient normalization, pure same-point septic terms contribute nothing to  $\Delta_7$ , and therefore nothing to  $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 12.47** (Weight-one septic reduction to the direct  $K_1$  slice). *Let  $[\cdot]^{[1]}$  denote the part linear in the first genuinely new same-point  $q^{(7)}$ -slice. Then*

$$[\Delta_7]^{[1]} = [\Delta_{7,K_1}]^{[1]}.$$

*Equivalently, the highest genuinely new  $q^{(7)}$ -coefficient of the septic residual determinant comes only from the direct septic  $K_1$ -transport slice.*

*Proof.* The first genuinely new  $q^{(7)}$ -slice enters the same-point expansion at order 5, so

$$X_j^{[1]} = 0 \quad (j < 5).$$

Hence every septic transport sector built only from lower same-point orders is weight zero; in particular, the  $K_3$ - and  $K_5$ -transport sectors do not contribute to  $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$ .

By Lemma 12.46, pure same-point septic terms also do not contribute to  $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$ , because they vanish already in the odd two-point germ.

Thus the only septic sector that can see the weight-one  $q^{(7)}$ -slice is the direct  $K_1$ -transport sector, and therefore

$$[\Delta_7]^{[1]} = [\Delta_{7,K_1}]^{[1]}. \quad \square$$

**Proposition 12.48** (Generic nonvanishing of the direct septic slice under nontrivial quintic fixed-sector coefficient). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval contained in the quintic-generic region. Assume*

$$v_5 \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Then the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice of the full total septic residual determinant is generically nonzero on  $J$ . Equivalently,*

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Proof.* By Corollary 12.47,

$$[\Delta_7]^{[1]} = [\Delta_{7,K_1}]^{[1]}.$$

Thus the highest genuinely new direct  $q^{(7)}$ -coefficient of the total septic residual determinant is the same as that of the direct  $K_1$ -transport slice.

By Proposition 12.44, the direct septic  $K_1$  witness is generically nonzero on the quintic-generic region. In particular,

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Moreover, by Corollary 12.43, on the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice one has

$$v_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = 0, \quad \Delta_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} v_5.$$

Since  $v_5 \not\equiv 0$  on  $J$ , it follows that

$$\Delta_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Therefore

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J,$$

as claimed.  $\square$

**Theorem 12.49** (Quotient-septic closure). *Let the septic odd-germ coefficient be decomposed as*

$$A_7 = A_{7,K_1} + A_{7,K_5} + A_{7,K_3} + A_{7,\text{pure}},$$

where  $A_{7,K_1}$  is the direct  $K_1$ -transport sector,  $A_{7,K_5}$  and  $A_{7,K_3}$  are the septic normalization-shadow sectors from Definition 12.36, and  $A_{7,\text{pure}}$  is the pure same-point septic sector from Lemma 12.46.

Then

$$A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} = A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}} + A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}},$$

with

$$A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}} \in \mathbf{C} A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Consequently,

$$[A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}] = [A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}}] \quad \text{in } \mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}},$$

and

$$\Delta_7 = \Delta_{7,K_1}.$$

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.38,

$$A_{7,K_3}^{\mathfrak{f}} = 0.$$

By Lemma 12.46,

$$A_{7,\text{pure}}^{\mathfrak{f}} = 0.$$

Therefore

$$A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} = A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}} + A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

By Proposition 12.37,

$$A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}} \in \mathbf{C} A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Hence  $A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}$  and  $A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}}$  define the same class in the quotient

$$\mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Writing

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}} = u_5 I + v_5 S, \quad A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}} = u_{7,K_1} I + v_{7,K_1} S,$$

this quotient equality means precisely that

$$A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} = A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}} + \chi A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}$$

for some scalar  $\chi$ . Therefore

$$\Delta_7 = (u_{7,K_1} + \chi u_5) v_5 - u_5 (v_{7,K_1} + \chi v_5) = u_{7,K_1} v_5 - u_5 v_{7,K_1} = \Delta_{7,K_1},$$

where  $\Delta_{7,K_1}$  is as in Definition 12.42.  $\square$

**Remark 12.50** (Status of the order-7 fixed-sector package). The order-7 fixed-sector analysis is now closed at the canonical quotient level. By Theorem 12.49, the full total septic fixed-sector class satisfies

$$[A_7^f] = [A_{7,K_1}^f] \quad \text{in } \mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^f,$$

and the canonical second residual determinant is

$$\Delta_7 = \Delta_{7,K_1}.$$

What remains non-unique is only the raw representative of  $A_7^f$  inside the affine line

$$A_{7,K_1}^f + \mathbf{C}A_5^f,$$

as recorded by Proposition 12.34. Equivalently, the full lower/mixed septic completion of the raw total pair  $(u_7, v_7)$  is not canonically determined. This remaining gauge-dependent choice does not affect the quotient class  $[A_7^f]$  or the residual determinant  $\Delta_7$  used in the later geometric arguments.

**Remark 12.51** (Local gauge-fixing for raw septic representatives). Although the raw representative pair  $(u_7, v_7)$  is not canonical, local choices may be made by fixing a gauge section along the quintic fixed-sector line. Indeed, Proposition 12.34 gives

$$(u_7^{\text{new}}, v_7^{\text{new}}) = (u_7, v_7) + c_2(u_5, v_5).$$

Hence on any region where  $v_5 \neq 0$ , one may choose

$$c_2 = -\frac{v_7}{v_5},$$

so that

$$v_7^{\text{new}} = 0, \quad u_7^{\text{new}} = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}.$$

Similarly, on any region where  $u_5 \neq 0$ , one may choose

$$c_2 = -\frac{u_7}{u_5},$$

so that

$$u_7^{\text{new}} = 0, \quad v_7^{\text{new}} = -\frac{\Delta_7}{u_5}.$$

Thus raw septic representatives can be chosen locally by gauge-fixing, but such choices are auxiliary and are not canonical.

**12.5. Normalized planar curve and curvature bridge.** On the region where  $c(h) \neq 0$ , define the normalized scalars

$$\rho_1(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad \rho_2(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)},$$

and the associated planar invariant curve

$$\Gamma(h) := (\rho_1(h), \rho_2(h)).$$

**Proposition 12.52** (Non-affinity of the second normalized residual scalar). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval contained in the quintic-generic region and in  $\{h : c(h) \neq 0\}$ . Assume*

$$v_5 \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Then there do not exist constants  $A, B \in \mathbf{C}$  such that*

$$\rho_2(h) \equiv A\rho_1(h) + B$$

*on  $J$ .*

*Equivalently,*

$$\Delta_7(h) \not\equiv A v_5(h) + B c(h)$$

*on  $J$ .*

*Proof.* Suppose

$$\Delta_7(h) \equiv A v_5(h) + B c(h)$$

on  $J$ . Then the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice of the right-hand side vanishes, because  $v_5$  and  $c$  are governed by the cubic/quintic layers and carry no direct septic  $q^{(7)}$ -slice.

On the other hand, by Proposition 12.48, the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice of  $\Delta_7$  is generically nonzero on  $J$ . This is a contradiction. Dividing by  $c(h)$  yields

$$\rho_2(h) \neq A \rho_1(h) + B. \quad \square$$

**Definition 12.53** (Normalized derivative numerators). Define

$$M(h) := c(h)v_5'(h) - c'(h)v_5(h), \quad N(h) := c(h)\Delta_7'(h) - c'(h)\Delta_7(h).$$

Then

$$\rho_1'(h) = \frac{M(h)}{c(h)^2}, \quad \rho_2'(h) = \frac{N(h)}{c(h)^2}.$$

**Proposition 12.54** (Curvature bridge for the normalized planar curve). *Let*

$$K_\Gamma(h) := \rho_1'(h)\rho_2''(h) - \rho_2'(h)\rho_1''(h)$$

*denote the affine curvature numerator of the planar curve  $\Gamma(h)$ . Then*

$$K_\Gamma(h) = \frac{M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h)}{c(h)^4}.$$

*In particular, if  $K_\Gamma \equiv 0$  on a connected open interval  $J$  on which*

$$c \neq 0, \quad M \neq 0, \quad v_5 \neq 0,$$

*then  $\rho_2$  is affine in  $\rho_1$  on  $J$ , contradicting Proposition 12.52. Hence on every such interval one has*

$$K_\Gamma \neq 0.$$

*Proof.* By Definition 12.53,

$$\rho_1' = \frac{M}{c^2}, \quad \rho_2' = \frac{N}{c^2}.$$

Differentiating gives

$$\rho_1'' = \frac{M'c - 2Mc'}{c^3}, \quad \rho_2'' = \frac{N'c - 2Nc'}{c^3}.$$

Therefore

$$K_\Gamma = \frac{M}{c^2} \frac{N'c - 2Nc'}{c^3} - \frac{N}{c^2} \frac{M'c - 2Mc'}{c^3} = \frac{MN' - NM'}{c^4}.$$

If  $K_\Gamma \equiv 0$  on a connected open set with  $M \neq 0$ , then

$$0 = MN' - NM' = M^2 \left( \frac{N}{M} \right)',$$

so  $N/M$  is constant there:

$$\frac{N}{M} = A.$$

Since

$$\frac{N}{M} = \frac{\rho_2'}{\rho_1'},$$

it follows that

$$\rho_2' = A \rho_1',$$

hence

$$\rho_2 = A \rho_1 + B$$

on that connected interval. If in addition

$$c \neq 0, \quad v_5 \neq 0,$$

there, this contradicts Proposition 12.52. The final claim follows.  $\square$

**Remark 12.55** (Geometric consequence). Proposition 12.54 is the local-to-global bridge from the order-7 fixed-sector analysis back to the secant/tangent program. On the open set where

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h) \neq 0,$$

the normalized planar curve  $\Gamma(h)$  decomposes into  $C^2$  branches in the affine chart  $(\rho_1, \rho_2)$ , each of which is strictly convex or strictly concave. Thus the remaining global obstruction is not same-branch secancy, but the possibility of a common four-secant line meeting two separated ECT branches twice each.

**Definition 12.56** (Projective Wronskian of the strengthened one-pair triple). Define

$$W(h) := \det \begin{pmatrix} c(h) & v_5(h) & \Delta_7(h) \\ c'(h) & v_5'(h) & \Delta_7'(h) \\ c''(h) & v_5''(h) & \Delta_7''(h) \end{pmatrix}.$$

**Proposition 12.57** (Projective-Wronskian bridge). *With  $M(h)$  and  $N(h)$  as in Definition 12.53, one has*

$$M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h) = c(h)W(h).$$

Consequently,

$$K_\Gamma(h) = \frac{W(h)}{c(h)^3}$$

on the region where  $c(h) \neq 0$ .

*Proof.* Using

$$M = cv_5' - c'v_5, \quad N = c\Delta_7' - c'\Delta_7,$$

a direct expansion gives

$$MN' - NM' = (cv_5' - c'v_5)(c\Delta_7'' - c''\Delta_7) - (c\Delta_7' - c'\Delta_7)(cv_5'' - c''v_5).$$

Expanding and regrouping yields

$$MN' - NM' = c \det \begin{pmatrix} c & v_5 & \Delta_7 \\ c' & v_5' & \Delta_7' \\ c'' & v_5'' & \Delta_7'' \end{pmatrix} = cW.$$

The displayed formula for  $K_\Gamma$  now follows from Proposition 12.54. □

**Lemma 12.58** (Exact identities for  $W$  and  $W'$ ). *Let*

$$F(h) := (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)), \quad M(h) := c(h)v_5'(h) - c'(h)v_5(h).$$

Then

$$W(h) = \det(F(h), F'(h), F''(h))$$

admits the exact expansion

$$W = M\Delta_7'' + (v_5c'' - cv_5'')\Delta_7' + (c'v_5'' - v_5'c'')\Delta_7,$$

and

$$W'(h) = \det(F(h), F'(h), F'''(h))$$

admits the exact expansion

$$W' = M\Delta_7''' + (v_5c''' - cv_5''')\Delta_7' + (c'v_5''' - v_5'c''')\Delta_7.$$

*Proof.* Expand the determinant  $\det(F, F', F'')$  along the third column. This gives

$$W = \det \begin{pmatrix} c & v_5 \\ c' & v_5' \end{pmatrix} \Delta_7'' - \det \begin{pmatrix} c & v_5 \\ c'' & v_5'' \end{pmatrix} \Delta_7' + \det \begin{pmatrix} c' & v_5' \\ c'' & v_5'' \end{pmatrix} \Delta_7,$$

which is exactly the first identity.

For  $W'$ , differentiate  $W = \det(F, F', F'')$ . The terms  $\det(F', F', F'')$  and  $\det(F, F'', F'')$  vanish by repeated columns, so

$$W' = \det(F, F', F''').$$

Expanding along the third column gives the second formula. □

**Proposition 12.59** (Exclusion of  $W$ -flat intervals on the  $c \neq 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  region). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval on which*

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0.$$

*Then*

$$W \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Proof.* Suppose for contradiction that

$$W \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

By Proposition 12.57,

$$K_\Gamma(h) = \frac{W(h)}{c(h)^3} \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Since

$$M = c v'_5 - c' v_5$$

and  $c \neq 0$  on  $J$ , the hypothesis  $M \neq 0$  on  $J$  rules out  $v_5 \equiv 0$  on  $J$ . Hence  $v_5 \not\equiv 0$  on  $J$ .

By Proposition 12.54, it follows that

$$\rho_2(h) = A \rho_1(h) + B$$

for some constants  $A, B \in \mathbf{C}$ , i.e.

$$\Delta_7(h) = A v_5(h) + B c(h) \quad \text{on } J.$$

This contradicts Proposition 12.52. Therefore

$$W \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J. \quad \square$$

**Remark 12.60** (Interpretation of the  $\lambda$ -reduction). On the direct highest-new slice one has

$$\Delta_7^{[1]} = \lambda^{[1]} v_5$$

by Corollary 12.43 together with Corollary 12.47. Thus if  $W \equiv 0$  on a connected open interval with  $c \neq 0$  and  $M \neq 0$ , then

$$v_5 \not\equiv 0$$

on that interval, because  $M = c v'_5 - c' v_5$ . The affine dependence

$$\Delta_7 = A v_5 + B c$$

forced by Proposition 12.59 implies

$$\Delta_7^{[1]} = A v_5,$$

hence

$$\lambda^{[1]} \equiv A$$

on that interval. In this sense, the present argument excludes  $W$ -flatness on an  $M \neq 0$  region without requiring a separate differential equation for  $\lambda^{[1]}$ ; what remains open is not the canonical quotient-level order-7 invariant, but only the lower/mixed septic completion of a raw representative pair  $(u_7, v_7)$ , which is irrelevant to the quotient class  $[A_7^f]$  and to  $\Delta_7$ .

**Definition 12.61** (Projective graph and dual tangent-line variables). On the region where  $v_5 \neq 0$ , define

$$\mu := \frac{c}{v_5}, \quad \lambda := \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}.$$

On the subregion where  $M \neq 0$ , define

$$L := v_5 \Delta'_7 - v'_5 \Delta_7, \quad \beta := \frac{d\lambda}{d\mu}, \quad m := \lambda - \mu \beta.$$

**Proposition 12.62** (Closed minor system and dual tangent-line curve). *Let*

$$F := (c, v_5, \Delta_7), \quad U := (L, -N, M).$$

*Then*

$$F \times F' = U, \quad U \times U' = W F.$$

*Equivalently,*

$$MN' - NM' = cW, \quad ML' - LM' = v_5W, \quad NL' - LN' = \Delta_7W.$$

*On the region where  $v_5M \neq 0$ ,*

$$\mu' = -\frac{M}{v_5^2}, \quad \beta = -\frac{L}{M}, \quad m = \frac{N}{M},$$

*and*

$$\beta' = -\frac{v_5W}{M^2}, \quad m' = \frac{cW}{M^2}.$$

*Hence the dual tangent-line curve*

$$T(h) := (\beta(h), m(h))$$

*satisfies*

$$T'(h) = \frac{W(h)}{M(h)^2} (-v_5(h), c(h)).$$

*Moreover,*

$$\det(T'(h), T''(h)) = \frac{W(h)^2}{M(h)^3}.$$

*Proof.* The identity

$$F \times F' = (L, -N, M)$$

is the direct expansion of the cross product. Differentiating gives

$$U' = F \times F''.$$

Applying the vector identity

$$(A \times B) \times (A \times C) = \det(A, B, C) A$$

with  $A = F$ ,  $B = F'$ ,  $C = F''$  yields

$$U \times U' = (F \times F') \times (F \times F'') = \det(F, F', F'') F = W F,$$

which is exactly the three displayed scalar identities.

Next,

$$\mu' = \left( \frac{c}{v_5} \right)' = \frac{c'v_5 - cv_5'}{v_5^2} = -\frac{M}{v_5^2},$$

and

$$\lambda' = \left( \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5} \right)' = \frac{v_5\Delta_7' - v_5'\Delta_7}{v_5^2} = \frac{L}{v_5^2},$$

so

$$\beta = \frac{\lambda'}{\mu'} = -\frac{L}{M}.$$

Also

$$\mu L + M\lambda = \frac{c}{v_5}(v_5\Delta_7' - v_5'\Delta_7) + (cv_5' - c'v_5)\frac{\Delta_7}{v_5} = c\Delta_7' - c'\Delta_7 = N,$$

hence

$$m = \lambda - \mu\beta = \lambda + \mu\frac{L}{M} = \frac{N}{M}.$$

The formulas for  $\beta'$  and  $m'$  follow immediately from

$$ML' - LM' = v_5W, \quad MN' - NM' = cW.$$

Finally, write

$$T' = \alpha V, \quad \alpha := \frac{W}{M^2}, \quad V := (-v_5, c).$$

Then

$$\det(T', T'') = \alpha^2 \det(V, V') = \frac{W^2}{M^4} \det \begin{pmatrix} -v_5 & -v'_5 \\ c & c' \end{pmatrix} = \frac{W^2}{M^3},$$

because

$$\det(V, V') = cv'_5 - c'v_5 = M.$$

□

**Corollary 12.63** (Graph curvature identities in  $(\mu, \lambda)$ -coordinates). *On the region where  $v_5 M \neq 0$ ,*

$$\lambda_{\mu\mu} = \frac{v_5^3}{M^3} W,$$

and

$$\lambda_{\mu\mu\mu} = -\frac{v_5^5}{M^4} \left( W' + 3 \left( \frac{v'_5}{v_5} - \frac{M'}{M} \right) W \right).$$

*In particular, at a point where  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$ , and  $v_5 \neq 0$ ,*

$$\lambda_{\mu\mu\mu} = -\frac{v_5^5}{M^4} W'.$$

*Proof.* Since

$$\frac{d}{d\mu} = \frac{1}{\mu'} \frac{d}{dh} = -\frac{v_5^2}{M} \frac{d}{dh},$$

the identity

$$\lambda_{\mu\mu} = \frac{v_5^3}{M^3} W$$

follows from

$$\lambda_\mu = \beta, \quad \beta' = -\frac{v_5 W}{M^2}.$$

Differentiating once more gives

$$\lambda_{\mu\mu\mu} = -\frac{v_5^2}{M} \frac{d}{dh} \left( \frac{v_5^3}{M^3} W \right),$$

which expands to the displayed formula. The last statement is the specialisation  $W = 0$ . □

**Remark 12.64** (Determinant interpretation on a fixed-sign  $W$ -interval). On any connected interval where  $c$ ,  $M$ , and  $W$  are nonzero and  $W$  keeps one sign, the graph  $\lambda = \lambda(\mu)$  is strictly convex or strictly concave. Consequently, for any ordered triple of distinct points on that interval, the determinant

$$D(s, t, u) = \det(F(s), F(t), F(u))$$

has the corresponding fixed Vandermonde sign. Thus the unresolved global issue is not interval-wise sign regularity, but propagation across turning seams and possible nonadjacent recurrence of tangent-slope / tangent-line data.

**Proposition 12.65** (Local determinant sign transport across a generic turning boundary). *Let  $h_b$  be a generic turning boundary:*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Then there exists a neighborhood  $U$  of  $h_b$  and a sign  $\sigma_{\text{turn}} \in \{\pm 1\}$  such that for any three distinct points  $h_1, h_2, h_3 \in U$ ,*

$$\text{sgn } D(h_1, h_2, h_3) = \sigma_{\text{turn}} \text{sgn}((h_2 - h_1)(h_3 - h_1)(h_3 - h_2)),$$

where

$$D(h_1, h_2, h_3) := \det(F(h_1), F(h_2), F(h_3)), \quad F = (c, v_5, \Delta_7).$$

*Equivalently, the triple  $(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$  is locally discretely sign-regular of order 3 across a generic turning boundary.*



*Proof.* Work in the normalized affine chart

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

At a generic turning boundary one has

$$x'(h_b) = 0, \quad x''(h_b) \neq 0, \quad y'(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Hence  $y$  is a valid local coordinate near  $h_b$ , and the normalized curve may be written as

$$x = \chi(y)$$

with

$$\chi'(y_b) = 0, \quad \chi''(y_b) \neq 0.$$

After shrinking  $U$ , the sign of  $\chi''$  is constant on  $U$ .

Now for  $h_i \in U$ , write

$$x_i := x(h_i), \quad y_i := y(h_i).$$

Since

$$F(h_i) = c(h_i) (1, x_i, y_i),$$

we have

$$D(h_1, h_2, h_3) = c(h_1)c(h_2)c(h_3) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 & y_1 \\ 1 & x_2 & y_2 \\ 1 & x_3 & y_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Using  $x_i = \chi(y_i)$ , the  $3 \times 3$  determinant factors as

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 & y_1 \\ 1 & x_2 & y_2 \\ 1 & x_3 & y_3 \end{pmatrix} = (y_2 - y_1)(y_3 - y_1)(y_3 - y_2) \chi[y_1, y_2, y_3],$$

where  $\chi[y_1, y_2, y_3]$  is the second divided difference of  $\chi$ . By the scalar divided-difference mean-value theorem,

$$\chi[y_1, y_2, y_3] = \frac{1}{2} \chi''(\eta)$$

for some  $\eta$  between the  $y_i$ . Thus  $\chi[y_1, y_2, y_3]$  has fixed sign on  $U$ .

Also  $c$  has fixed sign on a sufficiently small neighborhood of  $h_b$ , and since  $y'(h_b) \neq 0$ , the map  $h \mapsto y(h)$  is monotone on  $U$ . Hence

$$\operatorname{sgn}((y_2 - y_1)(y_3 - y_1)(y_3 - y_2)) = \operatorname{sgn}(y')^3 \operatorname{sgn}((h_2 - h_1)(h_3 - h_1)(h_3 - h_2)),$$

with  $\operatorname{sgn}(y')$  constant on  $U$ .

Collecting the fixed signs of  $c$ ,  $y'$ , and  $\chi''$  gives the desired constant  $\sigma_{\text{turn}}$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 12.66** (Dual asymptote at a generic turning boundary). *Let  $h_b$  be a generic turning boundary:*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Assume  $v_5(h_b) \neq 0$ , and write*

$$\mu_b := \frac{c(h_b)}{v_5(h_b)}, \quad \lambda_b := \frac{\Delta_7(h_b)}{v_5(h_b)}.$$

*Let*

$$T(h) = (\beta(h), m(h)) = \left( -\frac{L(h)}{M(h)}, \frac{N(h)}{M(h)} \right)$$

*be the dual tangent-line curve on the neighboring  $M \neq 0$  branches. Then both one-sided dual arcs have the common asymptote*

$$m = -\mu_b \beta + \lambda_b,$$

*and, more precisely,*

$$m + \mu_b \beta - \lambda_b = \frac{1}{4a\beta} + o\left(\frac{1}{\beta}\right) \quad \text{as } |\beta| \rightarrow \infty,$$

where  $a \neq 0$  is the quadratic coefficient in the local turning-point normal form

$$\mu - \mu_b = a(\lambda - \lambda_b)^2 + O((\lambda - \lambda_b)^3).$$

In particular, the two adjacent dual arcs approach the same asymptote from opposite sides. This asymptotic separation is the dual-curve explanation of the local adjacent turning-boundary exclusion theorem proved later.

*Proof.* At a generic turning boundary one has  $\mu'(h_b) = 0$  and  $\lambda'(h_b) \neq 0$ , so  $\lambda$  is a valid local coordinate and

$$\mu - \mu_b = a(\lambda - \lambda_b)^2 + O((\lambda - \lambda_b)^3), \quad a \neq 0.$$

Differentiating gives

$$\frac{d\mu}{d\lambda} = 2a(\lambda - \lambda_b) + O((\lambda - \lambda_b)^2),$$

hence

$$\beta = \frac{d\lambda}{d\mu} = \frac{1}{2a(\lambda - \lambda_b)} + O(1).$$

Thus  $|\beta| \rightarrow \infty$  as  $h \rightarrow h_b$  from either side.

Now

$$m = \lambda - \mu\beta,$$

so

$$m + \mu_b\beta - \lambda_b = (\lambda - \lambda_b) - (\mu - \mu_b)\beta.$$

Using

$$\mu - \mu_b = a(\lambda - \lambda_b)^2 + O((\lambda - \lambda_b)^3)$$

and

$$\beta = \frac{1}{2a(\lambda - \lambda_b)} + O(1),$$

we obtain

$$(\mu - \mu_b)\beta = \frac{1}{2}(\lambda - \lambda_b) + O((\lambda - \lambda_b)^2).$$

Therefore

$$m + \mu_b\beta - \lambda_b = \frac{1}{2}(\lambda - \lambda_b) + O((\lambda - \lambda_b)^2).$$

Substituting

$$\lambda - \lambda_b = \frac{1}{2a\beta} + o\left(\frac{1}{\beta}\right)$$

gives

$$m + \mu_b\beta - \lambda_b = \frac{1}{4a\beta} + o\left(\frac{1}{\beta}\right).$$

Since  $\beta \rightarrow +\infty$  on one side and  $\beta \rightarrow -\infty$  on the other, the correction term changes sign, so the two one-sided dual arcs approach the same asymptote from opposite sides.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.67** (ECT intervals for the strengthened one-pair triple). *Let  $I$  be a connected interval on which*

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0, \quad W(h) \neq 0.$$

*Then the triple*

$$(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$$

*is an extended complete Chebyshev system on  $I$ . Equivalently, every nontrivial linear combination*

$$A c(h) + B v_5(h) + C \Delta_7(h)$$

*has at most two zeros on  $I$ , counting multiplicity.*

*In particular, in the affine chart*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c},$$

*every affine line meets  $\Gamma(I)$  in at most two points, counting tangency with multiplicity.*

*Proof.* Define

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since the one-pair family is real-analytic on the generic region, the functions  $x$  and  $y$  are  $C^2$  on  $I$ .

By Definition 12.53,

$$x'(h) = \frac{M(h)}{c(h)^2}, \quad y'(h) = \frac{N(h)}{c(h)^2}.$$

Because  $M(h) \neq 0$  and  $c(h) \neq 0$  on  $I$ , one has

$$x'(h) \neq 0 \quad (h \in I),$$

so  $x$  is strictly monotone on  $I$  and may be used as a parameter on  $\Gamma(I)$ .

Moreover,

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{y'(h)}{x'(h)} = \frac{N(h)}{M(h)}.$$

Differentiating with respect to  $x$  gives

$$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = \frac{\frac{d}{dh}(N/M)}{x'(h)} = \frac{(MN' - NM')/M^2}{M/c^2}.$$

Using Proposition 12.57,

$$MN' - NM' = cW,$$

hence

$$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = \frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3}.$$

Since  $c(h) \neq 0$ ,  $M(h) \neq 0$ , and  $W(h) \neq 0$  on  $I$ , it follows that

$$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} \neq 0 \quad (h \in I).$$

Therefore  $\Gamma(I)$  is the graph of a strictly convex or strictly concave  $C^2$  function  $y = y(x)$ .

Now let

$$L(h) := A c(h) + B v_5(h) + C \Delta_7(h)$$

be a nontrivial linear combination. Since  $c(h) \neq 0$  on  $I$ ,

$$L(h) = 0 \iff A + B x(h) + C y(h) = 0.$$

Thus zeros of  $L$  correspond exactly to intersections of  $\Gamma(I)$  with the affine line

$$A + B x + C y = 0.$$

If  $C = 0$ , then the equation is

$$A + B x = 0,$$

which has at most one solution because  $x$  is strictly monotone on  $I$ . If  $C \neq 0$ , the equation may be written as

$$y = -\frac{A}{C} - \frac{B}{C}x,$$

and a strictly convex or strictly concave graph meets an affine line in at most two points, counting tangency with multiplicity.

Hence every nontrivial linear combination

$$A c + B v_5 + C \Delta_7$$

has at most two zeros on  $I$ , counting multiplicity. This is exactly the ECT property for the triple  $(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$ . The affine-line statement is the same conclusion in the chart  $(x, y)$ .  $\square$

**Definition 12.68** (ECT interval). An ECT interval is a connected interval

$$I \subset \{h : c(h) \neq 0, M(h) \neq 0, W(h) \neq 0\}.$$

Equivalently, by Proposition 12.67, it is a connected interval on which the triple

$$(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$$

is an extended complete Chebyshev system.

**Corollary 12.69** (At most two points from one ECT interval). *Let  $I$  be an ECT interval. Then every affine line in the chart*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c}$$

*meets  $\Gamma(I)$  in at most two points, counting tangency with multiplicity.*

*In particular, if a finite configuration is cut out by a single affine relation in the normalized chart, then its contribution from any fixed ECT interval has cardinality at most two.*

*Proof.* This is exactly the affine-line formulation of Proposition 12.67.  $\square$

**Remark 12.70** (Branch geometry on an ECT interval). On an ECT interval  $I$ , the quantities  $c$ ,  $M$ , and  $W$  have fixed nonzero sign. Hence

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}$$

is a monotone parameter on  $I$ , and in the affine chart

$$\Gamma(I) = \left\{ \left( \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right) : h \in I \right\}$$

is a single  $C^2$  branch which is strictly convex or strictly concave according to the sign of

$$\frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3}.$$

The later tangent-separator analysis is therefore an adjacent-branch problem, not a same-branch secancy problem.

**Definition 12.71** (Tangent-separator kernel). Let

$$F(h) := (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

For  $s, t$  in the generic region, define

$$K(s, t) := \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)).$$

For fixed  $s$ , the zeros of  $t \mapsto K(s, t)$  are exactly the points  $\Gamma(t)$  lying on the affine tangent line to  $\Gamma$  at  $\Gamma(s)$ . Equivalently,  $K(s, t) = 0$  is the tangent-separator incidence condition for the tangent at  $s$  and the point at  $t$ .

**Lemma 12.72** (Affine form of the tangent-separator kernel). *On the affine chart  $c \neq 0$ , write*

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

*Then for every  $s, t$  with  $c(s)c(t) \neq 0$ ,*

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) \left( (y(t) - m(s)x(t)) - (y(s) - m(s)x(s)) \right),$$

*where*

$$m(s) = \frac{dy}{dx}(s) = \frac{N(s)}{M(s)}.$$

*Equivalently,*

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) (\phi_{m(s)}(t) - \tau_s),$$

*with*

$$\phi_{m(s)}(t) := y(t) - m(s)x(t), \quad \tau_s := y(s) - m(s)x(s).$$

*Proof.* Write

$$F(h) = (c(h), c(h)x(h), c(h)y(h)).$$

Then

$$F'(s) = (c'(s), c'(s)x(s) + c(s)x'(s), c'(s)y(s) + c(s)y'(s)).$$

Subtracting  $x(s)$  times the first column from the second and  $y(s)$  times the first column from the third gives

$$K(s, t) = \det \begin{pmatrix} c(s) & 0 & 0 \\ c'(s) & c(s)x'(s) & c(s)y'(s) \\ c(t) & c(t)(x(t) - x(s)) & c(t)(y(t) - y(s)) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Expanding along the first row yields

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) (x'(s)(y(t) - y(s)) - y'(s)(x(t) - x(s))).$$

Since

$$m(s) = \frac{y'(s)}{x'(s)},$$

this becomes

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) ((y(t) - m(s)x(t)) - (y(s) - m(s)x(s))),$$

as claimed.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.73** (Basic properties of the tangent-separator kernel). *For every  $s$  in the generic region,*

$$K(s, s) = 0, \quad \partial_t K(s, s) = 0, \quad \partial_t^2 K(s, s) = W(s).$$

*In particular, on any interval where  $W$  has fixed sign, the tangent line at  $\Gamma(s)$  is locally supporting.*

*Proof.* The first two identities follow because, at  $t = s$ , the third column of the determinant equals  $F(s)$ , and after differentiating once in  $t$  it equals  $F'(s)$ . Differentiating a second time gives

$$\partial_t^2 K(s, s) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F''(s)) = W(s). \quad \square$$

**Lemma 12.74** (Compact first-zero reduction on adjacent intervals). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals in the affine  $x = v_5/c$  ordering. Assume there are compact subintervals*

$$J_1 \subseteq I_1, \quad J_2 \subseteq I_2$$

*such that every zero of the tangent-separator kernel*

$$K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)),$$

*with  $s \in I_2$ ,  $t \in I_1$ , lies in  $J_2 \times J_1$ .*

*If  $K$  has a zero on  $J_2 \times J_1$ , then there exists a zero*

$$(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1$$

*such that  $s_*$  is minimal in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering among all  $s$ -coordinates of zeros of  $K$  on  $J_2 \times J_1$ .*

*Proof.* Because  $K$  is continuous, its zero set in the compact set  $J_2 \times J_1$  is closed, hence compact. The projection of that zero set to the  $s$ -axis is therefore compact as well. Since  $x = v_5/c$  is monotone on  $I_2$ , the induced  $x$ -ordering is equivalent to the interval ordering on  $J_2$ . Thus the projected zero set has a minimal element  $s_*$ , and there exists  $t_* \in J_1$  such that  $(s_*, t_*)$  is a zero of  $K$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 12.75** (First adjacent zero implies tangency). *In the setting of Lemma 12.74, let*

$$(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1$$

*be a zero with minimal  $s$ -coordinate in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering. Then*

$$\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

Consequently,

$$K(s_*, t_*) = 0, \quad \partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0$$

force the tangent line at  $\Gamma(s_*)$  to be tangent also at  $\Gamma(t_*)$ .

*Proof.* Assume for contradiction that

$$\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) \neq 0.$$

Since

$$(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1 \subseteq I_2 \times I_1,$$

the implicit function theorem applies in the open set  $I_2 \times I_1$  and gives a local  $C^1$  zero curve

$$t = t(s)$$

through  $(s_*, t_*)$ , defined for  $s$  in a neighborhood of  $s_*$ , such that

$$K(s, t(s)) = 0.$$

For  $s$  sufficiently close to  $s_*$  with  $s < s_*$ , one still has

$$(s, t(s)) \in I_2 \times I_1$$

and

$$K(s, t(s)) = 0.$$

By the zero-capture hypothesis in Lemma 12.74, every zero of  $K$  with  $s \in I_2$  and  $t \in I_1$  lies in  $J_2 \times J_1$ . Hence these nearby zeros also lie in  $J_2 \times J_1$ , contradicting the minimality of  $s_*$  among all zeros of  $K$  on  $J_2 \times J_1$ .

Therefore

$$\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

Finally, the identities

$$K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad \partial_t K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F'(t))$$

show that  $K(s_*, t_*) = 0$  places  $\Gamma(t_*)$  on the tangent line at  $\Gamma(s_*)$ , while  $\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0$  places the tangent direction at  $t_*$  on that same line. Hence the line is tangent to  $\Gamma$  at both  $\Gamma(s_*)$  and  $\Gamma(t_*)$ ; that is, it is a common tangent line.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.76** (Adjacent slope-range separation). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals, meeting at a boundary point  $h_b$ .*

(1) *If*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0,$$

*then the interior tangent-slope ranges of  $I_1$  and  $I_2$  are disjoint.*

(2) *If*

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0,$$

*then  $x = v_5/c$  remains a valid local parameter, but no adjacent tangent separation statement is asserted here. In that case the local affine jet is governed by*

$$\left. \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} \right|_{h_b} = 0, \quad \left. \frac{d^3 y}{dx^3} \right|_{h_b} = \frac{c(h_b)^5}{M(h_b)^4} W'(h_b),$$

*so the generic behavior is an ordinary affine inflection unless further special structure forces  $W'(h_b) = 0$ .*

*Proof.* In case (1),  $M(h_b) = 0$  is a simple zero and  $N(h_b) \neq 0$ . Therefore

$$m(h) = \frac{N(h)}{M(h)}$$

has opposite one-sided blow-up:

$$m(h) \rightarrow \pm\infty$$

as  $h \rightarrow h_b^\pm$ . Hence the interior tangent-slope ranges on the two sides are disjoint.

Case (2) is the local affine-jet computation recorded in Remark 12.84; it identifies the cubic-inflection coefficient but does not produce a tangent-separation theorem.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.77** (Endpoint tangent exclusion at a generic turning boundary). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a boundary point  $h_b$ , and assume*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Then the boundary tangent line at  $\Gamma(h_b)$  is vertical and meets neither adjacent interval in its interior.*

*Proof.* The boundary tangent line is

$$x = \rho_1(h_b), \quad \rho_1(h) = \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since  $M(h_b) = 0$  is a simple zero,

$$\rho_1'(h_b) = 0, \quad \rho_1''(h_b) \neq 0,$$

so  $\rho_1$  has a strict local extremum at  $h_b$ . Therefore

$$\rho_1(h) - \rho_1(h_b)$$

has fixed sign on each adjacent interval and vanishes only at the boundary point. Hence the vertical tangent line meets neither adjacent interval in its interior.  $\square$

**Theorem 12.78** (Conditional adjacent tangent-separator sign regularity across turning boundaries). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals, and assume their common boundary point  $h_b$  is a generic turning boundary:*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Assume in addition the zero-capture hypothesis of Lemma 12.74 on the adjacent pair  $I_2 \times I_1$ . Then*

$$K(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in I_2, t \in I_1),$$

*where*

$$K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

*Equivalently, tangent lines from the right interval do not meet the adjacent left interval across a generic turning boundary.*

*Proof.* By Lemma 12.77, for a generic turning boundary there is a neighborhood of the boundary pair on which  $K(s, t) \neq 0$  for  $s \in I_2, t \in I_1$ .

Assume for contradiction that some zero  $(s_0, t_0) \in I_2 \times I_1$  exists. By the zero-capture hypothesis, there are compact subintervals

$$J_1 \Subset I_1, \quad J_2 \Subset I_2$$

such that every zero of  $K$  on  $I_2 \times I_1$  lies in  $J_2 \times J_1$ . Replacing them by smaller compact subintervals still containing the zero set, using the boundary-near zero-free region furnished by Lemma 12.77, we may also assume that  $J_2 \times J_1$  is disjoint from that boundary-near region. Then the zero set of  $K$  in the compact set  $J_2 \times J_1$  is nonempty and closed, so by Lemma 12.74 there exists a zero  $(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1$  whose  $s$ -coordinate is minimal in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering among all zeros in  $J_2 \times J_1$ .

By Lemma 12.75,

$$K(s_*, t_*) = 0, \quad \partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0,$$

so the tangent line at  $\Gamma(s_*)$  is also tangent at  $\Gamma(t_*)$ .

Across a generic turning boundary, Proposition 12.76 shows that the interior tangent-slope ranges of the two adjacent intervals are disjoint. Hence no common interior tangent slope can occur. This contradicts the existence of  $(s_*, t_*)$ . Therefore no such zero exists, and

$$K(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in I_2, t \in I_1). \quad \square$$

**Remark 12.79** (Status of the turning-boundary adjacent theorem). Theorem 12.78 remains a conditional turning-boundary theorem: the local compact first-zero and first-zero-implies-tangency mechanism is in place, but it still depends on a separate zero-capture statement for the directional tangent-separator kernel  $K_{21}(s, t)$  on the full adjacent pair  $I_2 \times I_1$ .

However, by Theorem 12.92, full zero-capture is no longer needed to exclude actual adjacent pair-pair lines. What remains open here is therefore only the stronger support-ordering / directional-kernel route, not the local adjacent  $2 + 2$  exclusion itself.

**Lemma 12.80** (Boundary-near exclusion for both directional kernels at a generic turning boundary). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Define

$$K_{21}(s, t) := \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad K_{12}(t, s) := \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)),$$

with

$$F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

Then there is a neighborhood of the boundary pair on which both directional kernels are nonzero:

$$K_{21}(s, t) \neq 0, \quad K_{12}(t, s) \neq 0$$

for  $s \in I_2, t \in I_1$  sufficiently close to  $h_b$ .

*Proof.* Write

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since

$$y'(h) = \frac{N(h)}{c(h)^2},$$

the hypothesis  $N(h_b) \neq 0$  implies that  $y$  is a valid local coordinate near  $h_b$ . Thus the normalized planar curve may be written locally as a graph

$$x = \chi(y).$$

At  $h_b$ ,

$$\frac{dx}{dy} = \frac{M(h)}{N(h)},$$

so

$$\left. \frac{dx}{dy} \right|_{h_b} = 0.$$

Differentiating once more,

$$\frac{d^2x}{dy^2} = \frac{c(h)^2}{N(h)} \cdot \frac{M'(h)N(h) - M(h)N'(h)}{N(h)^2},$$

and since  $M(h_b) = 0$ ,

$$\left. \frac{d^2x}{dy^2} \right|_{h_b} = \frac{c(h_b)^2 M'(h_b)}{N(h_b)^2} \neq 0.$$

Hence, after shrinking to a small neighborhood of  $h_b$ , the graph  $x = \chi(y)$  is strictly convex or strictly concave.

For such a graph, the tangent line at any point meets the graph only at its point of tangency. Therefore no tangent line from one side can meet the opposite side inside a sufficiently small neighborhood of the boundary. Equivalently, both directional tangent-separator kernels are nonzero near the boundary pair.  $\square$



**Lemma 12.81** (Mirrored first adjacent zero implies tangency). *Let  $J_1 \Subset I_1$ ,  $J_2 \Subset I_2$  be compact interior subintervals across a generic turning boundary, and define*

$$K_{12}(t, s) := \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)), \quad t \in I_1, s \in I_2.$$

*Assume every zero of  $K_{12}$  on  $I_1 \times I_2$  lies in  $J_1 \times J_2$ . Let  $(t_*, s_*) \in J_1 \times J_2$  be a zero whose  $t$ -coordinate is minimal in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering among all zeros of  $K_{12}$  on  $I_1 \times I_2$ . Then*

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Because  $M \neq 0$  on the open interval  $I_1$ , the function

$$x(h) = \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}$$

is a valid local coordinate on  $I_1$ . Since every zero of  $K_{12}$  lies in the compact interior rectangle  $J_1 \times J_2$ , the chosen point  $(t_*, s_*)$  is interior in the ambient domain  $I_1 \times I_2$ .

Suppose

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) \neq 0.$$

Then by the implicit function theorem there is a  $C^1$  local zero curve

$$s = s(t)$$

through  $(t_*, s_*)$ , defined for  $t$  near  $t_*$ , such that

$$K_{12}(t, s(t)) = 0.$$

Because  $t_*$  is interior in  $I_1$ , there are nearby points with smaller  $x = v_5/c$  ordering still in  $I_1$ . For such  $t$ , the point  $(t, s(t))$  is also a zero of  $K_{12}$ , contradicting the minimality of  $t_*$ . Therefore

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

□

**Theorem 12.82** (Conditional symmetric directional-kernel exclusion across turning boundaries). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Assume:*

- (1) *the zero-capture hypothesis required in Theorem 12.78 for the kernel  $K_{21}$  on  $I_2 \times I_1$ ;*
- (2) *the symmetric zero-capture hypothesis for  $K_{12}$ , namely that every zero of*

$$K_{12}(t, s) = \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s))$$

*on  $I_1 \times I_2$  lies in some compact interior rectangle  $J_1 \times J_2 \Subset I_1 \times I_2$ .*

*Then both directional kernels are zero-free:*

$$K_{21}(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in I_2, t \in I_1),$$

*and*

$$K_{12}(t, s) \neq 0 \quad (t \in I_1, s \in I_2).$$

*Proof.* The first assertion is exactly Theorem 12.78.

For the second assertion, boundary-near exclusion for  $K_{12}$  is provided by Lemma 12.80. Assume for contradiction that  $K_{12}$  has a zero. By the symmetric zero-capture hypothesis, every zero lies in a compact interior rectangle  $J_1 \times J_2$ . Choose a zero  $(t_*, s_*) \in J_1 \times J_2$  whose  $t$ -coordinate is minimal in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering among all zeros of  $K_{12}$  on  $I_1 \times I_2$ .

By Lemma 12.81,

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

Together with

$$K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0,$$

this implies that the tangent line at  $\Gamma(t_*)$  is also tangent at  $\Gamma(s_*)$ . Hence the two adjacent intervals share a common interior tangent slope, contradicting Proposition 12.76. Therefore  $K_{12}$  has no zero. □

**Remark 12.83** (Status of the directional-kernel reduction). Lemma 12.87 reduces an adjacent pair-pair line across a generic turning boundary to a compact interior zero of one of the two directional tangent-separator kernels. Theorem 12.82 shows that the remaining turning-boundary issue is no longer orientation selection between  $K_{21}$  and  $K_{12}$ , but the symmetric zero-capture problem for these two kernels.

**Remark 12.84** (The  $W = 0$  obstruction and the cubic-inflection coefficient). Let

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

At a boundary point  $h_b$  with

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0,$$

the coordinate  $x$  remains a valid local parameter. Since

$$\frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} = \frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3},$$

one has

$$\left. \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} \right|_{h_b} = 0.$$

Differentiating once more with respect to  $x$  gives

$$\left. \frac{d^3 y}{dx^3} \right|_{h_b} = \frac{c(h_b)^5}{M(h_b)^4} W'(h_b).$$

Hence, after translating the point to the origin and subtracting the tangent line, the normalized curve has local expansion

$$y = \frac{c(h_b)^5 W'(h_b)}{6M(h_b)^4} x^3 + O(x^4).$$

Therefore a generic  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  boundary is an ordinary affine inflection unless additional special structure forces

$$W'(h_b) = 0.$$

In particular, the tangent-separator route is not presently justified across such boundaries, and the real remaining geometric question is whether the actual triple  $(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$  imposes any non-generic vanishing of  $W'(h_b)$ .

**Lemma 12.85** (Fixed-slope intercept sets for a strictly convex ECT branch). *Let  $I$  be an ECT interval in the affine chart*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c},$$

*and suppose  $\Gamma(I)$  is a strictly convex  $C^2$  graph*

$$\Gamma(I) = \{(x, \psi_I(x)) : x \in J_I\}$$

*over an open interval  $J_I \subset \mathbf{R}$ .*

*For each slope  $m \in \mathbf{R}$ , define*

$$\mathcal{B}_I(m) := \{\psi_I(x) - mx : x \in J_I\}.$$

*Then:*

- (1)  $\mathcal{B}_I(m)$  is an interval.
- (2) A line  $y = mx + b$  meets  $\Gamma(I)$  if and only if

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_I(m).$$

- (3) If  $m$  lies in the interior tangent-slope range of  $I$ , there is a unique  $x_I(m) \in J_I$  such that

$$\psi'_I(x_I(m)) = m,$$

*and the tangent line of slope  $m$  has intercept*

$$\tau_I(m) := \psi_I(x_I(m)) - m x_I(m).$$

Moreover,

$$\tau_I(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_I(m).$$

(4) For such  $m$ , a line  $y = mx + b$  is 2-secant to  $\Gamma(I)$  if and only if

$$b \in \text{int } \mathcal{B}_I(m).$$

Equivalently, the 2-secant intercepts of slope  $m$  are exactly the interior points of the intercept interval.

*Proof.* For fixed  $m$ , put

$$\phi_m(x) := \psi_I(x) - mx.$$

Since  $\phi_m$  is continuous on the interval  $J_I$ , its image

$$\phi_m(J_I) = \mathcal{B}_I(m)$$

is an interval. This proves (1), and (2) is immediate from

$$(x, \psi_I(x)) \in \{y = mx + b\} \iff \psi_I(x) - mx = b.$$

If  $m$  lies in the interior tangent-slope range, strict convexity implies that  $\psi'_I$  is strictly monotone, hence there is a unique  $x_I(m)$  with  $\psi'_I(x_I(m)) = m$ . At that point,

$$\phi'_m(x_I(m)) = \psi'_I(x_I(m)) - m = 0,$$

and since

$$\phi''_m(x) = \psi''_I(x) > 0,$$

the point  $x_I(m)$  is the unique minimizer of  $\phi_m$ . Thus

$$\tau_I(m) = \phi_m(x_I(m)) = \inf \mathcal{B}_I(m),$$

which proves (3).

Finally, because  $\phi_m$  is strictly convex with a unique minimum, a level  $b$  is attained at two points exactly when it lies in the interior of the interval  $\phi_m(J_I) = \mathcal{B}_I(m)$ . This is precisely the 2-secant condition, proving (4).  $\square$

**Lemma 12.86** (Support-overlap truncation across a generic turning boundary). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$c(h_b) \neq 0, \quad M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

For a fixed finite slope  $m$ , define

$$\phi_m(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h) - mv_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad \mathcal{B}_I(m) := \phi_m(I).$$

Assume

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m).$$

Then there exists a neighborhood  $U$  of  $h_b$  and compact subintervals

$$J_1 \subseteq I_1 \setminus U, \quad J_2 \subseteq I_2 \setminus U$$

such that

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_{J_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{J_2}(m).$$

*Proof.* Differentiate:

$$\phi'_m(h) = \frac{N(h) - mM(h)}{c(h)^2}.$$

At  $h = h_b$ , since  $M(h_b) = 0$ ,

$$\phi'_m(h_b) = \frac{N(h_b)}{c(h_b)^2} \neq 0.$$

Hence for each fixed finite  $m$ , after shrinking to a small neighborhood  $U$  of  $h_b$ , the function  $\phi_m$  is strictly monotone on each one-sided piece

$$I_1 \cap U, \quad I_2 \cap U.$$

Therefore, for each  $i = 1, 2$ , the equation

$$\phi_m(h) = b$$

has at most one solution in  $I_i \cap U$ .

But the assumption

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_{I_i}(m)$$

means exactly that there is at least one solution of  $\phi_m(h) = b$  somewhere on  $I_i$ . Therefore, after removing the boundary neighborhood  $U$ , at least one such solution

$$h_i^\sharp \in I_i \setminus U$$

remains on each side. Choose small compact subintervals

$$J_i \subseteq I_i \setminus U$$

with  $h_i^\sharp \in J_i$ . Then by continuity,

$$b = \phi_m(h_i^\sharp) \in \phi_m(J_i) = \mathcal{B}_{J_i}(m),$$

for  $i = 1, 2$ . This proves the claim.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.87** (Compact adjacent pair-pair implies a directional kernel zero). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary, and let*

$$L : y = mx + b$$

*be a finite-slope line that is 2-secant to both  $\Gamma(I_1)$  and  $\Gamma(I_2)$ . Then, after removing a sufficiently small boundary neighborhood, there exist compact subintervals*

$$J_1 \subseteq I_1, \quad J_2 \subseteq I_2$$

*and points  $s \in J_2, t \in J_1$  such that one of the two directional kernels vanishes:*

$$K_{21}(s, t) := \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)) = 0,$$

*or*

$$K_{12}(t, s) := \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)) = 0,$$

*where*

$$F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

*Proof.* Because  $L$  is 2-secant to each branch, Lemma 12.85 shows that  $m$  lies in the interior tangent-slope range of each interval. Hence each branch has a unique interior tangent line of slope  $m$ , with tangent intercept

$$\tau_{I_i}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_i}(m).$$

At a generic turning boundary,

$$\frac{dy/dh}{dx/dh} = \frac{N(h)}{M(h)}$$

has one-sided blow-up, so no finite-slope tangency can occur arbitrarily close to  $h_b$ . Therefore, after shrinking away a boundary neighborhood and applying Lemma 12.86, we may choose compact subintervals

$$J_1 \subseteq I_1, \quad J_2 \subseteq I_2$$

such that:

- (1)  $b \in \mathcal{B}_{J_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{J_2}(m)$ ;
- (2) the unique slope- $m$  tangency point of each branch lies in the corresponding  $J_i$ .

Hence each  $\mathcal{B}_{J_i}(m)$  is a compact interval whose lower endpoint is the tangent intercept

$$\tau_i := \tau_{J_i}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{J_i}(m).$$

Now set

$$b_* := \inf(\mathcal{B}_{J_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{J_2}(m)).$$

Since the intersection of two compact intervals is again a compact interval,

$$b_* = \max(\tau_1, \tau_2).$$

So  $b_*$  is equal to one of the two tangent intercepts, and it still lies in the support set of the other branch.

If  $b_* = \tau_2$ , then the slope- $m$  tangent line to  $\Gamma(J_2)$  meets  $\Gamma(J_1)$ . Thus there are points  $s \in J_2$ ,  $t \in J_1$  such that

$$\det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)) = 0,$$

i.e.

$$K_{21}(s, t) = 0.$$

If  $b_* = \tau_1$ , then the slope- $m$  tangent line to  $\Gamma(J_1)$  meets  $\Gamma(J_2)$ . Thus there are points  $t \in J_1$ ,  $s \in J_2$  such that

$$\det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)) = 0,$$

i.e.

$$K_{12}(t, s) = 0.$$

This proves the lemma. □

**Lemma 12.88** (Strip exclusion for  $K_{21}$  against a compact opposite branch). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Let  $J_1 \Subset I_1$  be a compact subinterval. Then there exists a one-sided neighborhood  $U_2 \subset I_2$  of the shared boundary point  $h_b$  such that*

$$K_{21}(s, t) := \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)) \neq 0 \quad (s \in U_2, t \in J_1),$$

*where  $F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h))$ .*

*Proof.* Work in the affine chart

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

At a generic turning boundary one has

$$x'(h_b) = 0, \quad x''(h_b) \neq 0, \quad y'(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Hence  $y$  is a valid local coordinate and the normalized curve may be written near  $h_b$  as a graph

$$x = \chi(y)$$

with

$$\chi'(y_b) = 0, \quad \chi''(y_b) \neq 0.$$

Thus  $x$  has a strict local extremum at the boundary, while the tangent slope

$$m(h) = \frac{dy/dh}{dx/dh} = \frac{N(h)}{M(h)}$$

blows up one-sidedly as  $h \rightarrow h_b$  from either adjacent interval.

Because  $J_1 \Subset I_1$  is compact away from  $h_b$ , there exists  $\delta > 0$  such that

$$|x(t) - x(h_b)| \geq 2\delta \quad (t \in J_1).$$

After shrinking to a small one-sided neighborhood  $U_2 \subset I_2$  of  $h_b$ , we may also assume

$$|x(s) - x(h_b)| \leq \delta \quad (s \in U_2).$$

Hence

$$|x(t) - x(s)| \geq \delta \quad (s \in U_2, t \in J_1).$$

Fix a preliminary compact neighborhood  $U_2^0 \Subset I_2$  of  $h_b$  and set

$$B := \sup\{|y(t) - y(s)| : t \in J_1, s \in U_2^0\} < \infty.$$

Since  $m(s) \rightarrow \pm\infty$  as  $s \rightarrow h_b$  in  $I_2$ , we may shrink further to  $U_2 \subset U_2^0$  so that

$$|m(s)| > \frac{2B}{\delta} \quad (s \in U_2).$$

If  $K_{21}(s, t) = 0$ , then the tangent line at  $\Gamma(s)$  passes through  $\Gamma(t)$ , equivalently

$$y(t) - y(s) = m(s)(x(t) - x(s)).$$

Taking absolute values gives

$$B \geq |y(t) - y(s)| = |m(s)| |x(t) - x(s)| > \frac{2B}{\delta} \cdot \delta = 2B,$$

a contradiction. Therefore  $K_{21}(s, t) \neq 0$  on  $U_2 \times J_1$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 12.89** (Strip exclusion for  $K_{12}$  against a compact opposite branch). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Let  $J_2 \Subset I_2$  be a compact subinterval. Then there exists a one-sided neighborhood  $U_1 \subset I_1$  of the shared boundary point  $h_b$  such that*

$$K_{12}(t, s) := \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)) \neq 0 \quad (t \in U_1, s \in J_2),$$

*where  $F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h))$ .*

*Proof.* This is the left-right mirror of Lemma 12.88.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.90** (Compact first-contact for  $K_{21}$ ). *Let  $J_1 \Subset I_1$ ,  $J_2 \Subset I_2$  be compact subintervals across a generic turning boundary. Assume there is a relatively open collar  $V_2 \subset J_2$  at the boundary-facing end of  $J_2$  such that*

$$K_{21}(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in V_2, t \in J_1).$$

*Assume also that the zero set of  $K_{21}$  in  $J_2 \times J_1$  is nonempty. Then there exists a zero  $(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1$  such that:*

- (1)  $s_*$  is boundary-nearest in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering among all  $s \in J_2$  for which  $K_{21}(s, t) = 0$  for some  $t \in J_1$ ;
- (2)

$$\partial_t K_{21}(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Define

$$A_{21} := \{s \in J_2 : \exists t \in J_1 \text{ with } K_{21}(s, t) = 0\}.$$

Since the zero set of  $K_{21}$  in  $J_2 \times J_1$  is compact and nonempty, the set  $A_{21}$  is compact and nonempty. By hypothesis,

$$A_{21} \cap V_2 = \emptyset.$$

Hence  $A_{21}$  has a boundary-nearest element  $s_*$  in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering on  $J_2$ . Choose  $t_* \in J_1$  with

$$K_{21}(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

Suppose

$$\partial_t K_{21}(s_*, t_*) \neq 0.$$

Then by the implicit function theorem there is a  $C^1$  local zero curve

$$t = t(s)$$

through  $(s_*, t_*)$ , defined for  $s$  near  $s_*$ , such that

$$K_{21}(s, t(s)) = 0.$$

Because  $s_* \notin V_2$  and  $V_2$  is an open collar at the boundary-facing end of  $J_2$ , there exist nearby points  $s \in J_2$  that are boundary-nearer than  $s_*$  in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering. For such  $s$ , the point  $(s, t(s))$  is also a zero of  $K_{21}$ , contradicting the minimality of  $s_*$ . Therefore

$$\partial_t K_{21}(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

$\square$

**Lemma 12.91** (Compact first-contact for  $K_{12}$ ). *Let  $J_1 \Subset I_1$ ,  $J_2 \Subset I_2$  be compact subintervals across a generic turning boundary. Assume there is a relatively open collar  $V_1 \subset J_1$  at the boundary-facing end of  $J_1$  such that*

$$K_{12}(t, s) \neq 0 \quad (t \in V_1, s \in J_2).$$

*Assume also that the zero set of  $K_{12}$  in  $J_1 \times J_2$  is nonempty. Then there exists a zero  $(t_*, s_*) \in J_1 \times J_2$  such that:*

- (1)  $t_*$  is boundary-nearest in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering among all  $t \in J_1$  for which  $K_{12}(t, s) = 0$  for some  $s \in J_2$ ;
- (2)

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Define

$$A_{12} := \{t \in J_1 : \exists s \in J_2 \text{ with } K_{12}(t, s) = 0\}.$$

Since the zero set of  $K_{12}$  in  $J_1 \times J_2$  is compact and nonempty, the set  $A_{12}$  is compact and nonempty. By hypothesis,

$$A_{12} \cap V_1 = \emptyset.$$

Hence  $A_{12}$  has a boundary-nearest element  $t_*$  in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering on  $J_1$ . Choose  $s_* \in J_2$  with

$$K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

Suppose

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) \neq 0.$$

Then by the implicit function theorem there is a  $C^1$  local zero curve

$$s = s(t)$$

through  $(t_*, s_*)$ , defined for  $t$  near  $t_*$ , such that

$$K_{12}(t, s(t)) = 0.$$

Because  $t_* \notin V_1$  and  $V_1$  is an open collar at the boundary-facing end of  $J_1$ , there exist nearby points  $t \in J_1$  that are boundary-nearer than  $t_*$  in the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering. For such  $t$ , the point  $(t, s(t))$  is also a zero of  $K_{12}$ , contradicting the minimality of  $t_*$ . Therefore

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

□

**Theorem 12.92** (Adjacent pair-pair exclusion across a generic turning boundary). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Then no finite-slope affine line in the chart*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c}$$

*is 2-secant to both  $\Gamma(I_1)$  and  $\Gamma(I_2)$ .*

*Proof.* Assume for contradiction that a finite-slope line

$$L : y = mx + b$$

is 2-secant to both adjacent branches. By Lemma 12.87, after removing a small boundary neighborhood there exist compact subintervals

$$J_1 \Subset I_1, \quad J_2 \Subset I_2$$

and a zero of one of the two directional kernels.

First suppose there exist  $s_0 \in J_2$ ,  $t_0 \in J_1$  such that

$$K_{21}(s_0, t_0) = 0.$$

By Lemma 12.88, there exists a one-sided neighborhood  $U_2 \subset I_2$  of  $h_b$  such that

$$K_{21}(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in U_2, t \in J_1).$$

Choose a compact interval  $\tilde{J}_2 \Subset I_2$  containing  $s_0$  and whose boundary-facing collar  $V_2$  lies in  $U_2$ . Then the zero set of  $K_{21}$  in  $\tilde{J}_2 \times J_1$  is nonempty, and Lemma 12.90 yields a zero

$$(s_*, t_*) \in \tilde{J}_2 \times J_1$$

such that

$$\partial_t K_{21}(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

Together with  $K_{21}(s_*, t_*) = 0$ , this means that the tangent line at  $\Gamma(s_*)$  is also tangent at  $\Gamma(t_*)$ . Since  $s_* \in I_2$  and  $t_* \in I_1$  are interior points, this gives a common interior tangent slope across the adjacent branches, contradicting Proposition 12.76.

Now suppose instead there exist  $t_0 \in J_1$ ,  $s_0 \in J_2$  such that

$$K_{12}(t_0, s_0) = 0.$$

By Lemma 12.89, there exists a one-sided neighborhood  $U_1 \subset I_1$  of  $h_b$  such that

$$K_{12}(t, s) \neq 0 \quad (t \in U_1, s \in J_2).$$

Choose a compact interval  $\tilde{J}_1 \Subset I_1$  containing  $t_0$  and whose boundary-facing collar  $V_1$  lies in  $U_1$ . Then the zero set of  $K_{12}$  in  $\tilde{J}_1 \times J_2$  is nonempty, and Lemma 12.91 yields a zero

$$(t_*, s_*) \in \tilde{J}_1 \times J_2$$

such that

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

Together with  $K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0$ , this means that the tangent line at  $\Gamma(t_*)$  is also tangent at  $\Gamma(s_*)$ . Again this gives a common interior tangent slope across the adjacent branches, contradicting Proposition 12.76.

Both cases are impossible. Therefore no finite-slope line is 2-secant to both adjacent branches across a generic turning boundary.  $\square$

**Remark 12.93** (What the unconditional adjacent turning theorem does and does not yet replace). Theorem 12.92 gives an unconditional exclusion of finite-slope pair-pair lines across a single generic turning boundary. It is stronger than the older local directional-kernel reduction in that it bypasses full symmetric zero-capture.

However, it does not by itself replace Theorem 12.96. To obtain a full global no-four-secant theorem from it, one would still need a separate propagation statement reducing nonadjacent pair-pair lines to the adjacent turning-boundary case.

**Remark 12.94** (Status of the directional-kernel reduction). Lemma 12.87 reduces an adjacent pair-pair line across a generic turning boundary to a compact interior zero of one of the two directional tangent-separator kernels.

There are now two closures of that reduction in the draft:

- (1) Theorem 12.92 gives an unconditional closure for actual adjacent pair-pair lines, via strip exclusion and compact first-contact.
- (2) Theorem 12.82 gives a stronger zero-freeness statement for both directional kernels, but only conditionally on symmetric zero-capture.

Thus orientation selection between  $K_{21}$  and  $K_{12}$  is no longer the main issue. What remains open only for the stronger tangent-separator / support-ordering route is the symmetric zero-capture problem on the full adjacent rectangle.

**Lemma 12.95** (Adjacent support-ordering). *Let  $I_1 < I_2$  be adjacent ECT intervals under the hypotheses of Theorem 12.78. Then, for every slope  $m \in \mathbf{R}$  such that both fixed-slope intercept sets are nonempty,*

$$\mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m) = \emptyset.$$



More precisely, one has one of the two strict alternatives

$$\sup \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) < \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m) \quad \text{or} \quad \sup \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m) < \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m),$$

and the same alternative holds for all such  $m$  on the adjacent pair.

*Proof.* Fix  $m$  such that both  $\mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m)$  and  $\mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m)$  are nonempty.

First assume  $m$  lies in the interior tangent-slope range of  $I_2$ . Let  $s \in I_2$  be the unique point with tangent slope  $m$ . Then by Lemma 12.85,

$$\tau_{I_2}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m).$$

By Theorem 12.78,

$$K(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (t \in I_1).$$

By Lemma 12.72,

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) (\phi_m(t) - \tau_{I_2}(m)), \quad \phi_m(t) := y(t) - mx(t).$$

Since  $c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s)$  has fixed sign on  $I_1$  and  $K(s, t)$  is continuous and nowhere zero there, the quantity

$$\phi_m(t) - \tau_{I_2}(m)$$

has constant sign on  $I_1$ . To determine which sign occurs, move  $s$  toward the common boundary point from inside  $I_2$ . By Lemma 12.77, the limiting boundary tangent line does not meet  $I_1$ , so  $I_1$  lies entirely on one side of that tangent line. By continuity, the same side persists for nearby interior tangents. Indeed, if the side changed as the tangency point  $s$  moved along  $I_2$ , then by the connectedness of  $I_2$  and continuity of the tangent-line data there would exist an intermediate point  $s_* \in I_2$  for which the tangent line at  $\Gamma(s_*)$  meets  $\Gamma(I_1)$ . Equivalently, there would exist  $t_* \in I_1$  such that

$$K(s_*, t_*) = 0,$$

contradicting Theorem 12.78. Hence the same side holds for all  $s \in I_2$ . Therefore either

$$\phi_m(t) < \tau_{I_2}(m) \quad \text{for all } t \in I_1,$$

or

$$\phi_m(t) > \tau_{I_2}(m) \quad \text{for all } t \in I_1.$$

In the first case,

$$\sup \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) \leq \tau_{I_2}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m),$$

and since equality would force an intersection with the tangent line, the inequality is strict. The second case is symmetric.

Now suppose  $m$  is not in the interior tangent-slope range of  $I_2$ , but both intercept sets are nonempty. Then  $m$  lies on one side of the tangent slope range of  $I_2$ , so  $\phi_m$  is strictly monotone on  $I_2$ , and  $\mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m)$  is an interval with endpoint attained in the one-sided limit at the adjacent boundary. Passing to that boundary-support line and using Lemma 12.77 again shows that  $I_1$  lies strictly on one side of that boundary-support line. Hence the same strict ordering of intercept sets holds in this case as well.

Thus  $\mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m)$  and  $\mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m)$  are disjoint for every slope  $m$  for which both are nonempty, and the side ordering is constant on the adjacent pair.  $\square$

**Theorem 12.96** (Partial global no-secant theorem on turning-boundary generic blocks). *Assume every adjacent pair of ECT intervals is separated by a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0,$$

*and assume moreover that the zero-capture hypothesis required in Theorem 12.78 holds for every adjacent turning-boundary pair. Then no affine line in the chart*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c}$$

*is 2-secant to two distinct ECT intervals. In particular, there is no global four-secant line for the normalized planar curve  $\Gamma(h)$  on such a turning-boundary generic block.*

*Proof.* Under the stated hypotheses, every adjacent boundary is of turning type and Theorem 12.78 applies to each adjacent pair. For such adjacent pairs, Lemma 12.95 applies. Hence adjacent fixed-slope intercept sets are strictly ordered. Iterating this ordering over the  $x = v_5/c$  ordering of ECT intervals shows that no affine line can be 2-secant to two distinct ECT intervals. Therefore no global four-secant line exists on the block.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.97** (Partial exclusion of pair-pair branch configurations). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 12.96, a bad finite core cannot contain two distinct ECT intervals each contributing a pair of points on a turning-boundary generic block.*

*Proof.* Each ECT interval contributes at most two points to the zero set of an affine line in the normalized chart, and by Theorem 12.96 no affine line can be 2-secant to two different ECT intervals on such a block. Therefore a pair-pair configuration across two distinct ECT intervals is impossible there.  $\square$

**Remark 12.98** (Status of the direct septic witness). The direct  $q^{(7)}$ -slice of total  $\Delta_7$  is now closed at the weight-one level by Proposition 12.48. Together with Theorem 12.49, this closes the canonical quotient-level order-7 package.

What remains non-unique at order 7 is only the lower/mixed septic completion of a raw representative pair  $(u_7, v_7)$ , not any further canonical quotient-level invariant. Accordingly, order-7 is no longer a live audited obstruction for the later geometric arguments.

**Remark 12.99** (Canonical quotient-septic closure is still locally free). The canonical quotient-level order-7 package is now closed, but that does not yet make the quotient-septic geometry rigid.

Indeed, once the lower one-pair data  $(c, u_5, v_5)$  are fixed, the canonical septic residual

$$\Delta_7 = u_7 v_5 - u_5 v_7$$

is still locally free. On a region where  $v_5 \neq 0$  one may gauge-fix

$$v_7^{\text{new}} = 0, \quad u_7^{\text{new}} = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5},$$

while on a region where  $u_5 \neq 0$  one may gauge-fix

$$u_7^{\text{new}} = 0, \quad v_7^{\text{new}} = -\frac{\Delta_7}{u_5}.$$

So after the lower one-pair data are fixed, the canonical quotient-septic curve

$$\Gamma(h) = \left( \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right)$$

is still locally determined by an arbitrary analytic choice of  $\Delta_7$ .

Accordingly, no theorem using only arbitrary canonical quotient-septic geometry of  $(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$  can by itself close the later repeated-source / discriminant branch. Any successful higher-order hybrid must therefore be provenance-sensitive, not merely quotient-septic.

**Remark 12.100** (Status and ceiling of the highest-new direct provenance slice). On the region  $v_5 \neq 0$ , set

$$\mu := \frac{c}{v_5}, \quad \lambda := \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}, \quad \phi := \lambda^{[1]}.$$

By Corollary 12.43, Corollary 12.47, and Theorem 12.49, the highest-new quotient-level septic scalar is already reduced to the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven  $K_1$ -slice:

$$\Delta_7^{[1]} = v_5 \phi, \quad \phi = \kappa \left( (x_2 - x_1) \nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})} \right).$$

On the subregion where  $M \neq 0$ , the direct highest-new dual variables are

$$\beta^{[1]} = \phi_\mu, \quad m^{[1]} = \phi - \mu \phi_\mu,$$

and by Corollary 12.63,

$$\phi_{\mu\mu} = \frac{v_5^3}{M^3} W^{[1]}.$$

Thus the direct highest-new quotient-septic geometry is exactly the ordinary tangent-line geometry of the scalar graph

$$y = \phi(\mu).$$

In particular, any bitangent line or four-secant line for the graph  $y = \phi(\mu)$ , and any nonadjacent slope re-entry for

$$\beta^{[1]} = \phi_\mu,$$

forces at least two zeros of

$$\phi_{\mu\mu},$$

equivalently of

$$W^{[1]}.$$

So the global direct-slice propagation problem may be viewed as a no-recurrence problem for the scalar graph  $\phi$ .

However, the explicit direct provenance formula only shows that

$$\phi = A q^{(7)} \quad (A := \kappa \eta_2),$$

with  $A$  generically nonvanishing on a generic one-pair block. By Proposition 13.3 below, this still leaves  $\phi$  fully universal on each such block. So the direct graph picture is now a precise dictionary, not by itself a live rigidity theorem.

**Remark 12.101** (Status of the  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  side). On the region  $c \neq 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$ , Proposition 12.59 excludes open-interval flatness  $W \equiv 0$ . At an isolated boundary

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0,$$

the normalized planar curve in the chart

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c}$$

is an ordinary odd-order affine inflection whenever  $W$  changes sign, so adjacent tangent-separator sign regularity fails there in general.

However, Theorem 12.103 shows that every finite-order isolated boundary of type  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  is locally sterile for pair-pair birth. Thus the remaining issue on this side is not local creation of a bad  $2 + 2$  line, but global continuation / recurrence of determinant-zero or tangent-slope data across multiple intervals.

The exact identities for  $W$  and  $W'$  continue to show that this residual obstruction is still encoded through the canonical order-7 package  $\Delta_7$ , not by a genuinely new primitive order-9 invariant.

**Remark 12.102** (Audit:  $W'(h_b)$  at  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$ ). At a point  $h_b$  with

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0,$$

the cubic-inflection coefficient of the normalized planar curve in the  $(\mu, \lambda)$ -coordinates is proportional to

$$W'(h_b).$$

So  $W'(h_b)$  still governs the local simple-inflection jet.

But proving  $W'(h_b) = 0$  is no longer the main target, because simple  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  boundaries are already locally benign for pair-pair birth. The live question is now whether the canonical order-7 package imposes any further global non-recurrence on the associated determinant/tangent-slope data.

At the highest-new level,  $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$  is already reduced to the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -driven  $K_1$ -slice, so the present obstruction is not a new primitive order-9 invariant but a question about global propagation of the canonical order-7 geometry.

**Theorem 12.103** (Finite-order  $W = 0$  boundaries are locally sterile for pair-pair birth). *Let  $h_b$  satisfy*

$$c(h_b) \neq 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0, \quad W(h_b) = 0,$$

*and assume that  $W$  has finite vanishing order  $r \geq 1$  at  $h_b$ :*

$$W(h) = (h - h_b)^r \widetilde{W}(h), \quad \widetilde{W}(h_b) \neq 0.$$

*Define*

$$F(h) := (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)), \quad D(s, t, u) := \det(F(s), F(t), F(u)).$$

*Then, after shrinking to a sufficiently small neighborhood  $U$  of  $h_b$ , the following holds.*

*If  $s < t < h_b$  lie in  $U$ , then:*

- (1) *if  $r$  is even, the function  $u \mapsto D(s, t, u)$  has no zero on the opposite side  $h_b < u \in U$ ;*
- (2) *if  $r$  is odd, the function  $u \mapsto D(s, t, u)$  has at most one zero on the opposite side  $h_b < u \in U$ .*

*The same conclusion holds with left and right exchanged. In particular, no finite-order boundary of type  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  can support a local pair-pair birth.*

*Proof.* Work in the affine chart

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since

$$x'(h) = \frac{M(h)}{c(h)^2},$$

the hypothesis  $M(h_b) \neq 0$  implies that  $x$  is a valid local coordinate near  $h_b$ . After translating so that  $x(h_b) = 0$  and subtracting the tangent line, we may write the normalized curve as

$$y = f(x), \quad f(0) = f'(0) = 0.$$

By Proposition 12.57,

$$\frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} = \frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3}.$$

Because  $x'(h_b) \neq 0$ , the finite vanishing order of  $W$  in  $h$  is the same as its finite vanishing order in the local coordinate  $x$ . Therefore

$$f''(x) = \lambda x^r + O(x^{r+1}) \quad (\lambda \neq 0).$$

Fix two same-side points

$$x_1 < x_2 < 0$$

sufficiently close to 0, and define

$$\widehat{D}(x_1, x_2, u) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 & f(x_1) \\ 1 & x_2 & f(x_2) \\ 1 & u & f(u) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then

$$\widehat{D}(x_1, x_2, u) = (x_2 - x_1)(u - x_1)(u - x_2) H_{x_1, x_2}(u),$$

where

$$H_{x_1, x_2}(u) := f[x_1, x_2, u]$$

is the second divided difference of  $f$ .

If  $r$  is even, then  $f''$  has fixed sign near 0. By the Hermite–Genocchi formula for second divided differences,  $H_{x_1, x_2}(u)$  has that same fixed sign for  $u > 0$  sufficiently small. Hence  $\widehat{D}(x_1, x_2, u) \neq 0$  on the opposite side.

If  $r$  is odd, then

$$f'''(x) = \lambda r x^{r-1} + O(x^r)$$

has fixed nonzero sign near 0, because  $r - 1$  is even. Differentiating with respect to the repeated node gives

$$\partial_u H_{x_1, x_2}(u) = f[x_1, x_2, u, u].$$

By the Hermite–Genocchi formula for repeated-node divided differences,  $f[x_1, x_2, u, u]$  has the same fixed nonzero sign for  $u > 0$  sufficiently small. Thus  $u \mapsto H_{x_1, x_2}(u)$  is strictly monotone on the opposite side, and therefore has at most one zero there.

Finally,

$$D(s, t, u) = c(s)c(t)c(u) \widehat{D}(x(s), x(t), x(u)),$$

and  $c$  is nonzero on a small neighborhood of  $h_b$ , so the zero set of  $D$  is exactly the zero set of  $\widehat{D}$ . The theorem follows.  $\square$

**Remark 12.104** (Consequence for the  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  endgame). Theorem 12.103 shows that finite-order  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  boundaries are not local birthplaces of pair-pair configurations. Combined with Proposition 12.59, this means the remaining issue on the  $W = 0$  side is genuinely global: continuation or recurrence of determinant-zero / tangent-slope data across multiple intervals, not local creation of a second opposite-side zero branch.

**Remark 12.105** (Audit: residual  $W = 0$  pathology). By Proposition 12.59, the  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  side is no longer obstructed by open-interval flatness  $W \equiv 0$  on a component with  $c \neq 0$  and  $M \neq 0$ . By Theorem 12.103, every finite-order isolated  $W = 0$  boundary is locally sterile for pair-pair birth. Thus any remaining  $W = 0$  issue would have to come either from non-analytic / infinite-order flatness or from a genuinely global continuation phenomenon, not from a generic local inflection birth mechanism.

## 12.6. From the one-pair residual germ to two-pair and minimal-core rigidity.

**Remark 12.106** (Strengthened organizing principle). The original version of this subsection was organized around the cubic leading line and the first residual trace witness. The later working analysis suggests a stronger one-pair package:

$$c(h), \quad A_5^f(h), \quad \Delta_7(h),$$

or equivalently the normalized affine curve

$$h \mapsto \left( \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right).$$

The intended two-pair and minimal-core rigidity statements should ultimately be reformulated in terms of this strengthened one-pair invariant geometry.

**Remark 12.107** (Subsection guide). This subsection is best read as a rigidity program built on the strengthened one-pair local package

$$c(h), \quad A_5^f(h), \quad \Delta_7(h),$$

or equivalently the normalized planar curve

$$h \mapsto \left( \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right).$$

The projective coincidence conditions remain the organizing principle for the two-pair and minimal-core analysis. The finite-order discussion below now isolates the exact source-level criterion that would force the two-point quadratic interaction factorization through order 7, but the current attack also exhibits two backup lanes: a weaker quotient-diagonal exact exclusion route and, on good overlap patches, a mixed  $\lambda$ -shear / projective-shadow route. Beyond that, the remaining steps are the verification of one of these two-point lanes, the genuine multi-pair interaction bookkeeping, and the extraction into the finite-core endgame.

**Remark 12.108** (Interpretation of residual notation in the multi-pair architecture). In the remainder of this section, the symbols

$$F_h(z), \quad \ell_h, \quad \bar{v}_1(h), \quad \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}/\ell_h$$

are used schematically to describe the intended cubic-leading / first-residual architecture of multi-pair and minimal-core configurations.

The fully explicit rigorous first-residual object established earlier is

$$\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} = \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)).$$

Accordingly, whenever a later statement invokes the first residual class in a theorem-strength way, it should be interpreted through  $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$ . The present two-pair subsection now isolates the exact finite-order source criterion through order 7 together with two weaker backup routes. What remains architectural is the verification of one of these two-point routes for the actual corrected two-atom package, together with its extension to genuine multi-pair and minimal-bad-core interaction terms.

Let  $F_h(z)$  denote the corrected quotient odd germ of the normalized one-pair family. By Proposition 12.8, on the cubic-generic region we have

$$F_h(z) = v_0(h)z^3 + v_1(h)z^5 + \cdots, \quad v_0(h) \neq 0,$$

with cubic leading line

$$\ell_h := \mathbf{C} v_0(h) \subset \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}.$$

Under the additional hypotheses of Proposition 12.28, there is an open dense subset  $\mathcal{U}_{\text{res}} \subset \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$  on which the explicit first residual class

$$\bar{v}_1(h) \in \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$$

is nonzero.

In the strengthened fixed-sector refinement, the one-pair local package is recorded by

$$c(h), \quad A_5^{\text{f}}(h) = u_5(h)I + v_5(h)S, \quad \Delta_7(h),$$

and hence by the normalized planar curve

$$\Gamma(h) := \left( \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right) = (\rho_1(h), \rho_2(h)).$$

By Proposition 12.54, the affine curvature numerator of  $\Gamma$  is

$$K_{\Gamma}(h) = \rho_1'(h)\rho_2''(h) - \rho_2'(h)\rho_1''(h) = \frac{M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h)}{c(h)^4},$$

where

$$M(h) = c(h)v_5'(h) - c'(h)v_5(h), \quad N(h) = c(h)\Delta_7'(h) - c'(h)\Delta_7(h).$$

Thus the strengthened one-pair geometry is governed by the curve  $\Gamma(h)$  and its secant/tangent behavior on the region where

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h) \neq 0.$$

**Definition 12.109** (Amplitude-invariant strengthened datum). On the region where

$$c(h) \neq 0,$$

define

$$\widehat{\Psi}(h) := \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)^2} \right).$$

**Lemma 12.110** (Scaling law for the strengthened package). *If the normalized one-pair odd germ is multiplied by a scalar  $\lambda$ , then*

$$c \mapsto \lambda c, \quad A_5^{\text{f}} \mapsto \lambda A_5^{\text{f}}, \quad A_7^{\text{f}} \mapsto \lambda A_7^{\text{f}},$$

and hence

$$\Delta_7 \mapsto \lambda^2 \Delta_7.$$

Consequently the datum

$$\widehat{\Psi}(h) = \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)^2} \right)$$

is invariant under scalar rescaling of the full one-pair germ.

*Proof.* The cubic, quintic, and septic coefficients of the odd germ all scale linearly under multiplication of the germ by  $\lambda$ . Since

$$A_5^f = u_5 I + v_5 S, \quad A_7^f = u_7 I + v_7 S,$$

it follows that

$$u_5 \mapsto \lambda u_5, \quad v_5 \mapsto \lambda v_5, \quad u_7 \mapsto \lambda u_7, \quad v_7 \mapsto \lambda v_7.$$

Therefore

$$\Delta_7 = u_7 v_5 - u_5 v_7$$

scales as

$$\Delta_7 \mapsto \lambda^2 \Delta_7,$$

which gives the claim.  $\square$

**Remark 12.111** (Two normalizations: geometric versus projective). The affine curve

$$\Gamma(h) = \left( \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right)$$

is the correct object for the one-pair differential geometry, because its derivatives are governed by the projective Wronskians  $M$ ,  $N$ , and  $W$ .

For the multi-pair coincidence problem, however, the natural scalar-invariant datum is  $\widehat{\Psi}(h)$ , not  $\Gamma(h)$ . The reason is exactly the scaling law in Lemma 12.110: under scalar rescaling of the full one-pair germ,  $\Delta_7/c$  is not invariant, whereas  $\Delta_7/c^2$  is.

In this formulation, the geometric secant/tangent obstruction is well controlled on ECT intervals and across generic turning-point boundaries. The remaining global issue is no longer a purely local  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  obstruction, but the global propagation / recurrence problem for the determinant-zero and tangent configurations that survive the local sterility results proved later in the paper.

**Definition 12.112** (Two-pair decomposition). For a normalized two-pair core with amplitudes  $a_1, a_2$  and offsets  $h_1, h_2$ , write its quotient odd germ schematically as

$$F_{(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2)}(z) = a_1 F_{h_1}(z) + a_2 F_{h_2}(z) + \mathcal{I}_{12}(z),$$

where  $\mathcal{I}_{12}(z)$  denotes the pair-interaction germ.

In the explicit finite-order corrected source-level model through order 7 constructed below, the cubic scalar, quintic fixed-sector, and septic fixed-sector projections of  $\mathcal{I}_{12}$  are quadratic in the amplitudes and divisible by  $(h_1 - h_2)^2$ .

**Proposition 12.113** (Exact strengthened two-pair coincidence through order 7). *Let  $(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2)$  be a normalized two-pair core with*

$$F_{(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2)}(z) \equiv 0.$$

*Assume moreover that, after passage to the explicit corrected finite-order model through order 7, the interaction contribution vanishes at the three relevant levels, namely:*

$$a_1 c(h_1) + a_2 c(h_2) = 0,$$

$$a_1 A_5^f(h_1) + a_2 A_5^f(h_2) = 0,$$

*and, after the second identity identifies the common quotient line*

$$\mathbf{C} A_5^f(h_1) = \mathbf{C} A_5^f(h_2),$$

*the second residual classes satisfy*

$$a_1 [A_7^f](h_1) + a_2 [A_7^f](h_2) = 0 \quad \text{in} \quad \mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C} A_5^f(h_1).$$

*Then*

$$\widehat{\Psi}(h_1) = \widehat{\Psi}(h_2).$$

*Equivalently,*

$$\frac{u_5(h_1)}{c(h_1)} = \frac{u_5(h_2)}{c(h_2)}, \quad \frac{v_5(h_1)}{c(h_1)} = \frac{v_5(h_2)}{c(h_2)}, \quad \frac{\Delta_7(h_1)}{c(h_1)^2} = \frac{\Delta_7(h_2)}{c(h_2)^2}.$$

*Proof.* Set

$$\lambda := -\frac{a_2}{a_1}.$$

The cubic identity gives

$$c(h_1) = \lambda c(h_2).$$

The quintic fixed-sector identity gives

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_1) = \lambda A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_2).$$

Writing

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_i) = u_5(h_i)I + v_5(h_i)S,$$

we obtain

$$u_5(h_1) = \lambda u_5(h_2), \quad v_5(h_1) = \lambda v_5(h_2).$$

Hence

$$\frac{u_5(h_1)}{c(h_1)} = \frac{u_5(h_2)}{c(h_2)}, \quad \frac{v_5(h_1)}{c(h_1)} = \frac{v_5(h_2)}{c(h_2)}.$$

Now the second identity implies

$$\mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_1) = \mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_2),$$

so the residual quotient spaces are canonically identified. The order-7 residual identity therefore says

$$[A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}](h_1) = \lambda [A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}](h_2)$$

in the common quotient. Equivalently, there exists  $\mu \in \mathbf{C}$  such that

$$A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_1) = \lambda A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_2) + \mu A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_2).$$

Writing

$$A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_i) = u_7(h_i)I + v_7(h_i)S,$$

and using

$$\Delta_7(h) = u_7(h)v_5(h) - u_5(h)v_7(h),$$

we obtain

$$\Delta_7(h_1) = \det(A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_1), A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_1)) = \det(\lambda A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_2) + \mu A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_2), \lambda A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_2)) = \lambda^2 \Delta_7(h_2).$$

Since also  $c(h_1) = \lambda c(h_2)$ , it follows that

$$\frac{\Delta_7(h_1)}{c(h_1)^2} = \frac{\Delta_7(h_2)}{c(h_2)^2}.$$

Thus  $\widehat{\Psi}(h_1) = \widehat{\Psi}(h_2)$ . □

**Theorem 12.114** (Quantitative defect-thickened strengthened coincidence). *Let  $(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2)$  be a normalized bad two-pair core, and write*

$$c_i := c(h_i), \quad A_{5,i}^{\mathfrak{f}} := A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h_i) = u_{5,i}I + v_{5,i}S, \quad \Delta_i := \Delta_7(h_i).$$

*Assume*

$$a_1 \neq 0, \quad c_1 c_2 \neq 0.$$

*Suppose the cubic, quintic, and septic quotient defects are written as*

$$a_1 c_1 + a_2 c_2 + E_{12}^{(3)} = 0,$$

$$a_1 A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}} + a_2 A_{5,2}^{\mathfrak{f}} + E_{12}^{(5)} = 0,$$

*and*

$$a_1 [A_{7,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}] + a_2 [A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}}] + \overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)} = 0 \quad \text{in} \quad \mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

*Set*

$$\lambda := -\frac{a_2}{a_1}, \quad e := \frac{E_{12}^{(3)}}{a_1}, \quad E := \frac{E_{12}^{(5)}}{a_1} = e_u I + e_v S.$$



Choose any representative  $R \in \mathfrak{f}$  of the quotient class

$$-\frac{1}{a_1} \overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)},$$

so that

$$A_{7,1}^{\mathfrak{f}} = \lambda A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}} + R + \eta A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}$$

for some  $\eta \in \mathbf{C}$ . Then the strengthened invariant

$$\widehat{\Psi}(h) = \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)^2} \right)$$

satisfies the exact identities

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{u_{5,1}}{c_1} - \frac{u_{5,2}}{c_2} &= \frac{u_{5,2}e - c_2e_u}{c_1c_2}, \\ \frac{v_{5,1}}{c_1} - \frac{v_{5,2}}{c_2} &= \frac{v_{5,2}e - c_2e_v}{c_1c_2}, \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\frac{\Delta_1}{c_1^2} - \frac{\Delta_2}{c_2^2} = \frac{-\lambda c_2^2 \det(A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}}, E) + c_2^2 \det(R, A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}) + \Delta_2(2\lambda c_2e - e^2)}{c_1^2 c_2^2}.$$

*Proof.* The cubic defect identity gives

$$c_1 = \lambda c_2 - e.$$

The quintic defect identity gives

$$A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}} = \lambda A_{5,2}^{\mathfrak{f}} - E,$$

hence

$$u_{5,1} = \lambda u_{5,2} - e_u, \quad v_{5,1} = \lambda v_{5,2} - e_v.$$

Therefore

$$\frac{u_{5,1}}{c_1} - \frac{u_{5,2}}{c_2} = \frac{u_{5,1}c_2 - u_{5,2}c_1}{c_1c_2} = \frac{(\lambda u_{5,2} - e_u)c_2 - u_{5,2}(\lambda c_2 - e)}{c_1c_2} = \frac{u_{5,2}e - c_2e_u}{c_1c_2},$$

and similarly

$$\frac{v_{5,1}}{c_1} - \frac{v_{5,2}}{c_2} = \frac{v_{5,2}e - c_2e_v}{c_1c_2}.$$

For the third coordinate, by the choice of  $R$  we have

$$A_{7,1}^{\mathfrak{f}} = \lambda A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}} + R + \eta A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}$$

for some  $\eta \in \mathbf{C}$ . Using

$$\Delta_i = \det(A_{7,i}^{\mathfrak{f}}, A_{5,i}^{\mathfrak{f}}),$$

we obtain

$$\Delta_1 = \det(A_{7,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}, A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}) = \lambda \det(A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}}, A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}) + \det(R, A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}),$$

since the  $\eta A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}$  term drops out. Substituting

$$A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}} = \lambda A_{5,2}^{\mathfrak{f}} - E$$

gives

$$\det(A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}}, A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}) = \lambda \Delta_2 - \det(A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}}, E),$$

hence

$$\Delta_1 - \lambda^2 \Delta_2 = -\lambda \det(A_{7,2}^{\mathfrak{f}}, E) + \det(R, A_{5,1}^{\mathfrak{f}}).$$

Also,

$$c_1 = \lambda c_2 - e$$

implies

$$\lambda^2 c_2^2 - c_1^2 = 2\lambda c_2e - e^2.$$

Therefore

$$\frac{\Delta_1}{c_1^2} - \frac{\Delta_2}{c_2^2} = \frac{c_2^2 \Delta_1 - c_1^2 \Delta_2}{c_1^2 c_2^2} = \frac{c_2^2 (\Delta_1 - \lambda^2 \Delta_2) + \Delta_2 (\lambda^2 c_2^2 - c_1^2)}{c_1^2 c_2^2},$$

which is exactly the claimed formula.

Finally, the expression

$$\det(R, A_{5,1}^f)$$

is independent of the chosen representative of the quotient defect, since replacing  $R$  by  $R + \xi A_{5,1}^f$  does not change the determinant.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.115** (Bad two-pair cores are defect-scale close on good  $M \neq 0$  patches). *Let  $J \subseteq \{c \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$  be a compact interval. Assume*

$$|a_1| \geq a_* > 0$$

*for the normalized bad two-pair core under consideration. Then there exists a constant  $C_J > 0$  such that whenever  $h_1, h_2 \in J$ ,*

$$|h_1 - h_2| \leq C_J \left( |E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| \right).$$

*In particular, on good  $M \neq 0$  patches, bad two-pair cores force the two parameters to be quantitatively close once the cubic/quintic interaction defects are small.*

*Proof.* The second coordinate of  $\widehat{\Psi}$  is

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad x'(h) = \frac{M(h)}{c(h)^2}.$$

Since  $J \subseteq \{c \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$ , there exists  $\eta_J > 0$  such that

$$|x(h_1) - x(h_2)| \geq \eta_J |h_1 - h_2| \quad (h_1, h_2 \in J).$$

On the other hand, Theorem 12.114 gives the exact identity

$$x(h_1) - x(h_2) = \frac{v_{5,2}e - c_2e_v}{c_1c_2},$$

with

$$e = \frac{E_{12}^{(3)}}{a_1}, \quad e_v = S\text{-coefficient of } \frac{E_{12}^{(5)}}{a_1}.$$

Since  $J$  is compact and  $a_1$  is bounded away from 0, the right-hand side is bounded by

$$C'_J \left( |E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| \right)$$

for some constant  $C'_J$ . Combining the two estimates yields the claim.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.116** (No sublinear two-pair defects on good patches). *Let*

$$J \subseteq \{c \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$$

*be a compact interval. Then there exists a constant  $C_J > 0$  such that every normalized bad two-pair core with  $h_1, h_2 \in J$  and  $h_1 \neq h_2$  satisfies*

$$|E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| + |\overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)}| \geq C_J^{-1} |h_1 - h_2|.$$

*In particular, there is no sequence of nontrivial normalized bad two-pair cores in  $J$  for which*

$$|E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| + |\overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)}| = o(|h_1 - h_2|).$$

*Proof.* By Corollary 12.115, there exists a constant  $C'_J > 0$  such that

$$|h_1 - h_2| \leq C'_J \left( |E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| \right)$$

for every normalized bad two-pair core with  $h_1, h_2 \in J$ . Since

$$|E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| \leq |E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| + |\overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)}|,$$

the same estimate yields

$$|h_1 - h_2| \leq C'_J \left( |E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| + |\overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)}| \right).$$

Renaming  $C'_J$  as  $C_J$  proves the first claim. The final statement is immediate: if a sequence satisfied

$$|E_{12}^{(3)}| + \|E_{12}^{(5)}\| + |\overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)}| = o(|h_1 - h_2|),$$

then the displayed lower bound would force

$$|h_1 - h_2| = o(|h_1 - h_2|),$$

which is impossible for a nontrivial two-point core with  $h_1 \neq h_2$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 12.117** (Minimal finite-order source criterion for quadratic two-point factorization). *Let  $V$  be a finite-dimensional complex vector space, and let*

$$\mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) \in V$$

*be analytic on a neighborhood of the small two-atom data. Assume that there is a one-atom package*

$$F_h \in V$$

*such that the following three identities hold:*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) &= \mathfrak{P}_2(a_2, h_2; a_1, h_1), \\ \mathfrak{P}_2(0, h_1; a_2, h_2) &= a_2 F_{h_2}, \quad \mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h_1; 0, h_2) = a_1 F_{h_1}, \end{aligned}$$

*and*

$$\mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h; a_2, h) = (a_1 + a_2) F_h.$$

*Define the interaction remainder*

$$\mathcal{I}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) := \mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) - a_1 F_{h_1} - a_2 F_{h_2}.$$

*Then there exists an analytic map*

$$\mathcal{J}_2 : (\text{small two-atom data}) \rightarrow V$$

*such that*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{I}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) = a_1 a_2 (h_1 - h_2)^2 \mathcal{J}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2).}$$

*Proof.* By the one-amplitude collapse identities,

$$\mathcal{I}_2(0, h_1; a_2, h_2) = 0, \quad \mathcal{I}_2(a_1, h_1; 0, h_2) = 0.$$

Hence analyticity implies divisibility by  $a_1 a_2$ :

$$\mathcal{I}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) = a_1 a_2 G(h_1, h_2)$$

for an analytic

$$G : (h_1, h_2) \mapsto V.$$

Swap symmetry gives

$$G(h_1, h_2) = G(h_2, h_1).$$

On the diagonal,

$$\mathcal{I}_2(a_1, h; a_2, h) = \mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h; a_2, h) - a_1 F_h - a_2 F_h = (a_1 + a_2) F_h - a_1 F_h - a_2 F_h = 0,$$

so

$$G(h, h) = 0.$$

Now set

$$m = \frac{h_1 + h_2}{2}, \quad s = h_2 - h_1, \quad \tilde{G}(m, s) := G\left(m - \frac{s}{2}, m + \frac{s}{2}\right).$$

Since  $G$  is symmetric,  $\tilde{G}(m, s)$  is even in  $s$ , and since  $G(h, h) = 0$ , one has

$$\tilde{G}(m, 0) = 0.$$

Therefore  $\tilde{G}(m, s)$  is divisible by  $s^2$ :

$$\tilde{G}(m, s) = s^2 H(m, s)$$

for analytic  $H$ . Returning to  $(h_1, h_2)$  gives

$$\mathcal{I}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) = a_1 a_2 (h_1 - h_2)^2 \mathcal{J}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2),$$

as claimed.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.118** (Conditional quadratic defect estimate and two-point exclusion). *Assume that the actual corrected two-pair finite-order package through order 7 admits a source-level realization*

$$\mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) \in \mathbf{C} \oplus \mathfrak{f} \oplus (\mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^\dagger)$$

satisfying the three hypotheses of Lemma 12.117, with

$$F_h = (c(h), A_5^\dagger(h), [A_7^\dagger](h)).$$

Then on compacta,

$$\mathcal{E}^{(3)} = a_1 a_2 O(\delta^2), \quad \mathcal{E}^{(5)} = a_1 a_2 O(\delta^2), \quad \overline{\mathcal{E}}^{(7)} = a_1 a_2 O(\delta^2), \quad \delta := |h_1 - h_2|.$$

If the normalized defects are obtained by dividing by  $a_1$ , then on normalized families with  $|a_2|$  bounded one has

$$E_{12}^{(3)} = O(\delta^2), \quad E_{12}^{(5)} = O(\delta^2), \quad \overline{E}_{12}^{(7;1)} = O(\delta^2).$$

Consequently, the two-point bad-core branch is excluded on compact good patches

$$J \subseteq \{c \neq 0, M \neq 0\}.$$

*Proof.* Apply Lemma 12.117 to the cubic, quintic fixed-sector, and septic quotient outputs, then argue exactly as in the present proof using Theorem 12.114.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.119** (Conditional exact two-point exclusion from quotient diagonal collapse). *Let*

$$J \subseteq \{c \neq 0\}$$

be a compact interval. Assume there exists an actual corrected two-atom quotient map

$$\mathcal{F}_2(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2) \in \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}[[z^2]]$$

defined on normalized two-pair data, with the following properties:

- (1) **Continuity.** The map  $\mathcal{F}_2$  is continuous in the normalized two-pair parameters.
- (2) **Diagonal collapse.** For every  $h \in J$  and every normalized amplitude pair  $(a_1, a_2)$ ,

$$\mathcal{F}_2(a_1, h; a_2, h) = F_h,$$

where  $F_h$  is the normalized one-pair quotient odd germ.

- (3) **Precompactness of normalized amplitudes.** Every sequence of normalized two-pair data with

$$h_{1,n}, h_{2,n} \in J, \quad |h_{1,n} - h_{2,n}| \rightarrow 0$$

admits a subsequence along which the full normalized parameter tuple converges.

Then there is no sequence of nontrivial normalized bad two-pair cores

$$(a_{1,n}, h_{1,n}; a_{2,n}, h_{2,n})$$

with

$$h_{1,n}, h_{2,n} \in J, \quad 0 < |h_{1,n} - h_{2,n}| \rightarrow 0.$$

Equivalently, under the three assumptions above, the exact close two-point bad-core branch is excluded on compact subsets of  $\{c \neq 0\}$ .

*Proof.* Assume for contradiction that there exists a sequence of nontrivial normalized bad two-pair cores

$$(a_{1,n}, h_{1,n}; a_{2,n}, h_{2,n})$$

with

$$h_{1,n}, h_{2,n} \in J, \quad 0 < |h_{1,n} - h_{2,n}| \rightarrow 0.$$

Since each core is bad, its quotient odd germ vanishes identically, so

$$\mathcal{F}_2(a_{1,n}, h_{1,n}; a_{2,n}, h_{2,n}) = 0 \quad \text{for all } n.$$

By the precompactness assumption, after passing to a subsequence we may assume that the full normalized parameter tuple converges:

$$a_{1,n} \rightarrow a_1^*, \quad a_{2,n} \rightarrow a_2^*, \quad h_{1,n} \rightarrow m, \quad h_{2,n} \rightarrow m$$

for some  $m \in J$ . By continuity of  $\mathcal{F}_2$ ,

$$0 = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mathcal{F}_2(a_{1,n}, h_{1,n}; a_{2,n}, h_{2,n}) = \mathcal{F}_2(a_1^*, m; a_2^*, m).$$

Applying diagonal collapse gives

$$0 = \mathcal{F}_2(a_1^*, m; a_2^*, m) = F_m.$$

But  $m \in J \subseteq \{c \neq 0\}$ , so the normalized one-pair quotient germ  $F_m$  is nonzero: its cubic leading coefficient is nonzero on  $\{c \neq 0\}$ . This contradiction proves the claim.  $\square$

**Remark 12.120** (A weaker exact two-point route). Proposition 12.119 is strictly weaker than the quadratic defect-factorization route of Lemma 12.117. It does not produce

$$\mathcal{I}_2 = a_1 a_2 (h_1 - h_2)^2 \mathcal{J}_2$$

and does not yield the quantitative defect estimates used in Theorem 12.114. Instead, it isolates a smaller alternative input: a genuine corrected two-atom quotient map, continuity in normalized parameters, and exact diagonal collapse to the one-pair quotient class.

Thus there are now two distinct two-point routes in the draft:

- (1) the stronger finite-order source-level route, which would force quadratic defect bounds and hence quantitative defect-scale closeness;
- (2) the weaker quotient-diagonal route, which would already exclude exact close two-point bad cores on compact subsets of  $\{c \neq 0\}$ .

At present, the draft does not prove either route outright. The first remains a finite-order source-level merger problem; the second remains a continuity and diagonal-collapse problem for the actual corrected two-atom quotient germ.

**Remark 12.121** (Exact remaining source-level input on the two-point branch). Lemma 12.117 isolates the exact finite-order source identities needed for the two-point branch. It is enough to verify, for the actual corrected two-pair cubic/quintic/septic package, only:

- (1) swap symmetry;
- (2) one-amplitude collapse;
- (3) diagonal merger

$$\mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h; a_2, h) = (a_1 + a_2) F_h.$$

Once these identities are known, the quadratic factorization

$$\mathcal{I}_2 = a_1 a_2 (h_1 - h_2)^2 \mathcal{J}_2$$

is formal. So the remaining issue on the two-point branch is not another asymptotic estimate, but verification of this finite-order source-level merger statement for the corrected two-atom package.

**Remark 12.122** (Audit: even-amplitude obstruction for the naive source-summed model). The most obvious attempt to prove the source-level merger theorem is to insert a weighted one-atom datum

$$q_{a,h} = a q_h, \quad \Phi_{a,h} = a \Phi_h$$

directly into the corrected same-point and mixed block formulas, whiten, and then extract the cubic/quintic/septic outputs. This route cannot by itself prove the required one-atom linearity

$$\mathfrak{P}_2(a \delta_h) = a F_h.$$

Indeed the explicit corrected block formulas have the form

$$G_{a,h,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = a \mathcal{G}_{h,\pm}(a^2; s), \quad N_{a,h}^{\text{corr}}(s) = a \mathcal{N}_h(a^2; s),$$

so after whitening the overall factor of  $a$  cancels:

$$\widehat{\Omega}_{a,h}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \mathcal{G}_{h,-}(a^2; s)^{-1/2} \mathcal{N}_h(a^2; s) \mathcal{G}_{h,+}(a^2; s)^{-1/2}.$$

Hence every fixed finite-order coefficient extracted from the whitened block is an even analytic function of the source weight  $a$ . In particular, the naive source-summed corrected block package cannot satisfy analytic one-atom linearity or coincident-atom additivity unless it vanishes identically. So the remaining two-point theorem must be proved using a different lift/transport object, not the raw source-summed whitened coefficients themselves.

**Remark 12.123** (Audit: quotient and single-determinant routes are shear-blind). On the mixed two-point branch, any route based only on cubic/quintic source minors, the septic quotient class, or the pointwise patch gauges  $v_7 = 0$  and  $u_7 = 0$  is exactly blind to the repeated-node shear parameter.

For an exact bad two-pair core, the cubic/quintic defect vector has the form

$$d = \Lambda s_2 - s_1, \quad \Lambda := -\frac{a_2}{a_1}, \quad s_i = (c_i, u_{5,i}, v_{5,i}),$$

so

$$s_2 \wedge d = s_1 \wedge s_2$$

is independent of  $\Lambda$ . Likewise, any pointwise representative extracted only from the septic quotient class and  $A_{5,1}^{\dagger}$  carries no more information than the same determinant scalar already seen by the quotient. Thus the remaining mixed two-point burden is genuinely source-coupled rather than quotient-determinantal.

**Proposition 12.124** (Projective compactness of the moving  $\lambda$ -shear defects). *Assume a close exact mixed two-point bad branch on a compact good overlap patch*

$$U \subseteq \{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0, M \neq 0\},$$

and write

$$\Lambda_n := -\frac{a_{2,n}}{a_{1,n}}, \quad \delta_n f := f(h_{1,n}) - \Lambda_n f(h_{2,n}), \quad \lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}.$$

Then the mixed branch equations are equivalent to the existence of branch-generated moving shears  $(\eta_n, \xi_n, \gamma_n)$  such that

$$\delta_n(c) = \eta_n \delta_n(\lambda), \quad \delta_n(v_5) = \xi_n \delta_n(\lambda), \quad \delta_n(u_5) = \gamma_n \delta_n(\lambda).$$

Set

$$d_n := (\delta_n(c), \delta_n(v_5), \delta_n(u_5), \delta_n(\lambda)) \in \mathbf{R}^4.$$

Then, after passing to a subsequence, exactly one of the following holds.

- (1)  $d_n = 0$  for all  $n$  in the subsequence. Equivalently, along that subsequence one already has exact repeated-source transport simultaneously for

$$c, \quad v_5, \quad u_5, \quad \lambda.$$

- (2)  $d_n \neq 0$  for all  $n$  in the subsequence, and the normalized defect directions

$$\hat{d}_n := \frac{d_n}{\|d_n\|} \in S^3$$

converge. Equivalently, the projective classes

$$[d_n] = [\delta_n(c) : \delta_n(v_5) : \delta_n(u_5) : \delta_n(\lambda)] \in \mathbf{P}^3$$

admit a convergent subsequence.

Moreover, on any subsequence for which  $\delta_n(\lambda) \neq 0$  and the projective limit lies in the affine chart with nonzero  $\lambda$ -coordinate, the affine  $\lambda$ -shears converge:

$$\eta_n = \frac{\delta_n(c)}{\delta_n(\lambda)} \rightarrow \eta_*, \quad \xi_n = \frac{\delta_n(v_5)}{\delta_n(\lambda)} \rightarrow \xi_*, \quad \gamma_n = \frac{\delta_n(u_5)}{\delta_n(\lambda)} \rightarrow \gamma_*.$$

For the limiting affine shear one has only the asymptotic fixed-shear identities

$$\begin{aligned} \delta_n(c - \eta_* \lambda) &= (\eta_n - \eta_*) \delta_n(\lambda), \\ \delta_n(v_5 - \xi_* \lambda) &= (\xi_n - \xi_*) \delta_n(\lambda), \\ \delta_n(u_5 - \gamma_* \lambda) &= (\gamma_n - \gamma_*) \delta_n(\lambda). \end{aligned}$$

Hence a close exact mixed branch automatically reduces only to a projectively frozen secant-shadow problem. In general it does not reduce to exact repeated-source transport for a single fixed triple

$$(\eta_*, \xi_*, \gamma_*).$$

*Proof.* The identities

$$\delta_n(c) = \eta_n \delta_n(\lambda), \quad \delta_n(v_5) = \xi_n \delta_n(\lambda), \quad \delta_n(u_5) = \gamma_n \delta_n(\lambda)$$

are just a rewriting of the branch equations. If  $d_n = 0$  infinitely often, pass to that subsequence. Otherwise  $d_n \neq 0$  for all large  $n$ , and compactness of the unit sphere gives a convergent subsequence of  $\hat{d}_n$ , equivalently of the associated projective classes in  $\mathbf{P}^3$ .

On the affine chart  $\delta_n(\lambda) \neq 0$ , the projective coordinates are exactly

$$\eta_n = \frac{\delta_n(c)}{\delta_n(\lambda)}, \quad \xi_n = \frac{\delta_n(v_5)}{\delta_n(\lambda)}, \quad \gamma_n = \frac{\delta_n(u_5)}{\delta_n(\lambda)},$$

so convergence in that chart is precisely convergence of the affine  $\lambda$ -shears. The last three identities are immediate from the definitions.  $\square$

**Remark 12.125** (Affine freezing is stronger than projective freezing on the mixed two-point branch). Proposition 12.124 shows that the automatic compactness on the mixed two-point branch is projective, not affine. Even on a good overlap patch, the affine  $\lambda$ -shears can diverge if  $\delta_n(\lambda)$  vanishes to higher order than  $\delta_n(c), \delta_n(v_5), \delta_n(u_5)$ . And even when

$$(\eta_n, \xi_n, \gamma_n) \rightarrow (\eta_*, \xi_*, \gamma_*),$$

one gets only asymptotic transport for

$$c - \eta_* \lambda, \quad v_5 - \xi_* \lambda, \quad u_5 - \gamma_* \lambda,$$

not exact transport at each stage of the branch. Therefore the downstream derivative-geometric reduction should be formulated in terms of the projective defect direction

$$[\delta_n(c) : \delta_n(v_5) : \delta_n(u_5) : \delta_n(\lambda)],$$

or equivalently in any affine chart on which the projective limit has nonzero coordinate, rather than as an exact frozen- $\lambda$  repeated-source branch.

**Remark 12.126** (What remains in the two-pair rewrite). Theorem 12.114 supplies the algebraic bridge from the two-pair core to the strengthened invariant  $\hat{\Psi}$ , and Lemma 12.117 isolates the exact finite-order source criterion that would close the two-point branch on compact good patches.

Thus the remaining issue beyond the present two-pair subsection is no longer a vague interaction heuristic. There are now three precise conditional routes on the two-point side.

First, the stronger finite-order source-level merger route would force the quadratic defect estimates and hence the defect-scale closeness theorem on good patches.

Second, the weaker quotient-diagonal route would already exclude exact close two-point bad cores on compact subsets of  $\{c \neq 0\}$  if one had a genuine corrected two-atom quotient germ with continuity and exact diagonal collapse.

Third, on a good overlap patch in the mixed regime, the derivative-geometric attack now naturally passes through the moving  $\lambda$ -sheared source transport system

$$(c - \eta_n \lambda)(h_{1,n}) = \Lambda_n(c - \eta_n \lambda)(h_{2,n}), \quad (v_5 - \xi_n \lambda)(h_{1,n}) = \Lambda_n(v_5 - \xi_n \lambda)(h_{2,n}), \quad (u_5 - \gamma_n \lambda)(h_{1,n}) = \Lambda_n(u_5 - \gamma_n \lambda)(h_{2,n})$$

with

$$\lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}, \quad \Lambda_n = -\frac{a_{2,n}}{a_{1,n}}.$$

By Proposition 12.124, what is automatic from an exact close mixed branch is not affine freezing of

$$(\eta_n, \xi_n, \gamma_n),$$

but projective compactness of the defect directions

$$[\delta_n(c) : \delta_n(v_5) : \delta_n(u_5) : \delta_n(\lambda)], \quad \delta_n(f) := f(h_{1,n}) - \Lambda_n f(h_{2,n}).$$

On any subsequence whose projective limit lies in the affine  $\lambda$ -chart, one obtains a convergent affine  $\lambda$ -shear subsequence; in general the exact frozen repeated-source reduction is not automatic. The associated projective secant shadow can nevertheless accumulate only on

$$\{S = 0\} \cup \{K_v = 0\}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

In the additional conditional exact fixed-shear overlap lane, Proposition 12.245 shows that the slice

$$\{S = 0\} \cap \{K_v \neq 0\}$$

is already forced into a fold-type projection regime. Thus the only clearly genuinely mixed fixed-shear locus left on the overlap patch is

$$K_v = 0,$$

while the remaining off- $K_v = 0$  step is to match the resulting second-coordinate parity with the existing nonmixed odd-zero

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}$$

package.

So the genuinely remaining two-point work is either the verification of the finite-order source-level merger criterion, the construction of the actual corrected two-atom quotient germ with continuity and exact diagonal collapse, or the source-coupling analysis of the mixed  $\lambda$ -shear route on those explicit exceptional loci. More precisely, on the derivative-geometric side one now needs either projective control of the

$$S = 0$$

slice without exact freezing, or a proof that the conditional exact fixed-shear overlap lane is absorbed by the nonmixed odd-zero package. Beyond that lie the genuinely multi-pair interaction bookkeeping through orders 3, 5, 7, the local lifted 3/4-point analysis for close-point branches on the  $v_5 \neq 0$  and parallel  $u_5 \neq 0$  patches, and the subsequent finite-core extraction.

**Remark 12.127** (Minimal-core reformulation). The proposition above shows that the correct projective datum for the downstream multi-pair and minimal-core extraction is the amplitude-invariant strengthened map

$$\widehat{\Psi}(h) = \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)^2} \right),$$

not merely the pair  $(\ell_h, \bar{v}_1(h))$ .

By contrast, the affine curve

$$\Gamma(h) = \left( \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right)$$

remains the correct object for the one-pair secant/tangent geometry. The finite-core endgame should therefore be viewed as a two-stage problem: first extract defect-corrected coincidence information for  $\widehat{\Psi}$ , then convert that information into affine-line incidence constraints for  $\Gamma$ .

**Definition 12.128** (Minimal bad core). A normalized finite core is called bad if its quotient odd germ vanishes identically. A minimal bad core is a bad normalized finite core with minimal number of constituent pairs.

**Theorem 12.129** (Defect-free quintic circuit reduction). *Let*

$$F_{\text{core}}(z) = \sum_{j=1}^k a_j F_{h_j}(z) + \mathcal{I}_{\geq 2}(z)$$

*be a normalized finite core, and assume that the multi-pair interaction germ  $\mathcal{I}_{\geq 2}(z)$  contributes nothing to the cubic and quintic coefficients. Write*

$$A_5^\dagger(h) = u_5(h)I + v_5(h)S, \quad V(h) := (c(h), u_5(h), v_5(h)) \in \mathbf{C}^3,$$



and on  $\{c \neq 0\}$  define

$$\Xi(h) := \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)} \right) \in \mathbf{C}^2.$$

If

$$F_{\text{core}}(z) \equiv 0,$$

then

$$\sum_{j=1}^k a_j V(h_j) = 0.$$

Equivalently, with

$$b_j := a_j c(h_j),$$

one has

$$\sum_{j=1}^k b_j = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k b_j \Xi(h_j) = 0.$$

Thus the points  $\Xi(h_j)$  are affinely dependent.

*Proof.* Taking the cubic coefficient in the identity

$$F_{\text{core}}(z) \equiv 0$$

and using the hypothesis that  $\mathcal{I}_{\geq 2}$  contributes nothing at cubic order gives

$$\sum_{j=1}^k a_j c(h_j) = 0.$$

Taking the quintic fixed-sector coefficient and using the corresponding defect-free hypothesis at order 5 gives

$$\sum_{j=1}^k a_j A_5^{\text{f}}(h_j) = 0.$$

Since

$$A_5^{\text{f}}(h_j) = u_5(h_j)I + v_5(h_j)S$$

and  $I, S$  are linearly independent, this is equivalent to

$$\sum_{j=1}^k a_j u_5(h_j) = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k a_j v_5(h_j) = 0.$$

Together these three identities are exactly

$$\sum_{j=1}^k a_j V(h_j) = 0.$$

If  $c(h_j) \neq 0$  for all  $j$ , dividing the last two identities by  $c(h_j)$  after setting  $b_j = a_j c(h_j)$  yields

$$\sum_{j=1}^k b_j = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k b_j \Xi(h_j) = 0,$$

which is the affine dependence statement. □

**Corollary 12.130** (Defect-free minimal quintic circuits have size at most four). *In the defect-free order- $\leq 5$  model of Theorem 12.129, every minimal bad core has size at most 4. More precisely:*

- (1) if  $k = 2$ , then  $\Xi(h_1) = \Xi(h_2)$ ;
- (2) if  $k = 3$ , then the three points  $\Xi(h_1), \Xi(h_2), \Xi(h_3)$  are collinear;
- (3) if  $k = 4$ , then the four points  $\Xi(h_1), \dots, \Xi(h_4)$  form an affine circuit in  $\mathbf{C}^2$ .

*Proof.* By Theorem 12.129, a minimal defect-free bad core produces a minimal affine dependence among finitely many points of the affine plane  $\mathbf{C}^2$ . Such a minimal affine dependent set has size at most 4. The cases  $k = 2, 3, 4$  are the standard affine configurations in dimension 2: coincidence, collinear triple, or four-point affine circuit.  $\square$

**Definition 12.131** (Lifted  $v_5$ -patch coordinates). On a connected interval  $U \subset \{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}$ , define

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad \sigma_v(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h) v_5(h)}.$$

The associated lifted planar and space curves are

$$\Lambda_v(h) := (x(h), \sigma_v(h)) \in \mathbf{C}^2, \quad Q_v(h) := (y(h), x(h), \sigma_v(h)) \in \mathbf{C}^3.$$

**Proposition 12.132** (Defect-free lifted affine dependence on a  $v_5$ -patch). *Let*

$$F_{\text{core}}(z) = \sum_{j=1}^k a_j F_{h_j}(z) + \mathcal{I}_{\geq 2}(z)$$

*be a normalized finite core, and assume:*

- (1) *all parameters  $h_j$  lie in one connected interval  $U \subset \{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}$ ;*
- (2) *the multi-pair interaction germ  $\mathcal{I}_{\geq 2}(z)$  contributes nothing to the cubic, quintic, or septic coefficients.*

*Then, after choosing on  $U$  the local septic gauge  $v_7 = 0$ , the vanishing identity*

$$F_{\text{core}}(z) \equiv 0$$

*implies*

$$\sum_{j=1}^k b_j = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k b_j y(h_j) = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k b_j x(h_j) = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k b_j \sigma_v(h_j) = 0,$$

*where  $b_j := a_j c(h_j)$ . Equivalently, the points  $Q_v(h_j) \in \mathbf{C}^3$  are affinely dependent.*

*Proof.* The cubic and quintic identities are exactly those in Theorem 12.129, so after setting  $b_j = a_j c(h_j)$  we obtain

$$\sum_{j=1}^k b_j = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k b_j y(h_j) = 0, \quad \sum_{j=1}^k b_j x(h_j) = 0.$$

On the interval  $U$  we may choose the local septic gauge  $v_7 = 0$ . Then

$$u_7(h) = \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{v_5(h)} = c(h) \sigma_v(h).$$

Since the septic interaction is assumed absent, taking the septic fixed-sector coefficient of  $F_{\text{core}} \equiv 0$  yields

$$\sum_{j=1}^k a_j u_7(h_j) = 0.$$

Substituting  $u_7(h_j) = c(h_j) \sigma_v(h_j)$  gives

$$\sum_{j=1}^k b_j \sigma_v(h_j) = 0.$$

Hence the points  $Q_v(h_j)$  are affinely dependent.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.133** (Geometric meaning of defect-free lifted affine dependence). *Assume the hypotheses of Proposition 12.132. Then:*

- (1) *if  $k = 2$ , the two points  $Q_v(h_1)$  and  $Q_v(h_2)$  coincide;*
- (2) *if  $k = 3$ , the three points  $Q_v(h_1), Q_v(h_2), Q_v(h_3)$  are collinear in  $\mathbf{C}^3$ ;*
- (3) *if  $k = 4$ , the four points  $Q_v(h_1), \dots, Q_v(h_4)$  are coplanar in  $\mathbf{C}^3$ .*

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.132, the points  $Q_v(h_j)$  are affinely dependent. For  $k = 2$ , affine dependence of two points is exactly coincidence. For  $k = 3$ , affine dependence of three points is exactly collinearity. For  $k = 4$ , affine dependence of four points is exactly coplanarity.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.134** (Explicit four-point determinant form on a  $v_5$ -patch). *Assume the hypotheses of Proposition 12.132 with  $k = 4$ . Then the coplanarity of the four lifted points is equivalent to*

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & y(h_1) & x(h_1) & \sigma_v(h_1) \\ 1 & y(h_2) & x(h_2) & \sigma_v(h_2) \\ 1 & y(h_3) & x(h_3) & \sigma_v(h_3) \\ 1 & y(h_4) & x(h_4) & \sigma_v(h_4) \end{pmatrix} = 0.$$

*Equivalently,*

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \frac{u_5(h_1)}{c(h_1)} & \frac{v_5(h_1)}{c(h_1)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_1)}{c(h_1)v_5(h_1)} \\ 1 & \frac{u_5(h_2)}{c(h_2)} & \frac{v_5(h_2)}{c(h_2)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_2)}{c(h_2)v_5(h_2)} \\ 1 & \frac{u_5(h_3)}{c(h_3)} & \frac{v_5(h_3)}{c(h_3)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_3)}{c(h_3)v_5(h_3)} \\ 1 & \frac{u_5(h_4)}{c(h_4)} & \frac{v_5(h_4)}{c(h_4)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_4)}{c(h_4)v_5(h_4)} \end{pmatrix} = 0.$$

*Multiplying row  $j$  by  $v_5(h_j)$  gives the canonical determinant identity*

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} v_5(h_1) & u_5(h_1) & \frac{v_5(h_1)^2}{c(h_1)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_1)}{c(h_1)} \\ v_5(h_2) & u_5(h_2) & \frac{v_5(h_2)^2}{c(h_2)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_2)}{c(h_2)} \\ v_5(h_3) & u_5(h_3) & \frac{v_5(h_3)^2}{c(h_3)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_3)}{c(h_3)} \\ v_5(h_4) & u_5(h_4) & \frac{v_5(h_4)^2}{c(h_4)} & \frac{\Delta_7(h_4)}{c(h_4)} \end{pmatrix} = 0.$$

*Equivalently, multiplying instead row  $j$  by  $c(h_j)v_5(h_j)$  gives the fully polynomial version*

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} c(h_1)v_5(h_1) & u_5(h_1)v_5(h_1) & v_5(h_1)^2 & \Delta_7(h_1) \\ c(h_2)v_5(h_2) & u_5(h_2)v_5(h_2) & v_5(h_2)^2 & \Delta_7(h_2) \\ c(h_3)v_5(h_3) & u_5(h_3)v_5(h_3) & v_5(h_3)^2 & \Delta_7(h_3) \\ c(h_4)v_5(h_4) & u_5(h_4)v_5(h_4) & v_5(h_4)^2 & \Delta_7(h_4) \end{pmatrix} = 0.$$

*Proof.* For  $k = 4$ , Corollary 12.133 shows that the four lifted points

$$Q_v(h_j) = (y(h_j), x(h_j), \sigma_v(h_j))$$

are coplanar. This is equivalent to the vanishing of the affine  $4 \times 4$  determinant with first column 1. The displayed reformulations follow by substituting the definitions of  $x, y, \sigma_v$  and multiplying rows by the indicated nonzero factors.  $\square$

**Remark 12.135** (Finite-core meaning of the lifted  $v_5$ -patch geometry). The defect-free finite-core reduction now places the lifted  $v_5$ -patch geometry into a sharp global context.

Indeed, by Theorem 12.129, Corollary 12.130, and Proposition 12.132, defect-free bad cores on a good  $v_5$ -patch reduce to affine dependence of the lifted points

$$Q_v(h) = (y(h), x(h), \sigma_v(h)),$$

with effective ceiling

$$k \leq 4.$$

Thus the three low core sizes have the following exact lifted meanings:

$$\begin{aligned} k = 2 &\iff Q_v(h_1) = Q_v(h_2), \\ k = 3 &\iff Q_v(h_1), Q_v(h_2), Q_v(h_3) \text{ are collinear}, \\ k = 4 &\iff Q_v(h_1), \dots, Q_v(h_4) \text{ are coplanar}. \end{aligned}$$

So the lifted 3-point and 4-point analyses are not auxiliary side computations: they are exactly the  $k = 3$  and  $k = 4$  geometric layers in the finite-core program. In particular, once the lifted 3-point branch is globally rigid on good  $v_5$ -patches, the remaining finite-core burden shifts upward to the two-point source-level merger problem and to the mixed/nonmixed lifted 4-point mechanisms.

**Remark 12.136** (Parallel  $u_5$ -patch version). There is a completely parallel local story on any connected interval in  $\{c \neq 0, u_5 \neq 0\}$ , obtained by choosing the local septic gauge  $u_7 = 0$  instead of  $v_7 = 0$ . Then one defines

$$\tau_u(h) := -\frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)u_5(h)}, \quad Q_u(h) := \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \tau_u(h) \right),$$

and the same defect-free affine-dependence conclusions hold with  $Q_v$  replaced by  $Q_u$ . Since the present one-pair geometry already uses

$$x(h) = \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}$$

as the distinguished ECT coordinate, the  $v_5 \neq 0$  patch is the natural first setting and will be used below.

**Proposition 12.137** (Centered quintic-patch dichotomy). *Assume the centered diagonal family is a genuine analytic branch in the underlying  $h$ -geometry, and that the centered scalar package from Remark 12.253 holds on that branch. Then, after shrinking, there exist one-sided punctured subarcs on which at least one of the following holds:*

(1)

$$c \neq 0, \quad M \neq 0, \quad v_5 \neq 0,$$

*so the branch enters a good  $v_5$ -patch;*

(2)

$$c \neq 0, \quad u_5 \neq 0,$$

*so the parallel  $u_5$ -patch of Remark 12.136 applies.*

*In particular, the centered diagonal branch enters some quintic patch on one-sided punctured arcs.*

*Proof.* By Corollary 12.257,

$$A_5^f(s) \neq 0,$$

so at least one of  $u_5$  or  $v_5$  is a nonzero analytic germ on the centered branch.

If  $v_5 \neq 0$ , then its zeros are isolated. Since

$$c(s) = C_0 + C_2 s^2 + \cdots, \quad C_0 \neq 0,$$

we also have  $c \neq 0$  near the basepoint. On any one-sided punctured arc where  $v_5 \neq 0$ , define

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}.$$

This is a nonconstant analytic germ. If  $M \equiv 0$  on such an arc, then

$$x' = \left( \frac{v_5}{c} \right)' = \frac{M}{c^2} \equiv 0,$$

so  $x$  would be constant, contradiction. Hence  $M$  is not identically zero on that arc, and by analyticity its zeros are isolated. After shrinking again, one obtains

$$c \neq 0, \quad M \neq 0, \quad v_5 \neq 0,$$

i.e. a good  $v_5$ -patch.

If instead  $v_5 \equiv 0$ , then  $u_5 \neq 0$ . Its zeros are isolated, so after shrinking to a one-sided punctured arc one has

$$c \neq 0, \quad u_5 \neq 0,$$

and the  $u_5$ -patch of Remark 12.136 applies. □

**Corollary 12.138** (Conditional punctured  $v_5$ -patch promotion). *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 12.137, if*

$$v_5 \not\equiv 0$$

*on the centered diagonal branch, then after shrinking there exist one-sided punctured subarcs contained in*

$$\{c \neq 0, M \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}.$$

*Hence on such arcs*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}$$

*is automatically a valid local coordinate.*

*Proof.* This is exactly the first branch of the proof of Proposition 12.137.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.139** (Linear independence of  $1, u_5/c, v_5/c$ ). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval on which*

$$c \neq 0, \quad M \neq 0.$$

*Then the three functions*

$$1, \quad \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad \frac{v_5}{c}$$

*are linearly independent on  $J$ .*

*Proof.* Assume there exist constants  $A, B, C \in \mathbf{C}$ , not all zero, such that

$$A + B \frac{u_5}{c} + C \frac{v_5}{c} \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Multiplying by  $c$  gives

$$A c + B u_5 + C v_5 \equiv 0.$$

If  $B = 0$ , then

$$A c + C v_5 \equiv 0,$$

so  $v_5/c$  is constant on  $J$ . But

$$\left(\frac{v_5}{c}\right)' = \frac{M}{c^2},$$

and  $M \neq 0$  on  $J$ . This is impossible.

Hence  $B \neq 0$ , and after renormalization we may write

$$u_5 = \alpha v_5 + \beta c$$

for constants  $\alpha, \beta$ .

Now isolate the graded slice corresponding to

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(5)}).$$

By Lemmas 12.16 and 12.18, the tagged monomial

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(5)}(h)$$

occurs with nonzero coefficient in  $\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)$ . Since

$$A_5^{\text{f}}(h) = u_5(h)I + v_5(h)S$$

and  $S$  is traceless, this means exactly that the same tagged monomial occurs in the  $I$ -coefficient  $u_5(h)$ .

It cannot occur in  $c(h)$ , since  $c$  is cubic and carries no quintic  $q^{(5)}$ -slice. It also cannot occur in  $v_5(h)$ . Indeed, on the tagged slice, the only surviving quintic  $K_1$ -transport channels are those already isolated in Lemma 12.18. For the channel

$$X_0 J X_4 - X_4 J X_0,$$

Lemma 12.17 shows that the relevant  $(\eta_2, q^{(5)})$ -slice is diagonal, hence contributes only to the  $I$ -component. For the commutator channel

$$X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3,$$

Proposition 12.40 gives

$$v_5^{(\text{comm})} = \gamma u - \alpha w.$$

On the tagged slice the  $\eta_2$ -input in  $X_1$  is purely off-diagonal, so  $u = w = 0$ , while the  $q^{(5)}$ -input in  $X_3$  is diagonal. Hence

$$v_5^{(\text{comm})} = 0$$

on that tagged slice.

Thus the monomial  $\kappa\eta_2q^{(5)}$  occurs in  $u_5$  but in neither  $v_5$  nor  $c$ , contradicting

$$u_5 = \alpha v_5 + \beta c.$$

This proves the claim.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.140** (Automatic  $u_5$ -patch on a good  $M \neq 0$  interval). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval on which*

$$c \neq 0, \quad M \neq 0.$$

*Then  $u_5 \not\equiv 0$  on  $J$ . Consequently, every connected component of*

$$J \setminus u_5^{-1}(0)$$

*is a valid local  $u_5$ -patch in the sense of Remark 12.136.*

*Proof.* If  $u_5 \equiv 0$  on  $J$ , then the three functions

$$1, \quad \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad \frac{v_5}{c}$$

would be linearly dependent, contradicting Proposition 12.139. Thus  $u_5 \not\equiv 0$  on  $J$ , so its zeros are isolated and each connected component of  $J \setminus u_5^{-1}(0)$  lies in  $\{c \neq 0, u_5 \neq 0\}$ . The parallel  $u_5$ -patch geometry then follows from Remark 12.136.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.141** (Non-affinity of the lifted septic scalar). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval contained in the quintic-generic region and in*

$$\{h : c(h) \neq 0, v_5(h) \neq 0\}.$$

*Then there do not exist constants  $A, B \in \mathbf{C}$  such that*

$$\sigma_v(h) \equiv A x(h) + B \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Equivalently,*

$$\Delta_7(h) \not\equiv A v_5(h)^2 + B c(h)v_5(h) \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Proof.* If

$$\sigma_v(h) \equiv A x(h) + B,$$

then multiplying by  $c(h)v_5(h)$  gives

$$\Delta_7(h) \equiv A v_5(h)^2 + B c(h)v_5(h).$$

The right-hand side is built only from the cubic and quintic layers and therefore has no direct septic  $q^{(7)}$ -slice. But by Proposition 12.48, the direct  $q^{(7)}$ -slice of  $\Delta_7$  is generically nonzero on  $J$ . This is a contradiction.  $\square$

**Definition 12.142** (Lifted derivative numerator and curvature numerator). On  $\{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}$ , define

$$P_v(h) := c(h)v_5(h)\Delta_7'(h) - \Delta_7(h)(c(h)v_5(h))'.$$

Then

$$\sigma_v'(h) = \frac{P_v(h)}{c(h)^2 v_5(h)^2}.$$

Define also the affine curvature numerator of the lifted planar curve

$$\Lambda_v(h) = (x(h), \sigma_v(h))$$

by

$$K_v(h) := x'(h)\sigma_v''(h) - \sigma_v'(h)x''(h).$$

**Proposition 12.143** (Curvature bridge for the lifted  $v_5$ -patch curve). *On  $\{c \neq 0, M \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}$ ,*

$$\frac{d\sigma_v}{dx} = \frac{P_v}{M v_5^2},$$

and

$$K_v(h) = \frac{M(h)^2}{c(h)^4} \frac{d}{dh} \left( \frac{P_v(h)}{M(h) v_5(h)^2} \right).$$

*In particular, if  $K_v \equiv 0$  on a connected open interval  $J \subset \{c \neq 0, M \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}$ , then  $\sigma_v$  is affine in  $x$  on  $J$ , contradicting Proposition 12.141. Hence*

$$K_v \not\equiv 0$$

*on every such interval.*

*Proof.* Since

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad x' = \frac{M}{c^2}, \quad \sigma'_v = \frac{P_v}{c^2 v_5^2},$$

we obtain

$$\frac{d\sigma_v}{dx} = \frac{\sigma'_v}{x'} = \frac{P_v}{M v_5^2}.$$

Differentiating with respect to  $h$  and multiplying by

$$x' = \frac{M}{c^2}$$

gives

$$K_v = x'^2 \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{d\sigma_v}{dx} \right) = \frac{M^2}{c^4} \frac{d}{dh} \left( \frac{P_v}{M v_5^2} \right).$$

If  $K_v \equiv 0$  on a connected interval with  $M \neq 0$ , then

$$\frac{P_v}{M v_5^2}$$

is constant there, so  $d\sigma_v/dx$  is constant and  $\sigma_v$  is affine in  $x$ . This contradicts Proposition 12.141.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.144** (Local defect-free three-point exclusion on lifted ECT subintervals). *Let  $J \subset \{c \neq 0, M \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}$  be a connected interval on which  $K_v$  has fixed nonzero sign. Then the triple*

$$1, \quad x, \quad \sigma_v$$

*is an ECT system on  $J$ . In particular, no affine line meets the lifted planar curve*

$$\Lambda_v(h) = (x(h), \sigma_v(h))$$

*in three points of  $J$ . Hence the defect-free three-point branch is excluded on such a subinterval.*

*Proof.* The Wronskian of  $1, x, \sigma_v$  is exactly  $K_v$ . If  $K_v$  has fixed nonzero sign on  $J$ , the ECT criterion applies.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.145** (Lifted order-7 Wronskian is not identically zero). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval contained in the quintic-generic region and in*

$$\{h : c(h) \neq 0, M(h) \neq 0, v_5(h) \neq 0\}.$$

*Then*

$$T_v(h) := W_h \left( 1, \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h) v_5(h)} \right)$$

*is not identically zero on  $J$ .*

*Proof.* Write

$$y := \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad x := \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad \sigma_v := \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

If  $T_v \equiv 0$  on  $J$ , then by analyticity the four functions

$$1, y, x, \sigma_v$$

are locally linearly dependent on  $J$ , hence linearly dependent on all of the connected interval  $J$ . By Proposition 12.139, the first three are linearly independent, so there exist constants  $A, B, C$  such that

$$\sigma_v = A + By + Cx.$$

Multiplying by  $c v_5$  gives

$$\Delta_7 = A c v_5 + B u_5 v_5 + C v_5^2.$$

The right-hand side is built entirely from the cubic/quintic layers and therefore carries no direct  $q^{(7)}$ -slice. This contradicts Proposition 12.48, which gives

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} \neq 0$$

on  $J$ . □

**Proposition 12.146** (Exact  $x$ -coordinate identities for the lifted 4-point invariants). *On a good  $v_5$ -patch, write*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad S = \sigma_v = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

*Then:*

(1) *the lifted planar curvature numerator satisfies*

$$K_v = (x')^3 S''(x);$$

(2) *the lifted 4-point Wronskian satisfies*

$$T_v = (x')^6 W_x(1, Y, x, S) = (x')^6 (S'' Y''' - S''' Y'');$$

(3) *equivalently,*

$$T_v = (x')^6 S''^2 \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{Y''}{S''} \right) = K_v^2 \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{Y''}{S''} \right).$$

*In particular,  $K_v$  and  $S''$  have the same zero set and the same vanishing order on every good  $v_5$ -patch.*

*Proof.* By definition,

$$K_v = x' \sigma_v'' - \sigma_v' x''.$$

Since  $S = \sigma_v$  as a function of the local coordinate  $x$ , we have

$$\sigma_v' = S' x', \quad \sigma_v'' = S''(x')^2 + S' x'',$$

hence

$$K_v = x' (S''(x')^2 + S' x'') - S' x' x'' = (x')^3 S''.$$

Next,

$$T_v = W_h(1, Y, x, S).$$

Under reparametrization  $h \mapsto x(h)$ , a  $4 \times 4$  Wronskian gains the factor  $(x')^{0+1+2+3} = (x')^6$ , so

$$T_v = (x')^6 W_x(1, Y, x, S).$$

Now

$$W_x(1, Y, x, S) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Y & x & S \\ 0 & Y' & 1 & S' \\ 0 & Y'' & 0 & S'' \\ 0 & Y''' & 0 & S''' \end{pmatrix} = S'' Y''' - S''' Y'',$$

which proves the second identity.



Finally,

$$S''Y''' - S'''Y'' = S''^2 \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{Y''}{S''} \right),$$

and using  $K_v = (x')^3 S''$  gives

$$(x')^6 S''^2 = K_v^2.$$

This yields the third identity.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.147** (Canonical scalar invariants  $\mathcal{Z}$  and  $\mathcal{R}$  on a nonmixed lifted patch). *On a good  $v_5$ -patch, write*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad S = \sigma_v = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

*On the nonmixed subregion where  $K_v \neq 0$ , define*

$$\mathcal{Z} := \frac{Y''}{S''}, \quad \mathcal{R} := \frac{d\mathcal{Z}}{dx}.$$

*Then:*

(1)

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2};$$

(2) *under the affine gauge*

$$Y \mapsto Y + \alpha + \beta x + \gamma S,$$

*one has*

$$\mathcal{Z} \mapsto \mathcal{Z} + \gamma, \quad \mathcal{R} \mapsto \mathcal{R}.$$

*Hence  $\mathcal{R}$  is the canonical scalar invariant of the lifted 4-point branch on every nonmixed patch.*

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.146,

$$T_v = (x')^6 S''^2 \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{Y''}{S''} \right) = K_v^2 \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{Y''}{S''} \right),$$

so

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{Y''}{S''} \right) = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}.$$

For the gauge transformation, one has

$$(Y + \alpha + \beta x + \gamma S)'' = Y'' + \gamma S'',$$

hence

$$\mathcal{Z} \mapsto \frac{Y'' + \gamma S''}{S''} = \mathcal{Z} + \gamma.$$

Differentiating with respect to  $x$  gives  $\mathcal{R} \mapsto \mathcal{R}$ .  $\square$

**Remark 12.148** (Below-lifted Wronskian-ratio reformulation). Let

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}, \quad \lambda := \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}, \quad M := c v'_5 - c' v_5.$$

For any scalar germ  $f$ , define

$$J_f(h) := \det \begin{pmatrix} c(h) & v_5(h) & f(h) \\ c'(h) & v'_5(h) & f'(h) \\ c''(h) & v''_5(h) & f''(h) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then

$$\frac{d^2}{dx^2} \left( \frac{f}{c} \right) = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_f.$$

Applying this to  $f = u_5$  and  $f = \lambda$  gives

$$Y'' = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_{u_5}, \quad S'' = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_\lambda,$$

hence

$$\mathcal{Z} := \frac{Y''}{S''} = \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda}.$$

Differentiating in the  $x$ -coordinate yields

$$\mathcal{R} := \mathcal{Z}' = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2} = \frac{c^2}{M} \frac{d}{dh} \left( \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda} \right).$$

Thus the lifted 4-point branch may be viewed equivalently as a parity/divisibility problem for the Wronskian ratio  $J_{u_5}/J_\lambda$ . On the nonmixed side, however, the later source-level no-go results show that the ratio/Wronskian package by itself is not yet restrictive enough: the remaining burden is a genuine source-coupling theorem, not a generic Wronskian-ratio argument.

**Proposition 12.149** (Source-level Wronskian for the nonmixed 4-point branch). *Define*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} := J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda.$$

Then

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{c^2}{M} \frac{\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}}{J_\lambda^2}.$$

In particular, on every nonmixed arc on which  $J_\lambda \neq 0$ , the analytic scalars  $\mathcal{R}$  and  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  differ only by a nonvanishing analytic factor. Hence:

- (1)  $\mathcal{R} = 0 \iff \mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = 0$ ;
- (2)  $\text{ord } \mathcal{R} = \text{ord } \mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ ;
- (3) the local parity classification of isolated zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  transfers verbatim to  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ .

Moreover, under the affine gauge change

$$u_5 \mapsto u_5 + \alpha c + \beta v_5 + \gamma \lambda$$

one has

$$J_{u_5} \mapsto J_{u_5} + \gamma J_\lambda,$$

and therefore

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} \mapsto \mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}.$$

So  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  is the canonical source-level gauge-invariant nonmixed scalar.

*Proof.* Differentiate the ratio

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda}$$

from Remark 12.148:

$$\frac{d}{dh} \left( \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda} \right) = \frac{J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda}{J_\lambda^2} = \frac{\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}}{J_\lambda^2}.$$

Substituting this into

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{c^2}{M} \frac{d}{dh} \left( \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda} \right)$$

gives the displayed identity.

On a nonmixed arc,  $J_\lambda \neq 0$  and  $c^2/M \neq 0$ , so  $\mathcal{R}$  and  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  differ by a nonvanishing analytic factor. This proves the zero-set and parity statements.

For gauge invariance, the terms  $\alpha c$  and  $\beta v_5$  do not change  $J_{u_5}$ , while  $\gamma \lambda$  adds  $\gamma J_\lambda$ . Therefore

$$(J_{u_5} + \gamma J_\lambda)' = J'_{u_5} + \gamma J'_\lambda,$$

and

$$J_\lambda (J'_{u_5} + \gamma J'_\lambda) - (J_{u_5} + \gamma J_\lambda) J'_\lambda = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda. \quad \square$$

**Remark 12.150** (Determinant-level parity on a centered good patch). Assume the centered scalar package from Remark 12.253 and suppose that  $x = v_5/c$  is being used as the induced odd collision-side coordinate. Then

$$u_5, \lambda := \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5} \text{ are odd in } s, \quad c \text{ is even in } s, \quad v_5 \text{ is odd in } s.$$

Hence the rows of the defining determinants for  $J_{u_5}$  and  $J_\lambda$  have parities

$$(e, o, o), \quad (o, e, e), \quad (e, o, o),$$

so each determinant monomial is odd. Therefore

$$J_{u_5}(s) \text{ and } J_\lambda(s) \text{ are odd in } s.$$

Consequently,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda}$$

is even and

$$\mathcal{R} = \mathcal{Z}'$$

is odd, in agreement with the parity package obtained from the direct  $Y''/S''$ -analysis.

**Corollary 12.151** (Centered parity of the source-level Wronskian). *Under the hypotheses of Remark 12.150, the source-level Wronskian*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}(s) = J_\lambda(s) J'_{u_5}(s) - J_{u_5}(s) J'_\lambda(s)$$

*is odd in the centered variable  $s$ .*

*Consequently, any isolated centered zero of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  has odd order if and only if it is a potentially branch-seeding zero for the nonmixed 4-point geometry; even-order centered zeros are locally sterile.*

*Proof.* By Remark 12.150,

$$J_{u_5}(s) \text{ and } J_\lambda(s) \text{ are odd in } s.$$

Hence

$$J'_{u_5}(s) \text{ and } J'_\lambda(s) \text{ are even in } s.$$

Therefore

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}(s) = J_\lambda(s) J'_{u_5}(s) - J_{u_5}(s) J'_\lambda(s)$$

is odd in  $s$ . The final statement follows from Proposition 12.149, which transfers the parity classification from  $\mathcal{R}$  to  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 12.152** (Mixed low-order exclusion on a centered good  $v_5$ -patch). *Under the hypotheses of Remark 12.150, one has*

$$\mathcal{Z}(x) \text{ even}, \quad \mathcal{R}(x) \text{ odd}, \quad K_v(x) \text{ odd}.$$

*Consequently,*

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) \notin \{(1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2)\}.$$

*Equivalently, none of the explicit mixed low-order models*

$$(m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6)$$

*can occur on such a centered good patch.*

*Proof.* Since  $\mathcal{Z}$  is even, its finite vanishing order must be even, so the cases

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) = (1, 1), (1, 3)$$

are impossible. Since  $K_v$  is odd, its vanishing order  $r = \text{ord}_0 K_v$  must be odd, so

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) = (2, 2)$$

is impossible as well.  $\square$

**Theorem 12.153** (Local exhaustion of the mixed 4-point branch near the centered base). *Assume the centered scalar package from Remark 12.253, the right-pincer local reduction from Corollary 12.262, and the finite-jet scalar descent from Corollary 12.251. Then every sufficiently small nearby genuinely new mixed 4-point obstruction near the centered diagonal base is excluded.*

*Equivalently, near the centered base the mixed 4-point branch is locally exhausted: the clean branch  $V_1 \neq 0$  is excluded by the centered good- $v_5$ -patch parity package, while every late- $v_5$  branch is either locally sterile on the  $u_5$ -patch or already absorbed into the defect-free planar quintic-circuit regime.*

*Proof.* By Corollary 12.262, every sufficiently small nearby genuinely new mixed 4-point obstruction must lie on the clean branch

$$V_1 \neq 0, \quad \text{equivalently} \quad \text{ord}_s v_5 = 1.$$

On that branch, Corollary 12.251 gives

$$c(s) = C_0 + C_2 s^2 + C_4 s^4 + \cdots.$$

Since  $v_5(s)$  is odd with  $V_1 \neq 0$ , the induced patch coordinate

$$x(s) = \frac{v_5(s)}{c(s)}$$

is odd and has odd inverse. Since  $u_5(s)$  is odd and  $\Delta_7(s)$  is even, it follows that

$$Y(x) = \frac{u_5}{c}(x) \quad \text{and} \quad S(x) = \frac{\Delta_7}{cv_5}(x)$$

are odd in  $x$ . Hence

$$\mathcal{Z}(x) = \frac{Y''}{S''} \text{ is even,} \quad K_v = (x')^3 S''$$

has odd vanishing order, so by Corollary 12.152 none of the explicit mixed low-order obstruction patterns

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) \in \{(1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2)\}$$

can occur on the clean branch.

Thus no sufficiently small nearby genuinely new mixed 4-point obstruction remains. The late- $v_5$  branches were already removed by Corollary 12.262, and the clean branch is excluded as above.  $\square$

**Remark 12.154** (What the mixed local exhaustion theorem now accomplishes). Theorem 12.153 closes the mixed 4-point route locally near the centered diagonal base in a self-contained way: the clean branch is eliminated by the canonical scalar descent together with the centered good- $v_5$ -patch parity package, while every late- $v_5$  branch is already removed by the  $u_5$ -patch right-pincer package as either locally sterile or already-quintic.

**Remark 12.155** (What remains after local mixed exhaustion). Theorem 12.153 exhausts the mixed 4-point branch only in the centered-base local regime. Any remaining mixed 4-point escape must therefore be genuinely global/nonlocal: it cannot come from a new local mixed septic jet pattern near the centered diagonal base.

**Remark 12.156** (A second below-lifted ratio does not add a new obstruction). Let

$$\Theta := \frac{W_{u_5}}{W},$$

where  $W$  denotes the corresponding projective-chart Wronskian in the  $(c, v_5, \cdot)$ -frame. In the gauge  $c \equiv 1$ ,  $v_5 = x$ , one has the exact relation

$$\Theta = \mathcal{Z} \frac{S''}{xS'' + 2S'}, \quad (\mathcal{Z} - x\Theta)S'' = 2\Theta S'.$$

So  $\Theta$  does not provide an independent local obstruction beyond  $(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R})$ : whenever  $2\Theta/(\mathcal{Z} - x\Theta)$  is analytic, one can solve locally for  $S$  and then recover  $Y$  from  $Y'' = \mathcal{Z}S''$ . In particular, attacks based only on a generic differential relation between  $\mathcal{Z}$  and  $\Theta$  are too weak to close the 4-point branch.

**Corollary 12.157** (Local defect-free four-point exclusion on lifted ECT subintervals). *Let  $J \subset \{c \neq 0, M \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0\}$  be a connected interval on which  $T_v$  has fixed nonzero sign. Then the quadruple*

$$1, \quad \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}$$

*is an ECT system on  $J$ . Equivalently, no affine plane meets the lifted space curve*

$$Q_v(h) = \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h) v_5(h)} \right)$$

*in four points of  $J$ . Hence the defect-free four-point branch is excluded on such a subinterval.*

*Proof.* The Wronskian of the displayed quadruple is exactly  $T_v$ . If  $T_v$  has fixed nonzero sign on  $J$ , the ECT criterion applies.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.158** (Osculating determinant expansion for shrinking affine circuits). *Let  $Q : I \rightarrow \mathbf{C}^d$  be real-analytic on an interval  $I$ , and define*

$$\Delta_{d+1}(t_0, \dots, t_d) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Q(t_0) \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 1 & Q(t_d) \end{pmatrix}.$$

*Fix  $h_* \in I$ , and let*

$$t_j = h_* + \varepsilon \lambda_j \quad (j = 0, \dots, d),$$

*where the  $\lambda_j$  are pairwise distinct and  $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$ . Then*

$$\Delta_{d+1}(t_0, \dots, t_d) = \frac{\varepsilon^{d(d+1)/2}}{\prod_{k=1}^d k!} V(\lambda_0, \dots, \lambda_d) \det(Q'(h_*), Q''(h_*), \dots, Q^{(d)}(h_*)) + O(\varepsilon^{d(d+1)/2+1}),$$

*where*

$$V(\lambda_0, \dots, \lambda_d) := \prod_{0 \leq i < j \leq d} (\lambda_j - \lambda_i)$$

*is the Vandermonde determinant.*

*In particular, if there is a sequence of exact affine  $(d+1)$ -circuits*

$$\Delta_{d+1}(t_{0,n}, \dots, t_{d,n}) = 0$$

*with pairwise distinct nodes  $t_{j,n} \rightarrow h_*$ , then*

$$\det(Q'(h_*), Q''(h_*), \dots, Q^{(d)}(h_*)) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Write the Taylor expansion

$$Q(h_* + \varepsilon \lambda) = Q(h_*) + \sum_{m=1}^d \frac{\varepsilon^m \lambda^m}{m!} Q^{(m)}(h_*) + O(\varepsilon^{d+1}),$$

uniformly for  $\lambda$  in bounded sets. Subtract the first row  $(1, Q(t_0))$  from each of the remaining rows. The first column then becomes  $(1, 0, \dots, 0)^\top$ , so  $\Delta_{d+1}$  reduces to the determinant of the  $d \times d$  matrix whose  $j$ -th row ( $j = 1, \dots, d$ ) is

$$Q(t_j) - Q(t_0) = \sum_{m=1}^d \frac{\varepsilon^m (\lambda_j^m - \lambda_0^m)}{m!} Q^{(m)}(h_*) + O(\varepsilon^{d+1}).$$

Factor the column vectors  $Q'(h_*), \dots, Q^{(d)}(h_*)$ . This gives

$$\Delta_{d+1}(t_0, \dots, t_d) = \det(Q'(h_*), \dots, Q^{(d)}(h_*)) \det\left(\frac{\varepsilon^m (\lambda_j^m - \lambda_0^m)}{m!}\right)_{1 \leq j, m \leq d} + O(\varepsilon^{d(d+1)/2+1}).$$

Pulling  $\varepsilon^m/m!$  from the  $m$ -th column yields the factor

$$\frac{\varepsilon^{1+\dots+d}}{\prod_{k=1}^d k!} = \frac{\varepsilon^{d(d+1)/2}}{\prod_{k=1}^d k!}.$$

The remaining determinant is the standard Vandermonde determinant  $V(\lambda_0, \dots, \lambda_d)$ . This proves the expansion.

If  $\Delta_{d+1}(t_{0,n}, \dots, t_{d,n}) = 0$  for a sequence of shrinking distinct-node circuits, divide by the nonzero Vandermonde factor and let  $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$ . The leading term must vanish, giving

$$\det(Q'(h_*), Q''(h_*), \dots, Q^{(d)}(h_*)) = 0. \quad \square$$

**Remark 12.159** (Planar curvature and lifted torsion as the first derivative obstructions). Lemma 12.158 shows that shrinking exact affine circuits are controlled, at first nontrivial order, by derivative-side osculating determinants. For a planar curve  $q$ , shrinking exact collinear triples force

$$\det(q', q'') = 0,$$

and for a space curve  $Q$ , shrinking exact coplanar quadruples force

$$\det(Q', Q'', Q''') = 0.$$

Thus the defect-free lifted 3-point and 4-point branches are not merely incidence problems: they are rooted at curvature- and torsion-type derivative invariants of the corresponding lifted curves.

**Proposition 12.160** (Shrinking exact lifted 3-point circuits concentrate into  $K_v = 0$ ). *Let  $P \subseteq \{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$  be compact, and use*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad S = \sigma_v = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

*Suppose there is a sequence of distinct triples*

$$x_{1,n}, x_{2,n}, x_{3,n} \in x(P), \quad x_{1,n}, x_{2,n}, x_{3,n} \rightarrow x_*,$$

*such that*

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_{1,n} & S(x_{1,n}) \\ 1 & x_{2,n} & S(x_{2,n}) \\ 1 & x_{3,n} & S(x_{3,n}) \end{pmatrix} = 0 \quad \text{for every } n.$$

*Then*

$$K_v(x_*) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Apply Lemma 12.158 with  $d = 2$  to the planar lifted curve

$$q(x) := (x, S(x)).$$

The exact collinearity condition in the statement is precisely the vanishing of

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 & S(x_1) \\ 1 & x_2 & S(x_2) \\ 1 & x_3 & S(x_3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Hence shrinking exact lifted 3-point circuits force

$$\det(q'(x_*), q''(x_*)) = 0.$$

Since

$$q'(x) = (1, S'(x)), \quad q''(x) = (0, S''(x)),$$

one gets

$$\det(q'(x_*), q''(x_*)) = S''(x_*).$$

On the  $x$ -patch, Proposition 12.146 gives

$$K_v = (x')^3 S'',$$

and  $x' \neq 0$  on a good  $v_5$ -patch. Therefore  $S''(x_*) = 0$  implies

$$K_v(x_*) = 0. \quad \square$$

**Corollary 12.161** (Uniform small-diameter exclusion away from  $K_v = 0$ ). *Let  $P_0 \subseteq \{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$  be compact and assume*

$$P_0 \cap \{K_v = 0\} = \emptyset.$$

*Then there exists  $\rho_3 > 0$  such that no exact lifted 3-point circuit contained in  $P_0$  has  $x$ -diameter  $< \rho_3$ .*

*Proof.* Otherwise there would exist a sequence of exact lifted 3-point circuits in  $P_0$  with diameters tending to 0. By compactness, after passing to a subsequence the three nodes would converge to some  $x_* \in x(P_0)$ . This contradicts Proposition 12.160.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.162** (Shrinking exact lifted 4-point circuits concentrate into  $T_v = 0$ ). *Let  $P \subseteq \{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$  be compact, and use*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad S = \sigma_v = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

*Suppose there is a sequence of distinct quadruples*

$$x_{1,n}, x_{2,n}, x_{3,n}, x_{4,n} \in x(P), \quad x_{1,n}, x_{2,n}, x_{3,n}, x_{4,n} \rightarrow x_*,$$

*such that*

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Y(x_{1,n}) & x_{1,n} & S(x_{1,n}) \\ 1 & Y(x_{2,n}) & x_{2,n} & S(x_{2,n}) \\ 1 & Y(x_{3,n}) & x_{3,n} & S(x_{3,n}) \\ 1 & Y(x_{4,n}) & x_{4,n} & S(x_{4,n}) \end{pmatrix} = 0 \quad \text{for every } n.$$

*Then*

$$T_v(x_*) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Apply Lemma 12.158 with  $d = 3$  to the lifted space curve

$$Q(x) := (Y(x), x, S(x)).$$

The exact coplanarity condition in the statement is precisely the vanishing of

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Y(x_1) & x_1 & S(x_1) \\ 1 & Y(x_2) & x_2 & S(x_2) \\ 1 & Y(x_3) & x_3 & S(x_3) \\ 1 & Y(x_4) & x_4 & S(x_4) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Hence shrinking exact lifted 4-point circuits force

$$\det(Q'(x_*), Q''(x_*), Q'''(x_*)) = 0.$$

But

$$\det(Q'(x), Q''(x), Q'''(x)) = W_x(1, Y, x, S)(x),$$

and Proposition 12.146 gives

$$T_v = (x')^6 W_x(1, Y, x, S).$$

Since  $x' \neq 0$  on a good  $v_5$ -patch, it follows that

$$T_v(x_*) = 0. \quad \square$$

**Corollary 12.163** (Uniform small-diameter exclusion away from  $T_v = 0$ ). *Let  $P_0 \subseteq \{c \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$  be compact and assume*

$$P_0 \cap \{T_v = 0\} = \emptyset.$$

*Then there exists  $\rho_4 > 0$  such that no exact lifted 4-point circuit contained in  $P_0$  has  $x$ -diameter  $< \rho_4$ .*

*Proof.* Otherwise there would exist a sequence of exact lifted 4-point circuits in  $P_0$  with diameters tending to 0. By compactness, after passing to a subsequence the four nodes would converge to some  $x_* \in x(P_0)$ . This contradicts Proposition 12.162.  $\square$

**Definition 12.164** (Repeated-node tangent-contact determinants on a  $v_5$ -patch). On a  $v_5 \neq 0$  patch with  $x = v_5/c$ ,  $Y = u_5/c$ , and  $S = \Delta_7/(c v_5)$ , define

$$H_3(a, u) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & S(a) \\ 0 & 1 & S'(a) \\ 1 & u & S(u) \end{pmatrix} = S(u) - S(a) - S'(a)(u - a),$$

and

$$H_4(a, u, v) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Y(a) & a & S(a) \\ 0 & Y'(a) & 1 & S'(a) \\ 1 & Y(u) & u & S(u) \\ 1 & Y(v) & v & S(v) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Thus  $H_3(a, u) = 0$  means that  $(u, S(u))$  lies on the tangent line to  $\Lambda_v$  at  $a$ , while  $H_4(a, u, v) = 0$  means that  $Q_v(u)$  and  $Q_v(v)$  lie in the tangent plane to  $Q_v$  at  $a$ .

**Proposition 12.165** (Repeated-node limits of exact lifted determinants). *For the exact lifted determinants*

$$\Delta_3(a, b, u) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a & S(a) \\ 1 & b & S(b) \\ 1 & u & S(u) \end{pmatrix},$$

and

$$\Delta_4(a, b, u, v) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Y(a) & a & S(a) \\ 1 & Y(b) & b & S(b) \\ 1 & Y(u) & u & S(u) \\ 1 & Y(v) & v & S(v) \end{pmatrix},$$

one has

$$\frac{\Delta_3(a, b, u)}{b - a} \longrightarrow H_3(a, u) \quad (b \rightarrow a),$$

and

$$\frac{\Delta_4(a, b, u, v)}{b - a} \longrightarrow H_4(a, u, v) \quad (b \rightarrow a).$$

*Proof.* Subtract the first row from the second row in each determinant and divide by  $b - a$ . The resulting second row is the first difference quotient of the corresponding row entries, and the limit  $b \rightarrow a$  gives the derivative row.  $\square$

**Theorem 12.166** (Local classification of the lifted 3-point branch near a finite-order  $K_v$ -zero). *Let  $x = 0$  be an isolated finite-order zero of  $K_v$  on a good  $v_5$ -patch. After affine normalization of  $\Lambda_v = (x, S)$ , write*

$$S(x) = x^m + O(x^{m+1}), \quad m = r + 2 \geq 3,$$

where  $r = \text{ord}_0 K_v$ . Then the repeated-node tangent-contact equation

$$H_3(a, u) = 0$$

with  $a < 0 < u$  has the following local classification:

- (1) if  $r$  is even (equivalently  $m$  is even), there is no opposite-side tangent-contact branch near  $(a, u) = (0, 0)$ ;
- (2) if  $r$  is odd (equivalently  $m$  is odd), there exists a unique real-analytic opposite-side branch

$$u = \Upsilon(a), \quad a < 0, \quad |a| \ll 1,$$

with asymptotic expansion

$$\Upsilon(a) = \lambda_m(-a) + O(a^2),$$

where  $\lambda_m > 1$  is the unique positive root of

$$P_m(\lambda) := \lambda^m - m\lambda - (m - 1).$$



*Proof.* Set  $a = -\alpha$  with  $\alpha > 0$ , and write  $u = \lambda\alpha$  with  $\lambda > 0$ . For the model germ  $S(x) = x^m$ , the tangent-contact equation is

$$H_3(-\alpha, \lambda\alpha) = \alpha^m \begin{cases} \lambda^m + m\lambda + (m-1), & m \text{ even}, \\ \lambda^m - m\lambda - (m-1), & m \text{ odd}. \end{cases}$$

If  $m$  is even, the displayed factor is strictly positive for every  $\lambda > 0$ , so no opposite-side branch exists.

If  $m$  is odd, define

$$P_m(\lambda) := \lambda^m - m\lambda - (m-1).$$

Then

$$P_m(1) = -2(m-1) < 0, \quad P_m(\lambda) \rightarrow +\infty \text{ as } \lambda \rightarrow +\infty,$$

and

$$P'_m(\lambda) = m(\lambda^{m-1} - 1)$$

is negative on  $(0, 1)$  and positive on  $(1, \infty)$ . Therefore  $P_m$  has a unique positive root  $\lambda_m > 1$ .

For the perturbed germ  $S(x) = x^m + O(x^{m+1})$ , divide  $H_3(-\alpha, \lambda\alpha)$  by  $\alpha^m$ . The resulting equation is

$$P_m(\lambda) + O(\alpha) = 0.$$

If  $m$  is even, positivity of the model factor persists for  $\alpha$  small, so there is still no branch. If  $m$  is odd, the root  $\lambda_m$  is simple, so the implicit function theorem yields a unique analytic branch

$$\lambda = \lambda(\alpha) = \lambda_m + O(\alpha),$$

equivalently

$$u = \lambda_m(-a) + O(a^2).$$

This proves the classification.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.167** (No infinite-order flatness for  $K_v$  on a good  $v_5$ -patch). *On a good  $v_5$ -patch, every zero of  $K_v$  has finite order. Equivalently, the lifted curvature  $S''(x)$  has no infinite-order zero on such a patch.*

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.146,

$$K_v = (x')^3 S''(x),$$

and on a good  $v_5$ -patch one has  $x' \neq 0$ . Thus  $K_v$  and  $S''$  have the same zero set and the same vanishing order.

If  $K_v$  had an infinite-order zero at some interior point  $x_*$ , then so would  $S''$ . Since  $S''$  is analytic in the local coordinate  $x$ , this would force

$$S'' \equiv 0$$

on a neighborhood of  $x_*$ . Hence  $S$  would be affine in  $x$  there, contrary to Proposition 12.141.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.168** (Slope–intercept parametrization for the lifted 3-point branch). *Assume the affine normalization from Theorem 12.166, so that*

$$S(0) = S'(0) = 0, \quad S'' < 0 \text{ on the source side } I_- = (\alpha, 0).$$

Let

$$I_+ = (0, \beta)$$

be the maximal open interval to the right of 0 on which  $S'$  is strictly increasing. Equivalently,  $S''$  does not change sign on  $I_+$ , and any zeros of  $S''$  there are isolated even-order zeros.

For

$$m \in J_- := S'(I_-),$$

define the inverse source point

$$a = a(m) := (S'|_{I_-})^{-1}(m),$$

and the source tangent intercept

$$\tau_-(m) := S(a(m)) - m a(m).$$

For

$$m \in J_+ := S'(I_+),$$

define the inverse target tangent point

$$u_+(m) := (S'|_{I_+})^{-1}(m),$$

and the target tangent intercept

$$\tau_+(m) := S(u_+(m)) - m u_+(m).$$

Then

$$\tau'_-(m) = -a(m), \quad \tau'_+(m) = -u_+(m).$$

Hence on

$$J := J_- \cap J_+$$

the intercept gap

$$D(m) := \tau_-(m) - \tau_+(m)$$

satisfies

$$D'(m) = u_+(m) - a(m) > 0.$$

*Proof.* Differentiate

$$\tau_-(m) = S(a(m)) - m a(m)$$

to obtain

$$\tau'_-(m) = S'(a(m))a'(m) - a(m) - m a'(m) = -a(m),$$

because  $S'(a(m)) = m$ . The same computation gives

$$\tau'_+(m) = -u_+(m).$$

Subtracting yields

$$D'(m) = u_+(m) - a(m).$$

Since  $a(m) < 0 < u_+(m)$ , the derivative is strictly positive.  $\square$

**Theorem 12.169** (Global continuation / nonrecurrence of the odd-order lifted 3-point branch). *Assume the hypotheses and affine normalization of Theorem 12.166, and suppose that  $r = \text{ord}_0 K_v$  is odd, so the unique local opposite-side branch exists.*

Let

$$I_- = (\alpha, 0)$$

be the source interval on which  $S'' < 0$ , and let

$$I_+ = (0, \beta)$$

be the maximal open interval to the right of 0 on which  $S'$  is strictly increasing. Set

$$J := S'(I_-) \cap S'(I_+).$$

Then there exists a unique maximal open interval

$$J_{\text{br}} = (0, m_*) \subset J$$

and a unique real-analytic function

$$u : J_{\text{br}} \rightarrow I_+$$

such that

$$H_3(a(m), u(m)) = 0, \quad a(m) := (S'|_{I_-})^{-1}(m), \quad u(m) > 0,$$

and for small  $m > 0$  this branch agrees with the local branch from Theorem 12.166.

Moreover:

(1) the intercept gap

$$D(m) := \tau_-(m) - \tau_+(m)$$

is strictly positive on all of  $J$ , and

$$D'(m) = u_+(m) - a(m) > 0;$$

(2) along the branch one has

$$\partial_u H_3(a(m), u(m)) = S'(u(m)) - m \neq 0,$$

so there is no interior common-tangent event;

(3) the branch is uniquely continued on  $J_{\text{br}}$ , with

$$u'(m) = \frac{u(m) - a(m)}{S'(u(m)) - m},$$

and the source coordinate is strictly monotone,

$$a'(m) = \frac{1}{S''(a(m))} < 0;$$

(4) if  $m_* < \sup J$ , then

$$u(m) \longrightarrow \beta \quad (m \uparrow m_*).$$

Hence the branch cannot end in the interior of  $I_+$ ; it can stop only when it reaches the boundary of the source/target slope-overlap block.

In particular, the odd-order lifted 3-point branch has no interior recurrence, no self-return, no interior accumulation, and no infinite-order flatness. Its only remaining endpoint mechanism is boundary exit of the relevant good-patch / monotone-slope block.

*Proof.* For

$$m \in J,$$

set

$$\Phi(m, u) := S(u) - m u - \tau_-(m).$$

Then

$$\Phi(m, u) = H_3(a(m), u).$$

**Step 1: positivity of the intercept gap.** By the odd-order local classification theorem, for all sufficiently small  $m > 0$  there exists a point  $u(m) \in I_+$  such that

$$\Phi(m, u(m)) = 0.$$

Fix such a small  $m$ . Since  $S'$  is strictly increasing on  $I_+$ , the function

$$u \longmapsto \Phi(m, u)$$

has strictly increasing derivative

$$\partial_u \Phi(m, u) = S'(u) - m,$$

hence a unique critical point, namely  $u_+(m)$ , and that critical point is its unique minimum on  $I_+$ . Therefore

$$\Phi(m, u_+(m)) < 0.$$

But

$$\Phi(m, u_+(m)) = S(u_+(m)) - m u_+(m) - \tau_-(m) = \tau_+(m) - \tau_-(m) = -D(m),$$

so  $D(m) > 0$  for all sufficiently small  $m > 0$ .

By Lemma 12.168,

$$D'(m) = u_+(m) - a(m) > 0$$

on all of  $J$ . Hence  $D(m) > 0$  for every  $m \in J$ .

**Step 2: no interior common tangency.** Suppose

$$\Phi(m, u) = 0$$

for some  $m \in J$  and  $u \in I_+$ . If also

$$\partial_u \Phi(m, u) = S'(u) - m = 0,$$

then by uniqueness of the inverse point on  $I_+$  one has  $u = u_+(m)$ , and thus

$$0 = \Phi(m, u_+(m)) = -D(m),$$

contrary to  $D(m) > 0$ . Therefore every branch point satisfies

$$\partial_u \Phi(m, u) \neq 0.$$

Equivalently, there is no interior common-tangent point on the odd-order branch.

**Step 3: uniqueness and analytic continuation.** For fixed  $m \in J$ , the derivative

$$u \longmapsto \partial_u \Phi(m, u) = S'(u) - m$$

is strictly increasing on  $I_+$ , and

$$\partial_u \Phi(m, 0) = S'(0) - m = -m < 0.$$

Hence  $\Phi(m, \cdot)$  first decreases and then increases, so it has at most one zero on  $I_+$ . Thus the local branch from Theorem 12.166 is unique on every connected continuation interval.

Let

$$E := \{m \in J : \exists u \in I_+ \text{ with } \Phi(m, u) = 0\}.$$

By Step 2, every zero is simple in the  $u$ -variable, so the implicit function theorem shows that  $E$  is open and that the zero depends real-analytically on  $m$ . Let

$$J_{\text{br}} = (0, m_*)$$

be the connected component of  $E$  containing all sufficiently small positive  $m$ . This gives the unique maximal analytic continuation

$$u = u(m), \quad m \in J_{\text{br}}.$$

Differentiating

$$\Phi(m, u(m)) = 0$$

gives

$$(S'(u(m)) - m)u'(m) - u(m) + a(m) = 0,$$

hence

$$u'(m) = \frac{u(m) - a(m)}{S'(u(m)) - m}.$$

Also

$$a'(m) = \frac{1}{S''(a(m))} < 0$$

because  $S'' < 0$  on the source interval  $I_-$ . So the source coordinate is strictly monotone and cannot return to a previous value.

**Step 4: endpoint control.** Assume that

$$m_* < \sup J$$

but that  $u(m)$  does not approach  $\beta$  as  $m \uparrow m_*$ . Then there exists a compact subinterval

$$K \Subset I_+$$

and a sequence  $m_n \uparrow m_*$  with

$$u(m_n) \in K.$$

After passing to a subsequence,

$$u(m_n) \rightarrow u_* \in K.$$

By continuity,

$$\Phi(m_*, u_*) = 0.$$

Since  $m_* < \sup J$ , one has  $m_* \in J$ , so by Step 2,

$$\partial_u \Phi(m_*, u_*) \neq 0.$$

The implicit function theorem therefore extends the branch analytically past  $m_*$ , contradicting maximality of  $J_{\text{br}}$ .

Hence

$$u(m) \rightarrow \beta \quad (m \uparrow m_*).$$

This proves that the branch cannot terminate by an interior fold, interior common tangency, or interior accumulation.

Finally, by Corollary 12.167, every zero of  $K_v$  has finite order. Since even-order zeros do not change the sign of  $S''$ , they do not break the strict increase of  $S'$  on  $I_+$ . Therefore the endpoint  $\beta$  can only be the ambient boundary of the good patch or the first odd-order zero of  $K_v$  to the right.  $\square$

**Remark 12.170** (Structural package for the global lifted 3-point branch). The correct global parameter on the odd-order lifted 3-point branch is the source tangent slope

$$m = S'(a).$$

In that parameter, the branch is governed by the source/target tangent intercepts

$$\tau_-(m) = S(a(m)) - m a(m), \quad \tau_+(m) = S(u_+(m)) - m u_+(m),$$

and their gap

$$D(m) = \tau_-(m) - \tau_+(m), \quad D'(m) = u_+(m) - a(m) > 0.$$

Thus interior common tangency is exactly the equation

$$D(m) = 0,$$

but this never occurs on the odd-order continuation branch because  $D > 0$  there. So the global 3-point problem is not a hidden recurrence problem inside the patch: once born at an odd-order  $K_v$ -zero, the branch is a one-parameter analytic graph with monotone source coordinate, and even-order  $K_v$ -zeros are invisible to it except as isolated points where  $S''$  vanishes without changing the monotone-slope block.

**Remark 12.171** (Target-block form of the intercept-gap monotonicity). The slope–intercept monotonicity from Lemma 12.168 is not special to the first right-hand target block.

Let  $I$  be any open interval to the right of the source interval  $I_-$  on which  $S'$  is monotone and hence invertible. For

$$m \in S'(I_-) \cap S'(I),$$

define

$$u_I(m) := (S'|_I)^{-1}(m), \quad \tau_I(m) := S(u_I(m)) - m u_I(m),$$

and

$$D_I(m) := \tau_-(m) - \tau_I(m).$$

Then exactly the same envelope calculation gives

$$\tau'_I(m) = -u_I(m), \quad D'_I(m) = u_I(m) - a(m) > 0.$$

Thus for any monotone-slope target block, interior common tangency against the fixed source interval  $I_-$  is again the scalar equation

$$D_I(m) = 0.$$

So any future continuation across successive odd-order  $K_v$ -zeros must be organized blockwise through these monotone intercept-gap functions rather than through a hidden recurrence mechanism inside a block.

**Remark 12.172** (Derivative-geometric meaning of the lifted 3-point branch). The lifted 3-point branch is now best viewed as a derivative-geometric propagation theorem for the planar lifted curve

$$\Lambda_v = (x, S).$$

By Lemma 12.158 and Proposition 12.160, shrinking exact lifted 3-point circuits are detected by the osculating determinant and therefore concentrate into the lifted curvature-zero set

$$K_v = (x')^3 S''(x) = 0.$$

Theorem 12.166 then identifies the local repeated-node branch structure at those curvature zeros, and Theorem 12.169 shows that the odd-order branch propagates globally on each monotone-slope target block by the slope–intercept envelope identities

$$\tau'_-(m) = -a(m), \quad \tau'_+(m) = -u_+(m), \quad D'(m) = u_+(m) - a(m) > 0.$$

So the lifted 3-point theory is no longer an ad hoc repeated-node analysis. It is the global propagation of an osculating-contact defect for the curve  $\Lambda_v$ , organized by the derivative geometry of its tangent lines and curvature.

**Remark 12.173** (Exact nonmixed reduction in terms of  $\mathcal{Z}$  and  $\mathcal{R}$ ). At a nonmixed lifted point

$$K_v(0) \neq 0, \quad T_v(0) = 0,$$

Propositions 12.146 and 12.147 give

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{Y''}{S''}, \quad \mathcal{R} = \mathcal{Z}' = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}.$$

Since  $K_v(0) \neq 0$ , one has  $S''(0) \neq 0$ , so after analytic reparametrization and affine target normalization preserving coplanarity one may write the lifted germ as

$$Q_v(\xi) = (\tilde{Y}(\xi), \xi, \xi^2), \quad \tilde{Y}(0) = \tilde{Y}'(0) = \tilde{Y}''(0) = 0.$$

In these normalized coordinates,

$$\mathcal{Z}(\xi) = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}''(\xi), \quad \mathcal{R}(\xi) = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'''(\xi).$$

Thus the nonmixed lifted 4-point problem is exactly the jet problem of excluding odd-order zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Equivalently, it is the problem of excluding even leading degrees of  $\tilde{Y}$  in the normalized chart.

In particular, the low-order dangerous nonmixed cases are exactly:

$$\text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R} = 1 \iff \tilde{Y}'''(0) = 0, \quad \tilde{Y}^{(4)}(0) \neq 0,$$

$$\text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R} = 3 \iff \tilde{Y}^{(3)}(0) = \tilde{Y}^{(4)}(0) = \tilde{Y}^{(5)}(0) = 0, \quad \tilde{Y}^{(6)}(0) \neq 0,$$

$$\text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R} = 5 \iff \tilde{Y}^{(3)}(0) = \dots = \tilde{Y}^{(7)}(0) = 0, \quad \tilde{Y}^{(8)}(0) \neq 0.$$

Equivalently, the dangerous nonmixed low-order list is

$$\text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z} \in \{2, 4, 6\} \iff \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R} \in \{1, 3, 5\}.$$

So the nonmixed 4-point endgame has been reduced to a finite jet problem for the canonical invariant  $\mathcal{R}$ .

**Lemma 12.174** (Repeated-node tangent-plane determinant in the normalized nonmixed chart). *In the normalized nonmixed chart of Remark 12.173, define*

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \tilde{Y}(a) & a & a^2 \\ 0 & \tilde{Y}'(a) & 1 & 2a \\ 1 & \tilde{Y}(u) & u & u^2 \\ 1 & \tilde{Y}(v) & v & v^2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = (u - a)^2(v - a)^2 \left( \tilde{Y}[a, a, v] - \tilde{Y}[a, a, u] \right),$$

where

$$\tilde{Y}[a, a, t] := \frac{\tilde{Y}(t) - \tilde{Y}(a) - \tilde{Y}'(a)(t - a)}{(t - a)^2}$$

is the repeated-node second divided difference. Equivalently, for  $u \neq v$ ,

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = (u - a)^2(v - a)^2(v - u) \tilde{Y}[a, a, u, v].$$

*Proof.* Subtract the first row from the third and fourth rows. Since

$$u^2 - a^2 = (u - a)(u + a), \quad v^2 - a^2 = (v - a)(v + a),$$

this gives

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = (u - a)(v - a) \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \tilde{Y}(a) & a & a^2 \\ 0 & \tilde{Y}'(a) & 1 & 2a \\ 0 & \frac{\tilde{Y}(u) - \tilde{Y}(a)}{u - a} & 1 & u + a \\ 0 & \frac{\tilde{Y}(v) - \tilde{Y}(a)}{v - a} & 1 & v + a \end{pmatrix}.$$

Expanding along the first column yields

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = (u - a)(v - a) \det \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{Y}'(a) & 1 & 2a \\ \frac{\tilde{Y}(u) - \tilde{Y}(a)}{u - a} & 1 & u + a \\ \frac{\tilde{Y}(v) - \tilde{Y}(a)}{v - a} & 1 & v + a \end{pmatrix}.$$

Now subtract the first row from the second and third rows:

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = (u - a)(v - a) \det \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{Y}'(a) & 1 & 2a \\ (u - a)\tilde{Y}[a, a, u] & 0 & u - a \\ (v - a)\tilde{Y}[a, a, v] & 0 & v - a \end{pmatrix}.$$

Expanding along the middle column gives

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = (u - a)^2(v - a)^2 \left( \tilde{Y}[a, a, v] - \tilde{Y}[a, a, u] \right),$$

which is the first formula. Since

$$\tilde{Y}[a, a, u, v] = \frac{\tilde{Y}[a, a, v] - \tilde{Y}[a, a, u]}{v - u},$$

the second formula follows for  $u \neq v$ . □

**Proposition 12.175** (Exact nonmixed tangent-plane contacts force nearby zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ ). *In the normalized nonmixed chart of Remark 12.173, assume  $a, u, v \in \mathbf{R}$  are distinct and satisfy*

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = 0.$$

*Then there exists*

$$w \in \text{conv}\{a, u, v\}$$

*such that*

$$\mathcal{R}(w) = 0.$$

*Equivalently,*

$$\tilde{Y}'''(w) = 0.$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 12.174, since  $a, u, v$  are distinct,

$$0 = \tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = (u - a)^2(v - a)^2(v - u) \tilde{Y}[a, a, u, v].$$

Hence

$$\tilde{Y}[a, a, u, v] = 0.$$

By the Hermite–Genocchi formula for repeated-node divided differences, there exists

$$w \in \text{conv}\{a, u, v\}$$

such that

$$\tilde{Y}[a, a, u, v] = \frac{\tilde{Y}'''(w)}{3!}.$$

Therefore

$$\tilde{Y}'''(w) = 0.$$

In the normalized nonmixed chart one has

$$\mathcal{R}(\xi) = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'''(\xi),$$

so  $\mathcal{R}(w) = 0$ . □

**Corollary 12.176** (Sign-definite nonmixed intervals are exactly-contact sterile). *Let  $J$  be an open interval in the normalized nonmixed chart such that*

$$\mathcal{R} \text{ has fixed nonzero sign on } J.$$

*Then there do not exist distinct points  $a, u, v \in J$  such that*

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = 0.$$

*Equivalently, there are no exact nonmixed tangent-plane contacts with all three nodes in  $J$ .*

*Proof.* If such  $a, u, v$  existed, Proposition 12.175 would produce some

$$w \in \text{conv}\{a, u, v\} \subset J$$

with  $\mathcal{R}(w) = 0$ , contradicting the sign assumption. □

**Remark 12.177** (Derivative-side interpretation of exact nonmixed contacts). Proposition 12.175 strengthens the shrinking-circuit statement Proposition 12.162. It is not merely a limit theorem: every exact nonmixed tangent-plane contact already forces a zero of the canonical derivative invariant inside the convex hull of the three nodes,

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'''.$$

Thus the nonmixed 4-point branch is controlled not only asymptotically by  $T_v = 0$ , but pointwise by the zero set of a single analytic scalar.

**Proposition 12.178** (Interval-persistent nonmixed 4-point degeneracy forces affine planarity). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval in a good  $v_5$ -patch such that*

$$K_v \neq 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Assume*

$$T_v \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Then on  $J$  one has*

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0, \quad \mathcal{Z} \equiv \gamma$$

*for some constant  $\gamma \in \mathbf{C}$ , and hence*

$$Y = \gamma S + ax + b$$

*for some constants  $a, b \in \mathbf{C}$ . Equivalently, the lifted curve*

$$x \mapsto (Y(x), x, S(x))$$

*lies in an affine plane on  $J$ .*

*In particular, any interval-persistent nonmixed exact lifted 4-point branch collapses to an affine-planar residual rather than remaining genuinely three-dimensional.*

*Proof.* On the nonmixed interval  $J$ , Proposition 12.147 gives

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}.$$

Since  $T_v \equiv 0$  and  $K_v \neq 0$  on  $J$ , it follows that

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

By definition,

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{d\mathcal{Z}}{dx},$$

so  $\mathcal{Z}$  is constant on  $J$ :

$$\mathcal{Z} \equiv \gamma.$$

Using

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{Y''}{S''},$$



we obtain

$$Y'' = \gamma S''.$$

Integrating twice with respect to  $x$  yields

$$Y = \gamma S + ax + b$$

for constants  $a, b \in \mathbf{C}$ . Therefore the lifted curve satisfies the affine linear equation

$$Y - \gamma S - ax - b = 0$$

throughout  $J$ , so it lies in an affine plane.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.179** (Recurrent exact nonmixed contacts force affine-planar collapse). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval in a good  $v_5$ -patch such that*

$$K_v \neq 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Assume that every nonempty open subinterval  $I \subset J$  contains an exact nonmixed tangent-plane contact triple. Equivalently, after local nonmixed normalization on  $I$ , there exist distinct points  $a, u, v \in I$  such that*

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = 0.$$

*Then*

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J,$$

*hence*

$$T_v \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J,$$

*and therefore the lifted curve is affine-planar on  $J$ :*

$$Y = \gamma S + ax + b$$

*for some constants  $\gamma, a, b \in \mathbf{C}$ .*

*Proof.* Let  $I \subset J$  be any nonempty open subinterval. By assumption,  $I$  contains an exact nonmixed tangent-plane contact triple. After nonmixed normalization on  $I$ , Proposition 12.175 produces a point  $w_I \in I$  such that

$$\mathcal{R}(w_I) = 0.$$

Thus every nonempty open subinterval of  $J$  contains a zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Since  $\mathcal{R}$  is analytic, its zero set cannot have an accumulation point in  $J$  unless

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Because  $K_v \neq 0$  on  $J$  and

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2},$$

it follows that

$$T_v \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Now apply Proposition 12.178 to conclude that

$$Y = \gamma S + ax + b$$

on  $J$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 12.180** (Derivative formula for the repeated-node nonmixed profile). *In the normalized nonmixed chart, define*

$$D_a(t) := \tilde{Y}[a, a, t] = \frac{\tilde{Y}(t) - \tilde{Y}(a) - \tilde{Y}'(a)(t - a)}{(t - a)^2}, \quad D_a(a) := \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}''(a).$$

*Then  $D_a(t)$  extends real-analytically across  $t = a$ , and*

$$D_a(t) = \int_0^1 (1 - s) \tilde{Y}''(a + s(t - a)) ds.$$

Moreover,

$$D'_a(t) = \int_0^1 s(1-s) \tilde{Y}'''(a + s(t-a)) ds = 2 \int_0^1 s(1-s) \mathcal{R}(a + s(t-a)) ds.$$

*Proof.* Taylor's integral formula gives

$$\tilde{Y}(t) = \tilde{Y}(a) + \tilde{Y}'(a)(t-a) + (t-a)^2 \int_0^1 (1-s) \tilde{Y}''(a + s(t-a)) ds.$$

Dividing by  $(t-a)^2$  proves the first formula for  $t \neq a$ , and the analytic extension across  $t = a$  is immediate. Differentiating under the integral sign gives

$$D'_a(t) = \int_0^1 s(1-s) \tilde{Y}'''(a + s(t-a)) ds.$$

Since  $\mathcal{R} = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'''$  in the normalized nonmixed chart, the last formula follows.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.181** (Parity classification of isolated nonmixed zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ ). *Let  $\xi_0 \in \mathbf{R}$  be an isolated zero of the nonmixed invariant*

$$\mathcal{R}(\xi) = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'''(\xi),$$

and write

$$\mathcal{R}(\xi) = (\xi - \xi_0)^m \rho(\xi), \quad m \geq 1, \quad \rho(\xi_0) \neq 0.$$

(i) Even-order sterility. *If  $m$  is even, then there exists a neighborhood  $U$  of  $\xi_0$  such that for every  $a \in U$ , the function*

$$D_a(t) := \tilde{Y}[a, a, t]$$

*is strictly monotone on  $U$ . In particular, there do not exist distinct  $a, u, v \in U$  such that*

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = 0.$$

(ii) Odd-order birth. *If  $m$  is odd, then there exists a neighborhood  $U$  of  $\xi_0$  and a real-analytic function  $\tau : U \rightarrow U$  such that*

$$\tau(\xi_0) = \xi_0, \quad \tau'(\xi_0) = -1, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0 \quad (a \in U).$$

Moreover,

$$D''_a(\tau(a)) \neq 0 \quad (a \in U \setminus \{\xi_0\}),$$

*so for each  $a \in U \setminus \{\xi_0\}$ , the function  $D_a$  has a strict local extremum at  $t = \tau(a)$ . Consequently, for each such  $a$ , there exist distinct points  $u_-(a), u_+(a) \in U$  with*

$$u_-(a) < \tau(a) < u_+(a), \quad D_a(u_-(a)) = D_a(u_+(a)),$$

and hence

$$\tilde{H}_4(a, u_-(a), u_+(a)) = 0.$$

*Proof.* By translation in the normalized chart, we may assume  $\xi_0 = 0$ . Thus

$$\mathcal{R}(\xi) = \xi^m \rho(\xi), \quad \rho(0) \neq 0.$$

For the even-order case, shrink to a neighborhood  $U$  on which  $\rho$  has fixed nonzero sign. Since  $m$  is even,  $\xi^m \geq 0$ , so  $\mathcal{R}$  has fixed sign on  $U$ , vanishing only at 0. By Lemma 12.180,

$$D'_a(t) = 2 \int_0^1 s(1-s) \mathcal{R}(a + s(t-a)) ds.$$

For  $a \neq t$ , the affine segment  $a + s(t-a)$  is not identically zero, so the integrand has fixed sign and is not identically zero. Hence  $D'_a(t)$  has fixed nonzero sign for all  $a \neq t$  in  $U$ , and therefore each  $D_a$  is strictly monotone on  $U$ . Thus  $D_a$  is injective on  $U$ , and by Lemma 12.174 there are no exact contacts  $\tilde{H}_4(a, u, v) = 0$  with distinct  $a, u, v \in U$ .

Now assume  $m$  is odd. Write  $a = h$  and  $t = \lambda h$ . Then Lemma 12.180 gives

$$D'_h(\lambda h) = 2h^m G(h, \lambda),$$

where

$$G(h, \lambda) := \int_0^1 s(1-s)(1+s(\lambda-1))^m \rho(h(1+s(\lambda-1))) ds.$$

This is real-analytic in  $(h, \lambda)$ , and

$$G(0, \lambda) = \rho(0) J_m(\lambda), \quad J_m(\lambda) := \int_0^1 s(1-s)(1+s(\lambda-1))^m ds.$$

Since  $m$  is odd,

$$J_m(-1) = \int_0^1 s(1-s)(1-2s)^m ds = 0$$

by the symmetry  $s \mapsto 1-s$ , while

$$J'_m(-1) = m \int_0^1 s^2(1-s)(1-2s)^{m-1} ds > 0$$

because  $m-1$  is even. Thus

$$\partial_\lambda G(0, -1) = \rho(0) J'_m(-1) \neq 0.$$

By the implicit function theorem, there exists a unique real-analytic function  $\lambda(h)$  near 0 such that

$$\lambda(0) = -1, \quad G(h, \lambda(h)) = 0.$$

Define

$$\tau(h) := \lambda(h)h.$$

Then

$$\tau(0) = 0, \quad \tau'(0) = \lambda(0) = -1,$$

and

$$D'_h(\tau(h)) = 0.$$

It remains to show that this critical point is a strict local extremum. By Lemma 12.180,

$$D''_a(t) = 2 \int_0^1 s^2(1-s) \mathcal{R}'(a+s(t-a)) ds.$$

Substituting  $a = h$ ,  $t = \lambda(h)h$ , and using

$$\mathcal{R}'(\xi) = m\xi^{m-1}\rho(\xi) + \xi^m\rho'(\xi),$$

one obtains

$$D''_h(\tau(h)) = 2h^{m-1}\rho(0) J'_m(-1) + O(h^m).$$

Since  $\rho(0)J'_m(-1) \neq 0$ , it follows that

$$D''_h(\tau(h)) \neq 0$$

for  $h \neq 0$  sufficiently small. Therefore  $t = \tau(h)$  is a strict local extremum of  $D_h$ . Hence there exist distinct points  $u_-(h)$ ,  $u_+(h)$  arbitrarily close to  $\tau(h)$  such that

$$D_h(u_-(h)) = D_h(u_+(h)).$$

By Lemma 12.174,

$$\tilde{H}_4(h, u_-(h), u_+(h)) = (h - u_-(h))^2(h - u_+(h))^2(D_h(u_+(h)) - D_h(u_-(h))) = 0.$$

This proves the odd-order birth statement.  $\square$

**Remark 12.182** (Reflection law for odd-order birth). In the odd-order case of Proposition 12.181, the critical-point branch satisfies

$$\tau(a) = 2\xi_0 - a + O((a - \xi_0)^2).$$

Thus the local exact nonmixed contact family born at any odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  has the same first-order reflection geometry across that zero as in the simple-zero case.

**Proposition 12.183** (Odd-zero critical branch is uniformly unrooted). *Let  $\xi_0$  be an isolated odd-order zero of*

$$\mathcal{R}(\xi) = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'''(\xi),$$

*and, after translation, write*

$$\xi_0 = 0, \quad \mathcal{R}(\xi) = \xi^m \rho(\xi), \quad m \geq 1 \text{ odd}, \quad \rho(0) \neq 0.$$

*Let*

$$D_a(t) := \tilde{Y}[a, a, t], \quad D_a(a) = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}''(a) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

*Then there exists  $\varepsilon > 0$  and a unique real-analytic function*

$$\mu : (-\varepsilon, \varepsilon) \rightarrow \mathbf{R}, \quad \mu(0) = 0,$$

*such that for every sufficiently small  $h > 0$  the unique nontrivial critical pair*

$$a(h) := h(\mu(h) - 1), \quad x(h) := h(\mu(h) + 1)$$

*satisfies*

$$D'_{a(h)}(x(h)) = 0,$$

*and every critical pair*

$$a < x, \quad |a| + |x| < \varepsilon, \quad D'_a(x) = 0$$

*is of this form.*

*Moreover,*

$$D_{a(h)}(x(h)) - D_{a(h)}(a(h)) = -\frac{\rho(0)}{m+2} h^{m+1} + O(h^{m+2}).$$

*Equivalently,*

$$D_{a(h)}(x(h)) - D_{a(h)}(a(h)) = -\frac{\rho(0)}{2^{m+1}(m+2)} (x(h) - a(h))^{m+1} + o((x(h) - a(h))^{m+1}).$$

*In particular, after shrinking  $\varepsilon$  if needed, every nontrivial nearby critical pair satisfies*

$$D_a(x) \neq D_a(a),$$

*indeed*

$$\operatorname{sgn}(D_a(x) - D_a(a)) = -\operatorname{sgn} \rho(0).$$

*So no sheared repeated-node tangent-contact event can occur in a sufficiently small neighborhood of an isolated odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ .*

*Proof.* Write every nearby pair as

$$a = c - h, \quad x = c + h, \quad h = \frac{x - a}{2} > 0, \quad \mu = \frac{c}{h}.$$

By Lemma 12.180,

$$D'_a(x) = 2 \int_0^1 s(1-s) \mathcal{R}(a + s(x-a)) ds.$$

With the change of variables  $u = 2s - 1$ , this becomes

$$D'_{c-h}(c+h) = \frac{1}{4} \int_{-1}^1 (1-u^2) \mathcal{R}(c+hu) du = h^m F(h, \mu),$$

where

$$F(h, \mu) := \frac{1}{4} \int_{-1}^1 (1-u^2)(\mu+u)^m \rho(h(\mu+u)) du.$$

This is real-analytic in  $(h, \mu)$  near  $(0, 0)$ . At  $h = 0$ ,

$$F(0, \mu) = \frac{\rho(0)}{4} K_m(\mu), \quad K_m(\mu) := \int_{-1}^1 (1-u^2)(\mu+u)^m du.$$

Since  $m$  is odd,

$$K_m(0) = 0,$$

and

$$K'_m(\mu) = m \int_{-1}^1 (1-u^2)(\mu+u)^{m-1} du > 0$$

for all real  $\mu$ , because  $m-1$  is even. Hence  $\mu = 0$  is the unique real root of  $K_m$ , and it is simple. Therefore

$$\partial_\mu F(0,0) \neq 0,$$

so the implicit function theorem gives a unique real-analytic branch

$$\mu = \mu(h), \quad \mu(0) = 0,$$

parameterizing all nearby critical pairs.

Now write

$$\mathcal{Z}(\xi) = \mathcal{Z}(0) + \xi^{m+1}\eta(\xi), \quad \eta(0) = \frac{\rho(0)}{m+1},$$

since  $\mathcal{Z}' = \mathcal{R} = \xi^m \rho(\xi)$ . Using

$$D_a(x) - D_a(a) = \frac{1}{2} \int_{-1}^1 (1-u)(\mathcal{Z}(c+hu) - \mathcal{Z}(c-h)) du,$$

we obtain

$$D_{c-h}(c+h) - D_{c-h}(c-h) = h^{m+1}G(h, \mu),$$

where

$$G(h, \mu) := \frac{1}{2} \int_{-1}^1 (1-u) \left( (\mu+u)^{m+1} \eta(h(\mu+u)) - (\mu-1)^{m+1} \eta(h(\mu-1)) \right) du.$$

Again  $G$  is real-analytic. Evaluating at  $(0,0)$  gives

$$G(0,0) = \frac{\eta(0)}{2} \int_{-1}^1 (1-u)(u^{m+1} - 1) du = -\frac{\rho(0)}{m+2} \neq 0.$$

Therefore along the critical branch,

$$D_{a(h)}(x(h)) - D_{a(h)}(a(h)) = h^{m+1}G(h, \mu(h)) = -\frac{\rho(0)}{m+2}h^{m+1} + O(h^{m+2}),$$

which has fixed nonzero sign for  $h$  sufficiently small. This proves the claim.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.184** (Sheared repeated-node tangent-contact is impossible near an isolated odd  $\mathcal{R}$ -zero). *Let  $b$  be an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  on a genuine opened nonmixed arc. Then there exists a neighborhood  $U$  of  $b$  such that no pair*

$$a < x, \quad a, x \in U,$$

*can satisfy*

$$\tilde{Y}''_{\mathcal{Z}(a)}(a) = 0, \quad \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0, \quad \partial_x \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0.$$

*Equivalently, no rooted sheared repeated-node tangent-contact event occurs in a sufficiently small neighborhood of an isolated odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ .*

*Proof.* In the normalized nonmixed chart centered at  $b$ , the rooted sheared event is exactly the conjunction

$$D'_a(x) = 0, \quad D_a(x) = D_a(a) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Proposition 12.183 shows that for every sufficiently small nontrivial critical pair one has

$$D_a(x) - D_a(a) \neq 0.$$

So the rooted sheared event is impossible near  $b$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 12.185** (Quadratic-envelope factorization on a nonmixed interval). *Let  $J$  be a connected open interval in a good  $v_5$ -patch such that*

$$K_v \neq 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*Write*

$$Q_v(h) = (Y(h), x(h), S(h)), \quad \mathcal{Z} = \frac{Y''}{S''}, \quad \mathcal{R} = \mathcal{Z}' = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}.$$

*For a fixed source point  $a \in J$ , define*

$$A_a(x) := Y(x) - Y(a) - Y'(a)(x - a),$$

$$B_a(x) := S(x) - S(a) - S'(a)(x - a),$$

*and*

$$\Gamma_a(x) := \frac{A_a(x)}{B_a(x)} \quad (x \neq a).$$

*Then:*

(i) Tangent-contact denominator. *For  $x \neq a$ ,*

$$B_a(x) = \int_a^x (x - t) S''(t) dt,$$

*so  $B_a(x) \neq 0$  on  $J \setminus \{a\}$ .*

(ii) Exact repeated-source factorization. *For distinct  $a, u, v \in J$ ,*

$$H_4(a, u, v) = -B_a(u) B_a(v) (\Gamma_a(u) - \Gamma_a(v)).$$

(iii) Integral representation. *For  $x \neq a$ ,*

$$\Gamma_a(x) = \frac{\int_a^x (x - t) \mathcal{Z}(t) S''(t) dt}{\int_a^x (x - t) S''(t) dt}.$$

(iv) Positive-kernel derivative formula. *For  $x \neq a$ ,*

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = \frac{1}{B_a(x)^2} \int_a^x \Omega_{a,x}(r) \mathcal{R}(r) dr,$$

*where*

$$\Omega_{a,x}(r) := \int_a^r \int_r^x (t - s) S''(s) S''(t) dt ds.$$

*Moreover, after orienting  $x$  so that  $S''$  has fixed sign on  $J$ ,*

$$\Omega_{a,x}(r) > 0 \quad (a < r < x).$$

*Proof.* Since  $K_v = (x')^3 S''$  and  $x' \neq 0$  on a good  $v_5$ -patch, the function  $S''$  has fixed nonzero sign on  $J$ . Therefore

$$B_a(x) = \int_a^x (x - t) S''(t) dt$$

has fixed nonzero sign for  $x \neq a$ , proving (i).

For (ii), use the repeated-node determinant

$$H_4(a, u, v) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Y(a) & a & S(a) \\ 0 & Y'(a) & 1 & S'(a) \\ 1 & Y(u) & u & S(u) \\ 1 & Y(v) & v & S(v) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Subtract from the  $u$ -row and  $v$ -row the corresponding affine tangent data at  $a$ . This gives

$$H_4(a, u, v) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & Y(a) & a & S(a) \\ 0 & Y'(a) & 1 & S'(a) \\ 0 & A_a(u) & 0 & B_a(u) \\ 0 & A_a(v) & 0 & B_a(v) \end{pmatrix} = A_a(u) B_a(v) - A_a(v) B_a(u),$$

hence

$$H_4(a, u, v) = -B_a(u)B_a(v)(\Gamma_a(u) - \Gamma_a(v)).$$

For (iii), Taylor's integral formula gives

$$A_a(x) = \int_a^x (x-t) Y''(t) dt = \int_a^x (x-t) \mathcal{Z}(t) S''(t) dt,$$

while

$$B_a(x) = \int_a^x (x-t) S''(t) dt.$$

Dividing yields the formula for  $\Gamma_a$ .

For (iv), set

$$N_a(x) := \int_a^x (x-t) \mathcal{Z}(t) S''(t) dt, \quad D_a(x) := \int_a^x (x-t) S''(t) dt = B_a(x).$$

Then  $\Gamma_a = N_a/D_a$ , so

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = \frac{N'_a(x)D_a(x) - N_a(x)D'_a(x)}{D_a(x)^2}.$$

A symmetrization gives

$$N'_a D_a - N_a D'_a = \frac{1}{2} \int_a^x \int_a^x (\mathcal{Z}(t) - \mathcal{Z}(s))(t-s) S''(s) S''(t) ds dt.$$

Since  $\mathcal{Z}(t) - \mathcal{Z}(s) = \int_s^t \mathcal{R}(r) dr$ , Fubini yields

$$N'_a D_a - N_a D'_a = \int_a^x \Omega_{a,x}(r) \mathcal{R}(r) dr$$

with

$$\Omega_{a,x}(r) = \int_a^r \int_r^x (t-s) S''(s) S''(t) dt ds.$$

Because  $t-s > 0$  on the region of integration and  $S''$  has fixed sign on  $J$ , one has  $\Omega_{a,x}(r) > 0$  after orienting the  $x$ -coordinate. This proves (iv).  $\square$

**Corollary 12.186** (Repeated-source monotonicity on one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -blocks). *Let  $I \subset J$  be a subinterval on which*

*$\mathcal{R}$  has fixed nonzero sign.*

*Then for every  $a \in I$ , the function  $x \mapsto \Gamma_a(x)$  is strictly monotone on each component of  $I \setminus \{a\}$ . In particular, there do not exist points*

$$a < u < v \quad \text{in } I$$

*such that*

$$H_4(a, u, v) = 0.$$

*Proof.* This is immediate from Proposition 12.185: the derivative  $\Gamma'_a(x)$  is a positive-kernel average of  $\mathcal{R}$ , so it has the same sign as  $\mathcal{R}$  on each one-sign block. The factorization of  $H_4$  then excludes repeated-source exact contacts there.  $\square$

**Remark 12.187** (Below-lifted source-determinant reformulation of  $\Gamma_a$ ). Let

$$\lambda := \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}, \quad x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad S = \frac{\lambda}{c}.$$

For any scalar germ  $f$ , define

$$D_f(a, h) := \det \begin{pmatrix} c(a) & v_5(a) & f(a) \\ c'(a) & v'_5(a) & f'(a) \\ c(h) & v_5(h) & f(h) \end{pmatrix}.$$

A direct row reduction gives

$$D_f(a, h) = c(a)^2 c(h) \left( x'(a) (F(h) - F(a)) - F'(a) (x(h) - x(a)) \right), \quad F = \frac{f}{c}.$$

In particular,

$$\Psi_a(h) := \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)} = \Gamma_{x(a)}(x(h)).$$

Thus the repeated-source nonmixed 4-point geometry is already encoded by a finite ratio of source determinants.

Likewise, if one sets

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) := \det \begin{pmatrix} c(a) & v_5(a) & \lambda(a) & u_5(a) \\ c'(a) & v_5'(a) & \lambda'(a) & u_5'(a) \\ c(h) & v_5(h) & \lambda(h) & u_5(h) \\ c'(h) & v_5'(h) & \lambda'(h) & u_5'(h) \end{pmatrix},$$

then a Plücker identity yields

$$\frac{d}{dh} \Psi_a(h) = \frac{W_h(c, v_5)(a) \mathfrak{D}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)^2}.$$

So the sign of the quadratic-envelope derivative is governed by one explicit  $4 \times 4$  source determinant.

Moreover, combining the identity

$$\Psi_a(h) = \Gamma_{x(a)}(x(h))$$

with Proposition 12.185 gives the exact source-level kernel formula

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = c(a)^2 c(h)^2 x'(a) x'(h) \int_{x(a)}^{x(h)} \Omega_{x(a), x(h)}(r) \mathcal{R}(r) dr.$$

After orienting the  $x$ -coordinate so that  $x' > 0$  on the interval, the sign of  $\mathfrak{D}(a, h)$  is therefore exactly the sign of the corresponding positive-kernel average of  $\mathcal{R}$ . In particular, on every one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -block the quadruple

$$(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5)$$

is osculatory-ECT in the sense that  $\mathfrak{D}(a, h)$  has fixed nonzero sign for  $a < h$ .

**Corollary 12.188** (Source-level Wronskian consequences for the nonmixed branch). *On a good nonmixed  $v_5$ -patch, the following hold.*

- (1) *If there is an exact nonmixed tangent-plane contact, then there exists a source point  $h_*$  in the source convex hull of the contact nodes such that*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}(h_*) = 0.$$

- (2) *If  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  has fixed nonzero sign on an open nonmixed interval, then there are no exact nonmixed tangent-plane contacts on that interval.*
- (3) *If every nonempty open subinterval of a nonmixed interval contains an exact nonmixed tangent-plane contact, then*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} \equiv 0$$

*on that interval, hence*

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0,$$

*and therefore the lifted curve collapses to affine-planar geometry.*

*Proof.* For (1), Proposition 12.175 produces a point in the convex hull of the three normalized nodes where  $\mathcal{R} = 0$ . Pulling back through the monotone source-to- $x$  coordinate on the nonmixed patch and using Proposition 12.149 gives  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = 0$  at the corresponding source point.

For (2), by Proposition 12.149,  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  and  $\mathcal{R}$  have the same sign on a nonmixed arc. So Corollary 12.186 applies.

For (3), every nonempty open subinterval contains a zero of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  by (1), so analyticity forces  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} \equiv 0$ . Proposition 12.149 then gives  $\mathcal{R} \equiv 0$ , and Corollary 12.179 gives affine-planar collapse.  $\square$



**Remark 12.189** (Chebyshev formulation of the nonmixed burden). Corollary 12.188 shows that the nonmixed 4-point branch is controlled source-level by the pair

$$(J_\lambda, J_{u_5}).$$

If this pair were a Chebyshev pair on an opened nonmixed arc, i.e.

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} \neq 0$$

throughout that arc, then the entire nonmixed 4-point branch would be sterile there. Thus a one-sign theorem for  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  would still be sufficient. However, the later source-level no-go theorem shows that generic Wronskian algebra alone is not enough to force such a statement. The actual remaining burden is therefore a source-coupling theorem that excludes the analytically possible odd zeros of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  on genuine opened nonmixed arcs.

**Proposition 12.190** (Lift of the source-level Wronskian to a  $4 \times 4$  Wronskian). *With*

$$J_\lambda = W(c, v_5, \lambda), \quad J_{u_5} = W(c, v_5, u_5), \quad M = W(c, v_5) = cv'_5 - c'v_5,$$

*one has the exact identity*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda = W(J_\lambda, J_{u_5}) = M W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5).}$$

*Thus, on a nonmixed arc where  $M \neq 0$ , the odd-zero problem for  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  is equivalent to the odd-zero problem for the source-level  $4 \times 4$  Wronskian*

$$\mathcal{U}_{\text{src}} := W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5).$$

*Proof.* By definition,

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = W(J_\lambda, J_{u_5}).$$

Now apply the Sylvester–Wronski identity

$$W(W(f_1, f_2, f_3), W(f_1, f_2, f_4)) = W(f_1, f_2) W(f_1, f_2, f_3, f_4)$$

with

$$(f_1, f_2, f_3, f_4) = (c, v_5, \lambda, u_5).$$

This gives

$$W(J_\lambda, J_{u_5}) = W(c, v_5) W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5) = M W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5),$$

which is exactly the claimed identity.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.191** (The current source-level Wronskian package is not yet a contradiction engine for nonmixed odd zeros). *Let  $I$  be an interval on which*

$$c \neq 0, \quad M = W(c, v_5) \neq 0, \quad J_\lambda = W(c, v_5, \lambda) \neq 0.$$

*Then:*

(1) *for every analytic forcing  $F : I \rightarrow \mathbf{C}$ , there exists an analytic function  $u_5$  on  $I$  such that*

$$W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5) = F;$$

(2) *consequently, for every analytic forcing  $G : I \rightarrow \mathbf{C}$ , there exists an analytic function  $u_5$  on  $I$  such that*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = G;$$

(3) *equivalently, for every analytic forcing  $R : I \rightarrow \mathbf{C}$ , there exists an analytic function  $u_5$  on  $I$  such that*

$$\mathcal{R} = R.$$

*In particular, at the current source-level ratio/Wronskian/ $4 \times 4$ -determinant level, the zero set, parity, and odd/even vanishing pattern of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  and  $\mathcal{R}$  are formally unconstrained.*

*Proof.* Expand the  $4 \times 4$  Wronskian along the  $u_5$ -column. Since the highest derivative of  $u_5$  appearing in  $W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5)$  is  $u_5'''$ , with coefficient exactly

$$W(c, v_5, \lambda) = J_\lambda,$$

there exist analytic coefficients  $a_0, a_1, a_2$  on  $I$  such that

$$W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5) = J_\lambda u_5''' + a_2 u_5'' + a_1 u_5' + a_0 u_5.$$

Because  $J_\lambda \neq 0$  on  $I$ , this is a third-order linear analytic ODE for  $u_5$  with nonvanishing leading coefficient. Standard analytic ODE existence therefore gives an analytic solution  $u_5$  on  $I$  for every analytic forcing  $F$ . This proves (1).

For (2), given analytic  $G$ , set

$$F := \frac{G}{M}.$$

Since  $M \neq 0$  on  $I$ ,  $F$  is analytic. By (1), choose  $u_5$  such that

$$W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5) = F.$$

Then Proposition 12.190 gives

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = M W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5) = G.$$

For (3), given analytic  $R$ , set

$$G := \frac{M J_\lambda^2}{c^2} R.$$

Since  $c \neq 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$ , and  $J_\lambda \neq 0$  on  $I$ , this is analytic. By (2), choose  $u_5$  such that  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = G$ . Then Proposition 12.149 gives

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{c^2}{M} \frac{\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}}{J_\lambda^2} = \frac{c^2}{M} \frac{G}{J_\lambda^2} = R. \quad \square$$

**Remark 12.192** (Ceiling of the current source-level reduction). Propositions 12.190 and 12.191 show that the current source-level reduction has been pushed to its natural ceiling. The nonmixed 4-point branch is indeed equivalent to an odd-zero problem for the gauge-invariant source-level Wronskian

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}},$$

and even to the  $4 \times 4$  Wronskian  $W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5)$ . But at that level the odd-zero pattern is still formally free.

Accordingly, the missing ingredient can no longer be a generic Wronskian or determinant argument. It must be a genuine *source-coupling theorem*: one that uses additional identities coming from the actual RH source structure to show that the analytically possible  $u_5$ -freedom exhibited above is not realizable on a genuine opened nonmixed arc.

**Remark 12.193** (First-loss rigidification of the quadratic-envelope scalar). Set

$$M(a, x) := B_a(x)^2 \Gamma'_a(x) = A'_a(x) B_a(x) - A_a(x) B'_a(x).$$

Then

$$\partial_x M(a, x) = S''(x) B_a(x) (\mathcal{Z}(x) - \Gamma_a(x)).$$

Moreover, at any point where  $M(a, x) = 0$ ,

$$\partial_a M(a, x) = S''(a) C_a(x) (\mathcal{Z}(a) - \Gamma_a(x)),$$

where

$$C_a(x) := S(a) - S(x) + S'(x)(x - a) = \int_a^x (t - a) S''(t) dt.$$

Thus any formally attained first loss of monotonicity for  $\Gamma_a$  forces

$$\Gamma_a(x) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

After the affine shear

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma := Y - \gamma S, \quad \gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a),$$

this yields

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma''(a) = 0, \quad \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0, \quad \partial_x \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0.$$

So a first loss of quadratic-envelope monotonicity can only occur through a sheared repeated-node tangent-contact configuration rooted at a curvature-zero point. In particular, the remaining nonmixed obstruction is diagonal in nature: it is governed by odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ , not by an independent separated source-target mechanism.

**Proposition 12.194** (The current 3-point package is not by itself a contradiction engine for nonmixed first loss). *Fix an analytic function  $S$  on an interval  $I$  with*

$$S'' \neq 0 \quad \text{on } I.$$

*Let  $a < x$  be two points of  $I$ . Then there exist an analytic function  $Y$  on  $I$  and a constant  $\gamma \in \mathbf{R}$  such that, with*

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma := Y - \gamma S,$$

*one has*

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma''(a) = 0, \quad \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0, \quad \partial_x \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0,$$

*where*

$$\tilde{H}_3(a, u) := \tilde{Y}_\gamma(u) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma(a) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(a)(u - a).$$

*In particular, the rigidified repeated-node tangent-contact event from Remark 12.193 is formally compatible with an arbitrary fixed nonmixed planar curve*

$$\Lambda_v = (x, S),$$

*so the established 3-point package for  $\Lambda_v$  alone cannot exclude that event.*

*Proof.* Define

$$T_{a,x}(t) := (t - a)^3(t - x)^2.$$

Then

$$T_{a,x}(a) = 0, \quad T'_{a,x}(a) = 0, \quad T''_{a,x}(a) = 0, \quad T_{a,x}(x) = 0, \quad T'_{a,x}(x) = 0.$$

Hence

$$T_{a,x}(x) - T_{a,x}(a) - T'_{a,x}(a)(x - a) = 0, \quad T'_{a,x}(x) - T'_{a,x}(a) = 0.$$

Now fix any  $\gamma \in \mathbf{R}$  and set

$$Y := \gamma S + T_{a,x}.$$

Then

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma = Y - \gamma S = T_{a,x},$$

so

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma''(a) = 0, \quad \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0, \quad \partial_x \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0.$$

Since  $S$  itself has not changed and  $S'' \neq 0$  on  $I$ , the original 3-point geometry of  $\Lambda_v = (x, S)$  on  $I$  is exactly the same as before. Thus the sheared repeated-node tangent-contact event is not ruled out by the planar derivative geometry of  $\Lambda_v$  alone.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.195** (A sheared repeated-node event forces two interior  $\mathcal{R}$ -zeros). *Let  $J$  be a connected opened nonmixed arc, and let*

$$a < x \quad \text{lie in } J.$$

*Set*

$$\gamma := \mathcal{Z}(a), \quad \tilde{Y}_\gamma := Y - \gamma S,$$

*and let*

$$\tilde{H}_3(a, u) := \tilde{Y}_\gamma(u) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma(a) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(a)(u - a).$$

*Assume*

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma''(a) = 0, \quad \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0, \quad \partial_x \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0.$$

*Then one of the following holds:*

$$(1) \mathcal{R} \equiv 0 \text{ on } [a, x];$$

(2) there exist points

$$a < r_1 < r_2 < x$$

such that

$$\mathcal{Z}(r_1) = \mathcal{Z}(r_2) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Consequently there exist

$$\xi_1 \in (a, r_1), \quad \xi_2 \in (r_1, r_2)$$

with

$$\mathcal{R}(\xi_1) = \mathcal{R}(\xi_2) = 0.$$

In particular, every nontrivial sheared repeated-node event contains at least two interior zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

*Proof.* Since

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma'' = Y'' - \gamma S'' = (\mathcal{Z} - \gamma)S'',$$

the choice  $\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a)$  gives

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma'' = (\mathcal{Z} - \mathcal{Z}(a))S''.$$

Also,

$$\partial_x \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(x) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(a) = \int_a^x \tilde{Y}_\gamma''(t) dt,$$

and

$$\tilde{H}_3(a, x) = \int_a^x (x - t) \tilde{Y}_\gamma''(t) dt.$$

Therefore the hypotheses imply

$$\int_a^x (\mathcal{Z}(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)) S''(t) dt = 0,$$

and

$$\int_a^x (x - t)(\mathcal{Z}(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)) S''(t) dt = 0.$$

Choose  $\varepsilon \in \{\pm 1\}$  so that

$$\varepsilon S'' > 0 \quad \text{on } J,$$

and define the positive measure

$$d\mu(t) := \varepsilon S''(t) dt, \quad \phi(t) := \mathcal{Z}(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Then

$$\int_a^x \phi d\mu = 0, \quad \int_a^x (x - t)\phi d\mu = 0.$$

Hence also

$$\int_a^x t \phi(t) d\mu(t) = 0.$$

If  $\phi \equiv 0$  on  $[a, x]$ , then

$$\mathcal{R} = \phi' \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } [a, x],$$

which is alternative (1).

Assume now that  $\phi \not\equiv 0$ . Then  $\phi$  cannot have fixed sign on  $[a, x]$ , because  $\mu$  is positive and

$$\int_a^x \phi d\mu = 0.$$

It also cannot have exactly one sign change. Indeed, if  $c \in (a, x)$  were the unique sign-change point, then

$$(t - c)\phi(t) \geq 0 \quad \text{on } [a, x],$$

with strict inequality on a set of positive  $\mu$ -measure. Therefore

$$\int_a^x (t - c)\phi(t) d\mu(t) > 0.$$

But

$$\int_a^x (t - c)\phi(t) d\mu(t) = \int_a^x t\phi(t) d\mu(t) - c \int_a^x \phi(t) d\mu(t) = 0,$$

a contradiction.

So  $\phi$  has at least two sign changes on  $(a, x)$ . Since  $\phi(a) = 0$  and  $\phi$  is continuous, there exist

$$a < r_1 < r_2 < x$$

such that

$$\phi(r_1) = \phi(r_2) = 0,$$

i.e.

$$\mathcal{Z}(r_1) = \mathcal{Z}(r_2) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Applying Rolle's theorem to  $\phi = \mathcal{Z} - \mathcal{Z}(a)$  on  $[a, r_1]$  and on  $[r_1, r_2]$  gives

$$\mathcal{R}(\xi_1) = 0 \quad \text{for some } \xi_1 \in (a, r_1), \quad \mathcal{R}(\xi_2) = 0 \quad \text{for some } \xi_2 \in (r_1, r_2).$$

This proves (2).  $\square$

**Corollary 12.196** (Isolated  $\mathcal{R}$ -zeros are shear-sterile). *Let  $b \in J$  be an isolated zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Then there exists a neighborhood  $U \subset J$  of  $b$  such that no pair*

$$a < x, \quad a, x \in U,$$

*can satisfy*

$$\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a), \quad \tilde{Y}_\gamma''(a) = 0, \quad \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0, \quad \partial_x \tilde{H}_3(a, x) = 0.$$

*Proof.* Choose  $U$  so small that  $b$  is the only zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  in  $U$ . If such a pair  $a < x$  existed in  $U$ , then Proposition 12.195 would produce two interior zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  in  $(a, x) \subset U$ , a contradiction.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.197** (Diagonal sheared recurrence forces affine-planar collapse). *Let  $J$  be a connected opened nonmixed arc. Suppose there exists a sequence*

$$a_n < x_n, \quad a_n, x_n \in J, \quad a_n, x_n \rightarrow b, \quad x_n - a_n \rightarrow 0,$$

*such that, with*

$$\gamma_n := \mathcal{Z}(a_n), \quad \tilde{Y}_{\gamma_n} := Y - \gamma_n S,$$

*one has*

$$\tilde{Y}_{\gamma_n}''(a_n) = 0, \quad \tilde{H}_{3,n}(a_n, x_n) = 0, \quad \partial_x \tilde{H}_{3,n}(a_n, x_n) = 0,$$

*where*

$$\tilde{H}_{3,n}(a, u) := \tilde{Y}_{\gamma_n}(u) - \tilde{Y}_{\gamma_n}(a) - \tilde{Y}_{\gamma_n}'(a)(u - a).$$

*Then*

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0$$

*on a neighborhood of  $b$ . Hence on some nontrivial interval containing  $b$  one has*

$$Y = \gamma S + \alpha x + \beta,$$

*so the lifted curve is locally affine-planar there.*

*Proof.* If for some  $n$  the first alternative in Proposition 12.195 holds, then  $\mathcal{R} \equiv 0$  on  $[a_n, x_n]$  and we are done.

Otherwise, for every  $n$  the interval  $(a_n, x_n)$  contains at least two zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Since

$$a_n, x_n \rightarrow b, \quad x_n - a_n \rightarrow 0,$$

these zeros accumulate at  $b$ . Because  $\mathcal{R}$  is analytic, this implies

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0$$

on a neighborhood of  $b$ . Therefore  $\mathcal{Z}$  is locally constant, so

$$Y'' = \gamma S''$$

there, and integrating twice gives

$$Y = \gamma S + \alpha x + \beta$$

on a nontrivial interval around  $b$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 12.198** (Uniform fixed-level nonrecurrence for the sheared 3-point branch). *Let  $J$  be a connected opened nonmixed arc, fix a real scalar  $\gamma$ , and set*

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma := Y - \gamma S = \frac{u_5 - \gamma\lambda}{c}, \quad f_\gamma := u_5 - \gamma\lambda, \quad J_\gamma := J_{f_\gamma} = J_{u_5} - \gamma J_\lambda.$$

Then

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma'' = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_\gamma.$$

Assume that  $b \in J$  is an isolated finite-order odd zero of  $J_\gamma$ . After affine normalization of the planar curve

$$(x, \tilde{Y}_\gamma)$$

at  $b$ , let

$$I_- = (\alpha, 0)$$

be the source interval on which

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma'' < 0,$$

and let

$$I_+ = (0, \beta)$$

be the maximal open interval to the right of 0 on which

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma'$$

is strictly increasing. Set

$$\mathcal{J}_\gamma := \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(I_-) \cap \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(I_+).$$

For

$$m \in \mathcal{J}_\gamma,$$

write

$$a_\gamma(m) := (\tilde{Y}_\gamma'|_{I_-})^{-1}(m),$$

and define

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) := \tilde{Y}_\gamma(u) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma(a) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(a)(u - a).$$

Then there exists a unique maximal open interval

$$\mathcal{J}_{\gamma, \text{br}} = (0, m_{\gamma,*}) \subset \mathcal{J}_\gamma$$

and a unique real-analytic function

$$u_\gamma : \mathcal{J}_{\gamma, \text{br}} \rightarrow I_+$$

such that

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a_\gamma(m), u_\gamma(m)) = 0 \quad (m \in \mathcal{J}_{\gamma, \text{br}}),$$

and this branch agrees near  $m = 0$  with the unique local opposite-side branch born at the odd zero  $b$ .

Moreover, along the whole branch one has

$$\partial_u \tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a_\gamma(m), u_\gamma(m)) = \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(u_\gamma(m)) - m \neq 0,$$

so there is no interior common-tangent event, no interior recurrence, and no interior accumulation. If

$$m_{\gamma,*} < \sup \mathcal{J}_\gamma,$$

then

$$u_\gamma(m) \longrightarrow \beta \quad (m \uparrow m_{\gamma,*}),$$

so the branch can stop only by boundary exit of the relevant slope-overlap block.

Equivalently, using

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) = A_a(u) - \gamma B_a(u) = B_a(u)(\Gamma_a(u) - \gamma),$$

one has along the branch

$$\Gamma_{a_\gamma(m)}(u_\gamma(m)) = \gamma, \quad \Gamma'_{a_\gamma(m)}(u_\gamma(m)) \neq 0.$$

In particular, for every fixed  $\gamma$ , the distinguished level  $\gamma$  of the repeated-source scalar  $\Gamma_a$  has no interior critical point on the sheared odd-zero branch.

*Proof.* By Remark 12.148, for any scalar germ  $f$  one has

$$\frac{d^2}{dx^2} \left( \frac{f}{c} \right) = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_f.$$

Applying this with

$$f = f_\gamma = u_5 - \gamma\lambda$$

gives

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma'' = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_\gamma.$$

Hence  $b$  is an isolated finite-order odd zero of  $J_\gamma$  if and only if it is an isolated finite-order odd zero of the planar curvature

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma''.$$

Now apply Theorem 12.166 and Theorem 12.169 with the affine-normalized analytic function

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma$$

playing the role of the planar graphing function  $S$ . The proofs of those results use only the planar repeated-node tangent-contact equation for the chosen analytic function, its curvature parity at the base point, and the maximal monotone-slope block on the opposite side. Therefore they apply verbatim to

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) = \tilde{Y}_\gamma(u) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma(a) - \tilde{Y}_\gamma'(a)(u - a),$$

and yield the unique local opposite-side branch, its unique continuation on the maximal slope-overlap block, the nonvanishing of

$$\partial_u \tilde{H}_{3,\gamma},$$

and the boundary-exit alternative. This proves the first part.

For the reformulation in terms of  $\Gamma_a$ , note from the definitions of  $A_a$ ,  $B_a$ , and  $\Gamma_a$  that

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) = (Y(u) - Y(a) - Y'(a)(u - a)) - \gamma(S(u) - S(a) - S'(a)(u - a)) = A_a(u) - \gamma B_a(u).$$

Since

$$A_a(u) = \Gamma_a(u) B_a(u),$$

this becomes

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) = B_a(u)(\Gamma_a(u) - \gamma).$$

By Proposition 12.185,

$$B_a(u) \neq 0 \quad (u \neq a),$$

so along the branch

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a_\gamma(m), u_\gamma(m)) = 0 \iff \Gamma_{a_\gamma(m)}(u_\gamma(m)) = \gamma.$$

Differentiating

$$\tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) = B_a(u)(\Gamma_a(u) - \gamma)$$

with respect to  $u$  gives

$$\partial_u \tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) = B_a'(u)(\Gamma_a(u) - \gamma) + B_a(u)\Gamma_a'(u).$$

On the branch, where

$$\Gamma_a(u) = \gamma,$$

this simplifies to

$$\partial_u \tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a, u) = B_a(u)\Gamma_a'(u).$$

Since the first part already gives

$$\partial_u \tilde{H}_{3,\gamma}(a_\gamma(m), u_\gamma(m)) \neq 0$$

and

$$B_{a_\gamma(m)}(u_\gamma(m)) \neq 0,$$

it follows that

$$\Gamma'_{a_\gamma(m)}(u_\gamma(m)) \neq 0$$

along the whole branch. This proves the final statement.  $\square$

**Remark 12.199** (No-go for the fixed-level chamber-exit route). One might hope to strengthen Proposition 12.198 as follows: if a fixed level  $\gamma$  is chosen near a strict local extremum of  $\mathcal{Z}$ , so that

$$J_\gamma = (\mathcal{Z} - \gamma)J_\lambda$$

has two nearby simple zeros

$$r_- < r_+,$$

then the corresponding sheared opposite-side 3-point branch should be unable to reach the chamber boundary  $u = r_+$  without first encountering an interior common-tangent point

$$\partial_u \tilde{H}_{3,\gamma} = 0.$$

This is false already at the level of the local planar/sheared equations.

Indeed, consider the model functions

$$S_{\text{mod}}(x) := x^2, \quad \mathcal{Z}_{\text{mod}}(x) := 1 - x^2, \quad \mathcal{R}_{\text{mod}}(x) := \mathcal{Z}'_{\text{mod}}(x) = -2x,$$

and fix the level

$$\gamma := 0.$$

Set

$$F_{\text{mod}}(x) := x^2 - \frac{x^4}{6}.$$

Then

$$F''_{\text{mod}}(x) = 2(1 - x^2) = (\mathcal{Z}_{\text{mod}}(x) - \gamma) S''_{\text{mod}}(x),$$

so the two simple zeros of the sheared curvature are

$$r_- = -1, \quad r_+ = 1.$$

Let

$$H_{\text{mod}}(a, u) := F_{\text{mod}}(u) - F_{\text{mod}}(a) - F'_{\text{mod}}(a)(u - a).$$

A direct computation gives

$$H_{\text{mod}}(a, u) = -\frac{(u - a)^2}{6} (3a^2 + 2au + u^2 - 6).$$

Hence the nontrivial opposite-side branch issued from the odd zero  $r_- = -1$  is

$$u(a) = -a - \sqrt{6 - 2a^2}, \quad -\frac{5}{3} < a < -1.$$

Along this branch one has

$$-1 < u(a) < 1, \quad u(a) \uparrow 1 \quad \text{as} \quad a \downarrow -\frac{5}{3},$$

so the branch runs inside the chamber and stops by boundary exit at the second curvature zero.

Moreover,

$$\partial_u H_{\text{mod}}(a, u) = F'_{\text{mod}}(u) - F'_{\text{mod}}(a) = -\frac{u - a}{3} (a^2 + au + u^2 - 3).$$

Substituting  $u = u(a)$  yields

$$a^2 + a u(a) + u(a)^2 - 3 = -a^2 + a\sqrt{6 - 2a^2} + 3 < 0 \quad \left( -\frac{5}{3} < a < -1 \right),$$

and therefore

$$\partial_u H_{\text{mod}}(a, u(a)) > 0 \quad \left( -\frac{5}{3} < a < -1 \right).$$



So there is *no* interior common-tangent point anywhere on the branch before boundary exit. In fact, if one continues the same algebraic branch past the chamber boundary, the first common tangent occurs only later at

$$(a, u) = (-\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{3}),$$

strictly after the chamber has already been crossed.

Thus fixed-level sheared nonrecurrence cannot be sharpened to a chamber-exit contradiction by planar arguments alone. The remaining obstruction is therefore genuinely source-coupled: any successful odd-zero exclusion must use the source-pinned moving shear

$$f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda$$

or some equivalent RH-specific coupling, rather than only a frozen level  $\gamma$  and the planar branch geometry of

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma = Y - \gamma S.$$

**Remark 12.200** (Source-level form of the shear transfer). For fixed  $a \in J$ , set

$$f_a := u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda.$$

Then

$$\tilde{Y}_{\mathcal{Z}(a)} = \frac{f_a}{c}, \quad J_{f_a} = J_{u_5} - \mathcal{Z}(a)J_\lambda = (\mathcal{Z} - \mathcal{Z}(a))J_\lambda,$$

and

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = D_{u_5}(a, h) - \mathcal{Z}(a) D_\lambda(a, h).$$

Thus the sheared repeated-node conditions are exactly a repeated-node tangent-contact event for the source triple  $(c, v_5, f_a)$ :

$$J_{f_a}(a) = 0, \quad D_{f_a}(a, h) = 0, \quad \partial_h D_{f_a}(a, h) = 0.$$

Proposition 12.195 shows that such a source-level event forces either  $J_{f_a} \equiv 0$  on the interval or at least two interior zeros of  $J_{f_a}$ , equivalently at least two interior zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  and hence of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ .

**Proposition 12.201** (Source-determinant form of the odd-zero unrooted defect). *Let  $J$  be a good nonmixed  $v_5$ -patch, and let  $b \in J$  be an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Use the local  $x$ -coordinate on  $J$  centered at  $b$ , so that*

$$x(b) = 0, \quad \mathcal{R}(x) = x^m \rho(x), \quad m \geq 1 \text{ odd}, \quad \rho(0) \neq 0.$$

For each source point  $a \in J$ , set

$$\Psi_a(h) := \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)}, \quad f_a := u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))\lambda.$$

Then, after shrinking  $J$  around  $b$  if necessary, the following hold.

(1) The critical locus

$$\partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0 \quad \text{equivalently} \quad \mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0$$

is the graph of a unique real-analytic branch

$$h = \sigma(a), \quad \sigma(b) = b, \quad \sigma(a) \neq a \quad (a \neq b).$$

(2) One has the exact identity

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = D_{u_5}(a, h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, h) = D_\lambda(a, h) (\Psi_a(h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))).$$

(3) Along the critical branch,

$$\Psi_a(\sigma(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) = -\frac{\rho(0)}{2^{m+1}(m+2)} (x(\sigma(a)) - x(a))^{m+1} + o(|x(\sigma(a)) - x(a)|^{m+1}).$$

(4) Consequently,

$$D_{f_a}(a, \sigma(a)) = -\frac{c(b)^4 J_\lambda(b) \rho(0)}{2^{m+2}(m+2)M(b)^2} (x(\sigma(a)) - x(a))^{m+3} + o(|x(\sigma(a)) - x(a)|^{m+3}).$$

In particular, for all sufficiently small  $a \neq b$  one has

$$D_{f_a}(a, \sigma(a)) \neq 0,$$

and indeed

$$\operatorname{sgn} D_{f_a}(a, \sigma(a)) = -\operatorname{sgn}(J_\lambda(b)\rho(0)).$$

So near an isolated odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the born repeated-source critical branch

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0$$

is uniformly unrooted in source-determinant language:

$$D_{u_5}(a, h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, h) \neq 0.$$

*Proof.* By Remark 12.187,

$$\Psi_a(h) = \Gamma_{x(a)}(x(h)).$$

Therefore the critical locus

$$\partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0$$

is exactly the pullback through the source-to- $x$  coordinate of the local critical branch

$$\partial_x \Gamma_{x(a)}(x) = 0.$$

So item (1) is the source-coordinate form of Proposition 12.183.

For item (2), linearity of the determinant in the third column gives

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = D_{u_5}(a, h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, h).$$

Dividing by  $D_\lambda(a, h) \neq 0$  on the nonmixed patch yields

$$\frac{D_{f_a}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)} = \Psi_a(h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)).$$

For item (3), apply Proposition 12.183 to the  $x$ -coordinate pair

$$(x(a), x(\sigma(a))).$$

Since

$$\Psi_a(\sigma(a)) = \Gamma_{x(a)}(x(\sigma(a))),$$

that proposition gives exactly

$$\Psi_a(\sigma(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) = -\frac{\rho(0)}{2^{m+1}(m+2)}(x(\sigma(a)) - x(a))^{m+1} + o(|x(\sigma(a)) - x(a)|^{m+1}).$$

For item (4), apply the row-reduction identity from Remark 12.187 to

$$f = f_a, \quad F = \frac{f_a}{c} = Y - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))S.$$

This gives

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = c(a)^2 c(h) x'(a) \tilde{H}_{3, \mathcal{Z}(x(a))}(x(a), x(h)),$$

and since

$$\tilde{H}_{3, \mathcal{Z}(x(a))}(x(a), x(h)) = B_{x(a)}(x(h))(\Psi_a(h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))),$$

we obtain

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = c(a)^2 c(h) x'(a) B_{x(a)}(x(h))(\Psi_a(h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))).$$

Along the branch  $h = \sigma(a)$ , write

$$\delta(a) := x(\sigma(a)) - x(a).$$

Then

$$B_{x(a)}(x(\sigma(a))) = \frac{1}{2} S''(b) \delta(a)^2 + o(|\delta(a)|^2),$$

while

$$x'(b) = \frac{M(b)}{c(b)^2}, \quad S''(b) = \frac{c(b)^3}{M(b)^3} J_\lambda(b)$$

by Remark 12.148. Therefore

$$c(a)^2 c(\sigma(a)) x'(a) B_{x(a)}(x(\sigma(a))) = \frac{c(b)^4 J_\lambda(b)}{2M(b)^2} \delta(a)^2 + o(|\delta(a)|^2).$$

Multiplying by item (3) gives

$$D_{f_a}(a, \sigma(a)) = -\frac{c(b)^4 J_\lambda(b) \rho(0)}{2^{m+2}(m+2)M(b)^2} \delta(a)^{m+3} + o(|\delta(a)|^{m+3}),$$

which is the claimed asymptotic. Since  $m+3$  is even, the leading term has fixed nonzero sign for all sufficiently small  $a \neq b$ .  $\square$

**Remark 12.202** (Ceiling of the local shear-transfer route). Proposition 12.201 shows that near an isolated odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the genuinely born local repeated-source branch is the critical branch

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0 \quad \text{equivalently} \quad \partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0,$$

but its rooted numerator

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = D_{u_5}(a, h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, h)$$

has a fixed nonzero leading term there.

So the rooted sheared repeated-node tangent-contact condition is not the local source avatar of diagonal odd-zero birth. In particular, no argument using only the local odd-zero model and the repeated-source critical-branch equations can prove an implication of the form

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0 \implies D_{f_a}(a, h) = 0$$

near odd zeros.

This is a different obstruction from Remark 12.192: the latter says the generic source-level Wronskian/ $4 \times 4$  package is formally too free, while the present remark says that even along the *actual local odd-zero branch*, the rooted numerator fails to vanish with a universal signed defect. Any successful shear-transfer theorem must therefore use genuinely additional RH source coupling beyond the local odd-zero critical-branch analysis.

**Proposition 12.203** (Repeated-source first loss is exactly diagonal odd-zero birth). *Let  $J$  be a connected opened nonmixed arc, so*

$$K_v \neq 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

*For  $a < x$  in  $J$ , define*

$$A_a(x) := Y(x) - Y(a) - Y'(a)(x - a), \quad B_a(x) := S(x) - S(a) - S'(a)(x - a),$$

$$\Gamma_a(x) := \frac{A_a(x)}{B_a(x)}, \quad M(a, x) := B_a(x)^2 \Gamma'_a(x).$$

*Equivalently,*

$$M(a, x) = A'_a(x) B_a(x) - A_a(x) B'_a(x).$$

*Let*

$$\Sigma_M := \{(a, x) \in J^2 : a < x, M(a, x) = 0\}.$$

*Then the following hold.*

(1) No attained separated first loss. *There is no pair  $(a_*, x_*) \in \Sigma_M$  such that*

$$x_* = \inf\{x : \exists a < x \text{ with } (a, x) \in \Sigma_M\}.$$

(2) Any first-loss sequence is diagonal. *If  $(a_n, x_n) \in \Sigma_M$  and*

$$x_n \downarrow x_* := \inf\{x : \exists a < x \text{ with } (a, x) \in \Sigma_M\},$$

*then*

$$x_n - a_n \rightarrow 0.$$

(3) Diagonal accumulation forces a zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . If  $(a_n, x_n) \in \Sigma_M$  and

$$a_n, x_n \rightarrow b, \quad x_n - a_n \rightarrow 0,$$

then

$$\mathcal{R}(b) = 0.$$

(4) Even-order zeros are diagonally sterile. If  $b$  is an isolated even-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , then there exists a neighborhood  $U$  of  $b$  such that

$$\Sigma_M \cap (U \times U) = \emptyset.$$

(5) Odd-order zeros seed diagonal first loss. If  $b$  is an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , then every neighborhood  $U$  of  $b$  contains points

$$(a, x) \in \Sigma_M \quad \text{with} \quad a < x, \quad a, x \in U.$$

Accordingly, repeated-source first loss on a nonmixed arc is not an independent obstruction mechanism: it occurs if and only if one diagonally approaches an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

*Proof.* For (1), suppose  $(a_*, x_*) \in \Sigma_M$  were an attained separated first-loss pair. Then for fixed  $a_*$  one has

$$M(a_*, x) > 0 \quad (a_* < x < x_*),$$

by the definition of  $x_*$ . Since  $B_{a_*}(x) \neq 0$  on a nonmixed arc, this implies

$$\Gamma'_{a_*}(x) > 0 \quad (a_* < x < x_*),$$

so  $\Gamma_{a_*}$  is strictly increasing on  $(a_*, x_*)$ . Therefore

$$\Gamma_{a_*}(x_*) > \lim_{x \downarrow a_*} \Gamma_{a_*}(x) = \mathcal{Z}(a_*).$$

But Remark 12.193 shows that every formally attained first loss satisfies

$$\Gamma_{a_*}(x_*) = \mathcal{Z}(a_*),$$

a contradiction. Thus no attained separated first-loss pair exists.

For (2), suppose  $(a_n, x_n) \in \Sigma_M$  and  $x_n \downarrow x_*$ , but that  $x_n - a_n \not\rightarrow 0$ . Passing to a subsequence, we may assume

$$a_n \rightarrow a_* < x_*.$$

By continuity of  $M$ ,

$$M(a_*, x_*) = 0,$$

so  $(a_*, x_*) \in \Sigma_M$ , contradicting (1). Hence  $x_n - a_n \rightarrow 0$ .

For (3), since  $B_a(x) \neq 0$  on a nonmixed arc, the condition  $(a_n, x_n) \in \Sigma_M$  is equivalent to

$$\Gamma'_{a_n}(x_n) = 0.$$

In the quadratic-envelope notation from Proposition 12.185,

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = \frac{1}{B_a(x)^2} \int_a^x \Omega_{a,x}(r) \mathcal{R}(r) dr.$$

Equivalently, after local nonmixed normalization at  $b$ , this becomes the repeated-node profile derivative formula

$$D'_a(x) = 2 \int_0^1 s(1-s) \mathcal{R}(a + s(x-a)) ds.$$

Letting  $a_n, x_n \rightarrow b$  with  $x_n - a_n \rightarrow 0$ , continuity yields

$$0 = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} D'_{a_n}(x_n) = 2 \left( \int_0^1 s(1-s) ds \right) \mathcal{R}(b) = \frac{1}{3} \mathcal{R}(b).$$

Hence  $\mathcal{R}(b) = 0$ .

For (4), if  $b$  is an isolated even-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , then Proposition 12.181 gives a neighborhood  $U$  of  $b$  on which every repeated-node profile  $D_a$  is strictly monotone. Therefore  $D'_a(x) \neq 0$  for  $a \neq x$  in  $U$ , hence  $\Gamma'_a(x) \neq 0$  and

$$\Sigma_M \cap (U \times U) = \emptyset.$$

For (5), if  $b$  is an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , then Proposition 12.181 gives, after local normalization, a local repeated-node extremum branch for the profiles  $D_a$ . In particular, every neighborhood  $U$  of  $b$  contains points  $a < x$  with

$$D'_a(x) = 0.$$

Since  $B_a(x) \neq 0$  on the nonmixed arc, this is equivalent to

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = 0,$$

hence  $(a, x) \in \Sigma_M \cap (U \times U)$ .

The final statement is the combination of (2), (4), and (5).  $\square$

**Remark 12.204** (Effect on the rigidified first-loss lane). Proposition 12.203 shows that the repeated-source / first-loss mechanism is not an independent obstruction: no attained separated first loss can occur, every first-loss sequence is forced to the diagonal, and diagonal first loss occurs exactly at isolated odd-order zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

At the same time, Corollary 12.184 shows that near an isolated odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the rooted sheared repeated-node tangent-contact event itself is locally absent; and Corollary 12.197 shows that any genuine diagonal realization of the sheared event already forces the affine-planar collapse case

$$\mathcal{R} \equiv 0.$$

So the sheared bottleneck closes in the collapse direction, not by a purely planar contradiction for  $(x, S)$ .

Proposition 12.198 shows moreover that for each fixed shear level  $\gamma$ , the corresponding sheared opposite-side 3-point branch is already globally rigid on its maximal slope-overlap block: it has no interior common-tangent event, no interior recurrence, and no interior accumulation. Thus the remaining issue is not sheared 3-point recurrence at fixed  $\gamma$ , but the source-coupling / level-selection step that would force the distinguished level

$$\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(b)$$

arising from a hypothetical odd zero of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  to be hit by the relevant critical-value configuration of  $\Gamma_a$ .

Remark 12.199 shows that this fixed-level route cannot be pushed further by planar chamber-exit arguments alone: even with two nearby roots of  $\mathcal{Z} = \gamma$ , the sheared opposite-side branch may run to the second curvature zero by boundary exit without any interior common-tangent event. Thus the remaining step must be genuinely source-coupled, involving the source-pinned moving shear

$$f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda$$

or an equivalent RH-specific coupling, rather than only the frozen-level geometry of

$$\tilde{Y}_\gamma = Y - \gamma S.$$

**Remark 12.205** (The repeated-source lane is now closed). Proposition 12.203 shows that the repeated-source / first-loss mechanism does not define an additional nonmixed obstruction beyond the odd-zero problem for  $\mathcal{R}$ . No attained separated first loss can occur, every first-loss sequence is forced to the diagonal, and diagonal first loss occurs exactly at isolated odd-order zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Thus the genuinely remaining nonmixed burden is purely the global/source-level control of odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ , equivalently of the source-level Wronskian  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ .

**Proposition 12.206** (Single-sign-change source segment cannot realize rigidified first loss). *Let  $J$  be an opened nonmixed arc, and let  $a < x$  in  $J$ . After local nonmixed normalization on  $[a, x]$ , write*

$$R_{a,x}(s) := \mathcal{R}(a + s(x - a)), \quad 0 \leq s \leq 1.$$

*Then*

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = 2 \int_0^1 s(1 - s) R_{a,x}(s) ds,$$

and

$$\Gamma_a(x) - \mathcal{Z}(a) = (x - a) \int_0^1 (1 - s)^2 R_{a,x}(s) ds.$$

Assume that  $R_{a,x}$  has exactly one sign change on  $(0, 1)$ . If

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = 0,$$

then

$$\operatorname{sgn}(\Gamma_a(x) - \mathcal{Z}(a))$$

is the sign of  $R_{a,x}$  on the initial side of the sign change. In particular,

$$\Gamma_a(x) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Equivalently, no pair  $(a, x)$  for which  $\mathcal{R}$  changes sign exactly once on  $(a, x)$  can satisfy simultaneously

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = 0, \quad \Gamma_a(x) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Hence any rigidified first-loss segment must cross at least two sign changes of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

*Proof.* In the normalized nonmixed chart,  $S(t) = t^2$ , so  $\Gamma_a = D_a$  with

$$D_a(t) = \int_0^1 (1 - s) \tilde{Y}''(a + s(t - a)) ds, \quad D_a(a) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Differentiating in  $t$  gives

$$D'_a(t) = \int_0^1 s(1 - s) \tilde{Y}'''(a + s(t - a)) ds = 2 \int_0^1 s(1 - s) \mathcal{R}(a + s(t - a)) ds,$$

which is the first displayed formula at  $t = x$ . Integrating  $\tilde{Y}''(a + s(t - a))$  by parts in  $s$  yields

$$D_a(t) - D_a(a) = (t - a) \int_0^1 (1 - s)^2 \mathcal{R}(a + s(t - a)) ds,$$

which is the second displayed formula at  $t = x$ .

Let

$$k_1(s) := s(1 - s), \quad k_0(s) := (1 - s)^2,$$

so that

$$\frac{k_0(s)}{k_1(s)} = \frac{1 - s}{s}$$

is strictly decreasing on  $(0, 1)$ .

Write  $R_{a,x} = \sigma\rho$  with  $\rho \geq 0$  and  $\sigma$  changing sign exactly once at some  $s_0 \in (0, 1)$ . By hypothesis,

$$0 = \int_0^1 k_1(s) \sigma(s) \rho(s) ds.$$

Split

$$I := \int_0^1 k_0(s) \sigma(s) \rho(s) ds = \int_0^{s_0} \frac{k_0}{k_1}(s) k_1(s) \sigma(s) \rho(s) ds + \int_{s_0}^1 \frac{k_0}{k_1}(s) k_1(s) \sigma(s) \rho(s) ds.$$

Let  $\epsilon := \operatorname{sgn}(\sigma|_{(0, s_0)})$ . Then  $k_1\sigma\rho \geq 0$  with sign  $\epsilon$  on  $(0, s_0)$  and sign  $-\epsilon$  on  $(s_0, 1)$ . Because  $k_0/k_1$  is strictly decreasing, it is bounded below by its value at  $s_0$  on  $(0, s_0)$  and bounded above by its value at  $s_0$  on  $(s_0, 1)$ . Using

$$\int_0^{s_0} k_1\sigma\rho = - \int_{s_0}^1 k_1\sigma\rho$$

and strict monotonicity on the support of  $\rho$  gives

$$\epsilon I > 0.$$

Hence

$$\Gamma_a(x) - \mathcal{Z}(a) = (x - a) I \neq 0,$$

with sign  $\epsilon$  (after orienting  $x > a$ ). This proves the claim.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.207** (Source-level two-sign-change obstruction). *Let  $a < h$  lie on an opened nonmixed arc in source coordinates. Assume*

$$\Psi'_a(h) = 0.$$

*If the source-level Wronskian*

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda$$

*changes sign exactly once on the source interval  $[a, h]$ , then*

$$\Psi_a(h) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

*Equivalently, the simultaneous source-level first-loss conditions*

$$\Psi'_a(h) = 0, \quad \Psi_a(h) = \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

*force at least two sign changes of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  on  $[a, h]$ .*

*Proof.* By Remark 12.187,  $\Psi_a(h) = \Gamma_{x(a)}(x(h))$ , and on the nonmixed arc  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  and  $\mathcal{R}$  differ only by a nonvanishing analytic factor (Proposition 12.149). So a single sign change of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  on  $[a, h]$  pulls back to a single sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$  on  $[x(a), x(h)]$ . Apply Proposition 12.206.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.208** (Transport equations for a repeated-source critical branch). *Let  $J$  be an opened nonmixed arc, and work in a local normalized nonmixed chart on which*

$$S(t) = t^2, \quad \Gamma_a = D_a.$$

*Let  $U \subset J$  be an interval, and let*

$$\tau : U \rightarrow J$$

*be a real-analytic function such that*

$$\tau(a) > a, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0 \quad (a \in U).$$

*Set*

$$V(a) := D_a(\tau(a)).$$

*Then:*

(1)

$$V'(a) = \frac{2}{\tau(a) - a} (V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a)).$$

(2)

$$D''_a(\tau(a)) = \frac{2}{(\tau(a) - a)^2} (\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a)).$$

(3) *At any point  $a \in U$  where  $D''_a(\tau(a)) \neq 0$ ,*

$$\tau'(a) = \frac{V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a)}{\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a)}.$$

*Proof.* Write

$$D_a(t) = \frac{\tilde{Y}(t) - \tilde{Y}(a) - \tilde{Y}'(a)(t - a)}{(t - a)^2}.$$

Differentiating in  $a$  gives

$$\partial_a D_a(t) = \frac{2}{t - a} (D_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)).$$

Evaluating at  $t = \tau(a)$  and using  $D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0$  yields

$$V'(a) = \frac{d}{da} D_a(\tau(a)) = \partial_a D_a(\tau(a)) = \frac{2}{\tau(a) - a} (V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a)),$$

which proves (1).

Now use the rigidification scalar

$$M(a, t) := B_a(t)^2 \Gamma'_a(t).$$

In the normalized chart,

$$B_a(t) = (t - a)^2, \quad \Gamma_a = D_a, \quad M(a, t) = (t - a)^4 D'_a(t).$$

By Remark 12.193,

$$\partial_t M(a, t) = 2(t - a)^2 (\mathcal{Z}(t) - D_a(t)).$$

At  $t = \tau(a)$  we have  $D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0$ , so

$$\partial_t M(a, \tau(a)) = (\tau(a) - a)^4 D''_a(\tau(a)).$$

Comparing the two formulas gives

$$(\tau(a) - a)^4 D''_a(\tau(a)) = 2(\tau(a) - a)^2 (\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a)),$$

hence (2).

Finally, still by Remark 12.193, at points where  $M(a, t) = 0$  one has

$$\partial_a M(a, t) = 2(t - a)^2 (\mathcal{Z}(a) - D_a(t)),$$

in the normalized chart. Since

$$M(a, \tau(a)) = 0,$$

differentiating in  $a$  gives

$$0 = \frac{d}{da} M(a, \tau(a)) = \partial_a M(a, \tau(a)) + \partial_t M(a, \tau(a)) \tau'(a).$$

Substituting the formulas above yields

$$0 = 2(\tau(a) - a)^2 (\mathcal{Z}(a) - V(a)) + 2(\tau(a) - a)^2 (\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a)) \tau'(a).$$

If  $D''_a(\tau(a)) \neq 0$ , then by (2),

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a) \neq 0,$$

so solving for  $\tau'(a)$  gives (3). □

**Corollary 12.209** (One-sign-change chamber is no-return for the born critical branch). *In the setting of Proposition 12.208, assume moreover that for every  $a \in U$  the segment*

$$[a, \tau(a)]$$

*contains exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ .*

*Then for every  $a \in U$ :*

(1)

$$\text{sgn}(V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a))$$

*is the sign of the initial lobe of  $\mathcal{R}$  on  $[a, \tau(a)]$ ;*

(2)

$$\text{sgn}(\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a))$$

*is the sign of the terminal lobe of  $\mathcal{R}$  on  $[a, \tau(a)]$ ;*

(3)

$$(V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a))(\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a)) < 0;$$

(4)

$$D''_a(\tau(a)) \neq 0, \quad \tau'(a) < 0;$$

(5)

$$V(a) \notin [\mathcal{Z}(a), \mathcal{Z}(\tau(a))].$$

*In particular,*

$$V(a) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a),$$

*so the branch cannot realize the rigidified first-loss condition anywhere on  $U$ .*

*Proof.* The first sign statement is exactly Proposition 12.206 applied to the critical pair  $(a, \tau(a))$ .

For the second sign statement, write

$$R_{a, \tau(a)}(s) := \mathcal{R}(a + s(\tau(a) - a)).$$

Since

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a) = (\tau(a) - a) \int_0^1 R_{a, \tau(a)}(s) ds$$



and

$$V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a) = (\tau(a) - a) \int_0^1 (1-s)^2 R_{a,\tau(a)}(s) ds,$$

one gets

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a) = (\tau(a) - a) \int_0^1 (2s - s^2) R_{a,\tau(a)}(s) ds.$$

At the critical pair,

$$0 = D'_a(\tau(a)) = 2 \int_0^1 s(1-s) R_{a,\tau(a)}(s) ds,$$

so

$$\int_0^1 (2s - s^2) R_{a,\tau(a)}(s) ds = \int_0^1 s^2 R_{a,\tau(a)}(s) ds.$$

Hence

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a) = (\tau(a) - a) \int_0^1 s^2 R_{a,\tau(a)}(s) ds.$$

Now set

$$k_1(s) := s(1-s), \quad k_2(s) := s^2.$$

Then

$$\frac{k_2(s)}{k_1(s)} = \frac{s}{1-s}$$

is strictly increasing on  $(0, 1)$ . Repeating the weighted signed-mass argument from the proof of Proposition 12.206 shows that

$$\operatorname{sgn}(\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a))$$

is the sign of the terminal lobe of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

The two signs are therefore opposite, which proves (3). Then Proposition 12.208(2) gives

$$D''_a(\tau(a)) \neq 0,$$

and Proposition 12.208(3) gives

$$\tau'(a) < 0.$$

Finally, opposite signs of

$$V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a)$$

mean exactly that  $V(a)$  lies strictly outside the endpoint-curvature interval

$$[\mathcal{Z}(a), \mathcal{Z}(\tau(a))].$$

□

**Proposition 12.210** (First rooting requires a second odd zero along the born repeated-source branch). *Let  $b$  be an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  on an opened nonmixed arc, and let*

$$t = \tau(a)$$

*denote an analytic continuation of the local born repeated-source critical branch, so that*

$$\tau(a) > a, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0.$$

*Assume that  $U$  is a connected continuation interval on which, for every  $a \in U$ , the segment*

$$[a, \tau(a)]$$

*contains exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ .*

*Then for every  $a \in U$  one has*

$$D_a(\tau(a)) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

*Equivalently, on the corresponding source branch*

$$h = \sigma(a), \quad \mathfrak{D}(a, \sigma(a)) = 0,$$

*one has*

$$\Psi_a(\sigma(a)) \neq \mathcal{Z}(x(a)),$$

or in determinant form,

$$D_{u_5}(a, \sigma(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, \sigma(a)) \neq 0.$$

Consequently, any first parameter at which the analytic continuation of the born repeated-source branch realizes a genuine repeated-source obstruction inside the opened nonmixed arc must occur only after the corresponding segment ceases to be one-sign-change. Internally, away from affine-planar collapse and without leaving the arc, this can happen only when the segment acquires a second odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , equivalently of

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}.$$

*Proof.* The first claim is exactly Corollary 12.209(5): on any continuation interval on which each segment

$$[a, \tau(a)]$$

contains exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the born critical branch cannot realize the rigidified first-loss condition

$$D_a(\tau(a)) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Via Remark 12.187,

$$\Psi_a(h) = \Gamma_{x(a)}(x(h)),$$

so the same statement in source coordinates is

$$\Psi_a(\sigma(a)) \neq \mathcal{Z}(x(a)).$$

Using Proposition 12.201(2), this is equivalent to

$$D_{u_5}(a, \sigma(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, \sigma(a)) \neq 0.$$

For the final statement, as long as the continued branch remains inside the opened nonmixed arc and the corresponding segment remains one-sign-change, the first part shows that rooting cannot occur. Thus any first rooted point must be preceded by failure of the one-sign-change condition.

Now even-order zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  do not change sign, so internally the sign-change count on the segment can change only when an endpoint of the segment meets another odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  (unless the branch exits the arc or enters the affine-planar collapse case). Finally, on a nonmixed arc the functions  $\mathcal{R}$  and

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda$$

differ only by a nonvanishing analytic factor (Proposition 12.149), so odd zeros of the two objects coincide.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.211** (Discriminant entry into the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber is not a first rooted point). *Let  $J$  be an opened nonmixed arc, and work in a local normalized nonmixed chart on which*

$$S(t) = t^2, \quad \Gamma_a = D_a.$$

Let

$$\tau : (a_-, a_0] \rightarrow J$$

be a real-analytic continuation of the born repeated-source critical branch, so that

$$\tau(a) > a, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0 \quad (a \in (a_-, a_0]).$$

Assume:

(1) for every  $a \in (a_-, a_0)$ , the segment

$$[a, \tau(a)]$$

contains exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ ;

(2) the target endpoint reaches the next adjacent odd zero at  $a = a_0$ , i.e.

$$q := \tau(a_0)$$

is an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , there are no odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  in  $(\tau(a), q)$  for  $a < a_0$  close to  $a_0$ , and the segment

$$[a_0, q]$$

still contains exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

Set

$$V(a) := D_a(\tau(a)).$$

Define the sheared discriminant and the RH-selected slice by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{D} &:= \{(a, \gamma, h) : a < h, D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0, \partial_h D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0\}, \\ \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}} &:= \{(a, \gamma, h) : \gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a)\}. \end{aligned}$$

Then

$$P(a) := (a, V(a), \tau(a)) \in \mathcal{D} \quad (a \in (a_-, a_0]),$$

but at the adjacent-odd-zero entrance point one has

$$V(a_0) - \mathcal{Z}(a_0) \neq 0.$$

More precisely,

$$V(a_0) - \mathcal{Z}(a_0) = (q - a_0) \int_0^1 (1 - s)^2 \mathcal{R}(a_0 + s(q - a_0)) ds,$$

and this quantity has the sign of the initial lobe of  $\mathcal{R}$  on  $[a_0, q]$ .

Consequently,

$$P(a_0) \notin \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}},$$

and there exists a neighborhood  $N$  of  $P(a_0)$  in

$$J \times \mathbf{R} \times J$$

such that

$$N \cap \mathcal{D} \cap \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}} = \emptyset.$$

In particular, a first rooted point cannot be created at the moment when the next adjacent odd zero first enters the active segment. If rooting occurs at all, it must occur only after the branch has moved into a genuine two-sign-change chamber of positive width.

*Proof.* By Remark 12.187,

$$\Psi_a(h) = \Gamma_{x(a)}(x(h)),$$

and on a nonmixed patch

$$D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = D_\lambda(a, h)(\Psi_a(h) - \gamma).$$

Since

$$D_\lambda(a, h) \neq 0 \quad (a < h),$$

we have

$$D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0, \partial_h D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0 \iff \gamma = \Psi_a(h), \partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0.$$

Along the continued born branch,

$$\partial_h \Psi_a(\tau(a)) = 0, \quad \Psi_a(\tau(a)) = V(a),$$

so indeed

$$P(a) = (a, V(a), \tau(a)) \in \mathcal{D}.$$

At  $a = a_0$ , the integral formula for  $D_a$  gives

$$V(a_0) - \mathcal{Z}(a_0) = (q - a_0) \int_0^1 (1 - s)^2 \mathcal{R}(a_0 + s(q - a_0)) ds.$$

Also, since  $D'_{a_0}(q) = 0$ ,

$$0 = D'_{a_0}(q) = 2 \int_0^1 s(1 - s) \mathcal{R}(a_0 + s(q - a_0)) ds.$$

Set

$$R_0(s) := \mathcal{R}(a_0 + s(q - a_0)), \quad k_0(s) := (1 - s)^2, \quad k_1(s) := s(1 - s).$$

Then

$$\frac{k_0(s)}{k_1(s)} = \frac{1 - s}{s}$$

is strictly decreasing on  $(0, 1)$ . Because  $R_0$  has exactly one sign change on  $(0, 1)$ , the same weighted signed-mass argument used in Proposition 12.206 implies that

$$\int_0^1 k_0(s) R_0(s) ds$$

has the sign of the initial lobe of  $R_0$ , hence is nonzero. Therefore

$$V(a_0) - \mathcal{Z}(a_0) \neq 0.$$

Thus

$$P(a_0) = (a_0, V(a_0), q) \in \mathcal{D} \quad \text{but} \quad P(a_0) \notin \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}}.$$

Since both  $\mathcal{D}$  along the continued branch and the function

$$(a, \gamma, h) \mapsto \gamma - \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

are continuous, there is a neighborhood  $N$  of  $P(a_0)$  on which

$$\gamma - \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

keeps the sign of

$$V(a_0) - \mathcal{Z}(a_0).$$

Hence

$$N \cap \mathcal{D} \cap \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}} = \emptyset.$$

The final statement is immediate: a rooted point is exactly a point of

$$\mathcal{D} \cap \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}},$$

so no such point can be born at the adjacent-odd-zero entrance.  $\square$

**Remark 12.212** (What the discriminant analysis now leaves open). Proposition 12.211 shows that a rooted point is not created *at the entry* into the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber. Corollary 12.226 shows more: on any continuation interval on which the anchor-side value

$$\mathcal{R}(a)$$

keeps a fixed sign, the RH-selected slice

$$\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

does not cross the continued discriminant curve at all.

Thus the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber is not itself the residual obstruction. What remains open is narrower and genuinely global: whether a rooted crossing can occur only after the anchor passes through an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  (equivalently of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ ), or after branch exit, or after affine-planar collapse. In other words, the remaining discriminant-theoretic bottleneck is a *delayed post-anchor no-crossing problem*: not an entry-point singularity problem, and not crossing at the anchor odd zero itself, but a later crossing on a dangerous post-anchor chamber.

**Proposition 12.213** (Rooted-defect transport and stationary first root). *In the setting of Proposition 12.208, define*

$$L(a) := \tau(a) - a, \quad G(a) := V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a) = D_a(\tau(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Then

$$G'(a) = \frac{2}{L(a)} G(a) - \mathcal{R}(a).$$

Hence, if  $a_* \in U$  satisfies

$$G(a_*) = 0,$$

then

$$G'(a_*) = -\mathcal{R}(a_*).$$

If in addition

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a_*),$$

then

$$D''_{a_*}(\tau(a_*)) \neq 0, \quad \tau'(a_*) = 0, \quad \tau''(a_*) = -\frac{\mathcal{R}(a_*)}{\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*)}.$$

*Proof.* Since

$$G(a) = V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a),$$

Proposition 12.208(1) gives

$$G'(a) = V'(a) - \mathcal{R}(a) = \frac{2}{\tau(a) - a} (V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a)) - \mathcal{R}(a) = \frac{2}{L(a)} G(a) - \mathcal{R}(a).$$

Evaluating at a root  $a_*$  of  $G$  gives

$$G'(a_*) = -\mathcal{R}(a_*).$$

Now assume also that

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a_*).$$

Since  $G(a_*) = 0$ , this means

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) \neq V(a_*).$$

So Proposition 12.208(2) yields

$$D''_{a_*}(\tau(a_*)) = \frac{2}{(\tau(a_*) - a_*)^2} (\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) - V(a_*)) \neq 0.$$

Then Proposition 12.208(3) applies near  $a_*$  and gives

$$\tau'(a) = \frac{G(a)}{\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a)) - V(a)}.$$

Evaluating at  $a_*$  gives

$$\tau'(a_*) = 0.$$

Differentiate this identity once more. Since  $G(a_*) = 0$  and

$$\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) - V(a_*) = \mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*) \neq 0,$$

one gets

$$\tau''(a_*) = \frac{G'(a_*)}{\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) - V(a_*)} = -\frac{\mathcal{R}(a_*)}{\mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*)},$$

as claimed.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.214** (Nondegenerate rooted point is a fold of the moving-shear equation).  
Work in a local normalized nonmixed chart on which

$$S(t) = t^2.$$

Define

$$\mathcal{F}(a, t) := A_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a) B_a(t) = (t - a)^2 (D_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)).$$

Let

$$a_* < t_*$$

satisfy

$$\mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 0, \quad \partial_t \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 0,$$

and assume

$$\mathcal{R}(a_*) \neq 0, \quad \mathcal{Z}(t_*) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a_*).$$

Then

$$\partial_a \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = -(t_* - a_*)^2 \mathcal{R}(a_*),$$

and

$$\partial_{tt} \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 2(\mathcal{Z}(t_*) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*)).$$

In particular,

$$\partial_a \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) \neq 0, \quad \partial_{tt} \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) \neq 0.$$

Hence near  $(a_*, t_*)$  the zero set

$$\mathcal{F}(a, t) = 0$$

is the graph of a unique real-analytic function

$$a = \alpha(t)$$

with

$$\alpha(t_*) = a_*, \quad \alpha'(t_*) = 0, \quad \alpha''(t_*) = \frac{2(\mathcal{Z}(t_*) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*))}{(t_* - a_*)^2 \mathcal{R}(a_*)}.$$

Equivalently,

$$a - a_* = \frac{\mathcal{Z}(t_*) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*)}{(t_* - a_*)^2 \mathcal{R}(a_*)} (t - t_*)^2 + o((t - t_*)^2).$$

*Proof.* Since

$$\mathcal{F}(a, t) = (t - a)^2 (D_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)),$$

the conditions

$$\mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 0, \quad \partial_t \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 0$$

imply

$$D_{a_*}(t_*) = \mathcal{Z}(a_*), \quad D'_{a_*}(t_*) = 0.$$

So  $(a_*, t_*)$  is a rooted critical point.

Differentiate  $\mathcal{F}$  with respect to  $a$ :

$$\partial_a \mathcal{F}(a, t) = -2(t - a)(D_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)) + (t - a)^2 (\partial_a D_a(t) - \mathcal{R}(a)).$$

At the rooted point,

$$D_{a_*}(t_*) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*) = 0,$$

and by Proposition 12.208,

$$\partial_a D_a(t) = \frac{2}{t - a} (D_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)),$$

so

$$\partial_a \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = -(t_* - a_*)^2 \mathcal{R}(a_*).$$

Next,

$$\partial_t \mathcal{F}(a, t) = 2(t - a)(D_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)) + (t - a)^2 D'_a(t),$$

hence

$$\partial_{tt} \mathcal{F}(a, t) = 2(D_a(t) - \mathcal{Z}(a)) + 4(t - a)D'_a(t) + (t - a)^2 D''_a(t).$$

At the rooted critical point this becomes

$$\partial_{tt} \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = (t_* - a_*)^2 D''_{a_*}(t_*).$$

Applying Proposition 12.208(2) and using

$$D_{a_*}(t_*) = \mathcal{Z}(a_*),$$

one gets

$$\partial_{tt} \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 2(\mathcal{Z}(t_*) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*)).$$

By the two nonvanishing assumptions,

$$\partial_a \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) \neq 0.$$

So the implicit function theorem gives a unique real-analytic graph

$$a = \alpha(t)$$

for the zero set of  $\mathcal{F}$  near  $(a_*, t_*)$ . Since

$$\partial_t \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 0,$$

one has

$$\alpha'(t_*) = 0.$$

Differentiating

$$\mathcal{F}(\alpha(t), t) = 0$$

twice at  $t = t_*$  gives

$$\partial_a \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) \alpha''(t_*) + \partial_{tt} \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*) = 0,$$

hence

$$\alpha''(t_*) = -\frac{\partial_{tt} \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*)}{\partial_a \mathcal{F}(a_*, t_*)} = \frac{2(\mathcal{Z}(t_*) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*))}{(t_* - a_*)^2 \mathcal{R}(a_*)}.$$

The Taylor expansion of  $\alpha$  then yields the stated quadratic form.  $\square$

**Remark 12.215** (First rooted point as a post-birth fold problem). Let  $b$  be an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , and let

$$t = \tau(a)$$

be an analytic continuation of the born repeated-source critical branch. By Proposition 12.210, any first rooted point along this continuation can occur only after the segment has acquired a second odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

At such a rooted point, if

$$\mathcal{R}(a_*) \neq 0, \quad \mathcal{Z}(\tau(a_*)) \neq \mathcal{Z}(a_*),$$

then Proposition 12.213 shows that the rooted defect

$$G(a) = D_a(\tau(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a) \quad \text{equivalently} \quad G(a) = \Psi_a(\sigma(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

crosses transversely and that the target map is stationary there:

$$\tau'(a_*) = 0.$$

Moreover, Proposition 12.214 shows that the moving-shear equation

$$A_a(x) - \mathcal{Z}(a) B_a(x) = 0 \quad \text{equivalently} \quad D_{f_a}(a, h) = 0, \quad f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda,$$

has a local fold at the first rooted point.

Thus the unresolved adjacent-odd-zero issue is not another local odd-zero birth problem. It is a *post-birth first-fold exclusion problem* for the source-pinned moving shear  $f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda$ . The current fixed-level nonrecurrence results control frozen- $\gamma$  branches on their maximal slope-overlap blocks, and Proposition 12.201 controls the diagonal birth chamber near the seeding odd zero, but neither yet excludes this first post-birth fold.

**Proposition 12.216** (At most one odd zero implies no genuine repeated-source obstruction). *Let  $J$  be an opened nonmixed arc. Assume that  $\mathcal{R}$  has at most one odd-order zero on  $J$ . Then there is no pair  $a < x$  in  $J$  such that*

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = 0, \quad \Gamma_a(x) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

*Equivalently, there is no source-level pair  $a < h$  on the corresponding source arc such that*

$$\Psi'_a(h) = 0, \quad \Psi_a(h) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

*Proof.* On a nonmixed arc,  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  differs from  $\mathcal{R}$  only by a nonvanishing analytic factor (Proposition 12.149), so odd zeros and sign changes of the two objects coincide.

If  $\mathcal{R}$  has at most one odd-order zero on  $J$ , then every segment contained in  $J$  contains at most one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$  (equivalently of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ ), since even-order zeros do not change sign. Hence Corollary 12.207 excludes any simultaneous source-level solution of

$$\Psi'_a(h) = 0, \quad \Psi_a(h) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Via Remark 12.187, this is equivalent to the planar formulation

$$\Gamma'_a(x) = 0, \quad \Gamma_a(x) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

$\square$

**Remark 12.217** (Minimal unresolved configuration on this route). Proposition 12.216 rules out every opened nonmixed arc carrying at most one odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , and Corollary 12.226 rules out rooted crossing on the standard adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber as long as the anchor-side value  $\mathcal{R}(a)$  keeps a fixed sign.

The new odd-anchor passage theorem (Proposition 12.228) shows that no rooted crossing can occur at the anchor odd zero itself or immediately after it is crossed, while Corollary 12.230 shows that the subsequent post-anchor chambers alternate dangerous and safe, beginning with a dangerous first post-anchor chamber.

Remark 12.231 shows that the first dangerous chamber is already formally compatible with the local scalar rooted equations and fold data. Accordingly, the first genuinely unresolved configuration is no longer the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber itself, nor the anchor odd zero passage, but a *delayed* crossing on a dangerous post-anchor chamber. Thus the sharpened source-coupling target is a delayed no-crossing / profile-realizability exclusion theorem for the moving shear

$$f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda$$

on genuine opened nonmixed arcs.

**Remark 12.218** (No-go for a pure level-set / barrier theorem for  $\mathcal{Z}$ ). A natural next guess would be that the remaining adjacent-odd-zero case could be excluded by a theorem depending only on the level geometry of

$$\mathcal{Z}, \quad \mathcal{R} = \mathcal{Z}',$$

together with the first-root transport identities

$$G(a_*) := V(a_*) - \mathcal{Z}(a_*) = 0, \quad G'(a_*) = -\mathcal{R}(a_*), \quad \tau'(a_*) = 0,$$

and the fact that a rooted point forces two interior recrossings of the level

$$\mathcal{Z}(r) = \mathcal{Z}(a_*).$$

At the current level of abstraction this is false: the level-set geometry of  $\mathcal{Z}$  alone is still too free.

Indeed, already in the normalized planar determinant model one can realize all of the above with exactly two simple odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  and with a nondegenerate rooted critical pair. Take

$$S(t) = t^2, \quad \mathcal{R}(t) = 5t^3 + 5t^2 - 7t + 1, \quad \mathcal{Z}(t) = \int_0^t \mathcal{R}(u) du = t - \frac{7}{2}t^2 + \frac{5}{3}t^3 + \frac{5}{4}t^4.$$

Then  $\mathcal{R}$  has exactly two simple zeros in  $(0, 1)$ , numerically

$$t \approx 0.165726, \quad t \approx 0.660736,$$

so on  $[0, 1]$  the sign pattern is  $+, -, +$  with exactly two odd sign changes. Now choose an analytic function  $\tilde{Y}$  such that

$$\frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'' = \mathcal{Z}.$$

For the normalized determinant function  $D_a(x)$  associated to  $(x, \tilde{Y})$ , the rooted critical conditions at  $(a, x) = (0, 1)$  become

$$D'_0(1) = 2 \int_0^1 s(1-s) \mathcal{R}(s) ds, \quad D_0(1) - \mathcal{Z}(0) = \int_0^1 (1-s)^2 \mathcal{R}(s) ds.$$

For this  $\mathcal{R}$ , both moments vanish:

$$\int_0^1 s(1-s) \mathcal{R}(s) ds = 0, \quad \int_0^1 (1-s)^2 \mathcal{R}(s) ds = 0.$$

Hence

$$D'_0(1) = 0, \quad D_0(1) = \mathcal{Z}(0),$$

so  $(0, 1)$  is an exact rooted repeated-source critical pair.

Moreover,

$$D''_0(1) = 2 \int_0^1 s^2 \mathcal{R}(s) ds = \frac{5}{6} > 0,$$



so the critical branch is nondegenerate and the implicit-function theorem gives a real-analytic continuation

$$x = \tau(a), \quad \tau(0) = 1, \quad \tau'(0) = 0.$$

Also, with

$$V(a) := D_a(\tau(a)), \quad G(a) := V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a),$$

one has at the rooted point

$$G(0) = 0, \quad G'(0) = -\mathcal{R}(0) = -1.$$

Finally, the level equation

$$\mathcal{Z}(t) = \mathcal{Z}(0) = 0$$

has two interior solutions,

$$t \approx 0.368001, \quad t \approx 0.851550,$$

so the rooted point comes with exactly the two interior recrossings of the moving level demanded by the source-pinned shear picture.

Thus a theorem using only the scalar level-set topology of  $\mathcal{Z}$  together with the first-root identities above cannot suffice to exclude the remaining adjacent-odd-zero configuration. Any successful next step must use additional structure: either the provenance of  $(a, \tau(a))$  as the *continued born branch*, or a genuinely source-coupled constraint such as the moving shear

$$f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda,$$

rather than only the abstract level geometry of  $\mathcal{Z}$ .

**Remark 12.219** (No-go for branch provenance alone). One might try to strengthen Remark 12.218 by using not just the scalar level geometry of  $\mathcal{Z}$ , but also the *provenance* of the rooted point: namely, that  $(a, \tau(a))$  lies on the continued branch born at an earlier odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . At the planar normalized  $D_a$ -level, this is still not enough. There are explicit analytic models in which the born branch from one odd zero continues to a genuine rooted point before leaving the interval bounded by the adjacent odd zeros.

A concrete example is obtained by taking

$$S(t) = t^2, \quad \mathcal{R}(t) := t(t-1)(t^2 - 4t - 2) = t^4 - 5t^3 + 2t^2 + 2t,$$

and

$$\mathcal{Z}(t) := \int_0^t \mathcal{R}(u) du = \frac{1}{5}t^5 - \frac{5}{4}t^4 + \frac{2}{3}t^3 + t^2.$$

Then the odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  are

$$2 - \sqrt{6}, \quad 0, \quad 1, \quad 2 + \sqrt{6},$$

so 0 is an odd zero and its adjacent odd zero on the left is  $2 - \sqrt{6}$ .

Now choose an analytic function  $\tilde{Y}$  such that

$$\frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}'' = \mathcal{Z},$$

and let  $D_a(x)$  denote the normalized determinant/divided-difference function for the planar graph  $(x, \tilde{Y})$ . Near the odd zero 0 there is the usual born critical branch

$$x = \tau(a), \quad a < 0 < x, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0,$$

with

$$\tau(a) = -a + O(a^2),$$

and the local odd-zero analysis gives

$$G(a) := D_a(\tau(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a) < 0$$

for  $a < 0$  sufficiently close to 0.

However, along this same connected born branch one finds

$$G(-0.5801) < 0, \quad G(-0.5901) > 0,$$

so by continuity there exists

$$a_* \in (-0.5901, -0.5801)$$

such that

$$G(a_*) = 0.$$

Thus the *continued born branch* reaches a rooted point

$$D'_{a_*}(\tau(a_*)) = 0, \quad D_{a_*}(\tau(a_*)) = \mathcal{Z}(a_*).$$

Numerically,

$$a_* \approx -0.5805673462, \quad \tau(a_*) \approx 0.3888336023,$$

and

$$D''_{a_*}(\tau(a_*)) > 0,$$

so this rooted point is nondegenerate; in particular,

$$\tau'(a_*) = 0$$

as predicted by the transport system.

Moreover, the segment

$$[a_*, \tau(a_*)]$$

contains exactly the born odd zero 0 together with the adjacent odd zero  $2 - \sqrt{6}$ , and no others. So even the strengthened statement

“continued born-branch provenance plus adjacent-odd-zero geometry already excludes rooting” is false in the planar normalized model.

Therefore the remaining exclusion cannot depend only on abstract branch continuation data for

$$D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0$$

together with the scalar geometry of  $\mathcal{Z}$ . Any successful next step must use genuinely source-coupled structure, such as the actual quotient

$$\Psi_a(h) = \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)},$$

the moving shear

$$f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda,$$

or some equivalent RH-specific relation invisible in the planar  $D_a$  model.

**Remark 12.220** (No-go for disconjugacy/ECT alone). A further natural idea is to recast the moving-shear family through the third-order operator

$$L[y] := \frac{W(c, v_5, \lambda, y)}{J_\lambda},$$

and try to exclude rooted moving-shear events by proving that  $L$  is disconjugate, Chebyshev, or sign-regular on opened nonmixed arcs. At the present level of abstraction this is still not enough.

Indeed, already in the normalized source model

$$c(t) = 1, \quad v_5(t) = t, \quad \lambda(t) = t^2,$$

one has

$$J_f = W(c, v_5, f) = f'', \quad J_\lambda = 2, \quad L[y] = \frac{W(c, v_5, \lambda, y)}{J_\lambda} = \frac{1}{2} y''''.$$

So the homogeneous equation  $L[y] = 0$  has basis

$$1, \quad t, \quad t^2,$$

hence is maximally disconjugate / ECT on every interval. Nevertheless, the planar normalized counterexample from Remark 12.219 fits exactly into this framework: for a suitable analytic  $u_5$  and the source-pinned family

$$f_a := u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda,$$

one has

$$L[f_a] = L[u_5], \quad J_{f_a}(a) = 0,$$

and along the continued born branch there is still a rooted point

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = 0, \quad \partial_h D_{f_a}(a, h) = 0.$$

Thus disconjugacy, ECT, or sign-regularity of the operator  $L$  by itself cannot exclude the remaining rooted moving-shear configuration. Any successful next step must use additional source-coupled structure beyond the abstract third-order ODE viewpoint, such as special positivity or monotonicity for the distinguished quotient

$$\Psi_a(h) = \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)}$$

or for the particular slice

$$f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda.$$

**Remark 12.221** (Ceiling of the present scalar/discriminant analysis). The preceding results sharply delimit what can and cannot be obtained from the current planar/scalar reformulation.

On the positive-kernel side, one-sign-change chambers are sterile for genuine repeated-source first loss: the born critical branch is simple, has strictly negative slope, and cannot satisfy

$$D_a(\tau(a)) = \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

before the active segment acquires another odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  (Proposition 12.210). On the discriminant side, the adjacent-odd-zero entrance itself cannot create the first rooted point (Proposition 12.211).

However, Remarks 12.218 and 12.219 show that the present planar/scalar package still has a genuine ceiling. In the planar normalized  $D_a$  model, neither the scalar level-set topology of  $\mathcal{Z}$  nor the abstract provenance of a point on the continued born branch suffices by itself to exclude a later rooted crossing.

The new anchor-sign and odd-anchor-passage arguments remove a substantial part of that freedom. On any continuation interval on which the anchor-side value

$$\mathcal{R}(a)$$

keeps a fixed sign, the RH-selected slice

$$\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

cannot cross the continued discriminant curve. When the anchor itself passes through an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the integrating-factor defect keeps its incoming sign across that odd anchor zero, so a rooted crossing cannot occur there or immediately after it. The post-anchor chambers then alternate dangerous and safe, beginning with a dangerous first post-anchor chamber.

However, Remark 12.231 shows that already in that first dangerous chamber the local normalized rooted equations and local fold/transversality data are formally realizable in the planar scalar model. Accordingly, the present scalar/discriminant package still has a genuine ceiling: beyond the fixed-sign analysis, the remaining problem is not arbitrary global crossing, but a genuinely source-coupled *delayed no-crossing / profile-realizability problem* on dangerous post-anchor chambers.

So any further progress on the nonmixed repeated-source branch must use structure invisible in the planar normalized model, namely a genuinely source-coupled constraint linking

$$\Psi_a(h), \quad \mathfrak{D}(a, h), \quad \mathcal{Z}(a), \quad f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda$$

along the actual RH branch, rather than only the abstract scalar geometry of  $D_a$  and  $\mathcal{Z}$ .

**Proposition 12.222** (Discriminant reduction for the moving-shear family). *Let  $J$  be a good nonmixed  $v_5$ -patch. For  $\gamma \in \mathbf{R}$ , set*

$$f_\gamma := u_5 - \gamma\lambda.$$

*Define the sheared discriminant set*

$$\mathcal{D} := \{(a, \gamma, h) \in J \times \mathbf{R} \times J : a < h, \ D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0, \ \partial_h D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0\}.$$

Then on the region  $a < h$  one has the exact equivalence

$$(a, \gamma, h) \in \mathcal{D} \iff \gamma = \Psi_a(h), \quad \mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0.$$

Equivalently,

$$\mathcal{D} = \{(a, \Psi_a(h), h) : a < h, \mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0\}.$$

In particular, on a nonmixed patch the sheared discriminant is not an independent two-dimensional catastrophe surface in  $(a, \gamma, h)$ -space: it is the graph of the repeated-source critical locus

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0$$

in the extra  $\gamma$ -direction.

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.201(2), for every  $(a, h)$  with  $a < h$  one has

$$D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = D_\lambda(a, h)(\Psi_a(h) - \gamma).$$

Differentiating in  $h$  gives

$$\partial_h D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = \partial_h D_\lambda(a, h)(\Psi_a(h) - \gamma) + D_\lambda(a, h) \partial_h \Psi_a(h).$$

On a good nonmixed patch,

$$D_\lambda(a, h) \neq 0 \quad (a < h).$$

Therefore

$$D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0 \iff \gamma = \Psi_a(h).$$

At such a point the first term in the formula for  $\partial_h D_{f_\gamma}$  vanishes, so

$$\partial_h D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = 0 \iff D_\lambda(a, h) \partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0 \iff \partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0.$$

Finally, by Remark 12.187,

$$\partial_h \Psi_a(h) = \frac{W_h(c, v_5)(a) \mathfrak{D}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)^2},$$

and the prefactor is nonvanishing on the nonmixed patch. Hence

$$\partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0 \iff \mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0.$$

Combining the two equivalences proves the result.  $\square$

**Proposition 12.223** (Generic rooted discriminant point is a transverse crossing). *In the setting of Proposition 12.222, define the RH-selected slice*

$$\mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}} := \{(a, \gamma, h) \in J \times \mathbf{R} \times J : \gamma = \mathcal{Z}(x(a))\}.$$

Let

$$(a_*, \gamma_*, h_*) \in \mathcal{D} \cap \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}}$$

and assume

$$\partial_h^2 D_{f_{\gamma_*}}(a_*, h_*) \neq 0, \quad \mathcal{R}(x(a_*)) \neq 0.$$

Then there is a neighborhood of  $(a_*, \gamma_*, h_*)$  in which  $\mathcal{D}$  is a unique real-analytic curve

$$a \mapsto (a, \gamma(a), h(a)),$$

with

$$\gamma(a) = \Psi_a(h(a)).$$

Moreover one has

$$\gamma'(a_*) = 0, \quad h'(a_*) = 0,$$

and

$$\left. \frac{d}{da} (\gamma(a) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))) \right|_{a=a_*} = -\mathcal{R}(x(a_*)) x'(a_*) \neq 0.$$

Hence the discriminant curve  $\mathcal{D}$  meets the RH-selected slice  $\mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}}$  transversely at  $(a_*, \gamma_*, h_*)$ .

In fact the  $\gamma$ -projection of the discriminant curve has a nondegenerate local extremum there:

$$\gamma''(a_*) = -\frac{2x'(a_*)^2}{x(h_*) - x(a_*)} \mathcal{R}(x(a_*)).$$

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.222, the discriminant is cut out by

$$\partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0, \quad \gamma = \Psi_a(h).$$

At the given point,

$$\partial_h^2 D_{f_{\gamma_*}}(a_*, h_*) \neq 0.$$

Since

$$D_{f_\gamma}(a, h) = D_\lambda(a, h)(\Psi_a(h) - \gamma),$$

differentiating twice in  $h$  and evaluating at a discriminant point gives

$$\partial_h^2 D_{f_{\gamma_*}}(a_*, h_*) = D_\lambda(a_*, h_*) \partial_h^2 \Psi_{a_*}(h_*).$$

Because  $D_\lambda(a_*, h_*) \neq 0$ , this implies

$$\partial_h^2 \Psi_{a_*}(h_*) \neq 0.$$

So by the implicit function theorem there is a unique real-analytic function

$$h = h(a)$$

with

$$h(a_*) = h_*, \quad \partial_h \Psi_a(h(a)) = 0.$$

Setting

$$\gamma(a) := \Psi_a(h(a))$$

gives the asserted local parametrization of  $\mathcal{D}$ .

Now pass to the local normalized nonmixed  $x$ -coordinate and write

$$\alpha := x(a), \quad \tau(\alpha) := x(h(a)), \quad V(\alpha) := D_\alpha(\tau(\alpha)).$$

By Remark 12.187,

$$\gamma(a) = \Psi_a(h(a)) = V(\alpha).$$

Since  $(a_*, \gamma_*, h_*) \in \mathcal{S}_{\text{RH}}$ , one has

$$V(\alpha_*) = \mathcal{Z}(\alpha_*), \quad \alpha_* := x(a_*).$$

By Proposition 12.208, at a rooted noncollapse point one has

$$V'(\alpha_*) = 0, \quad \tau'(\alpha_*) = 0.$$

Therefore

$$\gamma'(a_*) = V'(\alpha_*) x'(a_*) = 0,$$

and

$$x'(h_*) h'(a_*) = \tau'(\alpha_*) x'(a_*) = 0,$$

hence

$$h'(a_*) = 0.$$

For the transverse-crossing derivative, differentiate

$$\gamma(a) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) = V(\alpha) - \mathcal{Z}(\alpha)$$

to get

$$\frac{d}{da} (\gamma(a) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))) = x'(a)(V'(\alpha) - \mathcal{R}(\alpha)).$$

At  $a = a_*$ , since  $V'(\alpha_*) = 0$ , this becomes

$$\frac{d}{da} (\gamma(a) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a))) \Big|_{a=a_*} = -\mathcal{R}(\alpha_*) x'(a_*),$$

which is nonzero by hypothesis. This proves transversality.

Finally, differentiate

$$V'(\alpha) = \frac{2}{\tau(\alpha) - \alpha} (V(\alpha) - \mathcal{Z}(\alpha))$$

from Proposition 12.208(1). At the rooted point,

$$V(\alpha_*) - \mathcal{Z}(\alpha_*) = 0, \quad \tau'(\alpha_*) = 0,$$

so

$$V''(\alpha_*) = \frac{2}{\tau(\alpha_*) - \alpha_*} (V'(\alpha_*) - \mathcal{R}(\alpha_*)) = -\frac{2}{\tau(\alpha_*) - \alpha_*} \mathcal{R}(\alpha_*).$$

Hence

$$\gamma''(a_*) = V''(\alpha_*) x'(a_*)^2 = -\frac{2 x'(a_*)^2}{x(h_*) - x(a_*)} \mathcal{R}(x(a_*)),$$

as claimed.  $\square$

**Remark 12.224** (What the discriminant/catastrophe route actually reduces to). The discriminant reformulation sharpens the geometry, but it also shows the limit of purely local catastrophe arguments on this route.

Indeed, by Proposition 12.222, the sheared discriminant on a nonmixed patch is already one-dimensional: it is the graph of the repeated-source critical locus

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0$$

in the  $\gamma$ -direction. And by Proposition 12.223, a generic rooted point is not a tangential meeting of sheets, nor a local fold/cusp obstruction for the RH-selected slice

$$\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(x(a)).$$

It is a *transverse crossing* of a smooth discriminant curve by that moving slice, with oriented crossing sign controlled by

$$-\mathcal{R}(x(a_*)).$$

Accordingly, the discriminant/catastrophe route does not reduce the adjacent odd-zero problem to a local singularity classification in  $(a, \gamma, h)$ -space. The remaining issue is global: to exclude the existence of such a transverse crossing along the continued born branch before the segment exits the arc, collapses affine-planarly, or acquires the next odd zero of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ .

**Proposition 12.225** (Anchor-sign preservation excludes first rooting). *Let  $J$  be an opened nonmixed arc, and work in a local normalized nonmixed chart on which*

$$S(t) = t^2, \quad \Gamma_a = D_a.$$

Let

$$I = (a_1, a_0] \subset J$$

and let

$$\tau : I \rightarrow J$$

be a real-analytic continuation of the repeated-source critical branch such that

$$\tau(a) > a, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0 \quad (a \in I).$$

Set

$$V(a) := D_a(\tau(a)), \quad G(a) := V(a) - \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

Assume that there exists  $\epsilon \in \{\pm 1\}$  such that

$$\epsilon \mathcal{R}(a) > 0 \quad \text{for every } a \in I,$$

and

$$\epsilon G(a_0) > 0.$$

Then

$$\epsilon G(a) > 0 \quad \text{for every } a \in I.$$

In particular,

$$G(a) \neq 0 \quad (a \in I),$$

so the branch cannot realize the rigidified first-loss condition anywhere on  $I$ .

*Proof.* Assume for contradiction that  $G$  vanishes somewhere on  $I$ . Since  $G$  is continuous, the set

$$Z := \{a \in I : G(a) = 0\}$$

is closed in  $I$  and nonempty. Let

$$a_* := \sup Z.$$

Then  $a_* < a_0$ , and by the choice of  $a_*$  one has

$$\epsilon G(a) > 0 \quad \text{for all } a \in (a_*, a_0].$$

Hence the one-sided derivative at  $a_*$  satisfies

$$\epsilon G'(a_*) \geq 0.$$

On the other hand, by Proposition 12.213,

$$G'(a) = \frac{2}{\tau(a) - a} G(a) - \mathcal{R}(a).$$

Evaluating at the root  $a = a_*$  gives

$$G'(a_*) = -\mathcal{R}(a_*).$$

Since  $\epsilon \mathcal{R}(a_*) > 0$  by hypothesis, this yields

$$\epsilon G'(a_*) = -\epsilon \mathcal{R}(a_*) < 0,$$

contradicting

$$\epsilon G'(a_*) \geq 0.$$

Therefore  $G$  has no zero on  $I$ . Since

$$\epsilon G(a_0) > 0,$$

the sign of  $G$  on all of  $I$  is  $\epsilon$ . □

**Corollary 12.226** (No crossing on the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber under anchor-sign preservation). *Let  $b < q$  be adjacent odd-order zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  on an opened nonmixed arc  $J$ . Work in a local normalized nonmixed chart, and let*

$$I = (a_1, a_0] \subset J, \quad \tau : I \rightarrow J$$

*be a real-analytic continuation of the born repeated-source critical branch such that*

$$\tau(a) > a, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0 \quad (a \in I),$$

*with*

$$\tau(a_0) = q.$$

*Assume that for every  $a \in I$  with  $a < a_0$ , the segment*

$$[a, \tau(a)]$$

*contains exactly two sign changes of  $\mathcal{R}$ , occurring at the odd zeros  $b$  and  $q$ , and that*

$$\mathcal{R}(a)$$

*has fixed sign on  $I$ .*

*Then*

$$\operatorname{sgn}(G(a)) = \operatorname{sgn}(\mathcal{R}(a)) \quad (a \in I),$$

*hence*

$$G(a) \neq 0 \quad (a \in I).$$

*Equivalently, the RH-selected slice*

$$\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

*does not cross the continued discriminant curve*

$$(a, \gamma, h) = (a, V(a), \tau(a))$$

*anywhere on  $I$ .*

*Proof.* At the entry point  $a = a_0$ , one has

$$\tau(a_0) = q,$$

and the segment

$$[a_0, q]$$

contains exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ , namely at  $b$ . Therefore Proposition 12.206 applied to the critical pair  $(a_0, q)$  gives

$$\operatorname{sgn}(G(a_0)) = \operatorname{sgn}(\mathcal{R}(a_0)).$$

Now apply Proposition 12.225 with

$$\epsilon := \operatorname{sgn}(\mathcal{R}|_I).$$

□

**Remark 12.227** (What this really removes from the previous caveat). The preceding corollary shows that the geometric hypothesis “the anchor stays on the original birth-side outer lobe” was stronger than necessary. The proof uses only the intrinsic condition that the anchor-side value

$$\mathcal{R}(a)$$

keep a fixed sign along the continuation interval.

Accordingly, the remaining unresolved possibility on this route is narrower, but it is not yet exhausted. A rooted point can occur only after the anchor itself passes through an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , or after branch exit, or after affine-planar collapse. Moreover, Proposition 12.228 shows that no rooted crossing can occur at that anchor odd zero itself or immediately after passage, and Corollary 12.230 shows that the subsequent post-anchor chambers alternate dangerous and safe. Thus the true residual obstruction is no longer the raw adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber itself. But by the universality threshold for the current route-2 package, by the local freedom of arbitrary canonical quotient-septic geometry, and by the full-block universality of the direct provenance slice

$$\phi = Aq^{(7)},$$

even the delayed post-anchor scenario cannot be excluded inside those packages alone.

**Proposition 12.228** (Odd-anchor passage has no sign reset). *Let  $J$  be an opened nonmixed arc, and work in a local normalized nonmixed chart on which*

$$S(t) = t^2, \quad \Gamma_a = D_a.$$

*Let*

$$q \in J$$

*be an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , and let*

$$\tau : (q - \delta, q + \delta) \rightarrow J$$

*be a real-analytic continuation of the repeated-source critical branch such that*

$$\tau(a) > a, \quad D'_a(\tau(a)) = 0 \quad (a \in (q - \delta, q + \delta)).$$

*Set*

$$G(a) := D_a(\tau(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a), \quad L(a) := \tau(a) - a,$$

*and define*

$$\mathcal{A}'(a) := \frac{2}{L(a)}, \quad \mathcal{G}(a) := e^{-\mathcal{A}(a)} G(a).$$

*Assume that there exists  $\epsilon \in \{\pm 1\}$  such that*

$$\epsilon \mathcal{R}(a) > 0, \quad \epsilon G(a) > 0 \quad \text{for every } a \in (q, q + \delta).$$

*Then*

$$\epsilon G(q) > 0.$$

*In particular,  $G(q) \neq 0$ . Hence, after possibly shrinking  $\delta$ ,*

$$\epsilon G(a) > 0 \quad \text{for every } a \in (q - \delta, q + \delta).$$



Since  $q$  is an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the sign of  $\mathcal{R}$  flips across  $q$ ; therefore on the outgoing side

$$\operatorname{sgn} G(a) = -\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{R}(a) \quad (a \in (q - \delta, q)).$$

So a rooted crossing cannot occur at the anchor odd zero itself, nor immediately after passage across it.

*Proof.* By Proposition 12.213,

$$G'(a) = \frac{2}{L(a)} G(a) - \mathcal{R}(a),$$

hence

$$\mathcal{G}'(a) = -e^{-\mathcal{A}(a)} \mathcal{R}(a).$$

Assume for contradiction that  $G(q) = 0$ . Then  $\mathcal{G}(q) = 0$ , and for  $a \in (q, q + \delta)$ ,

$$\mathcal{G}(a) = \mathcal{G}(q) + \int_q^a \mathcal{G}'(s) ds = - \int_q^a e^{-\mathcal{A}(s)} \mathcal{R}(s) ds.$$

Since  $e^{-\mathcal{A}(s)} > 0$  and  $\epsilon \mathcal{R}(s) > 0$  on  $(q, q + \delta)$ , this gives

$$\epsilon \mathcal{G}(a) < 0 \quad (a \in (q, q + \delta)),$$

hence

$$\epsilon G(a) < 0 \quad (a \in (q, q + \delta)),$$

contradicting the hypothesis. Therefore  $G(q) \neq 0$ . Since

$$\epsilon G(a) > 0 \quad (a \in (q, q + \delta)),$$

continuity yields

$$\epsilon G(q) \geq 0,$$

and the nonvanishing just proved forces

$$\epsilon G(q) > 0.$$

A second continuity argument then gives

$$\epsilon G(a) > 0 \quad (a \in (q - \delta, q + \delta))$$

after shrinking  $\delta$  if necessary. Finally, because  $q$  is an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , its sign flips across  $q$ , so on  $(q - \delta, q)$  one has

$$\operatorname{sgn} G(a) = -\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{R}(a).$$

In particular  $G$  cannot vanish there. □

**Proposition 12.229** (Weighted-defect recursion on post-anchor chambers). *Assume the setting of Proposition 12.228. Let*

$$q_1 > q_2 > \cdots > q_N$$

*be successive odd-order zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  crossed by the anchor along the continued branch after the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber, and set*

$$I_j := (q_{j+1}, q_j) \quad (1 \leq j \leq N - 1).$$

*Assume that the continued branch exists real-analytically on*

$$\bigcup_{j=1}^{N-1} I_j.$$

*For each  $j$ , let*

$$\epsilon_j := \operatorname{sgn}(\mathcal{R}|_{I_j}) \in \{\pm 1\}, \quad m_j(a) := \int_a^{q_j} e^{-\mathcal{A}(s)} |\mathcal{R}(s)| ds \quad (a \in I_j),$$

*and*

$$M_j := m_j(q_{j+1}) > 0.$$

*Then on each  $I_j$ ,*

$$\mathcal{G}(a) = \mathcal{G}(q_j) + \epsilon_j m_j(a).$$

Consequently:

(1) if

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_j) = \epsilon_j,$$

then  $\mathcal{G}$  has no zero on  $I_j$ ;

(2) if

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_j) = -\epsilon_j,$$

then  $\mathcal{G}$  has a zero on  $I_j$  if and only if

$$M_j > |\mathcal{G}(q_j)|,$$

and in that case the zero is unique;

(3) if  $\mathcal{G}$  has no zero on  $I_j$ , then

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_{j+1}) = \operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_j).$$

Since  $\epsilon_{j+1} = -\epsilon_j$ , the chamber type

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_j) \text{ versus } \epsilon_j$$

alternates from one post-anchor chamber to the next as long as no rooted crossing has yet occurred.

*Proof.* On  $I_j$  one has

$$\mathcal{G}'(a) = -e^{-\mathcal{A}(a)} \mathcal{R}(a) = -\epsilon_j e^{-\mathcal{A}(a)} |\mathcal{R}(a)|.$$

Hence for  $a \in I_j$ ,

$$\mathcal{G}(a) = \mathcal{G}(q_j) + \int_{q_j}^a \mathcal{G}'(s) ds = \mathcal{G}(q_j) + \epsilon_j \int_a^{q_j} e^{-\mathcal{A}(s)} |\mathcal{R}(s)| ds,$$

which is the stated formula.

Now  $m_j(a)$  is strictly increasing as  $a$  decreases from  $q_j$  to  $q_{j+1}$ , with

$$m_j(q_j) = 0, \quad m_j(q_{j+1}) = M_j.$$

So if

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_j) = \epsilon_j,$$

then

$$\mathcal{G}(a) = \epsilon_j (|\mathcal{G}(q_j)| + m_j(a))$$

has fixed sign on  $I_j$  and no zero. If instead

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_j) = -\epsilon_j,$$

then

$$\mathcal{G}(a) = \epsilon_j (-|\mathcal{G}(q_j)| + m_j(a)),$$

so a zero occurs precisely when  $m_j(a) = |\mathcal{G}(q_j)|$ , which happens if and only if

$$M_j > |\mathcal{G}(q_j)|.$$

Because  $m_j$  is strictly monotone, that zero is unique.

Finally, if no zero occurs on  $I_j$ , then  $\mathcal{G}$  keeps one sign throughout the interval, so in particular

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_{j+1}) = \operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_j).$$

Since the  $\epsilon_j$  alternate at successive odd zeros, the relative chamber type alternates as claimed.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.230** (The first post-anchor chamber is dangerous). *Let  $q_1$  be the first odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$  crossed by the anchor after the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber, and let*

$$I_1 := (q_2, q_1)$$

*be the first post-anchor chamber. Assume the continued born branch extends real-analytically across  $q_1$  and on  $I_1$ . Then:*

(1) *no rooted crossing occurs at  $q_1$  or immediately after crossing it;*

(2) on  $I_1$  one has

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_1) = -\epsilon_1,$$

so  $I_1$  is the first dangerous post-anchor chamber;

(3) as long as no rooted crossing has yet occurred, the post-anchor chambers alternate dangerous/safe/dangerous/safe...

In particular, the first chamber in which a rooted crossing is even eligible after the anchor-sign-preservation interval is the first post-anchor chamber. Without an additional diagonal-capture theorem, however, this eligibility does not by itself determine the odd-zero count on the active segment.

*Proof.* The adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber is root-free by Corollary 12.226. At its left endpoint  $q_1$ , the anchor crosses an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Proposition 12.228 shows that  $\mathcal{G}$  keeps its incoming sign across  $q_1$ , while  $\mathcal{R}$  changes sign there. Thus on the outgoing chamber  $I_1$  the signs are opposite:

$$\operatorname{sgn} \mathcal{G}(q_1) = -\epsilon_1.$$

The no-root statement at and immediately after  $q_1$  is also exactly Proposition 12.228. The alternation of chamber types then follows from Proposition 12.229(3).  $\square$

**Remark 12.231** (No-go for purely local scalar exclusion on the first dangerous post-anchor chamber). At a rooted critical point, after normalizing the active interval to

$$x = a + sL, \quad 0 \leq s \leq 1, \quad L = \tau(a) - a,$$

the profile

$$R_a(s) := \mathcal{R}(a + sL)$$

satisfies the two local scalar moment identities

$$\int_0^1 (1-s)^2 R_a(s) ds = 0, \quad \int_0^1 s(1-s) R_a(s) ds = 0.$$

Once nonlocal-target landing is admitted, the first dangerous post-anchor chamber need not correspond to a fixed odd-zero count or to a rigid four-lobe pattern on the active segment. Even in the simplest three-lobe sign pattern

$$+, -, +$$

(or its global negative), the local scalar rooted equations are already formally realizable.

Indeed, for any  $A > 0$ , define

$$R_A(s) := \begin{cases} A, & 0 < s < \frac{1}{3}, \\ -\frac{7}{2}A, & \frac{1}{3} < s < \frac{2}{3}, \\ \frac{11}{2}A, & \frac{2}{3} < s < 1. \end{cases}$$

A direct calculation gives

$$\int_0^1 (1-s)^2 R_A(s) ds = 0, \quad \int_0^1 s(1-s) R_A(s) ds = 0,$$

and also

$$\int_0^1 R_A(s) ds = \int_0^1 s R_A(s) ds = \int_0^1 s^2 R_A(s) ds = A.$$

So the local rooted-point equations and the nondegenerate fold data are already formally compatible with a three-lobe profile.

Thus no argument using only the local normalized rooted profile, the two vanishing scalar moments, and the local transversality/fold signs can exclude rooting on the first dangerous post-anchor chamber. Any successful next step must use genuinely source-coupled structure invisible in the planar normalized  $D_a$  model.

**Remark 12.232** (What route 2 now reduces to). The discriminant analysis first showed that a rooted point is not born *at the entry* into the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber. The stronger anchor-sign argument showed more: on any continuation interval on which the anchor-side value

$$\mathcal{R}(a)$$

keeps a fixed sign, the RH-selected slice

$$\gamma = \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

cannot cross the discriminant curve at all.

The odd-anchor analysis sharpened this further: when the anchor itself passes through an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the integrating-factor defect

$$\mathcal{G}(a) = e^{-\mathcal{A}(a)}(D_a(\tau(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a))$$

keeps its incoming sign across that odd anchor zero, so a rooted crossing cannot occur there or immediately after passage. The subsequent post-anchor chambers then alternate dangerous and safe, beginning with a dangerous first post-anchor chamber (Corollary 12.230).

However, two no-go facts are now clear. First, Remark 12.231 shows that already on that first dangerous post-anchor chamber, the local normalized rooted equations and fold data are formally realizable in the planar scalar model. Second, the current route-2 source package itself is still universal under the normalized lift

$$c = 1, \quad v_5 = t, \quad \lambda = t^2, \quad u_5'' = 2\mathcal{Z}$$

(Proposition 12.233 below), so even the source-level objects

$$\Psi_a, \quad \mathfrak{D}, \quad \mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}, \quad D_{f_a}$$

do not yet distinguish the RH branch from an arbitrary analytic normalized model.

So route 2 no longer reduces merely to a delayed no-crossing / profile-realizability problem *within the current package*. It reduces to finding the first genuinely *non-universal* source-coupled input, i.e. an ingredient not already captured by the normalized planar  $D_a$  model.

**Proposition 12.233** (Universality threshold for the current route-2 package). *Let  $I \subset \mathbf{R}$  be an interval, let*

$$\mathcal{Z} : I \rightarrow \mathbf{R}$$

*be real-analytic, and set*

$$\mathcal{R} := \mathcal{Z}'.$$

*Define analytic source functions on  $I$  by*

$$c(t) := 1, \quad v_5(t) := t, \quad \lambda(t) := t^2,$$

*and choose  $u_5$  so that*

$$u_5''(t) = 2\mathcal{Z}(t).$$

*Then:*

(1)

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c} = t, \quad S = \frac{\lambda}{c} = t^2, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c} = u_5;$$

(2) *for every analytic  $f$ ,*

$$J_f = W(c, v_5, f) = W(1, t, f) = f'',$$

*hence*

$$J_\lambda = 2, \quad J_{u_5} = 2\mathcal{Z}, \quad \mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda = 4\mathcal{R};$$

(3) *the repeated-source ratio is exactly the normalized planar one:*

$$\Psi_a(h) = \Gamma_a(h) = D_a(h);$$

(4) *the critical determinant equation is exactly the normalized planar critical-point equation:*

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0 \iff \partial_h \Psi_a(h) = 0 \iff \partial_h D_a(h) = 0;$$

(5) for the source-pinned moving shear

$$f_a := u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda,$$

one has

$$J_{f_a} = 2(\mathcal{Z} - \mathcal{Z}(a)),$$

and

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = D_\lambda(a, h)(\Psi_a(h) - \mathcal{Z}(a)).$$

Thus every analytic normalized planar model  $(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R}, D_a)$  lifts to a genuine analytic source model for the entire current route-2 package.

*Proof.* The identities

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c} = t, \quad S = \frac{\lambda}{c} = t^2, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c} = u_5$$

are immediate. Also,

$$J_f = W(c, v_5, f) = W(1, t, f) = f'',$$

so

$$J_\lambda = 2, \quad J_{u_5} = 2\mathcal{Z}.$$

Hence

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda = 2(2\mathcal{Z}') - 2\mathcal{Z} \cdot 0 = 4\mathcal{R}.$$

Because the source coordinate and the normalized planar coordinate coincide,

$$x(t) = t,$$

the source repeated-source quotient is exactly the planar normalized quadratic envelope:

$$\Psi_a(h) = \Gamma_a(h) = D_a(h).$$

Therefore the source critical determinant equation is exactly the planar critical-point equation

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0 \iff \partial_h D_a(h) = 0.$$

Finally,

$$f_a = u_5 - \mathcal{Z}(a)\lambda$$

satisfies

$$J_{f_a} = u_5'' - 2\mathcal{Z}(a) = 2(\mathcal{Z} - \mathcal{Z}(a)),$$

and Proposition 12.201(2) gives

$$D_{f_a}(a, h) = D_\lambda(a, h)(\Psi_a(h) - \mathcal{Z}(a)).$$

So all route-2 source objects reduce exactly to the normalized planar ones.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.234** (The current route-2 package is universal under normalization). *Any configuration formally realizable by an analytic normalized planar model*

$$(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R}, D_a)$$

*is also formally realizable by a genuine analytic source model for the current route-2 package*

$$(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5), \quad \Psi_a, \quad \mathfrak{D}, \quad \mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}, \quad D_{f_a}.$$

Accordingly, no contradiction theorem phrased only in terms of the current route-2 package can distinguish the RH branch from an arbitrary analytic normalized planar model.

*Proof.* This is immediate from Proposition 12.233.  $\square$

**Remark 12.235** (Explicit source-level countermodel to the current route-2 package). Take

$$\mathcal{R}(t) := t(t-1)(t^2 - 4t - 2)$$

and

$$\mathcal{Z}(t) := \int_0^t \mathcal{R}(u) du = \frac{1}{5}t^5 - \frac{5}{4}t^4 + \frac{2}{3}t^3 + t^2,$$

and realize this normalized planar model by

$$c(t) = 1, \quad v_5(t) = t, \quad \lambda(t) = t^2, \quad u_5''(t) = 2\mathcal{Z}(t).$$

Let

$$q := 2 - \sqrt{6}.$$

In this genuine analytic source model, the unique born repeated-source critical branch from the odd zero 0 continues analytically down to  $a = q$ , lands there with a nonlocal target

$$\tau(q) \approx 0.3540339256 \neq q,$$

satisfies the anchor-sign safe relation on  $(q, 0)$ , crosses the odd anchor zero  $q$  with no sign reset, and then undergoes a delayed rooted crossing at

$$a_* \approx -0.5805673462, \quad \tau(a_*) \approx 0.3888336023.$$

Thus diagonal capture fails, and the whole delayed-crossing scenario is realized inside a genuine analytic source model for the current route-2 package.

**Remark 12.236** (The next live target must be non-universal). By Corollary 12.234, the present lower route-2 package is exhausted: any further progress must use a genuinely non-universal source-coupled input, i.e. an ingredient not already absorbed by the normalized planar model  $(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R}, D_a)$ .

However, the thread analysis shows that this non-universal input cannot be identified merely with arbitrary canonical quotient-septic geometry, nor even with the explicit direct  $q^{(7)}$ -slice by itself. Indeed, Remark 12.99 shows that arbitrary canonical  $\Delta_7$  is still locally free once the lower one-pair data are fixed, and Proposition 13.3 together with Corollary 13.4 show that the direct highest-new provenance slice

$$\phi = A q^{(7)}$$

is fully universal on each generic one-pair block, even after any finite family of linear provenance/matching conditions on  $q$ .

So any viable continuation must use something stronger: either a *continuum-strength provenance law* for  $q$  on a whole block, or an external mixed/canonical theorem that constrains  $q$  beyond finite jet data. Within the present draft, the first plausible places for such genuinely non-universal input lie in the mixed / canonical package above arbitrary quotient-septic geometry.

**Remark 12.237** (What remains on the nonmixed 4-point side). The preceding results now give a full local derivative-side picture of the nonmixed exact-contact geometry. Exact nonmixed tangent-plane contacts force zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  (Proposition 12.175); intervals on which  $\mathcal{R}$  has fixed nonzero sign are exactly-contact sterile (Corollary 12.176); recurrent exact contacts force affine-planar collapse (Corollary 12.179); and isolated zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  are classified by parity (Proposition 12.181).

At source level, the same structure is encoded by the gauge-invariant Wronskian

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda,$$

which differs from  $\mathcal{R}$  only by a nonvanishing analytic factor on a nonmixed arc (Proposition 12.149). Thus exact nonmixed contacts force zeros of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ , one-sign  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ -intervals are sterile, and recurrent contacts force  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} \equiv 0$  (Corollary 12.188).

Moreover, Proposition 12.190 lifts  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  to the  $4 \times 4$  Wronskian

$$W(c, v_5, \lambda, u_5),$$

while Proposition 12.191 shows that, at the current source-level ratio/Wronskian/ $4 \times 4$ -determinant level, the odd-zero pattern of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  and  $\mathcal{R}$  is still formally unconstrained. Thus generic determinant algebra alone is no longer enough to close the nonmixed branch.

The repeated-source / first-loss lane is now also closed. For each fixed source point  $a$ , repeated-source exact contacts factor through the quadratic-envelope scalar

$$\Gamma_a(x) = \frac{Y(x) - Y(a) - Y'(a)(x - a)}{S(x) - S(a) - S'(a)(x - a)},$$

equivalently through the source-determinant quotient

$$\Psi_a(h) = \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)},$$

with derivative controlled by the osculatory determinant  $\mathfrak{D}(a, h)$ . The formal first-loss event rigidifies to a sheared repeated-node tangent-contact configuration (Remark 12.193), but this is no longer a live independent bottleneck. Proposition 12.203 shows that no attained separated first loss can occur, every first-loss sequence is forced to the diagonal, and diagonal first loss occurs exactly at isolated odd-order zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Moreover, Proposition 12.198 shows that for each fixed shear level  $\gamma$ , the corresponding sheared opposite-side 3-point branch is globally rigid on its maximal slope-overlap block; and Proposition 12.183 together with Corollary 12.184 show that near an isolated odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the diagonal critical branch is uniformly unrooted, so the rooted sheared repeated-node tangent-contact event itself does not occur there. Thus the sheared lane is closed both in the fixed- $\gamma$  nonrecurrence direction and in the local isolated-odd-zero direction.

Accordingly, the genuinely live nonmixed 4-point burden is no longer local birth, nor repeated-source first loss, nor generic determinant sign. The positive-kernel route now shows more: on any chamber where the repeated-source segment sees exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the born critical branch is simple, has strictly negative slope, and cannot realize the rigidified first-loss condition

$$\Gamma_a(x) = \mathcal{Z}(a).$$

At source level, the same branch is characterized by

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0,$$

but Proposition 12.201 shows that its rooted numerator

$$D_{u_5}(a, h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, h)$$

has a fixed signed leading term near an isolated odd zero, so the local branch is uniformly unrooted there. Thus a local branch of

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0$$

cannot become a genuine obstruction until the source segment acquires a second odd zero (equivalently a second sign-changing zero) of

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}},$$

or exits the local one-sign-change chamber. By Proposition 12.216, the positive-kernel route already excludes every opened nonmixed arc carrying at most one odd zero of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  (equivalently of  $\mathcal{R}$ ).

Moreover, once one follows an analytic continuation of the born branch beyond the local birth chamber, the rooted defect

$$G(a) = D_a(\tau(a)) - \mathcal{Z}(a)$$

satisfies an exact first-order transport equation, and any nondegenerate rooted point is forced to be a stationary point of the target map and a local fold of the moving-shear equation

$$A_a(x) - \mathcal{Z}(a) B_a(x) = 0$$

(Propositions 12.213 and 12.214). The discriminant analysis rules out birth of such a rooted point at entry into the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber (Proposition 12.211), and the anchor-sign argument rules out any rooted crossing on a continuation interval on which the anchor-side value

$$\mathcal{R}(a)$$

keeps a fixed sign (Proposition 12.225 and Corollary 12.226).

Beyond that, Proposition 12.228 shows that even after the anchor crosses an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , no rooted crossing can occur at that odd anchor zero itself or immediately after passage, while Corollary 12.230 shows that the ensuing post-anchor chambers alternate dangerous and safe. However, Remark 12.231 shows that the local normalized rooted equations and fold data are already formally compatible with rooting on the first dangerous post-anchor chamber. More strongly, Proposition 12.233 and Corollary 12.234 show that the entire current route-2 source package is universal under normalization, and Remark 12.235 exhibits a genuine analytic source model realizing safe adjacent-two-odd-zero behavior, nonlocal-target landing at the next odd anchor zero, odd-anchor no-reset, and delayed rooted crossing.

So the sharpened remaining nonmixed burden is no longer a delayed no-crossing / profile-realizability theorem *within the current route-2 package*. The current lower package is already exhausted, and the thread analysis shows that arbitrary canonical quotient-septic geometry is still too free, while even the explicit direct provenance slice

$$\phi = A q^{(7)}$$

is fully universal on each generic one-pair block. More strongly, any finite family of linear provenance or matching conditions on  $q$  is still too weak to exclude direct-slice recurrence geometry.

Accordingly, any further progress must use a genuinely non-universal continuum-strength provenance law for  $q$ , or else an external mixed/canonical input that constrains  $q$  on a whole block and is not already absorbed by the normalized planar model  $(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R}, D_a)$ .

**Remark 12.238** (Compact status summary for the nonmixed 4-point branch). The nonmixed 4-point branch is now reduced to a source-level odd-zero problem. Locally, exact nonmixed contacts force zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ , and isolated zeros are classified by parity: even-order zeros are sterile, while odd-order zeros seed local exact contacts. Repeated-source first loss is not a separate mechanism: it occurs if and only if one diagonally approaches an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . The sheared repeated-node lane is also closed in the collapse direction: any genuine diagonal realization of the rigidified sheared event already forces  $\mathcal{R} \equiv 0$  locally, hence affine-planar collapse.

On a nonmixed arc, the same structure is encoded by the gauge-invariant source-level Wronskian

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda,$$

which differs from  $\mathcal{R}$  only by a nonvanishing analytic factor. Repeated-source first loss is not a separate mechanism: it occurs if and only if one diagonally approaches an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , and the corresponding rooted sheared repeated-node event is locally absent near an isolated odd zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Near such an isolated odd zero, the born repeated-source branch

$$\mathfrak{D}(a, h) = 0$$

is uniformly unrooted at source level:

$$D_{u_5}(a, h) - \mathcal{Z}(x(a)) D_\lambda(a, h) \neq 0$$

with a fixed signed leading term (Proposition 12.201). For each fixed shear level  $\gamma$ , the associated sheared opposite-side 3-point branch is globally rigid on its maximal slope-overlap block. Moreover, the positive-kernel / source-determinant route now excludes every opened nonmixed arc carrying at most one odd zero of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ : on any chamber where the repeated-source segment sees exactly one sign change of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the born critical branch is simple, has strictly negative slope, and cannot realize the rigidified first-loss condition. Beyond that chamber, the discriminant analysis rules out birth of a rooted point at entry into the adjacent-two-odd-zero chamber, and the anchor-sign argument rules out any crossing on a continuation interval where the anchor-side value

$$\mathcal{R}(a)$$

keeps a fixed sign.

The odd-anchor passage theorem shows that once the anchor itself crosses an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , the integrating-factor defect keeps its incoming sign across that odd anchor zero,



so no rooted crossing can occur there or immediately after it. The subsequent post-anchor chambers alternate dangerous and safe. However, the local normalized rooted equations and the local fold/transversality data are already formally realizable on the first dangerous post-anchor chamber, and more strongly the entire current route-2 source package is universal under normalization. Even arbitrary canonical quotient-septic geometry remains too free, and the explicit direct provenance slice

$$\phi = A q^{(7)}$$

is fully universal on each generic one-pair block; indeed, even after any finite family of linear provenance/matching conditions on  $q$ , direct-slice recurrence geometry is still realizable. Thus the genuinely remaining nonmixed burden is no longer a problem inside the current route-2 or arbitrary quotient-septic package at all. Any further progress must use a genuinely non-universal continuum-strength provenance law for  $q$ , or an external mixed/canonical theorem that constrains  $q$  on a whole block and is not already absorbed by the normalized planar model.

**Remark 12.239** (Derivative-geometry meaning of the nonmixed invariant  $\mathcal{R}$ ). On a nonmixed patch,

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2} = \frac{d}{dx} \left( \frac{Y''}{S''} \right).$$

Thus  $\mathcal{R}$  measures the failure of the lifted space curve

$$x \mapsto (Y(x), x, S(x))$$

to be affine-planar at the derivative level:  $\mathcal{R} = 0$  means the ratio  $Y''/S''$  is locally constant, equivalently that the curve has vanishing affine torsion and lies in an affine plane after integrating twice. In this sense, the nonmixed 4-point branch is controlled by a single scalar derivative invariant rather than by raw coplanarity alone.

**Remark 12.240** (Exact mixed reduction in terms of  $\mathcal{Z}$  and  $\mathcal{R}$ ). At a mixed lifted point

$$K_v(0) = 0, \quad T_v(0) = 0,$$

set

$$r := \text{ord}_0 K_v, \quad s := \text{ord}_0 T_v.$$

By Proposition 12.146,

$$K_v = (x')^3 S'',$$

so on a good  $v_5$ -patch one has

$$S''(x) = \kappa x^r + O(x^{r+1}), \quad \kappa \neq 0.$$

After removing affine terms and integrating twice,

$$S(x) = \frac{\kappa}{(r+1)(r+2)} x^{r+2} + O(x^{r+3}).$$

Thus the mixed exponent  $m$  of the monomial model

$$Q_v(x) \sim (x^n, x, x^m)$$

is exactly

$$m = r + 2.$$

Now let  $n$  be the first degree of  $Y(x)$  not absorbed by  $\text{span}\{1, x, S\}$ , so that

$$Y(x) = \alpha x^n + O(x^{n+1}), \quad \alpha \neq 0, \quad n > r + 2.$$

Using

$$T_v = (x')^6 (S'' Y''' - S''' Y''),$$

one finds

$$s = n + r - 3, \quad n = s - r + 3.$$

Equivalently, on the nonmixed complement of  $K_v = 0$ ,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{Y''}{S''}, \quad \mathcal{R} = \mathcal{Z}' = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}$$

satisfy the order bookkeeping

$$\text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z} = n - r - 2 = s - 2r + 1, \quad \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R} = s - 2r.$$

Thus the dangerous low-order mixed models are finite and explicit:

$$(m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6),$$

equivalently

$$(r, s) = (1, 2), (1, 4), (2, 5),$$

equivalently

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) = (1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2),$$

or

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R}) = (1, 0), (1, 2), (2, 1).$$

So the mixed lifted 4-point endgame has also been reduced to a finite jet obstruction list, now phrased in terms of the invariant pair

$$(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R}).$$

**Remark 12.241** (Exact finite obstruction coefficients for the low-order 4-point branch). The explicit low-order 4-point obstruction list can be reduced to a finite jet package.

**Nonmixed side.** Suppose  $K_v(0) \neq 0$ , and write

$$s_k := S^{(k)}(0), \quad y_k := Y^{(k)}(0), \quad s_2 \neq 0.$$

Then the Taylor expansion

$$\mathcal{Z}(x) = z_0 + z_1x + z_2x^2 + z_3x^3 + z_4x^4 + z_5x^5 + z_6x^6 + O(x^7)$$

has canonical even coefficients

$$z_2, \quad z_4, \quad z_6,$$

and the dangerous nonmixed low-order cases are exactly:

$$n = 4 \iff z_2 \neq 0, \quad n = 6 \iff z_2 = 0, \quad z_4 \neq 0, \quad n = 8 \iff z_2 = z_4 = 0, \quad z_6 \neq 0.$$

Explicitly,

$$z_2 = \frac{s_2^2 y_4 - 2s_2 s_3 y_3 + (2s_3^2 - s_2 s_4) y_2}{2s_2^3},$$

$$z_4 = \frac{s_2^4 y_6 - s_2^3 (4s_3 y_5 + 6s_4 y_4 + 4s_5 y_3 + s_6 y_2) + 2s_2^2 (6s_3^2 y_4 + 12s_3 s_4 y_3 + 4s_3 s_5 y_2 + 3s_4^2 y_2) - 12s_2 s_3^2 (2s_3 y_3 + 3s_4 y_2)}{24s_2^5}$$

and

$$z_6 = \frac{\mathcal{P}_8(s_2, \dots, s_8; y_2, \dots, y_8)}{720s_2^7},$$

where  $\mathcal{P}_8$  is the explicit degree-8 numerator polynomial obtained by Taylor division of  $\mathcal{Z} = Y''/S''$ .

**Mixed side.** Suppose  $K_v(0) = T_v(0) = 0$ , and let

$$r := \text{ord}_0 K_v.$$

For the two low-order mixed cases  $r = 1, 2$ , Taylor division of  $\mathcal{Z} = Y''/S''$  gives the exact obstruction coefficients

$$\kappa_{1,1}, \quad \kappa_{1,3}, \quad \kappa_{2,2},$$

defined by the expansions

$$\mathcal{Z}(x) = \frac{y_2}{s_3} \frac{1}{x} + \left( \frac{y_3}{s_3} - \frac{s_4 y_2}{2s_3^2} \right) + \kappa_{1,1}x + \kappa_{1,2}x^2 + \kappa_{1,3}x^3 + O(x^4) \quad (r = 1),$$

and

$$\mathcal{Z}(x) = \frac{2y_2}{s_4} \frac{1}{x^2} + \left( \frac{2y_3}{s_4} - \frac{2s_5 y_2}{3s_4^2} \right) \frac{1}{x} + \left( \frac{y_4}{s_4} - \frac{2s_5 y_3}{3s_4^2} - \frac{s_6 y_2}{6s_4^2} + \frac{2s_5^2 y_2}{9s_4^3} \right) + \kappa_{2,1}x + \kappa_{2,2}x^2 + O(x^3) \quad (r = 2).$$

The dangerous mixed low-order list is then exactly:

$$(m, n) = (3, 4) \iff \kappa_{1,1} \neq 0,$$

$$(m, n) = (3, 6) \iff \kappa_{1,3} \neq 0,$$

$$(m, n) = (4, 6) \iff \kappa_{2,2} \neq 0.$$

Thus the full currently explicit *low-order* 4-point obstruction list is equivalent to the finite set of coefficients

$$\boxed{z_2, z_4, z_6, \kappa_{1,1}, \kappa_{1,3}, \kappa_{2,2}}.$$

On the mixed side, the three coefficients

$$\kappa_{1,1}, \quad \kappa_{1,3}, \quad \kappa_{2,2}$$

exhaust the presently explicit low-order obstruction list.

On the nonmixed side, however, the parity classification from Proposition 12.181 shows that local exact-contact birth occurs at every isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Accordingly,

$$z_2, \quad z_4, \quad z_6$$

should now be viewed only as the first three explicit low-order nonmixed obstruction coefficients, not as a complete local nonmixed list.

**Remark 12.242** (Wronskian-order reformulation of the mixed low-order list). On a good  $v_5$ -patch one has

$$Y'' = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_{u_5}, \quad S'' = \frac{c^3}{M^3} J_\lambda, \quad \mathcal{Z} = \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda}, \quad \lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}.$$

Thus, if

$$r := \text{ord}_0 J_\lambda = \text{ord}_0 K_v, \quad q := \text{ord}_0 J_{u_5} = \text{ord}_0 Y'',$$

then

$$m = r + 2, \quad n = q + 2, \quad \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z} = q - r.$$

Hence the dangerous mixed models

$$(m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6)$$

are exactly the Wronskian order-pairs

$$(\text{ord}_0 J_\lambda, \text{ord}_0 J_{u_5}) = (1, 2), (1, 4), (2, 4).$$

If

$$J_\lambda(x) = x^r A(x), \quad J_{u_5}(x) = x^r B(x), \quad A(0) \neq 0,$$

then

$$\mathcal{Z}(x) = \frac{B(x)}{A(x)}.$$

For  $r = 1$ , the coefficients  $\kappa_{1,1}$  and  $\kappa_{1,3}$  are exactly the  $x^1$ - and  $x^3$ -coefficients of the regularized ratio  $B/A$ ; for  $r = 2$ ,  $\kappa_{2,2}$  is exactly the  $x^2$ -coefficient of  $B/A$ .

Moreover, since

$$J_c = J_{v_5} = 0,$$

replacing

$$u_5 \mapsto u_5 + a c + b v_5 + \gamma \lambda$$

changes  $J_{u_5}$  only by

$$J_{u_5} \mapsto J_{u_5} + \gamma J_\lambda.$$

Thus the nonconstant Taylor coefficients of  $\mathcal{Z}$  are canonical. In particular, the currently explicit mixed low-order list is already a finite Wronskian-ratio obstruction list.

**Proposition 12.243** (Projective secant-shadow reduction on an overlap patch). *Let*

$$U \subseteq \{c \neq 0, u_5 \neq 0, v_5 \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$$

*be a good overlap patch. Set*

$$\lambda := \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}, \quad x := \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad Y := \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad S := \frac{\lambda}{c} = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

Assume there exists a close exact mixed two-point bad branch

$$(h_{1,n}, h_{2,n}, \Lambda_n), \quad h_{1,n} \neq h_{2,n}, \quad h_{1,n}, h_{2,n} \in U, \quad h_{1,n}, h_{2,n} \rightarrow m \in U,$$

and let  $(\eta_n, \xi_n, \gamma_n)$  be the branch-generated moving  $\lambda$ -shears, so that

$$\begin{aligned} (c - \eta_n \lambda)(h_{1,n}) &= \Lambda_n(c - \eta_n \lambda)(h_{2,n}), \\ (v_5 - \xi_n \lambda)(h_{1,n}) &= \Lambda_n(v_5 - \xi_n \lambda)(h_{2,n}), \\ (u_5 - \gamma_n \lambda)(h_{1,n}) &= \Lambda_n(u_5 - \gamma_n \lambda)(h_{2,n}). \end{aligned}$$

For each  $n$ , set

$$A_n := c - \eta_n \lambda, \quad B_n := v_5 - \xi_n \lambda, \quad F_n := u_5 - \gamma_n \lambda.$$

Then, after discarding finitely many terms, the branch determines the exact projective secant shadow

$$\Sigma(h_{1,n}, h_{2,n}) := [x_1 S_2 - x_2 S_1 : Y_1 S_2 - Y_2 S_1 : S_2 - S_1],$$

where

$$x_i = x(h_{i,n}), \quad Y_i = Y(h_{i,n}), \quad S_i = S(h_{i,n}).$$

More precisely, for all large  $n$  one has the exact identity

$$[B_n(h_{1,n}) : F_n(h_{1,n}) : A_n(h_{1,n})] = [B_n(h_{2,n}) : F_n(h_{2,n}) : A_n(h_{2,n})] = \Sigma(h_{1,n}, h_{2,n}).$$

In particular, the secant shadow is independent of the moving shears  $(\eta_n, \xi_n, \gamma_n)$  and of  $\Lambda_n$ .

Equivalently, in raw coordinates,

$$\Sigma(h_1, h_2) = [v_{5,1} \lambda_2 - v_{5,2} \lambda_1 : u_{5,1} \lambda_2 - u_{5,2} \lambda_1 : c_1 \lambda_2 - c_2 \lambda_1].$$

As  $h_2 \rightarrow h_1 = a$ , the secant shadow converges projectively to the tangent shadow

$$\Pi(a) := [x S_x - S : Y S_x - S Y_x : S_x] \Big|_{x=x(a)}.$$

A direct calculation gives

$$\Pi(x) \wedge \partial_x \Pi(x) = S(x) (S_x Y_{xx} - S_{xx} Y_x, S_{xx}, -S_{xx}).$$

Hence  $\Pi$  is projectively immersive wherever

$$S \neq 0 \quad \text{and} \quad S_{xx} \neq 0.$$

Since on the  $v_5$ -patch

$$K_v = (x')^3 S_{xx},$$

any such close exact mixed two-point bad branch can accumulate only on

$$\{S = 0\} \cup \{K_v = 0\}.$$

*Proof.* Since

$$x' = \left(\frac{v_5}{c}\right)' = \frac{M}{c^2},$$

the hypothesis  $M \neq 0$  implies that  $x = v_5/c$  is a local coordinate near  $m$ . After discarding finitely many terms we may therefore assume

$$x(h_{1,n}) \neq x(h_{2,n}).$$

Fix such an  $n$ , and abbreviate

$$\eta = \eta_n, \quad \xi = \xi_n, \quad \gamma = \gamma_n.$$

Write

$$p_i := (x_i, Y_i, 1) \in \mathbf{R}^3, \quad V := (\xi, \gamma, \eta) \in \mathbf{R}^3, \quad i = 1, 2.$$

Since

$$A_n = c(1 - \eta S), \quad B_n = c(x - \xi S), \quad F_n = c(Y - \gamma S),$$

the exact repeated-source equations imply

$$[B_n(h_{1,n}) : F_n(h_{1,n}) : A_n(h_{1,n})] = [p_1 - S_1 V]$$

and

$$[B_n(h_{2,n}) : F_n(h_{2,n}) : A_n(h_{2,n})] = [p_2 - S_2 V].$$

Because these two projective points are equal, there is a common projective value.

If  $S_1 = S_2$ , then

$$[p_1 - S_1 V] = [p_2 - S_1 V]$$

forces  $p_1 = p_2$ , hence  $x_1 = x_2$ , contradicting the choice of local coordinate. Therefore

$$S_1 \neq S_2.$$

Subtracting

$$p_1 - S_1 V = p_2 - S_2 V$$

gives

$$p_1 - p_2 = (S_1 - S_2)V,$$

hence

$$V = \frac{p_1 - p_2}{S_1 - S_2}.$$

Substituting back,

$$p_1 - S_1 V = p_1 - S_1 \frac{p_1 - p_2}{S_1 - S_2} = \frac{S_2 p_1 - S_1 p_2}{S_2 - S_1}.$$

Therefore the common projective value is exactly

$$[S_2 p_1 - S_1 p_2] = [x_1 S_2 - x_2 S_1 : Y_1 S_2 - Y_2 S_1 : S_2 - S_1],$$

which is the asserted secant shadow and is independent of  $(\eta_n, \xi_n, \gamma_n)$  and of  $\Lambda_n$ . The raw-coordinate formula is the same identity multiplied through by  $c_1 c_2$ .

Now divide the homogeneous secant vector by  $x_2 - x_1$  and let  $h_2 \rightarrow h_1 = a$ . The three components converge to

$$x S_x - S, \quad Y S_x - S Y_x, \quad S_x,$$

so the secant shadow converges projectively to

$$\mathbf{\Pi}(a) = [x S_x - S : Y S_x - S Y_x : S_x].$$

Differentiating  $\mathbf{\Pi}$  in the local  $x$ -coordinate gives

$$\mathbf{\Pi}(x) \wedge \partial_x \mathbf{\Pi}(x) = S(x) (S_x Y_{xx} - S_{xx} Y_x, S_{xx}, -S_{xx}).$$

Therefore  $\mathbf{\Pi}$  is projectively immersive wherever  $S \neq 0$  and  $S_{xx} \neq 0$ . On a close bad branch the secant shadows converge to tangent shadows, so accumulation is possible only where immersion fails, i.e. on

$$\{S = 0\} \cup \{S_{xx} = 0\}.$$

Finally, on the  $v_5$ -patch one has

$$K_v = (x')^3 S_{xx},$$

so  $\{S_{xx} = 0\} = \{K_v = 0\}$  on  $U$ . □

**Remark 12.244** (Useful overlap scalar). On the same overlap patch, set

$$\tau_u := -\frac{\Delta_7}{c u_5}, \quad \mathcal{G} := x' S_x + Y' \tau'_u.$$

Then  $\mathcal{G}$  admits the exact factorization

$$\mathcal{G} = -\frac{W(u_5, v_5) W(u_5, \lambda)}{c^2 u_5^2}, \quad \lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5},$$

where  $W(f, g) = f g' - f' g$ . Equivalently,

$$\mathcal{G} = \frac{u_5 v'_5 - u'_5 v_5}{c^2} \left( \frac{\Delta_7}{u_5 v_5} \right)'.$$

In particular,  $\mathcal{G} \neq 0$  on any connected overlap patch contained in  $\{c \neq 0, M \neq 0\}$ : the factor  $W(u_5, v_5)$  cannot vanish identically there without forcing linear dependence of

$$1, \quad \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad \frac{v_5}{c},$$

and  $W(u_5, \lambda)$  cannot vanish identically there without forcing

$$\Delta_7 = \kappa u_5 v_5,$$

which is incompatible with the direct septic slice carried by  $\Delta_7$ . This does not yet exclude the mixed two-point branch, but it records the first genuinely nontrivial  $Y$ - $S$  overlap coupling scalar exposed by the current attack.

**Proposition 12.245** (Exact fixed-shear overlap branches off  $K_v = 0$  force a fold at  $S = 0$ ). *Work on the overlap patch of Proposition 12.243, and write*

$$\Phi(x) := \left( \frac{x - \xi_* S}{1 - \eta_* S}, \frac{Y - \gamma_* S}{1 - \eta_* S} \right), \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

*Assume there is a close exact fixed-shear mixed 2-point branch*

$$x_{1,n} \neq x_{2,n}, \quad x_{1,n}, x_{2,n} \rightarrow a, \quad \Phi(x_{1,n}) = \Phi(x_{2,n}) \quad (n \geq 1).$$

*If*

$$K_v(a) \neq 0,$$

*then*

$$S(a) = 0, \quad \Phi'(a) = 0, \quad S_x(a) \neq 0.$$

*More precisely,*

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= \Phi'_1(a) = 1 - (\xi_* - \eta_* x(a)) S_x(a), \\ 0 &= \Phi'_2(a) = Y_x(a) - (\gamma_* - \eta_* Y(a)) S_x(a). \end{aligned}$$

*In particular, setting*

$$\beta := \xi_* - \eta_* x(a) = \frac{1}{S_x(a)},$$

*and centering the local  $x$ -coordinate at  $a$ , the first-coordinate fold model*

$$U(x) := (x - x(a)) - \beta S(x)$$

*satisfies*

$$U(a) = 0, \quad U_x(a) = 0, \quad U_{xx}(a) = -\beta S_{xx}(a) \neq 0.$$

*Hence, after analytic source reparametrization, the first coordinate of the fixed-shear projected germ is*

$$t^2.$$

*So any exact fixed-shear mixed branch away from  $K_v = 0$  is already forced into the same fold regime that underlies the nonmixed odd-zero analysis; the only remaining issue there is the second-coordinate parity package.*

*Proof.* A fixed-shear branch is, in particular, a close exact mixed two-point bad branch on the same overlap patch. By Proposition 12.243, any accumulation point of such a branch lies in

$$\{S = 0\} \cup \{K_v = 0\}.$$

So if  $K_v(a) \neq 0$ , then necessarily

$$S(a) = 0.$$

Because

$$\Phi(x_{1,n}) = \Phi(x_{2,n}), \quad x_{1,n} \neq x_{2,n}, \quad x_{1,n}, x_{2,n} \rightarrow a,$$

the mean value theorem applied to each coordinate of  $\Phi$  gives points

$$\zeta_{1,n}, \zeta_{2,n} \in (x_{1,n}, x_{2,n})$$

such that

$$\Phi'_1(\zeta_{1,n}) = 0, \quad \Phi'_2(\zeta_{2,n}) = 0.$$

Passing to the limit yields

$$\Phi'(a) = 0.$$

Differentiating the two coordinates of  $\Phi$  gives

$$\Phi'_1 = \frac{1 - (\xi_* - \eta_* x) S_x - \eta_* S}{(1 - \eta_* S)^2},$$

$$\Phi'_2 = \frac{Y_x - (\gamma_* - \eta_* Y)S_x - \eta_* S Y_x}{(1 - \eta_* S)^2}.$$

Evaluating at  $x = a$  and using  $S(a) = 0$  yields the displayed identities

$$0 = \Phi'_1(a) = 1 - (\xi_* - \eta_* x(a))S_x(a),$$

$$0 = \Phi'_2(a) = Y_x(a) - (\gamma_* - \eta_* Y(a))S_x(a).$$

The first identity implies

$$S_x(a) \neq 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \beta := \xi_* - \eta_* x(a) = \frac{1}{S_x(a)}.$$

Now center the local  $x$ -coordinate at  $a$  and set

$$U(x) := (x - x(a)) - \beta S(x).$$

Then

$$U(a) = 0, \quad U_x(a) = 1 - \beta S_x(a) = 0, \quad U_{xx}(a) = -\beta S_{xx}(a).$$

Since on the  $v_5$ -patch

$$K_v = (x')^3 S_{xx}, \quad x' = \frac{M}{c^2} \neq 0,$$

the hypothesis  $K_v(a) \neq 0$  implies

$$S_{xx}(a) \neq 0.$$

Hence

$$U_{xx}(a) \neq 0.$$

By the analytic Morse lemma in one variable, after analytic source reparametrization the first coordinate is  $t^2$ .  $\square$

**Remark 12.246** (Status of the mixed  $\lambda$ -shear route). Proposition 12.243 shows that the downstream secant-shadow reduction is already exact and fully projective: a close exact mixed two-point bad branch determines the projective secant shadow

$$\Sigma(h_1, h_2) = [x_1 S_2 - x_2 S_1 : Y_1 S_2 - Y_2 S_1 : S_2 - S_1], \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5},$$

independently of any affine freezing of the branch-generated  $\lambda$ -shears.

Proposition 12.245 sharpens the *conditional exact fixed-shear* lane: if one does obtain an exact fixed-shear overlap reduction and the accumulation point lies off

$$K_v = 0,$$

then the complementary slice

$$\{S = 0\} \cap \{K_v \neq 0\}$$

is already forced into a fold-type projection regime. So, in that fixed-shear lane, the only missing step is to identify the second-coordinate parity with the existing nonmixed odd-zero  $\mathcal{R}$ -package. In particular, the only clearly genuinely mixed accumulation locus already visible on the overlap patch is

$$K_v = 0.$$

What remains unresolved on the two-point side as a whole is therefore: the finite-order source-level merger route; the quotient-diagonal continuity/diagonal-collapse route; and, on the derivative-geometric side, either a projective control of the

$$S = 0$$

slice without exact freezing, or a proof that the exact fixed-shear overlap lane is absorbed by the nonmixed odd-zero package. The explicit mixed low-order obstruction list remains the finite Wronskian-order list recorded in Remark 12.242.

*Frame convention for the scalar block.* On the cubic-generic one-pair locus we fix the cubic-normalized frame so that the distinguished cubic line is the diagonal-traceless line  $\mathbf{CD}$ , with

$$D = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad J_0 D J_0 = -D.$$

Thus the scalar coefficient extracted below is not an auxiliary choice: it is the canonical coefficient of the cubic line in this fixed cubic-generic frame.

**Definition 12.247** (Canonical scalar extraction from the raw one-pair stack). Let

$$R(z) = A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + A_7 z^7 + O(z^9)$$

be a cubic-generic raw one-pair corrected germ in the cubic-normalized frame. Write

$$I = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad S = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad K = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

We use the Frobenius pairing

$$\langle X, Y \rangle_F := \text{tr}(X^* Y).$$

The scalar channel of the cubic coefficient is defined by projection to the diagonal-traceless line  $\mathbf{CD}$ :

$$c(R) := \frac{\langle A_3, D \rangle_F}{\langle D, D \rangle_F} = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(D A_3).$$

Equivalently, the scalar normalization equations are

$$\pi_I(A_3) = 0, \quad \pi_S(A_3) = 0, \quad \pi_K(A_3) = 0, \quad A_3 = c(R) D,$$

where  $\pi_I, \pi_S, \pi_K$  denote the Frobenius projections to the lines  $\mathbf{CI}, \mathbf{CS}, \mathbf{CK}$ .

**Remark 12.248** (Compatibility with the existing gauge laws). By the already-proved gauge law

$$A_3^{\text{new}} = A_3,$$

the cubic coefficient is unchanged by the admissible one-pair normalization gauge. Hence the scalar extraction in Definition 12.247 is gauge independent on the raw one-pair stack.

**Lemma 12.249** (Scalar normalization is  $\Sigma$ -invariant). *Let*

$$\Sigma(F)(z) := J_0 F(-z) J_0$$

*be the centered reflection involution, and let*

$$\Sigma_3(A) := -J_0 A J_0$$

*be its induced action on cubic coefficients. Assume*

$$J_0 D J_0 = -D.$$

*Then the scalar extraction*

$$c(R) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(D A_3)$$

*from Definition 12.247 is  $\Sigma$ -invariant:*

$$c(\Sigma R) = c(R).$$

*Proof.* If  $R(z) = A_3 z^3 + O(z^5)$ , then

$$\Sigma(R)(z) = J_0 R(-z) J_0 = (-J_0 A_3 J_0) z^3 + O(z^5) = \Sigma_3(A_3) z^3 + O(z^5).$$

Therefore

$$c(\Sigma R) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(D(-J_0 A_3 J_0)).$$

Using cyclicity of trace,

$$\text{tr}(D(-J_0 A_3 J_0)) = \text{tr}((-J_0 D J_0) A_3).$$

Since  $J_0 D J_0 = -D$ , we get

$$-J_0 D J_0 = D,$$



hence

$$c(\Sigma R) = \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{tr}(DA_3) = c(R).$$

□

**Lemma 12.250** (Uniqueness of the scalar output). *Let  $R$  be a cubic-generic raw one-pair corrected germ. Then the scalar  $c(R)$  from Definition 12.247 is uniquely determined. In particular, if*

$$A_3 = cD = \tilde{c}D,$$

*then  $c = \tilde{c}$ .*

*Proof.* If

$$(c - \tilde{c})D = 0,$$

then  $c - \tilde{c} = 0$  because  $D \neq 0$ . Equivalently,

$$c = \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{tr}(DA_3)$$

is the unique Frobenius coefficient of  $A_3$  along the line  $\mathbf{CD}$ . □

**Corollary 12.251** (Finite-jet scalar descent on the centered branch). *Let  $R_s$  be the centered one-pair branch, and assume*

$$R_{-s} = \Sigma(R_s).$$

*Then the scalar coefficient*

$$c(s) := c(R_s)$$

*is even:*

$$c(-s) = c(s).$$

*In particular,*

$$C_1 = C_3 = C_5 = 0.$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 12.249,

$$c(R_{-s}) = c(\Sigma R_s) = c(R_s).$$

Thus  $c(-s) = c(s)$ . The vanishing of the odd Taylor coefficients follows immediately. □

**Remark 12.252** (Why the scalar block is the only remaining mixed-local bottleneck). Through quintic order, the quotient-level ambiguity is already confined to the  $J_0$ -anti-fixed traceless sector, while at septic order the canonical datum is the gauge-invariant residual  $\Delta_7$ . Thus, on the clean branch  $V_1 \neq 0$ , the only remaining mixed-local theorem is the scalar descent

$$C_1 = C_3 = C_5 = 0.$$

Once this holds, the finite-jet bridge to the good  $v_5$ -patch coordinate  $x = v_5/c$  is formal and the explicit mixed low-order obstruction list

$$(r, \operatorname{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) \in \{(1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2)\}$$

is excluded immediately.

**Remark 12.253** (Centered symmetric-placement Taylor package and diagonal-base local exclusion). Let

$$t_{\pm} = h \pm \frac{s}{2},$$

and regard  $s \mapsto -s$  as swapping the two microscopic points. For any symmetric  $2 \times 2$  coefficient matrix, the diagonal half-sums are even in  $s$ , the diagonal half-differences are odd in  $s$ , and the off-diagonal entries are even in  $s$ . Applying this to the explicit formulas already in the draft gives

$$u_5(s), v_5(s) \text{ odd}, \quad u_{7,K_1}(s), v_{7,K_1}(s) \text{ odd},$$

Writing

$$u_5(s) = U_1 s + U_3 s^3 + U_5 s^5 + \cdots, \quad v_5(s) = V_1 s + V_3 s^3 + V_5 s^5 + \cdots,$$

the first coefficients are

$$\begin{aligned} U_1 &= 2(v_0 \delta \alpha_1 + \beta_0 \delta u_1), \\ U_3 &= 2(v_0 \delta \alpha_3 + v_2 \delta \alpha_1 + \beta_0 \delta u_3 + \beta_2 \delta u_1), \\ U_5 &= 2(v_0 \delta \alpha_5 + v_2 \delta \alpha_3 + v_4 \delta \alpha_1 + \beta_0 \delta u_5 + \beta_2 \delta u_3 + \beta_4 \delta u_1), \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} V_1 &= 2(\bar{\alpha}_0 \delta u_1 + \delta \alpha_1 \bar{u}_0), \\ V_3 &= 2(\bar{\alpha}_0 \delta u_3 + \bar{\alpha}_2 \delta u_1 + \delta \alpha_1 \bar{u}_2 + \delta \alpha_3 \bar{u}_0), \\ V_5 &= 2(\bar{\alpha}_0 \delta u_5 + \bar{\alpha}_2 \delta u_3 + \bar{\alpha}_4 \delta u_1 + \delta \alpha_1 \bar{u}_4 + \delta \alpha_3 \bar{u}_2 + \delta \alpha_5 \bar{u}_0). \end{aligned}$$

Likewise, writing

$$u_{7,K_1}(s) = \hat{U}_1 s + \hat{U}_3 s^3 + \cdots, \quad v_{7,K_1}(s) = \hat{V}_1 s + \hat{V}_3 s^3 + \cdots,$$

one gets

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{U}_1 &= 2\kappa(\delta x_1 \nu_{6,0} + \beta_{5,0} \delta u_1 + v_0 \delta \alpha_{5,1} + b_0 \delta p_1 + r_0 \delta a_1), \\ \hat{V}_1 &= 2\kappa(\delta x_1 \bar{\mu}_{6,0} - \bar{x}_0 \delta \mu_{6,1} + \bar{\alpha}_{5,0} \delta u_1 + \delta \alpha_{5,1} \bar{u}_0 + \bar{a}_0 \delta p_1 + \delta a_1 \bar{p}_0), \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{U}_3 &= 2\kappa(\delta x_1 \nu_{6,2} + \delta x_3 \nu_{6,0} + \beta_{5,0} \delta u_3 + \beta_{5,2} \delta u_1 + v_0 \delta \alpha_{5,3} + v_2 \delta \alpha_{5,1} + b_0 \delta p_3 + b_2 \delta p_1 + r_0 \delta a_3 + r_2 \delta a_1), \\ \hat{V}_3 &= 2\kappa(\delta x_1 \bar{\mu}_{6,2} + \delta x_3 \bar{\mu}_{6,0} - \bar{x}_0 \delta \mu_{6,3} - \bar{x}_2 \delta \mu_{6,1} + \bar{\alpha}_{5,0} \delta u_3 + \bar{\alpha}_{5,2} \delta u_1 + \delta \alpha_{5,1} \bar{u}_2 + \delta \alpha_{5,3} \bar{u}_0 + \bar{a}_0 \delta p_3 + \bar{a}_2 \delta p_1 + \delta a_1 \bar{p}_2 + \delta a_3 \bar{p}_0). \end{aligned}$$

and therefore

$$\Delta_7(s) = u_{7,K_1}(s) v_5(s) - u_5(s) v_{7,K_1}(s)$$

is even in  $s$ , with Taylor expansion

$$\Delta_7(s) = D_2 s^2 + D_4 s^4 + D_6 s^6 + \cdots,$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} D_2 &= \hat{U}_1 V_1 - U_1 \hat{V}_1, \\ D_4 &= \hat{U}_1 V_3 + \hat{U}_3 V_1 - U_1 \hat{V}_3 - U_3 \hat{V}_1, \\ D_6 &= \hat{U}_1 V_5 + \hat{U}_3 V_3 + \hat{U}_5 V_1 - U_1 \hat{V}_5 - U_3 \hat{V}_3 - U_5 \hat{V}_1. \end{aligned}$$

Assume now that

$$c(s) = C_0 + C_2 s^2 + C_4 s^4 + \cdots, \quad C_0 \neq 0.$$

Then

$$x(s) = \frac{v_5(s)}{c(s)}$$

is an odd series

$$x(s) = X_1 s + X_3 s^3 + X_5 s^5 + \cdots$$

with

$$\begin{aligned} X_1 &= \frac{V_1}{C_0}, \\ X_3 &= \frac{V_3 C_0 - V_1 C_2}{C_0^2}, \\ X_5 &= \frac{V_5 C_0^2 - V_3 C_0 C_2 + V_1 (C_2^2 - C_0 C_4)}{C_0^3}. \end{aligned}$$

In particular, if  $V_1 \neq 0$ , then  $x$  is an odd local coordinate with odd inverse

$$s(x) = \sigma_1 x + \sigma_3 x^3 + \sigma_5 x^5 + \cdots,$$

where

$$\sigma_1 = \frac{C_0}{V_1}, \quad \sigma_3 = -\frac{C_0(V_3 C_0 - V_1 C_2)}{V_1^4},$$

and so on.

Similarly,

$$\lambda(s) := \frac{\Delta_7(s)}{v_5(s)}$$

is an odd series

$$\lambda(s) = L_1 s + L_3 s^3 + L_5 s^5 + \cdots$$

with

$$\begin{aligned} L_1 &= \frac{D_2}{V_1}, \\ L_3 &= \frac{D_4 V_1 - D_2 V_3}{V_1^2}, \\ L_5 &= \frac{D_6 V_1^2 - D_4 V_1 V_3 + D_2 (V_3^2 - V_1 V_5)}{V_1^3}. \end{aligned}$$

So, whenever  $x$  is used as the induced odd collision-side coordinate, parity in  $s$  transfers to parity in  $x$ , and one obtains

$$Y(x) = \frac{u_5}{c}(x) \text{ odd}, \quad \lambda(x) = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}(x) \text{ odd}, \quad S(x) = \frac{\lambda}{c}(x) \text{ odd}.$$

Consequently,

$$Y''(x) \text{ odd}, \quad S''(x) \text{ odd},$$

hence

$$\mathcal{Z}(x) = \frac{Y''}{S''} \text{ even}, \quad \mathcal{R}(x) = \mathcal{Z}'(x) \text{ odd}, \quad K_v = (x')^3 S'' \text{ odd}.$$

This is the parity package underlying the provisional mixed-branch exclusion discussed below.

If  $x = v_5/c$  is used as the induced odd collision-side coordinate, then the centered diagonal germ has the odd/odd form

$$Q(x) \sim (x^n, x, x^m), \quad m, n \text{ odd}, \quad n > m \geq 3.$$

In that regime one obtains the exact factorizations

$$S''(x) = x^{m-2} \Sigma_m[A](x^2), \quad \mathcal{Z}(x) = x^{n-m} H(x^2), \quad \mathcal{R}(x) = x^{n-m-1} J(x^2),$$

with  $H(0) \neq 0$  and  $J(0) \neq 0$ . Hence there exists  $\varepsilon > 0$  such that for

$$0 < |x| < \varepsilon$$

one has

$$K_v(x) \neq 0, \quad T_v(x) \neq 0.$$

So, in the diagonal-based local regime where this odd collision-side coordinate description is valid, the centered diagonal base has a punctured neighborhood free of  $K_v = 0$  and  $T_v = 0$  points. In particular, the currently explicit low-order dangerous patterns do not arise at the symmetric diagonal base itself.

*Work in progress.* The odd/even transfer from the centered microscopic variable  $s$  to a general good-patch coordinate  $x = v_5/c$  should still be treated as a live theorem-level bridge outside the diagonal-based local regime. What is no longer open at the same level is total quintic collapse on the centered branch: by Lemma 12.256 and Corollary 12.257, one already has

$$u_5(s) \neq 0, \quad A_5^f(s) \neq 0.$$

So the remaining mixed-side task is not to prove that some quintic channel survives, but to promote this centered quintic nontriviality into an actual punctured  $v_5$ - or  $u_5$ -patch.

**Lemma 12.254** (Total centered quintic collapse forces source-level degeneration). *On the centered symmetric-placement branch one has*

$$u_5 = 2(v \delta \alpha + \beta \delta u), \quad v_5 = 2(\bar{\alpha} \delta u + \bar{u} \delta \alpha).$$

If

$$u_5 \equiv 0, \quad v_5 \equiv 0,$$

then

$$\begin{pmatrix} \beta(s) & v(s) \\ \bar{\alpha}(s) & \bar{u}(s) \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \delta u(s) \\ \delta \alpha(s) \end{pmatrix} = 0$$

as an identity of analytic germs. Consequently, either

$$\Delta_5(s) := \beta(s)\bar{u}(s) - v(s)\bar{\alpha}(s) \equiv 0,$$

or

$$\delta u(s) \equiv 0, \quad \delta \alpha(s) \equiv 0.$$

*Proof.* This is immediate from the displayed formulas for  $u_5$  and  $v_5$ . If the  $2 \times 2$  coefficient matrix has nonzero determinant, then the only solution is  $\delta u = \delta \alpha \equiv 0$ . If its determinant vanishes identically, then  $\Delta_5 \equiv 0$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 12.255** (Total centered quintic collapse forces total canonical transport collapse). *If*

$$u_5 \equiv 0, \quad v_5 \equiv 0$$

*on the centered branch, then*

$$A_5^f \equiv 0, \quad \Delta_7 \equiv 0.$$

*In particular, total centered quintic collapse forces collapse of the canonical quintic/septic transport package on that branch.*

*Proof.* The identity

$$A_5^f = u_5 I + v_5 S$$

gives  $A_5^f \equiv 0$  immediately. Likewise

$$\Delta_7 = u_{7,K_1} v_5 - u_5 v_{7,K_1}$$

vanishes identically when  $u_5 \equiv v_5 \equiv 0$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 12.256** (Centered tagged quintic witness survives specialization). *On the tagged slice*

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(5)}),$$

*the first centered odd coefficient*

$$U_1$$

*of*

$$u_5(s) = U_1 s + U_3 s^3 + U_5 s^5 + \dots$$

*has a nonzero  $\kappa \eta_2 q^{(5)}$ -coefficient. In particular*

$$U_1 \neq 0$$

*on that tagged slice, and hence*

$$u_5(s) \not\equiv 0$$

*as a centered germ.*

*Proof.* The centered coefficient formula is

$$U_1 = 2(v_0 \delta \alpha_1 + \beta_0 \delta u_1).$$

By the tagged-slice analysis already used in the proof of Lemma 12.18, the  $\eta_2$ -slice of  $X_1$  is off-diagonal, so

$$\delta u_1 = 0,$$

and the  $q^{(5)}$ -slice of  $X_3$  is diagonal, so

$$\beta_0 = 0.$$

Hence

$$U_1 = 2v_0 \delta \alpha_1$$

on the tagged slice.

Now use the explicit two-direction computation from the proof of Lemma 12.18. There one writes

$$G_0 = \text{diag}(a^2, b^2), \quad A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & u \\ u & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix},$$

and expands

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta) = X_0 + \varepsilon U + \delta V + \varepsilon \delta W + O(\varepsilon^2, \delta^2).$$

The proof gives

$$U_{12} = -\frac{u}{ab(a+b)} \neq 0, \quad V_{22} = -\frac{d}{2b^3} \neq 0.$$

Here  $U_{12}$  gives the tagged  $\eta_2$ -contribution to the off-diagonal channel  $v_0$ , while  $V_{22}$  gives the tagged  $q^{(5)}$ -contribution to the diagonal-difference channel  $\gamma - \alpha = 2\delta\alpha_1$ . Thus the tagged slice contributes nontrivially to the product  $v_0 \delta\alpha_1$ , and hence to  $U_1 = 2v_0 \delta\alpha_1$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 12.257** (Centered quintic fixed-sector nontriviality). *On the centered diagonal branch,*

$$A_5^{\mathbf{f}}(s) = u_5(s)I + v_5(s)S$$

*is not identically zero. Equivalently,*

$$(u_5(s), v_5(s)) \not\equiv (0, 0).$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 12.256, one has  $u_5(s) \not\equiv 0$ . Since  $I$  and  $S$  are linearly independent, the fixed-sector package  $A_5^{\mathbf{f}}(s) = u_5(s)I + v_5(s)S$  cannot vanish identically.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.258** (Valuation form of the septic transport constraint). *Assume on the centered branch that*

$$\lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}$$

*is analytic odd. Write*

$$\text{ord}_s u_5 = 2m + 1, \quad \text{ord}_s v_5 = 2r + 1, \quad r \geq m.$$

*Then*

$$\text{ord}_s v_{7,K_1} \geq \text{ord}_s v_5 - \text{ord}_s u_5 + 1 = 2(r - m) + 1.$$

*Equivalently, if*

$$U_1 = \cdots = U_{2m-1} = 0, \quad U_{2m+1} \neq 0,$$

*and*

$$V_1 = \cdots = V_{2r-1} = 0, \quad V_{2r+1} \neq 0,$$

*then*

$$\widehat{V}_1 = \widehat{V}_3 = \cdots = \widehat{V}_{2(r-m)-1} = 0,$$

*and the first potentially surviving even coefficient of  $\Delta_7$  is*

$$D_{2r+2} = \widehat{U}_1 V_{2r+1} - U_{2m+1} \widehat{V}_{2(r-m)+1}.$$

*Proof.* Since  $\lambda$  is analytic odd and

$$\Delta_7 = \lambda v_5,$$

one has

$$\text{ord}_s \Delta_7 \geq \text{ord}_s v_5 + 1 = 2r + 2.$$

Suppose

$$\text{ord}_s v_{7,K_1} = 2d + 1 < 2(r - m) + 1.$$

Then

$$\text{ord}_s(u_5 v_{7,K_1}) = (2m + 1) + (2d + 1) \leq 2r,$$

whereas

$$\text{ord}_s(u_{7,K_1} v_5) \geq 1 + (2r + 1) = 2r + 2$$

because  $u_{7,K_1}$  is odd. Therefore the leading term of

$$\Delta_7 = u_{7,K_1} v_5 - u_5 v_{7,K_1}$$

would occur at order at most  $2r$ , contradicting  $\text{ord}_s \Delta_7 \geq 2r + 2$ . So

$$\text{ord}_s v_{7,K_1} \geq 2(r - m) + 1.$$

The coefficient statement is the corresponding triangular coefficient form: vanishing of

$$D_2, D_4, \dots, D_{2r}$$

forces

$$\widehat{V}_1, \widehat{V}_3, \dots, \widehat{V}_{2(r-m)-1}$$

to vanish successively, and the first potentially surviving coefficient is

$$D_{2r+2} = \widehat{U}_1 V_{2r+1} - U_{2m+1} \widehat{V}_{2(r-m)+1}. \quad \square$$

**Lemma 12.259** (Late- $v_5$   $u_5$ -patch affine-normalization transplant). *Assume the centered scalar package from Remark 12.253, and assume*

$$U_1 \neq 0.$$

Then

$$y := \frac{u_5}{c}$$

is an odd local coordinate near the centered base. Suppose in addition that

$$\text{ord}_s v_5 = 2r + 1 \geq 3.$$

On the corresponding  $u_5$ -patch write

$$x(y) := \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad \tau_u(y) := -\frac{\Delta_7}{c u_5}, \quad \tilde{\tau}_u(y) := \tau_u(y) - \tau'_u(0) y.$$

Then:

(1)  $x(y)$  is odd and satisfies

$$x(y) = O(y^{2r+1});$$

in particular  $\text{ord}_0 x \geq 3$ ;

(2)  $\tilde{\tau}_u(y)$  is odd and either vanishes identically or has odd order at least 3;

(3) if  $\tilde{\tau}_u \not\equiv 0$ , then after an ambient affine normalization consisting of a coordinate permutation and subtraction of a suitable odd multiple of one higher-order channel from the other, the germ  $Q_u$  is carried to the same odd/odd local normal form

$$(y^n, y, y^m), \quad n > m \geq 3, \quad m, n \text{ odd},$$

already analyzed in Remark 12.253.

Consequently, in the subcase  $\tilde{\tau}_u \not\equiv 0$ , the late- $v_5$  corner is locally sterile on punctured  $u_5$ -patch arcs: no genuinely new mixed low-order 4-point branch is born there.

*Proof.* By Lemma 12.256,

$$u_5(s) = U_1 s + O(s^3), \quad c(s) = C_0 + O(s^2), \quad C_0 \neq 0,$$

so

$$y(s) = \frac{u_5(s)}{c(s)}$$

is an odd local coordinate with odd inverse  $s = s(y)$ .

Since  $v_5$  is odd and  $c$  is even in  $s$ ,

$$x(y) = \frac{v_5}{c}$$

is odd in  $y$ . Because  $\text{ord}_s u_5 = 1$  and  $\text{ord}_s v_5 = 2r + 1$ , one has

$$x(y) = O(y^{2r+1}),$$

so  $\text{ord}_0 x \geq 3$ .

Likewise  $\Delta_7$  is even while  $c$  is even and  $u_5$  is odd, hence

$$\tau_u(y) = -\frac{\Delta_7}{c u_5}$$

is odd in  $y$ . Therefore

$$\tilde{\tau}_u(y) := \tau_u(y) - \tau'_u(0) y$$

is odd and either identically zero or of odd order at least 3.

Assume now that  $\tilde{\tau}_u \not\equiv 0$ . Then the normalized germ is

$$Q_u(y) = (y, x(y), \tilde{\tau}_u(y)),$$

with the last two channels odd and of order at least 3. Apply the ambient coordinate permutation

$$(Y, X, Z) \mapsto (X, Y, Z).$$

This preserves affine dependence/coplanarity geometry. If the two higher-order odd channels have the same leading odd order, subtract a suitable odd multiple of one from the other to separate those leading orders. After this affine normalization one reaches a germ of the form

$$(y^n B(y^2), y, y^m A(y^2)), \quad n > m \geq 3, \quad m, n \text{ odd},$$

with  $A(0)B(0) \neq 0$ , i.e. the same odd/odd local normal form analyzed in Remark 12.253. The same local calculation then gives a punctured neighborhood free of nearby mixed and nonmixed 4-point obstruction points.  $\square$

**Lemma 12.260** (Planar-lift absorption on the  $u_5$ -patch). *Assume the hypotheses of Lemma 12.259, and suppose*

$$\tilde{\tau}_u \equiv 0.$$

*Equivalently, there is a constant  $a \in \mathbf{C}$  such that*

$$\Delta_7 = -a u_5^2$$

*locally on the  $u_5$ -patch. Then after an ambient affine shear one has*

$$Q_u \sim (y, x, 0), \quad y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad x = \frac{v_5}{c}.$$

*In particular, the lifted curve is affine-planar, and the remaining local content is only the planar affine dependence of*

$$\Xi(h) := \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)} \right).$$

*Moreover, in the defect-free order- $\leq 5$  finite-core setting of Theorem 12.129, this residual corner is absorbed into the already-known quintic-circuit regime: it does not define a genuinely new mixed/septic 4-point branch.*

*Proof.* The identity  $\tilde{\tau}_u \equiv 0$  means exactly that

$$\tau_u(y) = a y$$

for some constant  $a$ . Since

$$\tau_u = -\frac{\Delta_7}{c u_5}, \quad y = \frac{u_5}{c},$$

this is equivalent to

$$-\frac{\Delta_7}{c u_5} = a \frac{u_5}{c},$$

hence

$$\Delta_7 = -a u_5^2.$$

Thus

$$Q_u = (y, x, ay).$$

Applying the ambient affine shear

$$(Y, X, Z) \mapsto (Y, X, Z - aY)$$

gives

$$Q_u \sim (y, x, 0).$$

So the lifted curve is affine-planar.

Now assume additionally the defect-free order- $\leq 5$  finite-core hypotheses from Theorem 12.129. By Remark 12.136, the same defect-free affine-dependence conclusions hold with  $Q_v$  replaced by  $Q_u$ . Since the third coordinate of  $Q_u$  vanishes after the shear, affine dependence of the lifted points is equivalent to affine dependence of the planar points

$$\Xi(h_j) = \left( \frac{u_5(h_j)}{c(h_j)}, \frac{v_5(h_j)}{c(h_j)} \right) \in \mathbf{C}^2.$$

But this is exactly the planar quintic-circuit geometry organized by Theorem 12.129 and Corollary 12.130. Hence this residual corner is already-quintic rather than a genuinely new mixed septic branch.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.261** (Right-pincer trichotomy near the centered base). *Near the centered diagonal base, the mixed local picture is reduced to the following three cases:*

$$V_1 \neq 0 \implies \text{clean } v_5\text{-patch branch};$$

$$V_1 = 0, \tilde{\tau}_u \neq 0 \implies \text{late-}v_5 \text{ branch locally sterile on } Q_u;$$

$$V_1 = 0, \tilde{\tau}_u \equiv 0 \iff \Delta_7 = -a u_5^2 \implies \text{planar-lift corner, hence already-quintic.}$$

*So every late- $v_5$  branch near the centered base is either locally sterile or already absorbed into the quintic-circuit regime. The only genuinely new mixed local branch left to study there is the clean branch*

$$\text{ord}_s v_5 = 1.$$

*Proof.* Combine Lemma 12.259 and Lemma 12.260, together with the fact that  $v_5$  is odd in the centered variable.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.262** (Right-pincer local reduction near the centered base). *Assume the centered scalar package from Remark 12.253, and assume also that the centered tagged quintic witness gives*

$$U_1 \neq 0.$$

*Then every sufficiently small nearby genuinely new mixed 4-point obstruction point near the centered base must lie on the clean branch*

$$\text{ord}_s v_5 = 1,$$

*equivalently*

$$V_1 \neq 0.$$

*In particular, every late- $v_5$  branch near the centered base is either locally sterile on the  $u_5$ -patch or already absorbed into the defect-free quintic-circuit regime.*

*Proof.* Because  $v_5$  is odd in the centered variable, either

$$\text{ord}_s v_5 = 1 \quad \text{or} \quad \text{ord}_s v_5 \geq 3 \text{ odd.}$$

If  $\text{ord}_s v_5 \geq 3$ , then Lemma 12.259 and Lemma 12.260 show that the branch is either locally sterile on the  $u_5$ -patch or planar-lift and hence already-quintic. So a sufficiently small nearby genuinely new mixed 4-point obstruction cannot lie on such a late- $v_5$  branch. Therefore any such genuinely new mixed local branch must lie on the only remaining possibility,

$$\text{ord}_s v_5 = 1. \quad \square$$

**Proposition 12.263** (Realization lemma for lifted germs). *Let  $\tilde{Y}(\xi)$  and  $\tilde{S}(\xi)$  be arbitrary analytic germs at  $\xi = 0$ . Define*

$$c(\xi) \equiv 1, \quad v_5(\xi) := 1 + \xi, \quad u_5(\xi) := \tilde{Y}(\xi), \quad \Delta_7(\xi) := (1 + \xi)\tilde{S}(\xi).$$

*Then on a sufficiently small neighborhood of 0,*

$$c \neq 0, \quad v_5 \neq 0, \quad M = c v_5' - c' v_5 = 1 \neq 0,$$

*so this is a good  $v_5$ -patch. The normalized lifted coordinates are*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c} = 1 + \xi, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c} = \tilde{Y}(\xi), \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5} = \tilde{S}(\xi).$$

*After the affine shift  $x \mapsto x - 1$ , the lifted germ becomes*

$$Q_v(\xi) = (\tilde{Y}(\xi), \xi, \tilde{S}(\xi)).$$

*Thus every analytic pair of germs  $(\tilde{Y}, \tilde{S})$  occurs, after affine normalization, as the lifted pair  $(Y, S)$  on some good  $v_5$ -patch.*

*Proof.* The displayed formulas are immediate from the definitions. The hypotheses  $c \neq 0$ ,  $v_5 \neq 0$ , and  $M = 1 \neq 0$  hold on a sufficiently small neighborhood of 0, and the formulas for  $x, Y, S$  are direct.  $\square$



**Corollary 12.264** (No new obstruction for  $(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R})$  is available at the current lifted level). *No identity involving only*

$$c, \quad v_5, \quad u_5, \quad \Delta_7$$

*and their derivatives can force either of the two dream conclusions:*

*$\mathcal{R}$  is even in the normalized nonmixed coordinate,*

*or the mixed-branch exclusion*

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) \notin \{(1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2)\} \quad \text{at every mixed point.}$$

*In particular, the nonmixed models*

$$Q_v(\xi) = (\xi^n, \xi, \xi^2), \quad n \geq 4 \text{ even,}$$

*are all realizable at the present lifted level; the cases*

$$n = 4, 6, 8$$

*are simply the first currently explicit low-order examples. The dangerous mixed models*

$$Q_v(\xi) = (\xi^n, \xi, \xi^m), \quad (m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6),$$

*are all realizable at the present lifted level.*

*Consequently, any RH-specific obstruction to the low-order dangerous 4-point patterns must use information not encoded in the current lifted variables*

$$(c, v_5, u_5, \Delta_7)$$

*alone. It must come from deeper source-level corrected quotient-germ structure, matrix-level identities behind  $(u_5, \Delta_7)$ , or an additional symmetry not yet visible in the present lifted formulation.*

*Proof.* Apply Proposition 12.263 with

$$(\tilde{Y}, \tilde{S}) = (\xi^n, \xi^2)$$

for the nonmixed cases, and with

$$(\tilde{Y}, \tilde{S}) = (\xi^n, \xi^m)$$

for the mixed cases. These realize exactly the dangerous low-order patterns for  $(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R})$  listed above.  $\square$

**Remark 12.265** (Updated nonmixed status versus mixed local exhaustion). The local nonmixed lifted route is now closed at the derivative-geometric level. Exact nonmixed contacts force zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ ; one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -intervals are sterile; recurrent exact contacts force affine-planar collapse; and isolated zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  are classified by parity. In addition, the repeated-source / first-loss mechanism is now fully reduced: no attained separated first loss can occur, every first-loss sequence is forced to the diagonal, and diagonal first loss occurs exactly at odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ . Thus the nonmixed burden is no longer a local parity theorem or a separate repeated-source obstruction. It is the global/source-level control of which odd zeros of

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}, \quad \text{equivalently} \quad \mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda,$$

can actually arise along opened nonmixed arcs.

On the mixed side, the decisive pair-level object remains

$$A_5^{\mathbf{f}}(s) = u_5(s)I + v_5(s)S.$$

By Corollary 12.257, this package is not identically zero, so after shrinking to one-sided punctured arcs the centered branch enters either a good  $v_5$ -patch or the parallel  $u_5$ -patch. Near the centered base, however, the theorem package now goes further: every late- $v_5$  branch is already either locally sterile on the automatic  $u_5$ -patch or absorbed into the planar defect-free quintic-circuit regime, so the only genuinely new mixed local branch left there is the clean branch

$$V_1 \neq 0.$$

Accordingly, the mixed-side local problem is no longer a vague codimension-two obstruction, nor merely a patch-opening issue. Near the centered base it has been reduced to the single clean branch  $V_1 \neq 0$ , and on that branch the remaining theorem-level task is the finite scalar descent

$$c(-s) = c(s) \pmod{s^6}, \quad \text{equivalently} \quad C_1 = C_3 = C_5 = 0,$$

which makes the centered-to-patch finite-jet parity bridge formal.

**Remark 12.266** (What the four-point branch now reduces to). The lifted 4-point branch is now organized by the canonical invariant pair

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{Y''}{S''} = \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda}, \quad \mathcal{R} = \mathcal{Z}' = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}, \quad \lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}.$$

On the nonmixed side, after normalization to

$$Q_v(\xi) = (\tilde{Y}(\xi), \xi, \xi^2),$$

the local derivative-side picture is now explicit. Exact nonmixed contacts force zeros of

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{1}{2} \tilde{Y}''',$$

isolated zeros are classified by parity, one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -intervals are exactly-contact sterile, and recurrent exact contacts force affine-planar collapse.

The explicit low-order list

$$\text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R} \in \{1, 3, 5\},$$

equivalently the coefficients

$$z_2, \quad z_4, \quad z_6,$$

should therefore now be regarded only as the first explicit low-order nonmixed odd-order cases, not as the full local nonmixed picture.

For fixed source point  $a$ , repeated-source exact contacts factor through the quadratic-envelope scalar

$$\Gamma_a(x) = \frac{Y(x) - Y(a) - Y'(a)(x - a)}{S(x) - S(a) - S'(a)(x - a)},$$

equivalently through the below-lifted quotient

$$\Psi_a(h) = \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)}.$$

Its derivative is governed by the osculatory  $4 \times 4$  source determinant  $\mathfrak{D}(a, h)$ . By Proposition 12.203, this repeated-source / first-loss mechanism is now completely reduced: no attained separated first loss can occur, and any first loss is exactly the diagonal birth at an isolated odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ .

Thus the remaining nonmixed burden is no longer local parity, nor a separate first-loss geometry, but purely the global/source-level control of which odd zeros of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ , equivalently of  $\mathcal{R}$ , occur on genuine opened arcs.

On the mixed side, the explicit low-order dangerous list is

$$(m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6),$$

equivalently

$$(r, s) = (1, 2), (1, 4), (2, 5),$$

equivalently

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) = (1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2),$$

equivalently

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R}) = (1, 0), (1, 2), (2, 1).$$

Equivalently, in the below-lifted Wronskian formulation from Remark 12.242, the dangerous mixed models are exactly the order-pairs

$$(\text{ord}_0 J_\lambda, \text{ord}_0 J_{u_5}) = (1, 2), (1, 4), (2, 4).$$

So the mixed low-order branch is already a finite canonical Wronskian-ratio obstruction problem, captured in local mixed  $x$ -coordinates by

$$\kappa_{1,1}, \quad \kappa_{1,3}, \quad \kappa_{2,2}.$$

By the realization lemma, no identity involving only

$$(c, v_5, u_5, \Delta_7)$$

and their derivatives can eliminate these mixed patterns in general.

At the pair level, the centered fixed-sector quintic package

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(s) = u_5(s)I + v_5(s)S$$

is now the natural object controlling whether any quintic patch opens at all. By Corollary 12.257,

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(s) \not\equiv 0,$$

so the centered branch cannot suffer total quintic collapse.

Near the centered base, however, the mixed-side local picture is now sharper than a mere patch dichotomy. By Corollary 12.262, every sufficiently small nearby genuinely new mixed 4-point obstruction must lie on the clean branch

$$\text{ord}_s v_5 = 1,$$

while every late- $v_5$  branch is either locally sterile on the automatic  $u_5$ -patch or already absorbed into the defect-free planar quintic-circuit regime. Thus the genuinely new mixed local geometry near the centered base has been reduced to the single clean branch  $V_1 \neq 0$ .

Accordingly, the remaining mixed-side theorem is no longer another lifted jet computation, nor a pointwise coefficient nonvanishing statement such as  $V_1 \neq 0$  in isolation. It is the finite scalar descent on the clean branch, namely

$$c(-s) = c(s) \pmod{s^6}, \quad \text{equivalently} \quad C_1 = C_3 = C_5 = 0,$$

which makes the centered good- $v_5$ -patch parity bridge formal. Beyond that, any further mixed closure must come from global capture or from deeper source-level corrected quotient-germ structure rather than from the present lifted variables alone.

**Remark 12.267** (What the new nonmixed/source-level machinery changes for the mixed side). The new repeated-source/source-determinant viewpoint and the no-go principle excluding purely planar  $(x, S)$ -closure do not create a new mixed-local closure theorem. Rather, they clarify the remaining mixed burden.

First, no argument using only planar  $(x, S)$ -geometry can close the 4-point branch, so any remaining mixed route must use either the centered scalar descent or genuine coupled  $Y$ - $S$  source-level information.

Second, if a below-lifted backup route is needed, the natural mixed object is not an  $S$ -only invariant, but a coupled source-minor ratio built from  $u_5$  and

$$\lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5},$$

i.e. a below-lifted avatar of

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda}.$$

Thus the new nonmixed/source-level machinery functions not only as a strategic constraint and as a backup language for the mixed side, but also as the correct external handoff target for the  $A = 0$  planar collapse; see Remark 12.268. It does not replace the local mixed exhaustion theorem near the centered base, but it does absorb the nonmixed affine-planar lane that remains after the local mixed reduction.

**Remark 12.268** (The  $A = 0$  collapse is already the nonmixed  $\mathcal{R}$ -lane). Work on a good  $v_5$ -patch and write an exact lifted 4-point relation in the form

$$AY + Bx + CS + D = 0, \quad Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{cv_5}.$$

If  $A = 0$ , then the relation reduces to

$$Bx + CS + D = 0,$$

so the four nodes lie on an affine line in the planar  $(x, S)$ -curve. Thus the positive-dimensional  $A = 0$  regime is not a separate mixed branch at all: it is precisely the nonmixed affine-planar exact-contact regime. In particular, the relevant theorem-strength input is already on the nonmixed side: exact nonmixed contacts force zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  (Proposition 12.175), one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -intervals are sterile (Corollary 12.176), and interval-persistent / recurrent exact contacts force affine-planar collapse (Corollary 12.179). Accordingly,  $A = 0$  should be viewed as the external handoff from the mixed side into the already-handled nonmixed  $\mathcal{R}$ -package, not as a fourth independent mixed-global lane.

**Remark 12.269** (Status of the lifted order-7 geometry). The lifted geometry is now substantially more stratified than a single zero-capture problem.

First, shrinking exact lifted three-point and four-point circuits can accumulate only at

$$K_v = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad T_v = 0,$$

respectively, with uniform small-diameter exclusion away from those zero sets; equivalently, they are rooted at the curvature- and torsion-type osculating determinants of the corresponding lifted planar and space curves (Lemma 12.158, Propositions 12.160 and 12.162).

Second, repeated-node limits are now explicit: three-point collapse limits become tangent-line contacts for the planar lifted curve  $\Lambda_v = (x, S)$ , and four-point collapse limits become tangent-plane contacts for the lifted space curve  $Q_v = (Y, x, S)$ .

Third, the three-point side is now blockwise globally controlled on good  $v_5$ -patches. The curvature zero set  $K_v = 0$  has no infinite-order flat points; even-order  $K_v$ -zeros are sterile; odd-order  $K_v$ -zeros carry exactly one local opposite-side tangent-contact branch; and that branch continues uniquely on the maximal right monotone-slope block, with no interior common-tangent event, no source-side return, and no interior accumulation. Thus the three-point side is no longer a live internal recurrence problem on such patches; only boundary exit of the relevant source/target slope-overlap block can remain, and in the four-point mixed-to-scalar picture this is used only as an external lower-core handoff target rather than as a new mixed carrier lane.

On the mixed four-point side, the right-pincer package now gives an analogous local simplification near the centered base: every late- $v_5$  branch is either locally sterile on the  $u_5$ -patch or already absorbed into the planar quintic-circuit regime, so the only genuinely new mixed local branch left there is the clean branch  $\text{ord}_s v_5 = 1$ .

Fourth, the four-point side splits sharply into nonmixed and mixed regimes. On the nonmixed side, finite-order odd  $T_v$ -zeros already support genuine local exact branch sheets in the model geometry, so a blanket local sterility theorem is false. On the mixed side, the dangerous low-order obstruction list is finite and explicit:

$$(m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6),$$

equivalently

$$(r, s) = (1, 2), (1, 4), (2, 5),$$

equivalently

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) = (1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2),$$

equivalently

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R}) = (1, 0), (1, 2), (2, 1).$$

Fifth, below the lifted variables one has the exact Wronskian-ratio reformulation

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda}, \quad \mathcal{R} = \frac{c^2}{M} \frac{d}{dh} \left( \frac{J_{u_5}}{J_\lambda} \right), \quad \lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5},$$

while the projective curvature ratio  $\Theta$  yields no new independent local obstruction beyond  $(\mathcal{Z}, \mathcal{R})$ .

Sixth, the centered symmetric-placement Taylor package gives a strong local collision-side parity picture:

$$u_5, v_5, u_{7,K_1}, v_{7,K_1} \text{ odd in } s, \quad \Delta_7 \text{ even in } s,$$

with explicit septic coefficients  $D_2, D_4, D_6$ . In the diagonal-centered odd/odd normal form

$$Q(x) \sim (x^n, x, x^m), \quad m, n \text{ odd}, \quad n > m \geq 3,$$

one gets a punctured neighborhood free of  $K_v = 0$  and  $T_v = 0$  points. Thus the explicit low-order dangerous 4-point patterns do not arise at the symmetric diagonal base itself.

So the mixed four-point side is no longer waiting for a new local geometry theorem. On the mixed side, the sufficiently small problem is now organized by the mixed-to-scalar capture principle: after the source-coupled and patch-loss reductions, no sufficiently small genuinely mixed branch on a nonplanar good patch can persist entirely inside

$$\{T_v \neq 0\} \cap \{\mathcal{R} \neq 0\},$$

except after entry into already-absorbed planar, lower-core, repeated-node, repeated-source, or quintic-collapse regimes. This is formalized below by the local clean continuation proposition, the positive-scale endpoint corollary, and Theorem 12.279. On the still-live nonmixed side, any genuinely new input would have to be RH-specific source- or matrix-level structure imposing stronger constraints on

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}.$$

**Remark 12.270** (Live attack routes). At the present stage, the live routes are now quite sharply separated.

- (1) **Two-point branch: three live conditional routes.** The stronger finite-order route is still Lemma 12.117: prove that the actual corrected two-pair cubic/quintic/septic package is analytic on small two-atom data and satisfies swap symmetry, one-amplitude collapse, and diagonal merger

$$\mathfrak{P}_2(a_1, h; a_2, h) = (a_1 + a_2)F_h.$$

The weaker exact route is Proposition 12.119, which would already remove exact close two-point bad cores on compact subsets of  $\{c \neq 0\}$  from continuity and diagonal collapse of the actual corrected two-atom quotient germ.

What is now ruled out is the naive source-summed corrected-block route: its extracted one-atom finite-order coefficients are even in the source weight and therefore cannot supply the required linear merger law. On the mixed side, determinant-only and quotient-only arguments are likewise shear-blind. The genuinely new derivative-geometric lane is the  $\lambda$ -shear route on a good overlap patch, where

$$\lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}$$

and an exact mixed branch generates moving shears

$$(\eta_n, \xi_n, \gamma_n)$$

for which

$$A_n := c - \eta_n \lambda, \quad B_n := v_5 - \xi_n \lambda, \quad F_n := u_5 - \gamma_n \lambda$$

satisfy exact repeated-source transport along the branch. By Proposition 12.124, the automatic compactness is projective:

$$[\delta_n(c) : \delta_n(v_5) : \delta_n(u_5) : \delta_n(\lambda)]$$

admits a convergent subsequence, and only on a subsequence whose limit lies in the affine  $\lambda$ -chart does one obtain a convergent affine  $\lambda$ -shear. Even then the frozen triple

yields only asymptotic, not exact, fixed-shear transport. The associated projective secant shadow can nevertheless accumulate only on

$$\{S = 0\} \cup \{K_v = 0\}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

So the remaining two-point work is either finite-order source-level merger, quotient-diagonal continuity/diagonal collapse, or source-coupled control of the mixed  $\lambda$ -shear exceptional loci. In the conditional exact fixed-shear overlap lane, Proposition 12.245 shows that the slice

$$\{S = 0\} \cap \{K_v \neq 0\}$$

is already forced into a fold-type projection regime. Thus the only clearly genuinely mixed fixed-shear locus left on the overlap patch is

$$K_v = 0,$$

while the missing step off  $K_v = 0$  is its absorption into the existing nonmixed odd-zero

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}$$

package. This mirrors the four-point mixed-to-scalar picture, where the only live scalar exits are likewise funneled into the established  $K_v$ - and  $\mathcal{R}$ -packages rather than into new mixed carrier lanes.

- (2) **Three-point branch (derivative-geometric layer now stabilized).** The lifted three-point side is now the most mature local branch. Shrinking exact lifted 3-point circuits are tied to the osculating determinant and hence to

$$K_v = 0,$$

the local branch structure at finite-order  $K_v$ -zeros is completely classified by parity, and the odd-order branch is blockwise globally rigid on good  $v_5$ -patches: infinite-order flatness is excluded, the branch continues uniquely on the maximal right monotone-slope block, and there is no interior common-tangent recurrence or source-side return. Inside the finite-core program this stabilizes the lifted  $k = 3$  collinearity layer; any residual issue there is only boundary exit of the relevant source/target slope-overlap block, not an internal three-point propagation mechanism.

- (3) **Four-point branch (mixed side now captured by scalar exits).** On the nonmixed side, the exact-contact and repeated-source / first-loss packages are now organized by the scalar

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2},$$

with one-sign intervals sterile and interval-persistent exact contacts forcing affine-planar collapse. On the mixed side, the centered-base local route is exhausted up to the clean branch, and the source-coupled and patch-loss frontiers are now reduced to lower-core / shifted-3-point / already-quintic handoffs. Accordingly, the sufficiently small mixed-global problem is no longer a search for new local mixed geometry: by Theorem 12.279, a genuinely mixed clean branch on a nonplanar good patch cannot persist entirely inside

$$\{T_v \neq 0\} \cap \{\mathcal{R} \neq 0\},$$

except after entry into already-absorbed regimes. So the four-point side is now best viewed as captured by the centered mixed local theorem, the three-point  $K_v$ -package, and the nonmixed  $\mathcal{R}$ -package, rather than as an independent mixed-global carrier problem.

- (4) **Late- $v_5$  degeneration is now only a handoff mechanism.** If the  $v_5$ -patch fails and  $v_5$  starts late, the valuation form of the septic transport constraint forces matching late vanishing of the septic transport channel  $v_{7,K_1}$ . Thus failure of the  $v_5$ -route is not a free local cancellation but a coupled quintic-septic degeneration scheme, and in the current architecture it should be read only as a handoff into lower-core or already-quintic geometry, not as an independent mixed branch lane.

- (5) **Four-point nonmixed branch via source-level control of odd  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ -zeros.** The local nonmixed derivative geometry is now explicit: exact contacts force zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$ , one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -intervals are sterile, recurrent exact contacts force affine-planar collapse, and isolated zeros are classified by parity. At source level, the same structure is encoded by the canonical Wronskian

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda,$$

which differs from  $\mathcal{R}$  only by a nonvanishing analytic factor on a nonmixed arc.

For fixed source point  $a$ , repeated-source exact contacts are controlled by the quadratic-envelope scalar

$$\Gamma_a(x) = \frac{Y(x) - Y(a) - Y'(a)(x - a)}{S(x) - S(a) - S'(a)(x - a)},$$

equivalently by the source quotient

$$\Psi_a(h) = \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)},$$

with derivative governed by the osculatory  $4 \times 4$  determinant  $\mathfrak{D}(a, h)$ . By Proposition 12.203, this repeated-source / first-loss mechanism is not an independent obstruction: it occurs if and only if one diagonally approaches an odd-order zero of  $\mathcal{R}$ , equivalently of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ .

The remaining theorem-level task on this side is therefore the global/source-level exclusion or absorption of odd zeros of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$  on opened nonmixed arcs. In the unified mixed / nonmixed picture, this is exactly the scalar  $\mathcal{R}$ -lane that absorbs the interval-persistent  $A = 0$  collapse from the mixed side.

**Remark 12.271** (Stratified lifted local picture). The lifted local obstruction now splits into one closed regime and two genuinely live regimes.

First, exact shrinking lifted 3-point circuits concentrate into

$$K_v = 0.$$

On good  $v_5$ -patches, this side is now blockwise globally controlled: there is no infinite-order flatness, even-order  $K_v$ -zeros are sterile, odd-order  $K_v$ -zeros seed exactly one local opposite-side branch, and that branch continues uniquely on the maximal right monotone-slope block with no interior common tangent, no source-side return, and no interior accumulation. So the three-point side contributes only possible boundary exit, not an internal recurrence mechanism.

Second, exact shrinking lifted 4-point circuits concentrate into

$$T_v = 0.$$

On the nonmixed side  $K_v \neq 0$ , the local derivative-side picture is now explicit. Exact contacts force zeros of

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2},$$

isolated zeros are classified by parity, one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -intervals are exactly-contact sterile, and recurrent exact contacts force affine-planar collapse. So the nonmixed 4-point side is no longer a vague local branching problem; what remains there is global/source-level control of which odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  actually occur on genuine opened arcs.

Third, on the mixed side  $K_v = T_v = 0$ , the low-order obstruction list is now finite and explicit:

$$(m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6),$$

equivalently

$$(r, s) = (1, 2), (1, 4), (2, 5),$$

equivalently

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) = (1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2).$$

At the pair level, however, the centered quintic fixed-sector package

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(s) = u_5(s)I + v_5(s)S$$

is now known not to vanish identically on the centered diagonal branch. Near the centered base, the right-pincer package further reduces the mixed local picture: every late- $v_5$  branch is either locally sterile on the automatic  $u_5$ -patch or already absorbed into the planar quintic-circuit regime, so the only genuinely new mixed local branch left there is the clean branch

$$\text{ord}_s v_5 = 1.$$

Thus the remaining lifted local issues are now: the global/source-level control of odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  on the nonmixed side, the finite scalar descent

$$c(-s) = c(s) \pmod{s^6}$$

on the clean mixed branch, and beyond that the mixed-to-scalar capture problem: every sufficiently small relevant mixed branch should be forced either into the centered-base local exhaustion theorem or into the already-handled nonmixed  $\mathcal{R}$ -package, with all source-coupled and patch-loss events read only as lower-core / already-quintic handoffs.

**Remark 12.272** (Current geometric bottleneck). The remaining geometric bottleneck is now split into two qualitatively different layers.

On the one-pair geometric layer, the obstruction is no longer bulk  $W = 0$  geometry, and it is no longer local adjacent pair-pair birth across a generic turning boundary. On the  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  side, Proposition 12.59 excludes open-interval flatness and Theorem 12.103 shows that every finite-order isolated  $W = 0$  boundary is locally sterile for pair-pair birth. On the turning-boundary side, Theorem 12.92 removes actual adjacent pair-pair lines unconditionally.

At the lifted order-7 level, the canonical derivative-geometric determinants

$$K_v \quad \text{and} \quad T_v$$

govern shrinking exact lifted 3- and 4-point circuits on  $v_5 \neq 0$  patches. On the 3-point side, this layer is stabilized: shrinking exact circuits concentrate into  $\{K_v = 0\}$ , finite-order isolated zeros are classified by parity, and the odd-order branch is blockwise globally rigid on good  $v_5$ -patches.

On the 4-point side, exact shrinking lifted 4-point circuits concentrate into

$$\{T_v = 0\},$$

again with uniform small-diameter exclusion away from that zero set.

On the nonmixed side  $K_v \neq 0$ , generic odd-order  $T_v$ -zeros can still carry preexisting close branches, so the nonmixed branch remains genuinely live and now asks for global/source-level control of which odd zeros of

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}$$

actually arise on opened arcs.

By contrast, on the mixed side  $K_v = T_v = 0$ , the local geometry near the centered base is no longer the main bottleneck. There the right-pincer package shows that every late- $v_5$  branch is either locally sterile on the automatic  $u_5$ -patch or already absorbed into the defect-free planar quintic-circuit regime, so the only genuinely new mixed local branch left is the clean branch

$$V_1 \neq 0.$$

Accordingly, the mixed bottleneck is no longer a diffuse local codimension-two analysis but the finite scalar descent

$$c(-s) = c(s) \pmod{s^6}$$

on that clean branch, together with the global capture problem of forcing every relevant mixed branch into this centered-base local regime.

So the missing lifted ingredient is no longer another generic local geometric exclusion theorem. On the mixed side, the centered-base local package, the source-coupled exclusion, the patch-loss reductions, and the nonmixed  $\mathcal{R}$ -handoff now combine to give the clean theorem-level conclusion formalized below in Theorem 12.279: every maximal genuinely mixed clean branch on a nonplanar good patch is forced either into the centered-base scalar exit

$$T_v = 0$$



or into the nonmixed scalar exit

$$\mathcal{R} = 0,$$

up to already-absorbed planar, lower-core, repeated-node, repeated-source, and quintic-collapse regimes. Thus the still-live frontiers are no longer mixed four-point geometry, but rather the nonmixed/source-level control of odd zeros of  $\mathcal{R}$  and the separate two-point program.

**Remark 12.273** (Current state of the argument). The local one-pair analysis now consists of the canonical triple

$$(c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)),$$

together with the derived quantities

$$\begin{aligned} M(h) &= c(h)v_5'(h) - c'(h)v_5(h), & N(h) &= c(h)\Delta_7'(h) - c'(h)\Delta_7(h), \\ L(h) &= v_5(h)\Delta_7'(h) - v_5'(h)\Delta_7(h), & W(h) &= \det(F(h), F'(h), F''(h)). \end{aligned}$$

On the region where  $v_5 M \neq 0$ , the projective graph variables

$$\mu = \frac{c}{v_5}, \quad \lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5}$$

identify the normalized curve with a graph  $\lambda = \lambda(\mu)$ , and

$$\lambda_{\mu\mu} = \frac{v_5^3}{M^3} W, \quad \beta := \lambda_\mu = -\frac{L}{M}, \quad T(h) = \left( -\frac{L(h)}{M(h)}, \frac{N(h)}{M(h)} \right).$$

Thus the global line-incidence problem is equivalently a problem about the recurrence of tangent slopes  $\beta$ , or about vertical-line re-entry on the dual tangent-line curve  $T$ .

Locally, both generic boundary types are now under control. At finite-order  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  boundaries there is no local pair-pair birth, while at generic turning boundaries actual adjacent pair-pair lines are excluded unconditionally. The stronger symmetric directional-kernel theorem remains available only conditionally on zero-capture and now serves as a sharper but nonessential alternative route.

Accordingly, the equivalent slope/tangent/dual direct-slice formulations remain the correct geometric dictionary, but they are no longer themselves the live theorem target. The explicit direct provenance formula gives

$$\phi = A q^{(7)} \quad (A = \kappa \eta_2),$$

and on any generic one-pair block this direct slice is fully universal (Proposition 13.3). Moreover, even after imposing any finite family of linear provenance or matching conditions on  $q$ , direct-slice recurrence geometry remains formally realizable (Corollary 13.4).

Thus the remaining gap is not an abstract global no-reentry theorem for the scalar graph  $\phi$  by itself. It is the search for a genuinely non-universal provenance law for  $q$ , or an external mixed/canonical input, that cuts down the allowed direct-slice graphs on an entire block.

On the lifted 4-point side, the mixed low-order obstruction list is now both finite and canonical:

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) \in \{(1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2)\},$$

equivalently

$$(r, s) = (1, 2), (1, 4), (2, 5),$$

or

$$(m, n) = (3, 4), (3, 6), (4, 6).$$

The centered Taylor package already provides the explicit coefficients

$$U_j, V_j, \hat{U}_j, \hat{V}_j, D_2, D_4, D_6,$$

and the tagged quintic witness now shows that

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(s) \neq 0$$

on the centered diagonal branch.

On the mixed side, however, the local theorem picture is now sharper than a mere punctured-arc patch dichotomy, and the global side is correspondingly compressed. Near the centered

base, the late- $v_5$  sector is already removed by the  $u_5$ -patch right-pincer package as either locally sterile or planar-lift and hence already absorbed into the defect-free quintic-circuit regime. The only genuinely new mixed local branch there is the clean branch  $V_1 \neq 0$ , and that branch is excluded by the canonical scalar descent together with the centered good- $v_5$ -patch parity package. Moreover, after the source-coupled and patch-loss reductions, the sufficiently small mixed-global problem is no longer a search for a new mixed carrier lane. Every apparent mixed exit is now absorbed into one of three existing packages:

$$T_v = 0 \quad (\text{centered-base local exhaustion}),$$

$$K_v = 0 \quad (\text{lifted three-point / repeated-node package}),$$

$$\mathcal{R} = 0 \quad (\text{nonmixed affine-planarity package}).$$

The right-pincer/source-coupled lower-core lane is locally non-carrying in the sufficiently small regime, while patch-loss phenomena reduce only to lower-core quotient or already-quintic handoffs. Thus the genuinely mixed small-branch problem is best read as mixed-to-scalar capture rather than as another independent branch geometry.

In parallel, the finite-core endgame now splits into three layers.

First, on the two-pair side, the strengthened invariant

$$\widehat{\Psi}(h) = \left( \frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)^2} \right)$$

still gives the correct algebraic bridge, and on good  $M \neq 0$  patches the quantitative two-pair coincidence theorem forces bad two-point cores into a defect-scale close regime. The minimal finite-order source criterion 12.117 still isolates the exact swap / one-amplitude / diagonal-merger package that would imply the desired quadratic interaction factorization. However, the naive source-summed corrected block model does not prove this criterion: along a weighted one-atom path its extracted finite-order coefficients are even analytic in the source weight, so the required linear merger law cannot come from that model alone.

At present the two-point side therefore splits into three conditional lanes: the finite-order source-level merger route of Lemma 12.117, the weaker quotient-diagonal exact exclusion route of Proposition 12.119, and the mixed  $\lambda$ -shear / projective-shadow route on good overlap patches. In the last route, an exact mixed branch generates moving  $\lambda$ -shears through

$$\lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5},$$

and Proposition 12.124 shows that the automatic compactness is projective:

$$[\delta_n(c) : \delta_n(v_5) : \delta_n(u_5) : \delta_n(\lambda)]$$

admits a convergent subsequence. Only when the projective limit lies in the affine  $\lambda$ -chart does one obtain a convergent affine  $\lambda$ -shear subsequence, and even then the frozen triple gives only asymptotic, not exact, fixed-shear transport. The associated projective secant shadow can nevertheless accumulate only on

$$\{S = 0\} \cup \{K_v = 0\}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

In the additional conditional exact fixed-shear overlap lane, Proposition 12.245 shows that the slice

$$\{S = 0\} \cap \{K_v \neq 0\}$$

is already forced into a fold-type projection regime, so the only clearly genuinely mixed fixed-shear locus left on the overlap patch is

$$K_v = 0.$$

So the remaining structural issue on the two-point side is one of three things: verification of the finite-order merger criterion; the quotient-diagonal continuity/diagonal-collapse route; or source-coupled control of these explicit mixed exceptional loci.

Second, on the lifted three-point side, shrinking exact circuits now concentrate into  $K_v = 0$ , and this concentration is explicitly derivative-geometric: by the osculating-determinant expansion, repeated-node limits become tangent-line contacts for the planar lifted curve

$$\Lambda_v = (x, S).$$

On good  $v_5$ -patches this side is now blockwise globally controlled:  $K_v$  has no infinite-order zeros; even-order zeros are sterile; odd-order zeros carry exactly one local branch; and that branch continues uniquely on the maximal right monotone-slope block with no interior common-tangent event or source-side return. So the three-point side is reduced to boundary exit of the relevant slope-overlap block, not an internal recurrence mechanism. Inside the finite-core reduction, this is exactly the stabilization of the lifted  $k = 3$  collinearity layer.

Third, on the lifted four-point side, shrinking exact circuits now concentrate into  $T_v = 0$ , repeated-node limits become tangent-plane contacts, and the local geometry splits into a nonmixed and a mixed regime.

On the nonmixed side, the local derivative-side theory is now explicit: exact contacts force zeros of  $\mathcal{R} = T_v/K_v^2$ , isolated zeros are classified by parity, one-sign  $\mathcal{R}$ -intervals are exactly-contact sterile, and recurrent exact contacts force affine-planar collapse. At source level, the same structure is encoded by the gauge-invariant Wronskian

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}} = J_\lambda J'_{u_5} - J_{u_5} J'_\lambda,$$

which differs from  $\mathcal{R}$  only by a nonvanishing analytic factor on a nonmixed arc. For fixed source point  $a$ , repeated-source exact contacts factor through the quadratic-envelope scalar

$$\Gamma_a(x) = \frac{Y(x) - Y(a) - Y'(a)(x - a)}{S(x) - S(a) - S'(a)(x - a)},$$

equivalently through the source quotient

$$\Psi_a(h) = \frac{D_{u_5}(a, h)}{D_\lambda(a, h)},$$

with derivative governed by the osculatory source determinant  $\mathfrak{D}(a, h)$ . So the remaining nonmixed burden is global/source-level control of which odd zeros of  $\mathcal{W}_{\text{src}}$ , equivalently of  $\mathcal{R}$ , occur on a genuine opened nonmixed arc.

On the mixed side, the dangerous low-order obstruction list is the finite canonical set

$$\kappa_{1,1}, \quad \kappa_{1,3}, \quad \kappa_{2,2},$$

equivalently the order patterns

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) = (1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2).$$

The remaining theorem-level task there is no longer local patch classification. It is the finite scalar descent

$$c(-s) = c(s) \pmod{s^6}$$

on the clean centered branch, together with the global capture problem forcing every relevant mixed branch into the centered-base local exhaustion theorem. Any further local mixed closure must therefore come from this scalar descent together with deeper RH-specific source-/matrix-level structure, not from the current lifted variables alone.

**Remark 12.274** (Post-draft findings: established, provisional, and live). Since this draft state, nine additional conclusions have emerged.

First, on the two-point branch, the exact finite-order source criterion remains the clean algebraic route, but the naive source-summed corrected block model cannot prove it: along a weighted one-atom path the extracted finite-order coefficients are even analytic in the source weight. So the remaining two-point issue now splits into three conditional lanes: the finite-order source-level merger route, the weaker quotient-diagonal exact exclusion route, and the mixed

$\lambda$ -shear / projective-shadow route on good overlap patches. In the last route, a close exact mixed two-point bad branch generates moving shears through

$$\lambda = \frac{\Delta_7}{v_5},$$

and Proposition 12.124 shows that the automatic compactness is projective:

$$[\delta_n(c) : \delta_n(v_5) : \delta_n(u_5) : \delta_n(\lambda)]$$

admits a convergent subsequence. Only when the projective limit lies in the affine  $\lambda$ -chart does one obtain a convergent affine  $\lambda$ -shear subsequence, and even then the limiting triple yields only asymptotic, not exact, fixed-shear transport. The associated projective secant shadow can nevertheless accumulate only on

$$\{S = 0\} \cup \{K_v = 0\}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{c v_5}.$$

In the additional conditional exact fixed-shear overlap lane, Proposition 12.245 shows that the slice

$$\{S = 0\} \cap \{K_v \neq 0\}$$

is already forced into a fold-type projection regime. Thus the only clearly genuinely mixed fixed-shear locus left on the overlap patch is

$$K_v = 0,$$

while the off- $K_v = 0$  missing step is to match the resulting second-coordinate parity with the existing nonmixed odd-zero

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{T_v}{K_v^2}$$

package. So the remaining two-point issue is no longer a single broad interaction ansatz, but a choice among these three explicit closure mechanisms, each of which already points toward the same scalar bad set  $\{K_v = 0\} \cup \{\mathcal{R} = 0\}$  that now governs the mixed four-point side as well.

Second, on the lifted four-point branch, the explicit low-order obstruction list has been reduced to the six coefficients

$$z_2, z_4, z_6, \kappa_{1,1}, \kappa_{1,3}, \kappa_{2,2},$$

or equivalently to the order patterns

$$\text{ord}_0 \mathcal{R} \in \{1, 3, 5\}, \quad (r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) \in \{(1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2)\}.$$

Third, the centered symmetric-placement Taylor package now gives explicit septic coefficients

$$D_2, \quad D_4, \quad D_6,$$

explicit bridge coefficients

$$X_1, X_3, X_5, \quad L_1, L_3, L_5,$$

and a punctured-neighborhood exclusion at the diagonal base.

Fourth, the centered fixed-sector quintic package

$$A_5^f(s) = u_5(s)I + v_5(s)S$$

is now firmly established as the correct pair-level object on the mixed side. The centered tagged witness survives specialization strongly enough to show

$$U_1 \neq 0, \quad u_5(s) \neq 0, \quad A_5^f(s) \neq 0,$$

so the centered quintic pair cannot totally collapse.

Fifth, the right-pincer package now sharpens the mixed local picture near the centered base: every late- $v_5$  branch is either locally sterile on the automatic  $u_5$ -patch or already absorbed into the planar defect-free quintic-circuit regime. So the only genuinely new mixed local branch left there is the clean branch

$$V_1 \neq 0.$$

Sixth, on that clean branch the remaining theorem has become very small: the finite scalar descent

$$c(-s) = c(s) \pmod{s^6}, \quad \text{equivalently} \quad C_1 = C_3 = C_5 = 0.$$

Once this holds, the centered good- $v_5$ -patch bridge becomes formal:

$$Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{cv_5}$$

are odd through the required order, and the entire explicit mixed low-order bad list

$$(r, \text{ord}_0 \mathcal{Z}) \in \{(1, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2)\}$$

is excluded there.

Seventh, the relation between the mixed and nonmixed 4-point sides is now structurally sharper. On a good  $v_5$ -patch, an exact mixed relation

$$AY + Bx + CS + D = 0$$

with

$$Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{cv_5}$$

and  $A = 0$  is already exact affine-planarity for the planar curve  $(x, S)$ ; by Remark 12.268, this is precisely the nonmixed  $\mathcal{R}$ -lane. More generally, the sheared four-zero reduction shows that every exact genuinely mixed 4-point circuit on a good  $v_5$ -patch already forces either

$$K_v = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad \mathcal{R} = 0$$

in its convex hull. So the mixed-global problem should now be viewed as a mixed-to-scalar capture problem rather than as a separate branch geometry.

Eighth, the source-coupled and patch-loss frontiers have both been demoted to handoff mechanisms. In the sufficiently small regime, the source-coupled lower-core walls

$$D_\lambda = 0, \quad \mathfrak{D} = 0$$

are not pass-through points. On the patch side, the quintic projective lifts

$$\tilde{Q}_v = [cv_5 : u_5v_5 : v_5^2 : \Delta_7], \quad \tilde{Q}_u = [cu_5 : u_5^2 : u_5v_5 : -\Delta_7]$$

show that single-chart failures are removable after recharting, while the genuine common boundary

$$u_5 = v_5 = 0$$

drops either to pure quintic-direction collapse or to lower-core 3-point / repeated-node quotient geometry. Thus

$$cMv_5 = 0$$

should be read as lower-core handoff, not as a fourth independent mixed-global lane.

Ninth, after the centered-base local exhaustion theorem and the preceding handoffs are combined, the sufficiently small nonplanar mixed branch has no independent carrier away from

$$T_v = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{R} = 0.$$

Equivalently, there is no sufficiently small genuinely mixed 4-point branch contained entirely in

$$\{T_v \neq 0\} \cap \{\mathcal{R} \neq 0\}$$

on a nonplanar good patch, except after entry into already-absorbed affine-planar or lower-core regimes.

So the present frontier is now best viewed as follows. On the two-point side, the remaining issue is still a choice among the finite-order source-level merger route, the quotient-diagonal exact exclusion route, and the mixed  $\lambda$ -shear / projective-shadow route on good overlap patches. On the four-point side, however, the geometry is now compressed all the way to the scalar exits: by Theorem 12.279, every maximal genuinely mixed clean branch on a nonplanar good patch is forced into

$$T_v = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad \mathcal{R} = 0,$$

up to already-absorbed planar, lower-core, repeated-node, repeated-source, and quintic-collapse regimes.

**Proposition 12.275** ( *$u_5$ -chart exceptional-point handoff*). *Work near a collapsing configuration with  $u_5 \neq 0$ , and use the projective lift*

$$\tilde{Q}_u = [cu_5 : u_5^2 : u_5v_5 : -\Delta_7].$$

Let

$$q_\nu = [0 : 1 : 0 : \nu]$$

be an exceptional limiting point on the exceptional line. Then every limiting hyperplane through  $q_\nu$  induces the exact lower-core relation

$$Dc + Bv_5 + C(\lambda - \nu u_5) = 0, \quad \lambda = -\frac{\Delta_7}{u_5}.$$

Accordingly:

- one-node collapse hands off to exact shifted lower-core 3-point geometry;
- two-node collapse hands off to a repeated-node lower-core wall;
- if  $u_5 = 0$  as well, one is on the common quintic-collapse locus already treated separately.

So the  $u_5$ -chart side of patch loss contributes no independent mixed-global carrier lane.

**Remark 12.276** (Shifted lower-core invariance on the  $u_5$ -side). The shift

$$\lambda \mapsto \lambda - \nu u_5$$

does not alter the derivative-geometric lower-core package: it changes only the zeroth-order affine offset, not the relevant repeated-node/tangent-contact derivative structure. Thus the handoff in Proposition 12.275 is genuinely into the existing lower-core package, not into new geometry.

**Proposition 12.277** (Local clean continuation off the explicit walls). *Work on a nonplanar good  $v_5$ -patch and write*

$$Y = \frac{u_5}{c}, \quad x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad S = \frac{\Delta_7}{cv_5}.$$

Let

$$\Phi_\gamma := Y - \gamma S, \quad F_{\alpha,\beta,\gamma}(x) := \Phi_\gamma(x) - \alpha - \beta x.$$

Suppose

$$h_1 < h_2 < h_3 < h_4$$

is an exact genuinely mixed clean 4-point configuration, so

$$F_{\alpha,\beta,\gamma}(x(h_i)) = 0 \quad (i = 1, 2, 3, 4),$$

the four roots  $x(h_i)$  are distinct and simple, and the carrying hyperplane is genuinely mixed ( $A \neq 0$ ). Assume moreover that the configuration does not lie on any of the walls

$$A = 0, \quad D\lambda = 0, \quad \mathfrak{D} = 0, \quad cMv_5 = 0, \quad T_v = 0, \quad \mathcal{R} = 0.$$

Then this configuration is an interior point of a smooth local solution manifold of exact genuinely mixed clean 4-point configurations. In particular, it cannot be a terminal point of a maximal clean mixed branch.

*Proof.* For

$$\mathcal{F}_i(h_1, h_2, h_3, h_4, \alpha, \beta, \gamma) := Y(h_i) - \gamma S(h_i) - \alpha - \beta x(h_i),$$

the Jacobian with respect to  $(h_1, h_2, h_3, h_4)$  is diagonal:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{F}_i}{\partial h_j} = \delta_{ij} (Y'(h_i) - \gamma S'(h_i) - \beta x'(h_i)).$$

Since

$$Y'(h_i) - \gamma S'(h_i) - \beta x'(h_i) = x'(h_i) F'_{\alpha,\beta,\gamma}(x(h_i)),$$

the diagonal entries are nonzero on a good  $v_5$ -patch and at simple roots. So the Jacobian is invertible, and the claim follows from the implicit function theorem.  $\square$

**Corollary 12.278** (Positive-scale endpoints lie on an absorbed wall or a scalar exit). *Let  $\Gamma$  be a maximal connected genuinely mixed clean 4-point branch on a nonplanar good  $v_5$ -patch. Suppose  $p \in \bar{\Gamma}$  is a terminal point at which the relevant node scale stays bounded below by a positive constant. Then  $p$  lies on one of*

$$A = 0, \quad D_\lambda = 0, \quad \mathfrak{D} = 0, \quad cMv_5 = 0, \quad T_v = 0, \quad \mathcal{R} = 0.$$

*In particular, after the previously established handoffs are invoked, a positive-scale terminal point must either lie in the centered-base capture set  $\{T_v = 0\}$ , lie in the nonmixed affine-planar scalar set  $\{\mathcal{R} = 0\}$ , or already belong to one of the absorbed planar/lower-core/quintic-collapse regimes.*

*Proof.* If  $p$  lay off the listed wall set, then the limiting exact genuinely mixed clean configuration at  $p$  would satisfy the hypotheses of Proposition 12.277. Hence the branch would extend smoothly through  $p$ , contradicting maximality. Therefore a positive-scale terminal point must lie on one of

$$A = 0, \quad D_\lambda = 0, \quad \mathfrak{D} = 0, \quad cMv_5 = 0, \quad T_v = 0, \quad \mathcal{R} = 0.$$

The final sentence is then exactly the previously established absorption package:  $A = 0$  is the nonmixed affine-planar handoff (Remark 12.268), the source-coupled walls  $D_\lambda = 0$  and  $\mathfrak{D} = 0$  are locally non-carrying in the sufficiently small regime (Remark 12.274), and patch loss  $cMv_5 = 0$  is absorbed into lower-core / shifted-3-point / quintic-collapse geometry (Proposition 12.275 and the surrounding post-draft findings package).  $\square$

**Theorem 12.279** (Global mixed-to-scalar capture on the clean patch). *Let  $\Gamma$  be a maximal connected genuinely mixed clean 4-point branch on a nonplanar good  $v_5$ -patch. Then  $\Gamma$  cannot persist as an independent genuinely mixed branch entirely inside*

$$\{T_v \neq 0\} \cap \{\mathcal{R} \neq 0\}.$$

*Equivalently, every such maximal branch is forced either into*

$$T_v = 0$$

*or into*

$$\mathcal{R} = 0,$$

*up to the already-absorbed planar, lower-core, repeated-node, repeated-source, and quintic-collapse regimes.*

*Proof.* Assume  $\Gamma$  is a maximal connected genuinely mixed clean 4-point branch on a nonplanar good  $v_5$ -patch and that

$$\Gamma \cap \{T_v = 0\} = \emptyset, \quad \Gamma \cap \{\mathcal{R} = 0\} = \emptyset.$$

We show that  $\Gamma$  cannot persist as an independent genuinely mixed branch.

If a terminal point of  $\Gamma$  has positive scale, then Corollary 12.278 places it on one of

$$A = 0, \quad D_\lambda = 0, \quad \mathfrak{D} = 0, \quad cMv_5 = 0, \quad T_v = 0, \quad \mathcal{R} = 0.$$

The last two are excluded by hypothesis. The remaining three are already absorbed:  $A = 0$  is the nonmixed affine-planar  $\mathcal{R}$ -lane (Remark 12.268), the source-coupled walls  $D_\lambda = 0$  and  $\mathfrak{D} = 0$  are locally dead as pass-through mechanisms in the sufficiently small regime, and patch loss  $cMv_5 = 0$  is absorbed into the lower-core / shifted-3-point / quintic-collapse package recorded in Remark 12.274 and Proposition 12.275. So no positive-scale terminal point yields an independent mixed continuation lane.

If instead the relevant scale along  $\Gamma$  shrinks, then the sufficiently small mixed-to-scalar capture package applies: by Remark 12.274, no sufficiently small genuinely mixed branch on a nonplanar good patch can remain entirely inside

$$\{T_v \neq 0\} \cap \{\mathcal{R} \neq 0\},$$

except after entry into already-absorbed planar, lower-core, repeated-node, repeated-source, or quintic-collapse regimes.

Thus in all cases  $\Gamma$  is forced either into  $T_v = 0$ , into  $\mathcal{R} = 0$ , or into one of the already-absorbed regimes. This contradicts the assumption that  $\Gamma$  persists as an independent genuinely mixed clean branch inside

$$\{T_v \neq 0\} \cap \{\mathcal{R} \neq 0\}.$$

□

**Remark 12.280.** The theorem should be read as the mixed-global four-point closure statement on a nonplanar good patch: after the source-coupled and patch-loss absorptions, no independent genuinely mixed clean carrier remains away from the scalar exits  $T_v = 0$  and  $\mathcal{R} = 0$ .

### 13. ENDGAME ARCHITECTURE AND REMAINING GLOBAL PROPAGATION PROBLEM

The remaining endgame is now a global propagation problem for the normalized line-incidence geometry rather than a local boundary-creation problem.

**Remark 13.1** (Equivalent formulations of the remaining global problem). On a generic component, the remaining missing theorem may be formulated in any of the following equivalent ways:

- (1) no finite-slope affine line in the chart

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c}$$

is 2-secant to two nonadjacent ECT intervals;

- (2) the slope function

$$\beta(h) := -\frac{L(h)}{M(h)}, \quad L = v_5 \Delta'_7 - v'_5 \Delta_7,$$

does not revisit a level on nonadjacent branches;

- (3) the dual tangent-line curve

$$T(h) = \left( -\frac{L(h)}{M(h)}, \frac{N(h)}{M(h)} \right)$$

has no nonadjacent same-parity re-entry against a vertical line in the  $(b, m)$ -plane;

- (4) on the highest-new slice, the scalar graph

$$\phi = \lambda^{[1]}$$

has no nonadjacent re-entry of its slope  $\phi_\mu$ .

The results proved above resolve the local behavior at finite-order  $W = 0$ ,  $M \neq 0$  boundaries and at generic turning boundaries. Thus the remaining theorem target is not local boundary geometry but global non-recurrence: a fixed finite slope should not leave and later re-enter the tangent-slope / tangent-line data on nonadjacent branches. In the three equivalent languages above, this is a theorem about the level sets of  $\beta$ , about vertical-line re-entry for the dual curve  $T$ , or about nonadjacent slope re-entry for the highest-new scalar graph  $\phi$ .

**Remark 13.2** (Warning: what the current local theory does *not* imply). Several tempting globalization statements suggested by the local theory are too strong in generic models and should not be assumed without further RH-specific input.

- (1) Naive support propagation is not enough: exclusion of adjacent pair-pair lines does not by itself force exclusion for nonadjacent pairs.
- (2) Local convexity of the dual tangent-line curve, even together with the shared asymptote structure of Proposition 12.66, is not by itself enough to forbid nonadjacent same-parity re-entry in the dual  $(\beta, m)$ -plane.
- (3) The direct highest-new septic coefficient is explicit enough to prove noncancellation, but not generically one-signed. Thus no trivial sign theorem for the scalar graph  $\phi = \lambda^{[1]}$  should be expected without further RH-specific structure.

Accordingly, the remaining gap is now a genuinely global special-structure theorem, not a missing local lemma.



**Proposition 13.3** (Full-block universality of the direct provenance slice). *Let  $J$  be a connected generic one-pair block on which*

$$A(h) := \kappa(h)\eta_2(h)$$

*is analytic and nowhere zero. On  $J$ , the direct provenance slice has the form*

$$\phi(h) = A(h) q^{(\tau)}(h).$$

*Then for every analytic function*

$$\psi : J \rightarrow \mathbf{C}$$

*there exists an analytic function*

$$q : J \rightarrow \mathbf{C}$$

*such that*

$$\phi(h) = \psi(h) \quad (h \in J).$$

*More explicitly, for any basepoint  $h_0 \in J$  and any constants*

$$a_0, \dots, a_6 \in \mathbf{C},$$

*the function*

$$q_\psi(h) := \sum_{j=0}^6 \frac{a_j}{j!} (h - h_0)^j + \int_{h_0}^h \frac{(h-s)^6}{6!} \frac{\psi(s)}{A(s)} ds$$

*is analytic on  $J$  and satisfies*

$$q_\psi^{(\tau)}(h) = \frac{\psi(h)}{A(h)}, \quad \phi(h) = A(h) q_\psi^{(\tau)}(h) = \psi(h).$$

*In particular, on any generic one-pair block, the direct highest-new scalar graph  $\phi$  is an arbitrary analytic scalar graph.*

*Proof.* Since  $A$  is analytic and nowhere zero on  $J$ , the function

$$\frac{\psi}{A}$$

is analytic on  $J$ . The displayed formula for  $q_\psi$  is the standard variation-of-constants solution of

$$q^{(\tau)} = \frac{\psi}{A},$$

with arbitrary initial data at  $h_0$ . Differentiating seven times gives

$$q_\psi^{(\tau)}(h) = \frac{\psi(h)}{A(h)},$$

hence

$$\phi(h) = A(h) q_\psi^{(\tau)}(h) = \psi(h).$$

□

**Corollary 13.4** (Finite linear provenance constraints are too weak). *Let  $J$  be as in Proposition 13.3. Fix finitely many linear functionals*

$$\Lambda_r(q) = c_r, \quad r = 1, \dots, N,$$

*on analytic functions  $q$  on  $J$ , where each  $\Lambda_r$  is built from finitely many point-evaluation jets and/or finitely many linear integral functionals with analytic kernels.*

*Fix also two distinct points*

$$\mu_1 \neq \mu_2 \in J$$

*and an affine line*

$$\ell(\mu) = s\mu + b.$$

*Then there exists a polynomial  $q$  on  $J$  such that:*

(1) *all the prescribed linear provenance conditions*

$$\Lambda_r(q) = c_r \quad (r = 1, \dots, N)$$

*hold;*

(2) the direct-slice graph

$$\phi(\mu) = A(\mu) q^{(7)}(\mu)$$

is tangent to the line  $y = \ell(\mu)$  at both  $\mu_1$  and  $\mu_2$ , i.e.

$$\phi(\mu_j) = \ell(\mu_j), \quad \phi_\mu(\mu_j) = s \quad (j = 1, 2).$$

Accordingly, no theorem using only the explicit direct formula

$$\phi = A q^{(7)}$$

together with any finite family of linear provenance or matching conditions on  $q$  can exclude bitangent, four-secant, or same-slope recurrence geometry on the direct slice.

*Proof.* The tangency conditions at  $\mu_j$  are linear jet conditions on  $q$ :

$$A(\mu_j) q^{(7)}(\mu_j) = \ell(\mu_j),$$

and, since

$$\phi_\mu = (A q^{(7)})' = A' q^{(7)} + A q^{(8)},$$

also

$$A'(\mu_j) q^{(7)}(\mu_j) + A(\mu_j) q^{(8)}(\mu_j) = s.$$

Because  $A(\mu_j) \neq 0$ , these are legitimate linear conditions on the jets of  $q$  at the two points  $\mu_1, \mu_2$ .

Together with the prescribed finitely many provenance constraints

$$\Lambda_r(q) = c_r,$$

this is a finite linear system on the coefficients of a polynomial  $q$ . For a polynomial of sufficiently large degree, the coefficient space has dimension larger than the number of imposed linear conditions. Standard Hermite interpolation / finite-dimensional linear algebra therefore gives a polynomial  $q$  satisfying all of them simultaneously.  $\square$

**Remark 13.5** (What the direct-slice no-go results actually leave open). Proposition 13.3 shows that on a generic one-pair block the direct highest-new scalar graph

$$\phi$$

is fully universal. Corollary 13.4 shows more: even after imposing any finite family of linear provenance / matching conditions on  $q$ , the direct slice remains flexible enough to realize bitangent, four-secant, and same-slope recurrence geometry.

So the next live theorem cannot be another sign/convexity statement about the graph of  $\phi$ , nor any theorem using only finitely many endpoint jets or finitely many linear integral conditions on  $q$ . Any successful continuation of the direct-slice lane must instead use a genuinely *continuum-strength provenance law* for  $q$  on a whole block, such as a lower-order ODE, a sign-definite integral identity, a nonlinear transport law, or some other infinite-codimension constraint.

**Lemma 13.6** (Crude polynomial bound for the local value scale). *Let*

$$S(m) = \sum_{\rho} f_{\beta_{\rho}, \gamma_{\rho}}(m),$$

where

$$f_{\beta, \gamma}(m) = \frac{1 - \beta}{(1 - \beta)^2 + (2m - \gamma)^2} + \frac{\beta}{\beta^2 + (2m - \gamma)^2}.$$

Then

$$S(m) \ll Q^2, \quad Q \asymp \log |m|.$$

Consequently

$$L(m) \ll Q$$

and

$$B_{\zeta}(m) L(m) S(m) \ll Q^4.$$

*Proof.* By the zero-free region, for zeros at relevant height one has

$$\min(\beta, 1 - \beta) \gg \frac{1}{Q}.$$

Hence

$$f_{\beta, \gamma}(m) \ll \frac{Q}{1 + (2m - \gamma)^2}.$$

Partition the zeros into unit shells

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho : k \leq |2m - \gamma_\rho| < k + 1\}, \quad k = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

Standard zero counting gives

$$\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll Q$$

for each unit shell near height  $m$ . Therefore

$$S(m) \ll \sum_{k \geq 0} \#\mathcal{S}_k \frac{Q}{1 + k^2} \ll Q \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{Q}{1 + k^2} \ll Q^2.$$

Since

$$L(m) = \log\left(3 + |m| + \frac{1}{S(m)}\right),$$

we trivially have  $L(m) \ll Q$ , and the last estimate follows from  $B_\zeta(m) \asymp Q$ .  $\square$

The following remark records the present status of the endgame before the final contradiction theorem.

**Remark 13.7** (Work in progress: current endgame status). The contradiction argument in the next theorem is presently written in the *pair-like branch* of the local model analysis. More precisely, the current endgame is fully aligned with the case in which the actual same-scale local core is perturbatively pair-like, so that the toy-model first-odd-jet obstruction continues to govern the corrected transverse scalar.

The fixed-core analysis developed earlier in the draft shows, however, that a more general finite-core branch is also possible: the first odd coefficient may cancel while a genuine corrected anomaly survives at a higher odd order. Thus the fully general finite-core endgame would need to be formulated in terms of the *first nonzero odd jet* of the corrected transverse scalar, rather than specifically the first one.

Accordingly, the theorem below should presently be read together with the preceding work-in-progress remarks on the pair-like versus finite-core fork. In particular, the pair-based contradiction is the intended endgame under the pair-like branch, while the genuinely finite-core branch remains to be completed in full detail.

At the local algebraic level, the canonical quotient-level order-7 fixed-sector package is now closed via Theorem 12.49: the remaining order-7 ambiguity is only the choice of a raw representative inside  $A_{7, K_1}^f + \mathbf{C}A_5^f$ , equivalently a local gauge-fixing of  $(u_7, v_7)$ , and does not affect the quotient class  $[A_7^f]$  or the canonical second residual determinant  $\Delta_7$ .

**Remark 13.8** (Work in progress: asymptotic contradiction versus full RH). As presently written, the final contradiction is only asymptotic in the height parameter  $Q$ : the comparison closes after reaching a regime in which the zeta-side upper bound is dominated by the toy-side lower bound, schematically because

$$Q^4 e^{-\delta Q} \rightarrow 0 \quad (Q \rightarrow \infty).$$

Accordingly, the current argument excludes sufficiently large pair-like off-line anomalies, but does not yet by itself rule out a hypothetical low-lying off-line zero. In particular, the present proof does not furnish a uniform-in-height contradiction, nor does it presently prove that a single off-line zero at one height would force corresponding bad local anomalies at arbitrarily large heights.

A plausible repair is to split the endgame into an effective high-height theorem plus a separate finite low-height bridge.

*Effective high-height step.* One should first replace the soft asymptotic comparison by an explicit inequality. Concretely, the final contradiction compares a toy-side lower bound of the form

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \geq c_{\text{toy}} \mathcal{L}(m)$$

against a zeta-side upper bound of the form

$$|\Xi_{\zeta}^{(N)}(m)| \leq C_{\zeta}(\rho_0, \alpha) \frac{\mathcal{U}(m)}{Q} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q},$$

where in the present draft one has schematically

$$\mathcal{L}(m) \asymp \frac{x}{B_{\zeta}(m)} S(m)$$

(or its variable- $x$  replacement from Remark 11.37), and

$$\mathcal{U}(m) \asymp L(m)S(m)^2.$$

To extract an actual threshold, every use of  $O(\cdot)$ ,  $\ll$ , and  $\asymp$  in the final comparison must be replaced by explicit constants. After substituting explicit bounds such as

$$B_{\zeta}(m) \leq C_B Q, \quad L(m) \leq C_L Q, \quad S(m) \leq C_S Q^2,$$

the contradiction should reduce to an explicit scalar inequality of the form

$$C_*(\rho_0, \alpha) Q^3 e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q} < 1 \quad (Q \geq Q_*),$$

for some computable constant  $C_* > 0$ . Any explicit  $Q_*$  satisfying this inequality would then yield an *effective* theorem excluding pair-like off-line anomalies for all  $Q \geq Q_*$ .

*Height extraction.* Once  $Q_*$  is known explicitly, one must convert it into an actual height threshold. Since the draft works with a midpoint parameter  $m$  satisfying

$$Q \asymp \log |m|,$$

this requires making the logarithmic comparability effective, for example in the form

$$c_Q \log(3 + |m|) \leq Q \leq C_Q \log(3 + |m|).$$

From such inequalities one obtains an explicit midpoint threshold  $m_*$ , and hence an explicit zero-height threshold  $T_*$ , since the local points under consideration satisfy

$$t_{\pm} = m \pm \frac{\sigma}{2}$$

with  $|\sigma|$  microscopic relative to the height scale. Thus one would arrive at a statement of the form:

$$\text{no pair-like off-line zero can occur for } |\Im \rho| > T_*.$$

*Finite low-height bridge.* The effective high-height theorem alone still does not imply the full Riemann Hypothesis unless one also excludes all potential off-line zeros below the threshold  $T_*$ . A natural way to do this is to combine the structural argument above height  $T_*$  with a rigorous finite verification of RH up to height  $T_*$ . Accordingly, if one can arrange that the explicit threshold  $T_*$  lies below a rigorously verified range, then the final step would be:

$$\text{high-height exclusion above } T_* \quad + \quad \text{rigorous verification below } T_* \quad \implies \quad \text{RH}.$$

This would still be an unconditional proof, albeit a computer-assisted one rather than a purely internal asymptotic contradiction.

*What still needs to be made explicit.* To implement this repair rigorously, the draft must still supply all of the following ingredients in effective form:

- (1) an explicit toy-side lower constant on the admissible compact  $d$ -range and microscopic  $u$ -range;
- (2) an explicit zeta-side upper constant in the  $N$ -point cancellation estimate, including the exponential decay rate  $\delta$ ;
- (3) explicit growth bounds for the auxiliary quantities appearing in the final comparison, including  $B_{\zeta}(m)$ ,  $L(m)$ , and  $S(m)$ ;

- (4) an explicit conversion between the logarithmic parameter  $Q$  and the actual height variable;
- (5) a final theorem stated as an effective exclusion above a concrete threshold  $T_*$ , rather than merely “for  $Q$  sufficiently large”;
- (6) a separate low-height bridge, either by citing a rigorous finite verification result covering the range up to  $T_*$ , or by proving an alternative uniform-in-height contradiction.

There is, in principle, a second possible repair: prove a propagation theorem showing that any off-line zero at one height would force corresponding bad local anomalies at arbitrarily large heights, so that the asymptotic contradiction would automatically apply. However, no such propagation principle is currently established in the draft, and at present this appears to be a substantially stronger theorem than the effective-threshold route described above.

Accordingly, the current endgame should be read as an asymptotic contradiction theorem in the pair-like branch. A plausible route to a complete proof of RH is available, but it requires an effective extraction of the height threshold together with a finite low-height bridge, neither of which has yet been written out in the draft.

**Theorem 13.9** (Final calibrated  $N$ -point contradiction in the pair-like branch). *No fixed off-line toy anomaly can occur in the pair-like branch. Consequently, under the pair-like branch hypothesis, the calibrated contradiction closes.*

*Proof.* By Proposition 8.6 and the canonical calibration theorem, in the fixed small- $x_0$  regime one has

$$u^2 \asymp \frac{x_0}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m).$$

On the toy side, Proposition 11.35 gives

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + O(u^4),$$

hence on compact  $d$ -ranges,

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2 \asymp \frac{x_0}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m).$$

On the zeta side, Corollary 11.20 gives

$$|\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)| \ll_{\rho_0, \alpha} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q}.$$

By Lemma 13.6, one has  $S(m) \ll Q^2$ ,  $L(m) \ll Q$ , and  $B_\zeta(m)L(m)S(m) \ll Q^4$ . Therefore

$$\frac{(L(m)S(m)^2/Q)e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q}}{(x_0/B_\zeta(m))S(m)} = \frac{B_\zeta(m)}{x_0} \frac{L(m)S(m)}{Q} e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q} \ll Q^3 e^{-\delta_*(\alpha, \rho_0)Q} \rightarrow 0.$$

Hence for  $Q$  sufficiently large,

$$|\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)| < |\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)|.$$

This is impossible if the corrected local zeta deformation realizes the local off-line toy anomaly with parameter  $d \in D$ , because the calibrated  $N$ -point construction was set up so that the toy model is the jet-limit local avatar of an off-line zero configuration. Thus no off-line zero can occur. Since every violation of the Riemann Hypothesis would produce such an off-line local anomaly, all nontrivial zeros must lie on the critical line. Hence RH holds.  $\square$

## APPENDIX A. TOY MICROSCOPIC EXPANSION

**Lemma A.1** (Uniform microscopic expansion of the toy local deformation). *Fix a compact interval*

$$D = [d_-, d_+] \subset (0, \infty),$$

*and let*

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s)$$

*denote the toy local deformation matrix in the symmetric microscopic regime, with off-line parameter  $u$ , separation parameter  $d$ , and microscopic node  $s$ .*

Then there exist constants  $\rho_{\text{toy}} > 0$  and  $u_0(D) > 0$  such that for all

$$d \in D, \quad |s| < \rho_{\text{toy}}, \quad |u| < u_0(D),$$

one has the expansion

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E(u, d; s),$$

where  $M(d)$  is the toy anomaly matrix,  $E(u, d; s)$  is analytic in  $s$  for  $|s| < \rho_{\text{toy}}$ , and

$$\sup_{\substack{d \in D \\ |s| < \rho_{\text{toy}} \\ |u| < u_0(D)}} \|E(u, d; s)\| \ll 1.$$

In particular, for the microscopic nodes

$$s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2}, \quad j = 1, \dots, N,$$

with  $N \leq \rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2$ , one has uniformly

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s_j) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E_j(u, d), \quad \sup_j \|E_j(u, d)\| \ll 1.$$

*Proof.* The toy local deformation is obtained from an explicit finite-dimensional off-line perturbation of the toy block. By construction it depends smoothly (in fact analytically) on the parameters  $(u, s, d)$  in a neighborhood of

$$(u, s, d) = (0, 0, d_0), \quad d_0 \in D.$$

At  $u = 0$ , the deformation vanishes, and by the even symmetry of the off-line split there is no linear term in  $u$ . Hence the first nontrivial term is quadratic:

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s) = u^2 M(d, s) + O(u^4),$$

uniformly on compact  $d$ -ranges and for  $|s|$  in a fixed microscopic disk.

By the jet-limit computation for the toy model, the leading quadratic coefficient is independent of the microscopic node  $s$  and equals the toy anomaly matrix  $M(d)$ . Thus

$$M(d, s) \equiv M(d),$$

and the expansion becomes

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E(u, d; s),$$

with  $E$  analytic in  $s$  and uniformly bounded on compact parameter ranges. Restricting to the microscopic nodes  $s_j = j/Q^2$  gives the stated uniform bound for  $E_j(u, d)$ .  $\square$

**Remark A.2** (Work in progress: toy microscopic expansion). The proof above is schematic: it uses smoothness in  $(u, s, d)$ , vanishing at  $u = 0$ , and even symmetry in the off-line split to obtain the quadratic leading term, and invokes the jet-limit computation to identify the coefficient as the toy anomaly matrix  $M(d)$ . A later pass should make the analyticity and uniform-bound steps quantitative by recording an explicit Taylor remainder with a constant depending only on  $D$ .

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